



RESEARCH REPORT

5,000+ HOURS OF RESEARCH | 20+ SUB-SEGMENTS | 170+ COMPANIES

MAY 2026

Author's Note

India's digital landscape is evolving rapidly, shaped by multiple interconnected sectors and structural shifts.

To navigate this report effectively, it may be useful to view it as a strategic map of this landscape. Given the depth of our 5,000-hour research effort, readers can optimise their time by engaging with it in a structured manner.

The report begins with the Evolution of the Global Tech Ecosystem to understand the 'North Star' for digital innovation. It then moves to India's Tech Evolution to see how the country has adapted global models into its unique framework. These sections provide the first principles needed to interpret the sector-specific data that follows.

Building on this foundation, the report is categorised into 20+ sub-segments. Rather than approaching it linearly, the landscape can also be viewed through specific clusters based on areas of interest:



The consumption engine:

High-velocity sectors like e-commerce, quick commerce, food delivery, and ad-tech.



Logistics and infrastructure:

The backbone of the digital economy, covering new-age logistics, prop-tech, co-working spaces, and clean-tech.



Emerging frontiers:

Specialised niches such as agri-tech, ed-tech, auto-tech, mobility, and enterprise tech.



Entertainment and access:

Consumer-facing segments including media, gaming, online classifieds, and online ticketing.

For each sub-segment, we provide SWOT profiles and market sizing. Since 170+ companies are featured, most of which are private, these profiles are designed to help identify the market movers as well as the under-the-radar players likely to disrupt their respective categories.

Alongside this, the report highlights regulatory catalysts and government triggers within each section. In India's new-age tech space, policy shifts often act as primary inflection points that can either compress the adoption curve or create structural moats.

For a quicker view, readers may also refer to the SWOT analysis summaries available in each deep dive to grasp the key signals before engaging with the granular data.

We hope this report serves as a definitive compass for navigating India's digital frontier, helping separate the signal from the noise and supporting informed strategic decisions.



11 May 2026

India | Equity Research | Sector Thematic

Internet

Decoding New-Age Tech in India – Where we are, where we will be, who are leading the way?

At a time marked by geopolitical tensions and uncertainties around the potential fallout of AI-led disruption, we have decided to get back to the basics. This thematic report seeks to address fundamental investor imperatives such as market sizing, and features SWOT analyses of 20 sub-segments in India's 'New-Age Tech' space, along with profiles of ~170 prominent companies. We have refrained from making stock recommendations; instead, this report is the culmination of over 5,000 man-hours of primary and secondary research, including more than 10 expert interviews. Our objective is to understand the nuances of each sub-segment and the potential government triggers that could support or impede growth. Given that most of these companies are still private, we have used the latest available public data.

The global context: Where we stand on the global digital map?

While the US has evolved rapidly as a global leader over the last 6–7 decades, we identify a recurring trend underlying the transition into newer technologies. First, building blocks are established through the creation of hardware and infrastructure; then, software is developed to optimise these capabilities; and finally, products and services are built on top to solve real-world problems. In the previous generation's products and services segment, Chinese companies largely caught up with their US counterparts, despite a much later start. India has similarly narrowed the gap, now trailing China by about a decade—a significant reduction from the 20-year lag seen in the early 2010s. This progress was facilitated by private investments in democratising data and government investments in digital infrastructure, such as UPI and ONDC.

In the AI era, we anticipate an even faster catch-up. China remains only 12–18 months behind the US in software resources, despite constraints in computing power. In India, the government has backed a sovereign AI platform, Sarvam AI, while private companies have pledged over USD 200bn toward Indian AI infrastructure over the next decade. Although this remains a fraction of the ~USD 700bn in US AI infrastructure investments scheduled for CY26, the lag is significantly smaller than that in previous generations.

Can India catch up faster?

India is at an inflection point that is structurally analogous to China's 2006–12 discretionary spending boom—when per capita income doubled and retail sales growth accelerated from ~11% to ~18%. India's GDP per capita now sits in the same income band that triggered China's digital consumption take-off. India now has ~970mn internet subscribers, highest mobile data consumption per user globally and UPI-powering 15–20bn transactions per month. India's digital public infrastructure (UPI, DigiLocker, ONDC) creates a structurally lower-friction environment for new entrants, compressing the adoption curve. The recent spate of FTAs signed by the government as the developed world looks to diversify supply chains should aid this trend, in our view.

Key learnings for investors

Despite relentless evolution and valuation swings, the Nasdaq Composite has outpaced the S&P 500 in every decade but the 2000s—a period flatlined only by the dot-com collapse. Consequently, we view exposure to New-Age Tech as an alpha-generating imperative. While staying invested is the foundation, the ultimate prize lies in identifying the generational outliers: the IBMs of the 60s, the Ciscos of the 90s, the Apples of the 2000s, and the Nvidias of today.

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Executive Summary

Global tech evolution – where does India stand?

While the US has dominated the tech landscape for decades, a sequential blueprint has emerged: hardware lays the foundation, software optimises the architecture, and services solve real-world problems.

In the PC era, the US held a multi-decade lead before Chinese and Korean smartphones players helped democratise computing. Yet, while US operating systems remain the global gold standard, China narrowed the gap in services to a mere decade. India followed suit, trailing China by ten years—a catch-up fuelled by private data access and state-backed digital infrastructure like UPI and ONDC.

In the AI race, this time-lag is evaporating. China is now just 12–18 months behind the US in software, despite hardware constraints. Meanwhile, India is closing the distance at an unprecedented pace. With the government-backed Sarvam AI providing a full-stack sovereign platform and domestic titans like Reliance and Adani pledging over USD 200bn in infrastructure, India no longer appears to be a laggard.

Though the US remains the heavyweight spender, with USD 700bn slated for CY26, India's current deficit is now materially lower than before.

Exhibit 1: Key companies in first and second-gen tech evolution in US, China and India

	First Gen			Second Gen		
	Hardware/Infra	Software Resources	Products	Hardware/Infra	Software Resources	Products
	   	  	   	   	   	   
	   	 	   	 	  	   
	 		    			 

Source: I-Sec research

India could be at an inflection point

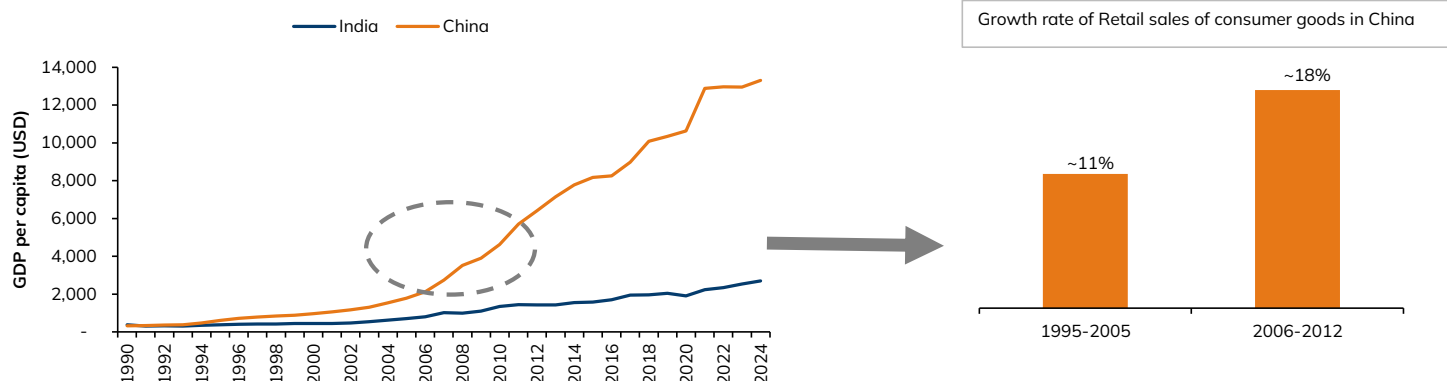
India is at a major turning point, mirroring China's spending boom between 2006 and 2012. During that time, China's per capita income doubled and retail sales growth jumped from 11% to 18%.

Today, India's GDP per capita has reached the same critical level that sparked China's digital consumption surge. The foundation is already in place with:

- 970mn internet subscribers.
- The world's highest mobile data usage per person.
- A UPI payment system handling 15–20bn transactions every month.

India's unique digital infrastructure—including UPI, DigiLocker, and ONDC—makes it much easier and cheaper for new businesses to enter the market. This setup is expected to speed up how quickly people adopt new digital services.

Exhibit 2: Between 2006–12, China's GDP per capita almost doubled, retail sales saw strong growth of ~18% (vs ~11% period before); India is now in the same income band that saw China's take-off



Sources: Statista, I-Sec Research

Global context: Lessons from US, China, Korea and Indonesia

Major technology markets have followed a recurring pattern:

Hardware → Software → Products

India is building across all three layers in parallel, with first-gen companies (Flipkart, Zomato, Zoho) and emerging second-gen AI-native models (Sarvam.AI, Bhashini).

Exhibit 3: Lessons from US, China, Korea and Indonesia

Country	Defining phase	Market leader	Key parallel for India
USA (1990s)	Internet boom — software and OS	Cisco ~250x, Microsoft ~21x	Digital infra buildout; India's UPI is its 'internet backbone'
USA (2010s)	Mobile and Cloud	Nvidia ~33x, Netflix ~21x	Mobile-first adoption; India already leads in mobile data consumption
China (2006–12)	Super-app and consumer boom	Alibaba, Tencent 50–100x+	India at same GDP/capita inflection
Indonesia	Super-app logistics integration	GoTo Group ~USD 3.7bn mkt cap	Focus on tier-2/3 city penetration
South Korea	AI Sovereignty	LG, Samsung, Naver, SK Telecom outperform	India's AI ambition; Sarvam.AI, other LLMs emerging

Source: I-Sec research, Bloomberg

Key learnings for investors

Despite the continuous evolution in US' tech space and the apparent swing in valuations of tech companies, the Nasdaq Composite has outperformed the broader S&P500 in every decade, except the 2000s (when it was flat) due to the dot-com bust.

Therefore, we believe staying invested in the new-age tech space is essential for creating alpha. The cherry on top would be to identify and own rockstars such as IBM in the 60s/70s, or Cisco in the 90s, or Apple in the 2000s, or Nvidia post 2010.

Exhibit 4: Summary of US' tech evolution and returns of leading companies in each phase

Period	Focus	Leader	Leader return	Nasdaq composite return
1960s-1980s	Hardware	IBM	~18x	~5x
1990s	Software	Cisco, Microsoft	~250x, 21x	~7x
2000s	Crash & Consumer Pivot	Apple, Amazon	Apple → 43x, Amazon → 12x	Flat
2010s	Cloud/Mobile	Nvidia, Netflix	Nvidia → 34x, Netflix → 22x	~5x
2020-25	AI/Compute	Nvidia	~14x	~1.8x

Source: I-Sec research, Bloomberg

Below are the market sizes and key nuances of the sub-segments in the New-Age Tech space we have analysed in this note.

Exhibit 5: Key sectors and market size

Sector	Current market size in India – GOV/GMV (USD bn)	Revenue (USD bn)*	Key insights/opportunities
E-Commerce	70	16	India's e-commerce market shows significant growth potential because its shopper base (250–270 million in FY25) is less than half of its smartphone user population and lags far behind the penetration rates of mature and other emerging economies.
B2B E-commerce	45	11**	Indian B2B market is one of the largest and the fastest growing globally, and is expected to be USD 2.5trn by 2030, as per our estimates. Digital penetration currently in B2B commerce is still under 2%, indicating massive headroom for scalable digital-first platforms.
QComm	6.2	1.1	Quick-commerce has become a fast-growing channel in organised retail and has grown 100% YoY from USD 6.2bn in FY25 to ~USD 11-12bn in FY26E.
Food Delivery	9	2	Online food delivery has emerged as a meaningful sub-segment within India's food services industry, accounting for ~12% of total food services and ~25% of the organised segment as of FY25.
Travel-tech	21	2	Growth in online travel is led by hotel bookings and bus ticketing, which have low penetration.
Mobility	22	1.5	Rapido disrupting Uber-Ola duopoly; subscription model replacing commissions.
Ed-tech	NA	10	Transitioning from a period of rapid, pandemic-induced growth to a more sustainable, outcome-focused model; GenAI-powered personalisation gaining momentum.
Prop-tech	NA	1.5	Diversification imperative: Pure-play model is generally less profitable without adjacent revenues.
Co-working space	NA	0.7	Co-working space forms a meaningful share of overall Grade-A office leasing driven by GCC-led demand.
Online Ticketing	3.8	0.7	While movies and large concerts remain the core revenue contributors, seasonal festivals and curated IP-based events are expanding the monetizable base.
Online Classifieds - Recruitment	NA	0.5	Naukri.com, owned by Info Edge, dominates the organised online recruitment classifieds space.
Online Classifieds - Matrimony	NA	0.1	The market structure is oligopolistic, with Matrimony.com (BharatMatrimony), Shaadi.com, and Jeevansathi.com accounting for the majority of online market share.
New-age logistics	NA	2	The sector has seen disruption as many 3PL players relied heavily on Meesho for volume. The resulting profitability pressures have led to exits and distress among smaller players. This trend is driving consolidation, as seen in Delhivery's acquisition of Ecom Express.
Gaming	1.2	1.2	The industry is shifting towards in-app purchases, and the average revenue per paying user is increasing.

Source: I-Sec research, IBEF,

*Take rate

**Combination of inventory and platform models

Exhibit 6: Sector landscape & opportunity sizing

E-Commerce USD 70bn GMV 20–25% CAGR → USD 174–214bn by FY30 Shopper base <50% of smartphone users; tier-2/3 cities key driver	B2B E-Commerce USD 45bn TAM <2% digital penetration → USD 2.5trn market by FY30 Biggest structural whitespace; full-stack procurement platforms emerging	Food Delivery USD 9bn (FY25) 17–23% CAGR → USD 20–26bn by FY30 Zomato + Swiggy ~85% share; take rate stabilising at ~25%
Quick Commerce USD 6.2bn Hypergrowth Quick-commerce has become a fast-growing channel in organised retail and has grown 100% YoY from USD 6.2bn in FY25 to ~USD 11-12bn in FY26E	Travel-tech USD 21bn ~16% CAGR Air; Hotels & buses — rising digital adoption	Media / OTT USD 11bn rev Digital ad: 15–16% CAGR → 600mn OTT users Digital overtakes TV; CTV crossing 50mn households
Ed-tech USD 10bn rev (CY25) ~25% CAGR → USD 29bn by CY30 AI enabling 1:150 teacher ratios; unit economics improving	New-age logistics USD 2bn rev (FY25) We expect improved pricing discipline and a shift in focus from volume growth to profitability	Mobility USD 22bn ~19% CAGR Move towards subscription model disrupting commissions

Source: I-Sec research

Key insights for major sectors in New-Age Tech in India

- E-commerce:** India's e-commerce industry is experiencing rapid growth, with its market size valued at USD 70bn in FY25 and projected to reach USD 174bn-214bn by FY30, driven by a 20-25% CAGR (Source: Redseer report). Fuelled by increased smartphone penetration, affordable internet, and UPI adoption, the sector is expected to see strong growth, with tier-2/3 cities accelerating this expansion.
- Auto-tech:** The automotive industry has undergone a structural shift from offline to digital discovery, with 92% of new car buyers and 85% of used car buyers now beginning their purchase journey online — a dramatic rise from just 20–30% five years ago. While discovery has gone digital, fulfilment remains hybrid/phygital, still relying on dealer ecosystems for final transactions. The used-to-new car sales ratio has surged to 1.4x (up from <1x five years ago) and is expected to hit a 1.7:1 ratio within the next 4–5 years, growing at a ~10% CAGR, as per our channel checks. Used car market size currently stands at ~USD 34bn (FY25) and is expected to reach ~USD 70bn by FY30, expanding at a ~15% CAGR.
- Media/OTT:** India's M&E sector reached ~USD 26bn in CY24, with digital media overtaking television as the largest segment. OTT audiences have grown to ~600mn users, advertising is increasingly digital-first (55% share), and traditional media continues to decline, while online gaming and live events are showing strong momentum.
- Clean-tech:** India has ~250GW of renewable energy capacity as of FY26 and aims to reach 500GW by 2030, with solar power leading the charge, after a 42x surge in installed capacity since 2014. The EV market sold 2.3mn units in 2025, dominated by 2Ws and 3Ws, with battery demand projected to grow 14x by 2032, as per our channel checks.
- Mobility:** India's ride-hailing market is valued at ~USD 22bn (FY25) and is growing at ~19% CAGR, with Uber, Rapido, and Ola competing across 2W, 3W, and 4W segments. The industry has structurally shifted from commission-based to subscription-based revenue models, while bike taxis are the fastest-growing segment driven by last-mile demand in tier-2/3 cities.
- Prop-tech:** India's prop-tech market spans four stages - discovery, transaction, financing, and post-sale services - with total online Prop-tech revenue estimated at ~USD 1.5bn. Some players struggle with profitability due to thin margins, heavy reliance on real estate cycles, and competition from Google/Meta for ad budgets, and companies are seen diversifying into adjacent services like loans and interiors.
- Ed-tech:** India's Ed-tech sector, valued at ~USD 10bn in CY25, is projected to expand at ~25% CAGR to reach USD 29bn by CY30, as per our channel checks. The market spans four key segments – K-12, test preparation, upskilling, and online certification – with AI integration now enabling personalisation and teacher-to-student ratios of as high as 1:150, fundamentally improving unit economics.
- Online Ticketing:** India's online entertainment ticketing market is growing at ~15–20% annually, driven by rising experience-led consumption, strong live event supply, and increasing digital penetration. While movies and large concerts remain the core revenue contributors, seasonal festivals and curated IP-based events are expanding the monetisable base. Core ticketing margins remain healthy (~20–25% EBITDA); though, live events are more volatile and sponsorship-dependent. Competition is intensifying with players like District, but BookMyShow retains strong brand and promoter relationships. Medium-term growth visibility remains strong, contingent on content pipeline, infrastructure development, and regulatory simplification.

- Travel-tech:** India's Travel-tech sector is a multi-vertical ecosystem spanning air, rail, buses and hotels, with growth increasingly driven by online penetration rather than pure volume expansion. Air is a mature, high-base segment with stable but margin-sensitive economics, while buses and hotels offer stronger structural upside due to rising digital adoption and higher take rates. Rail remains highly penetrated online but constrained by supply and regulatory reliance on IRCTC. Profitability dynamics are improving, particularly in hotels, as discount intensity moderates and ancillary attach rates expand. Competitive intensity remains high, especially in hotels, but top players retain scale advantages and cross-sell leverage. Overall, the sector's growth outlook is structurally positive, though supply constraints in aviation and regulatory asymmetry in rail remain key risks.
- Co-working space:** India's flexible workspace sector has moved from a niche startup-focused model to a mainstream office solution used by large enterprises and GCCs. It now forms a meaningful share of overall Grade-A office leasing, reflecting structural adoption rather than temporary demand. Growth is supported by India's services-led economy and steady macro momentum. Companies are increasingly adopting a 'Core + Flex' strategy, making flexible offices a permanent part of their real estate planning. While the business is capital-intensive and sensitive to occupancy levels, scaled operators demonstrate healthy margins and operating leverage. Overall, the sector offers long-term growth visibility within India's evolving commercial real estate ecosystem.
- Gaming:** The Indian gaming sector has undergone a sharp structural reset after the RMG ban, shrinking from a ~USD 6bn industry to nearly USD 1bn. Earlier growth was heavily driven by real money gaming, but today the market is led mainly by PUBG, Free Fire, and eSports formats. Monetisation has shifted toward in-app purchases, ads, and experimental models like audio rooms, though revenue quality remains lower than pre-ban levels. A significant portion of former RMG demand appears to have moved offshore via crypto routes. Growth in the current ecosystem is concentrated and moderate, largely dependent on a few large titles. The long-term outlook hinges on regulatory clarity and whether RMG returns under strict guardrails.
- Food delivery:** India's food services industry expanded at ~9% CAGR (FY20–25) to ~INR 7trn (~USD 79bn), with the organised segment now at 48% share and projected to reach 63% by FY30P, as per our estimates. Online food delivery has consolidated into a duopoly - Zomato and Swiggy command ~85% market share - with the segment growing from USD 3bn (FY20) to USD 9bn (FY25) and expected to reach USD 20–26bn by FY30P at a 17–23% CAGR. The next growth phase will likely be driven by tier-2+ city expansion, rising ordering frequency among power users (50+ orders/year), and monetisation diversification into advertising and platform fees as take rates stabilise around ~25%.
- Quick commerce:** India's quick-commerce sector has evolved rapidly from traditional e-commerce to a hyperlocal, dark store-driven model, with the overall e-commerce market at USD 70bn and projected to reach USD 174bn-214bn by FY30 (Source: Redseer report). Dark stores — micro-warehouses spanning 3,000–8,000sq.ft. — now form the backbone of the ecosystem, with leading platforms expanding to 100+ tier-2/3 cities, and average dark store density stands at ~50sq.ft. per 1,000 people nationwide. The sector is transitioning from aggressive expansion to scale consolidation, with improving unit economics driven by higher order density, growing non-grocery category mix, and retail media monetisation; online grocery penetration currently at ~2% (FY25) provides a long runway toward a projected 6–7% by FY30, as per our estimates.

- **New-age logistics:** The sector has seen disruption as many 3PL players relied heavily on Meesho for volume. The resulting profitability pressures have led to exits and distress among smaller players. This trend is driving consolidation, as seen in Delhivery's acquisition of Ecom Express, which will likely increase its market share to 47–50%. As competition thins out, we expect improved pricing discipline and a shift in focus from volume growth to profitability.
- **Ad-tech:** India total ad market is USD 16–18bn; Digital ad market accounts for 50–60% of total Indian ad market valued at USD 8–10bn. It stands out as one of the fastest growing digital advertising markets globally. Our channel checks with agencies and advertisers suggest digital ad spends will likely grow at ~15–16% CAGR over CY24–29E, with penetration rising from ~55–60% currently (USD 8–10bn) to ~68–70% by 2029 (USD 27–29bn).
- **B2B e-commerce:** Indian B2B market is one of the largest and the fastest growing globally and is estimated to be USD 2.5trn by 2030E, as per our estimates. Digital penetration today in B2B commerce is still under 2%, indicating massive headroom for scalable digital-first platforms. The TAM for the B2B e-commerce segment as of FY25 is ~USD 40–45bn by our estimates. Just as B2C evolved from unstructured marketplaces to integrated platforms, B2B is expected to move from listing-based models to full-stack procurement ecosystems with embedded credit, tech-enabled fulfilment, and category expansion.
- **SaaS:** India's total technology spending is estimated at ~USD 160bn annually. Although India's IT spending as a percentage of GDP remains below developed markets, it is expanding rapidly due to digitisation across BFSI, telecom, retail, startups, and government initiatives such as India Stack and UPI. Within total tech spends, India's domestic enterprise SaaS spends remains at USD 3bn annually (2% of total Indian IT spends). In CY25, Indian-origin SaaS companies generated ~USD 20–25bn in global revenue, reflecting a strong export-led orientation.
- **Agri-tech:** India's agriculture sector remains one of the largest in the world, contributing ~15–18% to GDP and supporting over 45% of the workforce. The total agricultural ecosystem in India covering inputs, outputs, and credit facilities. Agri-tech is attempting to digitise this fragmented and inefficient value chain, although online penetration remains very low across most segments.

Exhibit 7: Top potential policy pathways

Sector	Recommendations	Further details
E-commerce	Providing further clarification on the FDI framework would establish distinct boundaries between inventory and marketplace models, effectively minimizing regulatory ambiguity and fostering a more predictable investment environment.	Click
Hyperlocal -Food delivery + QC	Clear, balanced and uniform gig worker regulation across states to ensure common market dynamics.	Click
New-age logistics	Scaling of PM Gati Shakti's digital layer (spatial planning + unified cargo data) and creating interoperable freight-data standards so rail/port/road/air manifests and tracking can be stitched together.	Click
Mobility	Considering scale up of white-plate (private) vehicles to augment supply cliff in the mobility space over the next 3-4 years. A Standardized Digital Permit system that allows private vehicle owners to opt into shared mobility without the friction of commercial registration would aid affordable mobility growth through better utilisation of vehicles.	Click
Auto-tech	Standardised EV battery certification and used-car condition benchmarking could reduce information asymmetry and unlock financing.	Click
Ed-tech	Rationalization of GST on Ed-tech services (currently 18%) could improve affordability	Click
Media	Replacing of fragmented rules with an integrated National M&E Policy that covers TV, OTT, and digital under a 'same content, same rules' logic.	Click
Prop-tech	Standardised digital architectures and open APIs to enable interoperability across different property management systems and public agencies.	Click
Clean-tech	With only ~1% of Li-ion batteries currently recycled, India would benefit immensely from a framework with binding targets, collection infrastructure funding, and incentives for secondary material recovery – creating a circular supply chain for battery materials	Click
Ad-tech	Clear, operational privacy rules and implementation guidance (DPDP rollout support).	Click
Travel-tech	Continued rationalisation, clarity in tax slabs and input tax credit (on capex) could further encourage formalisation and digital bookings.	Click
Agri-tech	Startups operating across states face compliance fragmentation and local approval delays. A national unified licensing framework, digital approvals, and portability of licenses across states would significantly reduce friction.	Click
Gaming	E-sports guidelines with clarity on how prize money should be structured, and how organizers can earn through sponsorships and broadcasting.	Click

Source: I-Sec Research

Chapter 1: Evolution of global tech ecosystems

Global leader: US tech – evolving from mainframes to AI

The US technology sector has undergone a profound structural shift in the last 3-4 decades, with its weight in S&P 500 now reaching 36-40% (~5% in early 1990s and ~30% by end of the decade)-a level of concentration not seen since the 1960s. This dominance is currently anchored by the 'Magnificent Seven' whose collective market capitalisation stands at USD 20trn+ (as of Feb'26).

Exhibit 8: Market cap of the 'Magnificent Seven' companies in US

Company	Market cap (USD trn) (as on 31 Mar'26)	Core dominance
Nvidia	~4.2	AI Hardware and Compute
Apple	~3.7	Consumer Ecosystem
Alphabet	~3.5	Search and AI Infrastructure
Microsoft	~2.8	Enterprise Software and Cloud
Amazon	~2.2	E-commerce and Cloud
Meta	~1.4	Social Media and Metaverse
Tesla	~1.4	EVs and Autonomous AI

Source: Bloomberg, I-Sec research

Exhibit 9: Key evolution in US tech – from hardware (IBM/Intel) --> software (Microsoft/Oracle) --> ecosystems (Apple/Google) --> intelligence (OpenAI/Nvidia)

VALUE CREATION STAGES



1960s-80s

Mainframes & Microchips

Hardware: IBM, Intel



1990s

Software & OS

Microsoft, Oracle



2000s-2010s

Connected Ecosystems

Consumer & Cloud



2020s-Present

AI Intelligence Era

Nvidia, Open AI

Source: I-Sec research

However, underlying this transition into newer technologies, there is a recurring trend. First, the building blocks are laid through creation of hardware/ infrastructure, then software is created to optimise the newer capabilities, then products and services are built on top of these to solve real world problems.

Understanding the US evolution in detail

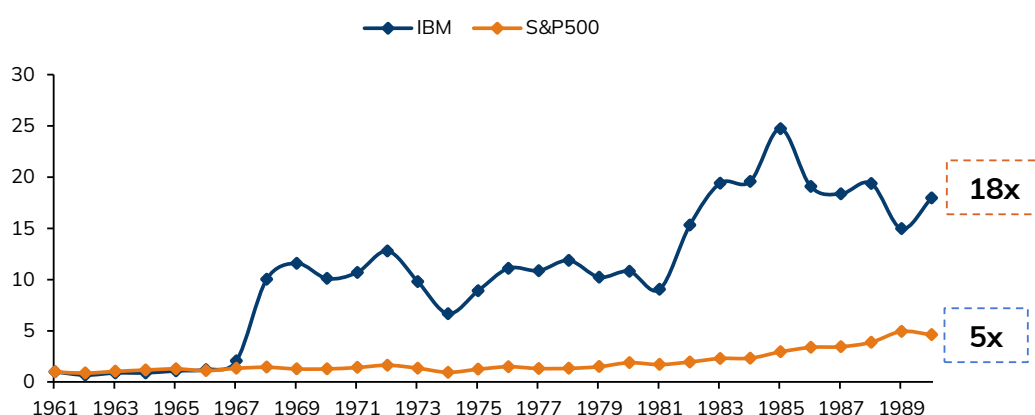
1960s–80s: Mainframes and microchips

Main theme: Scale down form factor, scale up performance

The era shifted from room-sized machines to desktop PCs. IBM dominated corporate data processing with the System/360, while Intel's 4004 chip (1971) pioneered programmable processing.

Top performers: IBM (from 1960-1990, it beat S&P500 by 3x) as it became the world's most valuable company. IBM's stock value then plummeted and continued to underperform the broader market through the majority of the 1980s. Still, patient investors would have made more money holding it through the cycle than buying the index).

Exhibit 10: Performance of IBM stock vs. S&P 500 index (prices in 1960 = 1)



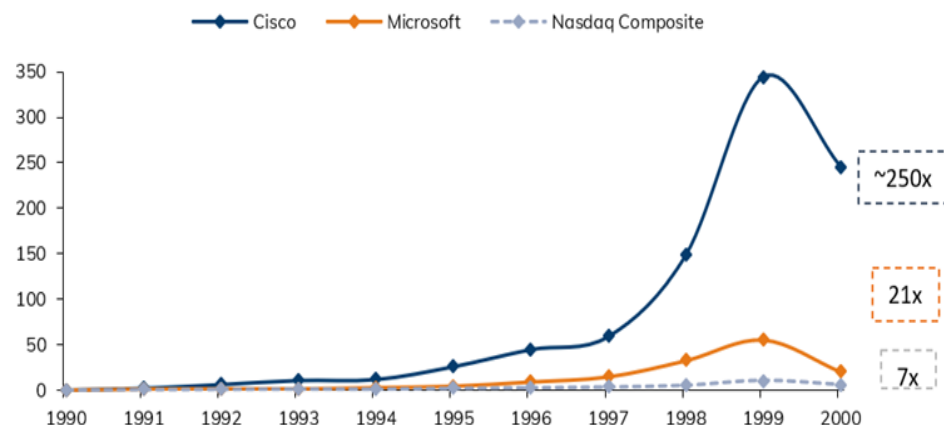
Source: Bloomberg, Macrotrends, I-Sec Research

1990s: The internet boom

The focus shifted from "calculating" to "connecting." Web browsers like Netscape gave the internet a face, while Amazon and eBay birthed e-commerce. Internet-based companies in the US saw a rapid rise in equity valuations during this period. The NASDAQ grew 5x from 1995 to 2000.

Top performer: Cisco for building the internet's "pipes," followed by Microsoft via Windows dominance.

Exhibit 11: Performance of Cisco and Microsoft's stocks vs. Nasdaq Composite index (prices in 1990 = 1)



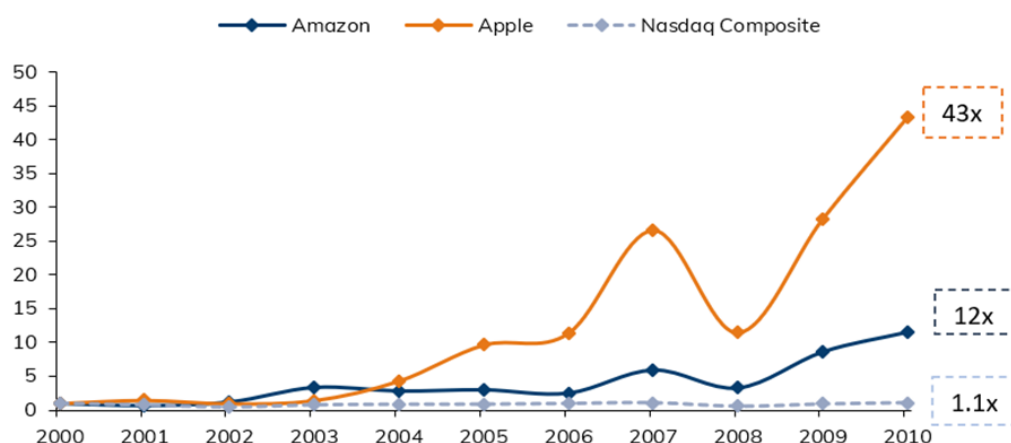
Source: I-Sec research, Bloomberg

2000s: Crash and consumer pivot

After the dot-com bubble burst, winners survived by focusing on consumer tech. Google (IPO 2004) mastered data, and Apple pivoted to lifestyle tech with the iPod and iPhone.

Top performers: Amazon and Apple

Exhibit 12: Performance of Amazon and Apple's stocks vs. Nasdaq Composite index (prices in 2000 = 1)



Source: I-Sec research, Bloomberg

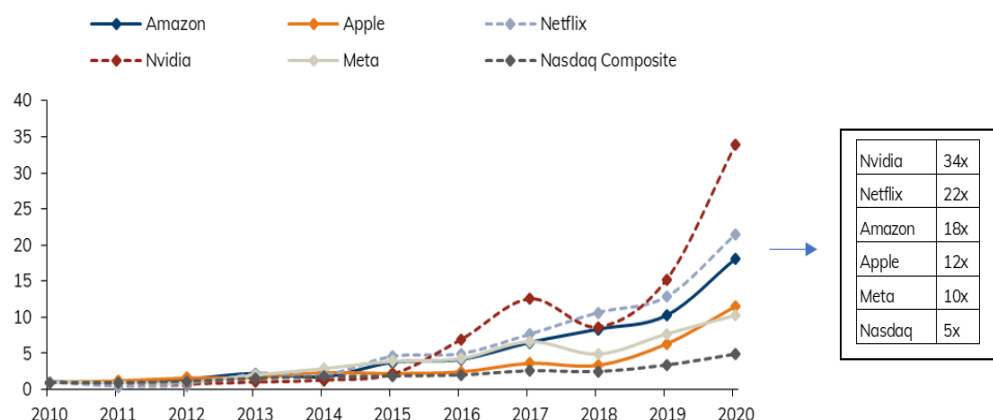
2010s: Mobile and cloud

The smartphone replaced the PC as the primary device. AWS allowed startups (Uber, Airbnb) to scale instantly, while 'social media' began to dominate the advertising landscape.

Top performers

- Nvidia: 34x, driven by GPUs for gaming and AI innovation
- Netflix: 22x, leading streaming media
- Amazon: 18x, fuelled by e-commerce and AWS
- Meta: 10x (post-2012 IPO), driven by social media and advertising
- Even the index (Nasdaq composite)- grew 5x in 10 years

Exhibit 13: Top performing tech stocks in the 2010–20 period vs. Nasdaq Composite index (prices in 2010 = 1)



Source: I-Sec research, Bloomberg

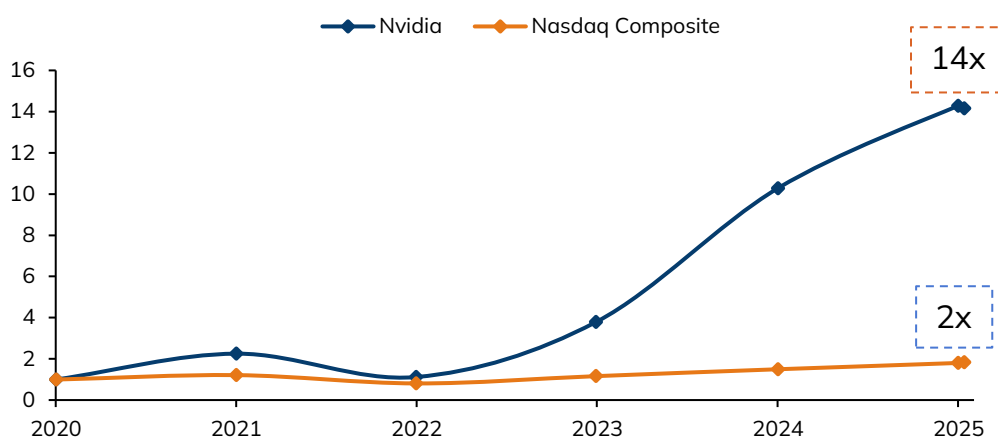
2020s: AI and semiconductors

There is a shift from "tools we use" to "systems that think." Generative AI and Green Tech are the new frontiers, fuelled by a massive hardware super cycle.

- Key drivers: The 2022 ChatGPT moment. By 2025, the focus shifted to Physical AI—integrating intelligence into robotics and energy-efficient data centres.

Top performers: Nvidia (~14x since 2020), becoming the first USD 4trn company in late 2025. Microsoft (~1.5x) remains a leader through AI integration.

Exhibit 14: Nvidia share price vs. Nasdaq Composite index (prices in 2020 = 1)



Source: I-Sec Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 15: Summary of US' tech evolution and returns of leading companies in each phase

Period	Focus	Leader	Leader Return	Nasdaq Composite Return
1960s-1980s	Hardware	IBM	~18x	~5x
1990s	Software	Cisco, Microsoft	~250x, 21x	~7x
2000s	Crash and Consumer Pivot	Apple, Amazon	Apple → 43x, Amazon → 12x	Flat
2010s	Cloud/Mobile	Nvidia, Netflix	Nvidia → 34x, Netflix → 22x	~5x
2020-25	AI/Compute	Nvidia	~14x	~1.8x

Source: I-Sec research, Bloomberg

China tech: The super-app ecosystem

Key evolution: Copy-cat era --> integration (WeChat/Alipay) --> hyper-efficiency/social commerce (Pinduoduo/TikTok)

China has seen a rapid transition from localizing western concepts to creating a world-leading, hyper-integrated digital infrastructure. Its development is segmented into three distinct phases followed by a recent strategic pivot.

Phase 1: The copy-cat era

- Early Chinese tech companies mirrored successful western models, adapting them for the local market.
- Platforms like Baidu (Google), Alibaba (eBay/Amazon), and Tencent (ICQ/AOL) leveraged China's massive population and less competitive landscape to build local dominance.
- These firms learned from western innovation and localized it, establishing the first generation of Chinese internet giants.

Phase 2: Integration and rise of the super-app

- This phase marked a significant divergence from the West. Instead of fragmented apps, core services were integrated into single platforms.
- These apps achieved a level of daily integration unmatched in the West. Key companies in this phase:
 - WeChat (Tencent): Evolved from a simple messaging app into a colossal ecosystem offering mobile payments, social media, gaming, and "mini-programs".
 - Alipay (Ant Group): Expanded from a payment platform into a lifestyle super-app for insurance, utility payments and credit scoring.

Phase 3: Hyper-efficiency and social commerce

- A focus on optimizing the user journey and leveraging social dynamics for commerce
- Key companies
 - Pinduoduo: Perfected social commerce and group buying, challenging incumbents with a consumer-to-manufacturer (C2M) model.
 - TikTok/Douyin (ByteDance): Revolutionized content consumption via AI-driven recommendation engines and seamless e-commerce integration.

Current status and the Hard-tech pivot

The environment for Chinese tech has shifted dramatically due to regulatory changes and geopolitical tensions, prompting a national move toward self-sufficiency

- Consumer tech constraints: Stringent regulatory crackdowns on data privacy, anti-monopoly practices, and the addictive nature of apps have constrained the growth of traditional internet giants.
- The Hard-tech pivot: China is now aggressively directing investment into strategically important Hard-tech sectors – semiconductors, EVs, AI infrastructure, and advanced manufacturing.
- Companies like Huawei and BYD have become global leaders, showcasing China's focus on engineering-intensive industries.

Tech evolution in Indonesia

Indonesia is a key country in Southeast Asia's digital economy, accounting for ~40% of the region's GMV. Its evolution has seen leapfrogging of legacy systems through mobile-first 'Super-Apps'.

Indonesia's tech evolution can be broadly seen over three periods:

1. The foundational marketplace era (2009–14)

- Focus: Bridging the geographical fragmentation of an archipelagic nation.
- Key Companies: The birth of Tokopedia (2009) and Bukalapak (2010). These marketplaces established the first "digital trust layer," allowing small merchants across 17,000 islands to access a national customer base.
- Established the physical and digital logistics foundation for e-commerce.

2. The super-app and logistics integration (2015–20)

- Hyper-local service integration to solve the last-mile problem.
- Key companies: Gojek transformed from a motorbike hailing service into a 'super-app' eventually merging with Tokopedia in 2021 to form GoTo Group. This entity alone contributed ~2% to Indonesia's GDP at its peak.
- Tech became a daily utility (payments, food, transport)

3. The AI pivot (2021–26)

- Sustainable unit economics and 'Hard-tech' industrialisation.
- **Key companies:** 2025 marks the era of AI implementation, highlighted by Microsoft's USD 1.7bn investment in Indonesian cloud and AI infrastructure.
- **Outcome:** Emergence of sector-specific unicorns like eFishery (agri-tech), signalling a move from pure consumer apps toward B2B efficiency.

Exhibit 16: Major technology leaders in Indonesia and their valuations

Company	Sector	Est. Valuation / Status	Highlight
GoTo Group	Super-app	~USD 3.7bn (Market Cap)	Turned adjusted EBITDA positive in 2025.
Traveloka	Travel-tech	~USD 2.8bn - USD3.0bn	Dominant regional player; benefited from the travel rebound.
Akulaku	Fin-tech	~USD 2bn	Heavily backed by MUFG; leader in digital banking/credit.
eFishery	Agri-tech	~USD 1.4bn	World's first aquaculture unicorn; focused on food security.
Xendit	Payments	~USD 1bn	The "Stripe of SE Asia"; building regional payment rails.

Source: I-Sec research, Company data, Media sources

South Korea tech – from hardware to AI

While US followed a software-led trajectory, South Korea's evolution is deeply rooted in its manufacturing prowess. South Korea's economic journey mirrors a fast-paced technology transition — from an agrarian economy in 1950 to a world-class semiconductor and consumer electronics powerhouse in under 50 years, driven by chaebol-led industrial policy and export-oriented growth.

Today, Korea stands at its third inflection point — moving from hardware manufacturer to platform operator and, increasingly, becoming an AI sovereign.

The 4 phases of Korean tech leadership

- **Industrial foundation (1960s–80s):** Rise of the Chaebols (Samsung, LG, Hyundai) focusing on heavy industry and electronics.
- Revenues of the top six conglomerates — Hyundai, Samsung, Lucky Goldstar (LG), Daewoo, Sunkyung (SK) and Ssangyong — totalled KRW 400bn in 1973; by 1980, their combined revenues soared to ~KRW 15trn.
- **Memory and display dominance (1990s–2010s):** Global leadership in semiconductors (SK Hynix, Samsung Electronics), providing the hardware backbone for the world's mobile revolution.
- **Platform and super-app era (2010s–20s):** Domestic giants like Naver (Search/AI) and Kakao (Messaging/Fintech) created closed-loop digital ecosystems that resisted global dominance by US players.
- **AI sovereignty (2025–present):** A state-guided pivot to Full Stack AI, characterised by a KRW 100trn (~USD 67bn) public-private investment fund and the development of homegrown LLMs.

Exhibit 17: What Korea's journey signals for India

Korean Precedent	Period	Market Leader	India Analog Today
Broadband-led internet boom	1999–04	NHN / Kakao	Jio-led data penetration; Zomato, Meesho inflection
Super-app consolidation	2010–15	Kakao	Tata Digital, Jio Platforms attempting same
Semiconductor AI super cycle	2016–21	SK Hynix, Samsung	India fab buildout; TCS/Infosys AI services layer
K-content global distribution	2019–24	CJ ENM, Kakao Ent	Jio Studios, Eros Now, regional OTT IP
AI sovereign LLM buildout	2023–present	Naver	Sarvam.AI, IIT-led LLMs; 2–3 year lag

Source: I-Sec research

Chapter 2: Tech evolution in India

The institutional foundation (1950s–80s)

In the early decades, the focus was on self-reliance and creating a scientific base. The government established elite educational and research institutions to solve national problems like food security (The Green Revolution) and satellite communication.

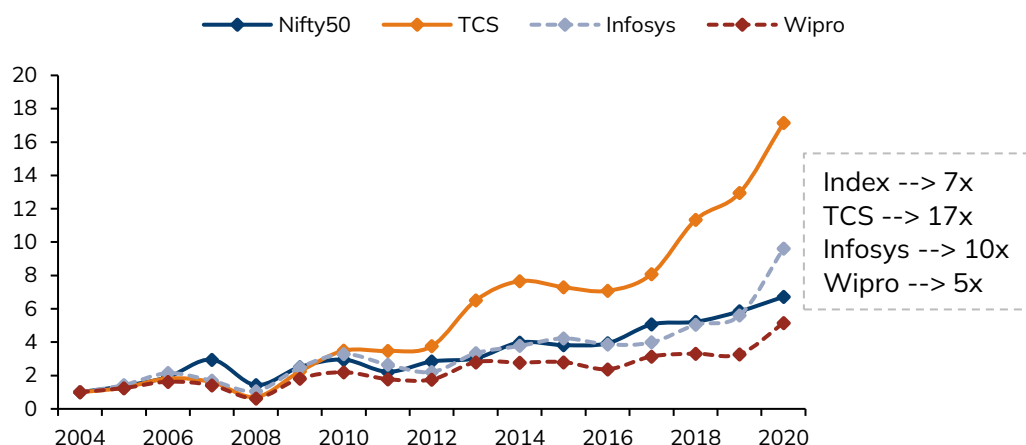
- **Key milestones:** Establishment of IITs, CSIR, and ISRO.
- **Leading entities**
 - ECIL (Electronics Corporation of India): Early attempts at indigenous computer manufacturing.
 - ISRO: Spearheading the space program (Aryabhata satellite, 1975)

The global delivery model (1990s–2010s)

The Indian IT story began with companies like TCS, Infosys, Wipro and HCL pioneering software services for global clients. India's strengths like English-speaking talent, time-zone advantages, and lower costs made it the go-to destination for outsourcing and transformed the nation into a global hub for IT services and BPO.

- **Key milestones:** The 1991 Reforms; the dot-com boom; the rise of BPO (Business Process Outsourcing).
- **Leading companies**
 - The 'Big Three': TCS, Infosys and Wipro.
 - Genpact: Pioneered the BPO/ITES (IT Enabled Services) sector.
 - Satyam: Until its 2009 crisis, was a major pillar of this era

Exhibit 18: Performance of TCS, Infosys and Wipro share prices over 2004–20 (prices in 2004 =1)



Source: Bloomberg, I-Sec Research

Rise of engineering and R&D centres (mid-2000s–mid-2010s)

Companies increasingly began offshoring higher-value functions like product engineering, R&D, and testing.

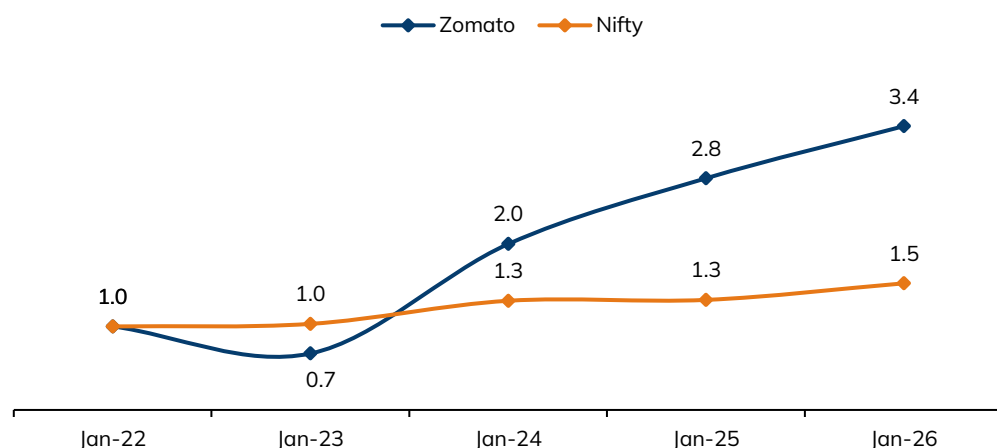
- Establishment of captive centres for critical functions (e.g., Intel, Cisco, Microsoft).
- Start of IP creation and design ownership in India.
- Leadership roles and architect-level talent began emerging locally.

India's New-Age Tech journey (mid-2010s to present)

The New-Age Tech space has evolved very rapidly over the last decade. From a handful of early-stage ventures, now it ranks third globally with over 200k+ DPIIT-registered startups, spanning a wide range of sectors. The ecosystem has seen 120+ unicorns and ~150 soonicorns, fuelled by PE/ VC capital and policy push.

Affordable data plans, particularly after the entry of new operators, and widespread smartphone availability led to a mobile data boom. India has become the world's top consumer of mobile data per user.

Exhibit 19: Zomato's share price performance vs. Nifty over last 5 years (prices in 2022 = 1)



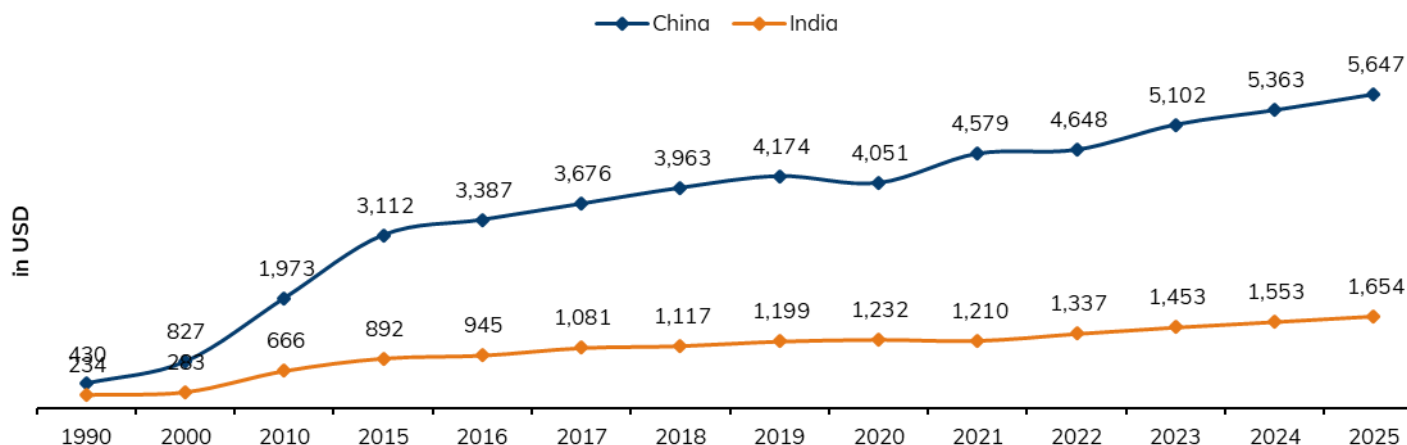
Source: Bloomberg, I-Sec research

There is a strong growth potential in India led by:

- internet penetration levels still below that of major global economies
- low consumer expenditure per capita compared to peers

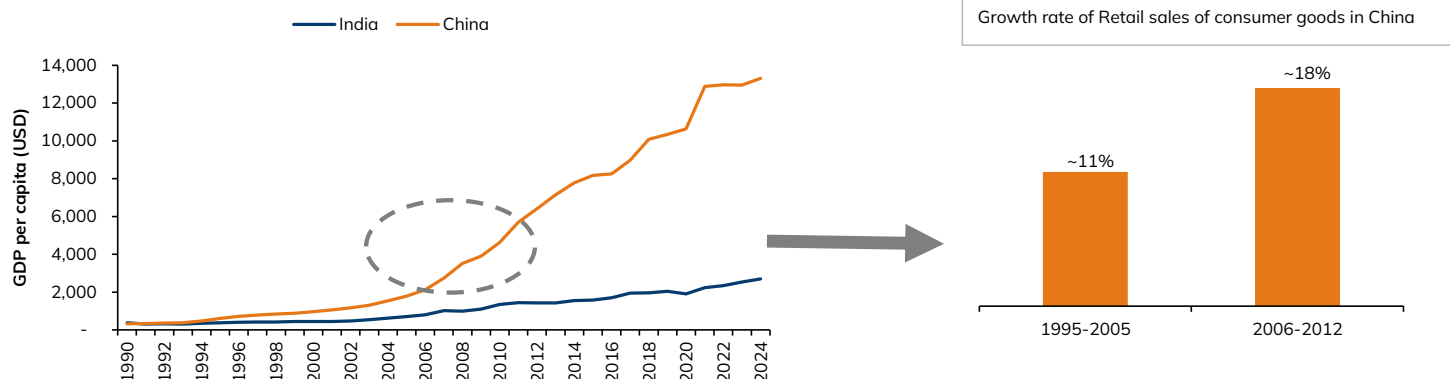
The China example: Between 2006–12, China experienced a massive surge in discretionary spending, driven by rapidly rising incomes and a doubling of per capita income – from 2006 (~USD 6k) to 2012 (~USD 11.5k).

Exhibit 20: Consumer expenditure per capita (USD) in China is 3.5x compared to India



Source: Statista, I-Sec research

Exhibit 21: China's GDP per capita almost doubled, from 2006–12 and retail sales saw strong growth of ~18% in that period (vs. ~11% in the period before); India is now in the same income band that saw China's take-off



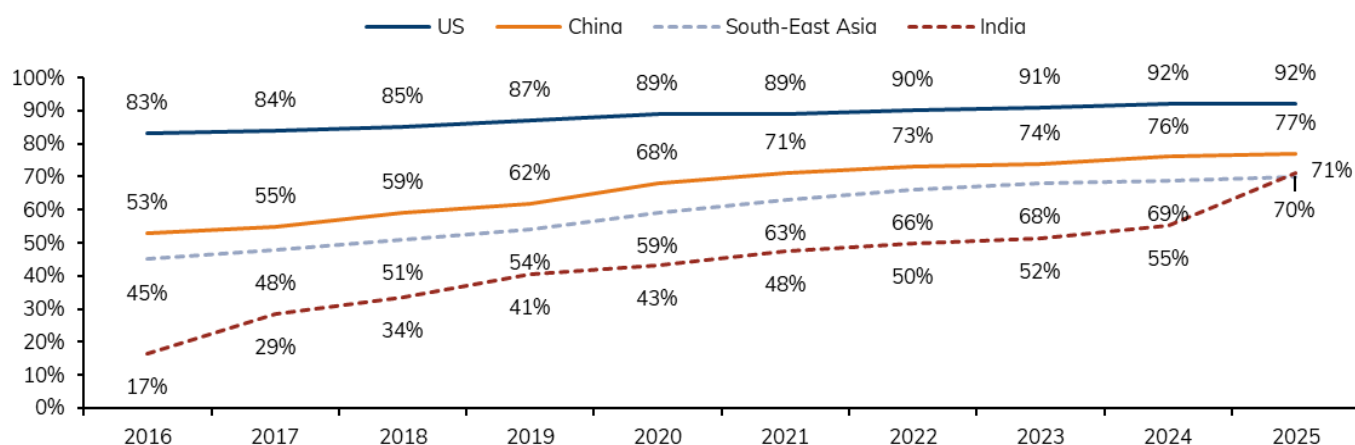
Sources: Statista, I-Sec Research

Exhibit 22: Strong growth in the mid to high-income bands in India expected to drive consumption growth

	2014	2018	2025 (Est.)	2030 (Proj.)
Total Population	1.2bn	1.3bn	1.5bn	1.5bn
Income: > INR 3mn	1%	3%	5%	10%
Income INR 1.5mn-3mn	7%	21%	35%	46%
Income INR 0.2mn-1.5mn	23%	33%	48%	38%
Income < INR 0.2mn	69%	43%	12%	6%
Discretionary Income (USD)	~1,300	~1,800	~2,500	~4,000

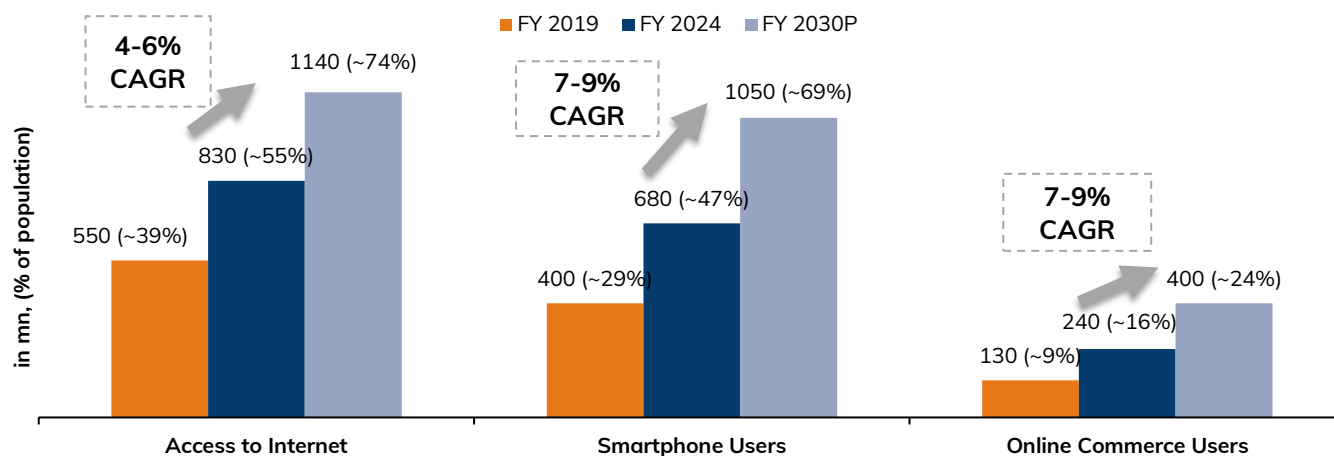
Source: Kantar, I-Sec Research

Exhibit 23: Internet penetration in India vs. US, China and Southeast Asia region; India has seen strong growth over the past decade



Source: I-Sec research, Statista

Exhibit 24: Growth in internet penetration in India should boost number of online commerce users to ~400mn by FY30



Source: Redseer, I-Sec research

Exhibit 25: Key companies in first and second-gen tech evolution in US, China and India

	First Gen			Second Gen		
	Hardware/Infra	Software Resources	Products	Hardware/Infra	Software Resources	Products

Source: I-Sec research

A set of open APIs and digital public goods provides the infra for the digital economy in India:

- **Payments layer (UPI):** UPI unbundled banking. It allowed any app (like Google Pay, PhonePe, or a small bank's app) to connect with any other app. In 2026, UPI handles 15bn–20bn transactions a month, making India a world leader in real-time retail payments.
- **Paperless/data layer (DigiLocker and e-KYC):** Digitises documents (driver's licenses, degrees, tax records). This moved India from a 'high-trust, high-friction' paper society to a 'low-friction' digital one, allowing for instant bank account opening and mobile connections.
- **Commerce layer (ONDC):** Uses open protocols to democratise e-commerce and reduce platform monopolies.

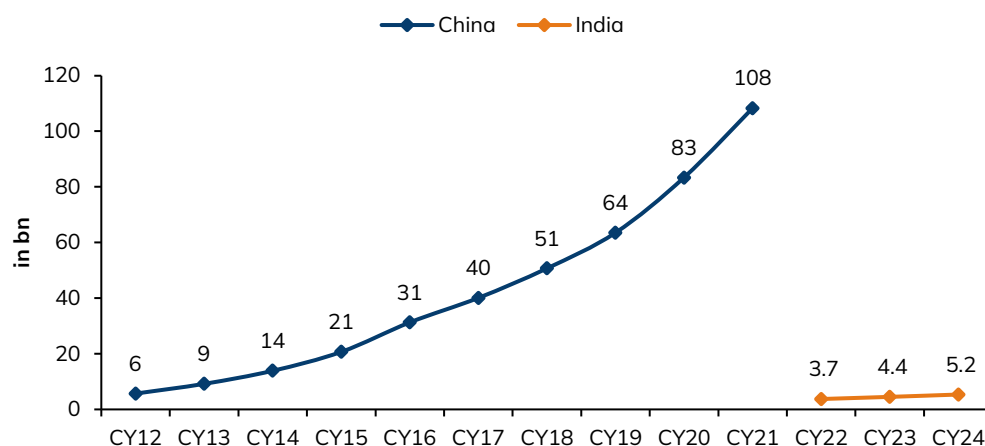
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Chapter 3: Key segments in New-Age Tech in India – India vs. global markets

E-commerce

China and US are neck-and-neck in e-commerce sales, but China remains the undisputed leader in sheer delivery scale. India is rapidly narrowing the gap, boasting a massive base of 600mn users and a surge in daily shipment volumes.

Exhibit 26: Express delivery volumes in India vs. China (in bn shipments)



Source: Statista, I-Sec research

While shipments in India are increasing at a fast pace, they are lagging by ~14 years vs. shipment volumes in China.

Travel-tech

The US leads the Travel-tech industry in both revenue and transaction scale, followed by China.

Travel and tourism market revenue (2024)

US: USD 218bn; China: USD 154bn; and India: USD 23bn

Transaction volumes

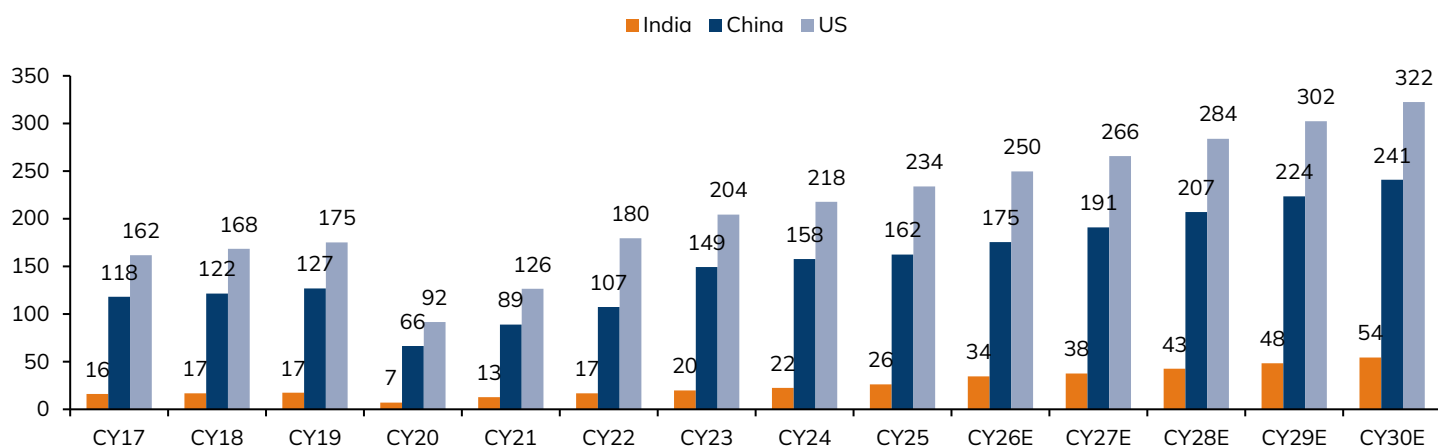
- India: In 2022, out of 1.7bn trips taken, 99% were domestic and just 1% international
- China: In 2024, ~82% of business trips were domestic, with 18% international
- US: In 2024, ~97% of all trips were domestic, and 3% were international

Market scale and monetisation

US and China dominate the global travel app market revenue, but India leads in download volume (Indian apps make up 15% of global downloads; Chinese 10%). However, monetisation lags significantly in India and China—US and Europe account for 78% of global travel app revenues.

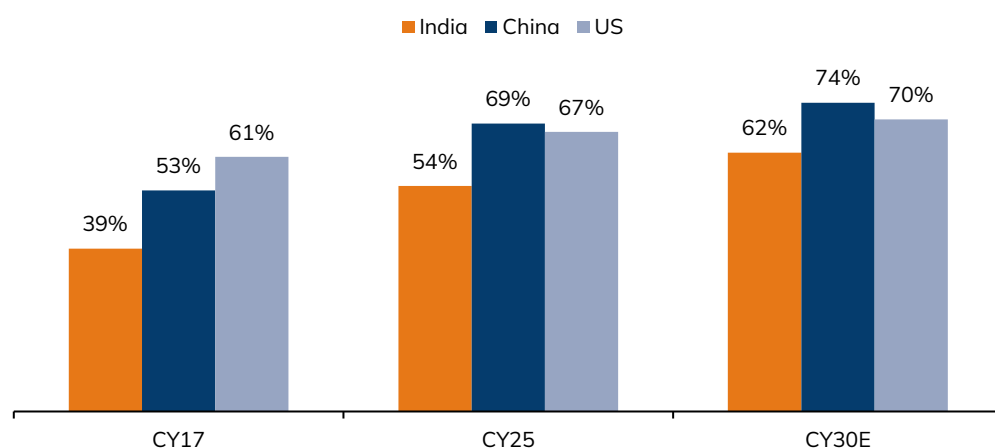
OTA segment

In India, MakeMyTrip leads with USD 783mn operating revenue (FY24); other OTAs record significantly lower revenues.

Exhibit 27: Revenue in the travel and tourism market across India, China and US (in USD bn) from CY17–30P

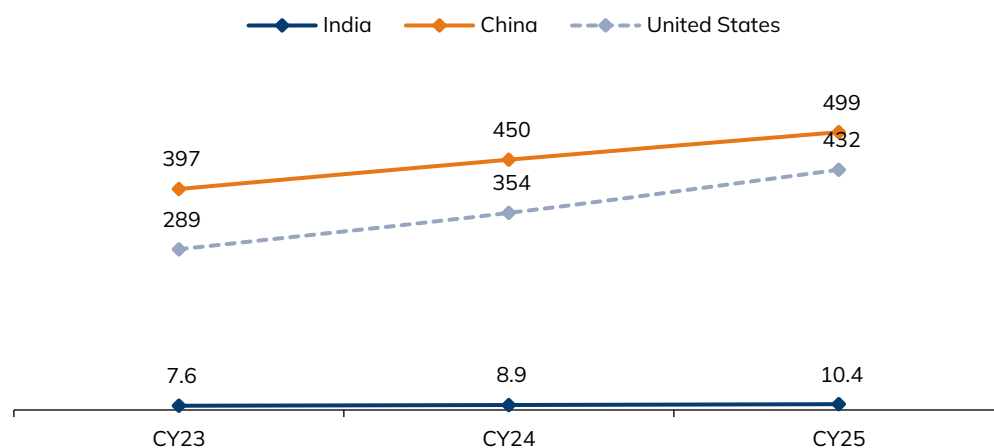
Source: Statista

Revenue includes package holidays, hotel accommodations, private vacation rentals, camping experiences, and cruises

Exhibit 28: Share of online sales in India at 54% in CY25 is similar to that of China in CY17

Source: Statista, I-Sec research

Hyperlocal

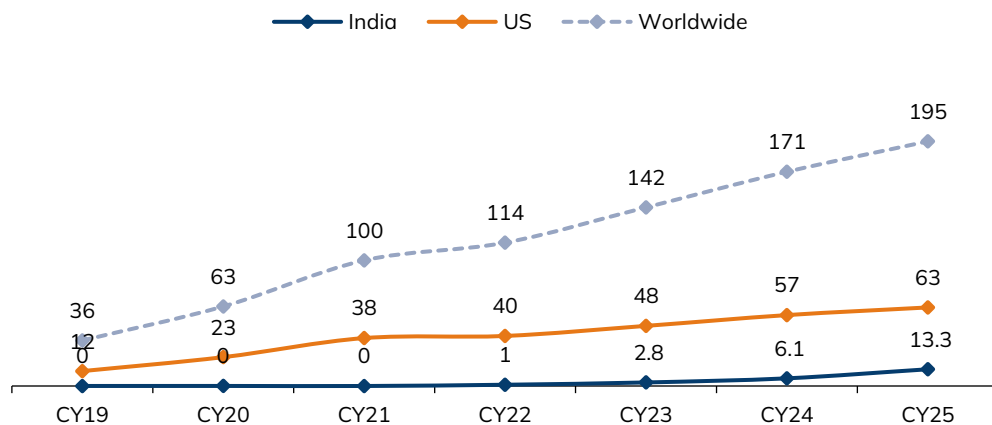
Exhibit 29: Revenue of online food delivery market in India, China and the US from CY23-25 (in bn USD)

Source: Statista, I-Sec Research

India lags China's market by ~12 years in terms of online food delivery market revenue, with projected revenues for CY29P in India to be close to CY17 revenues in China (Source: Statista).

As of CY25, the estimated revenue of quick-commerce amounted to ~USD 13bn in India, levels seen in China in CY19.

Exhibit 30: Revenue of quick-commerce market (in USD bn) from CY19–25



Source: Statista, I-Sec research

Chapter 4: Deep dive into E-commerce

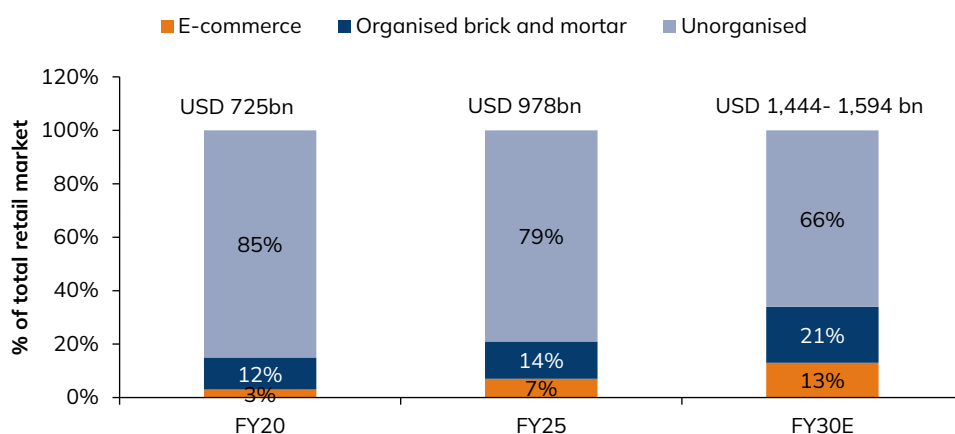
E-commerce – sector overview

The evolution of India's digital commerce landscape

India's digital commerce journey has evolved rapidly over the past decade, transitioning from traditional e-commerce to hyperlocal quick commerce (Q-commerce). What began in the early 2000s with online ticketing and basic retail platforms accelerated meaningfully post-2016, driven by widespread internet penetration, smartphone adoption, digital payment infrastructure such as UPI, improved logistics networks, and rising disposable incomes.

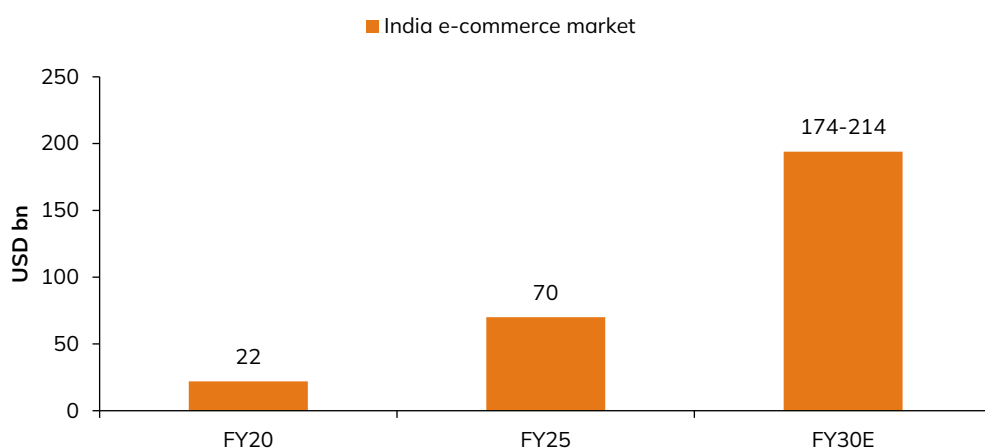
The Covid-19 pandemic acted as a structural catalyst, particularly for groceries and essentials, pushing online adoption into mainstream consumption. Today, India's e-commerce industry is valued at over USD 70bn and is projected to scale to ~USD 174-214bn by 2030E, reflecting sustained long-term momentum, despite moderating growth rates from the early hyper-growth phase.

Exhibit 31: India total retail market – split by purchase format



Source: I-Sec research, Redseer Report

Exhibit 32: India e-commerce market (USD 70bn) is ~7% of total retail market (USD 978bn) in FY25



Source: I-Sec research, Redseer Report

Growth drivers

Expanding shopper base: The sector is currently fuelled by 500mn online shoppers, positioning India as a global leader in the digital shopping revolution.

Internet connectivity: As of Mar'25, India has ~970mn internet subscribers, supported by affordable data and expansive digital infrastructure.

Rural demand driver: Rural areas and tier-2–4 towns are expected to drive over 60% of total e-commerce demand by 2026, marking a shift from metro-centric growth to a more inclusive, national market.

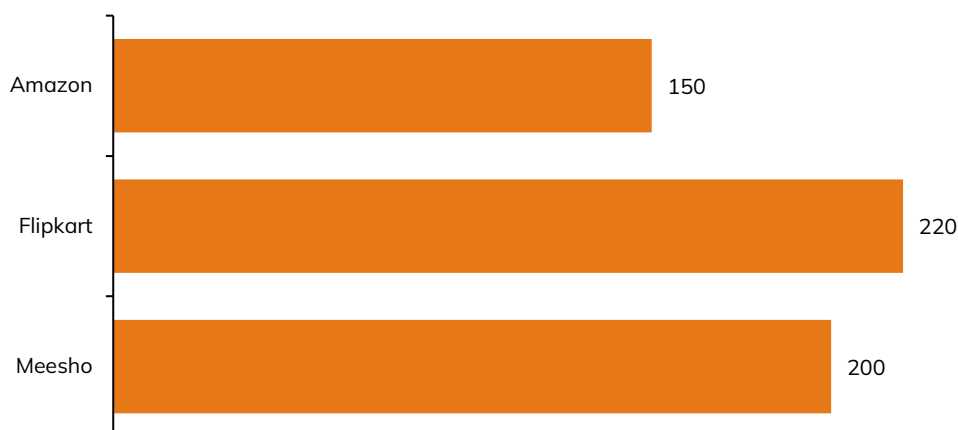
Competitive landscape and player analysis

Exhibit 33: Comparison of major E-commerce players across key metrics

Metric	Flipkart	Amazon India	Meesho
GMV market share	~50-60%	~25-30%	~10%
Number of products	150mn+ products across 80+ categories	~180mn products across 100+ categories	Not available
Business model	3P marketplace (seller driven)	3P marketplace (seller driven)	3P marketplace (seller driven)
Sellers on the platform	~450,000	~700,000	~400,000
Regional strengths	Metros, Tier 2 and beyond	Metros	Tier 3 and beyond
Private labels	Electronics (Smart Buy, MarQ) and home (Perfect Homes) to fashion (Roadster, HRX, Anouk, Divastri, Metronaut) and baby care (Miss & Chief)	Solimo, Amazon Basics, Symbol, Vedaka, Presto	-
Payments	PhonePe	Amazon Pay	Meesho Payments
Logistics	In-house (~90%)	In-house (~95%)	In-house (~65%+)
	Ekart Logistics	Amazon transport services	Valmo
	100+ fulfilment centres	100+ fulfilment centres	

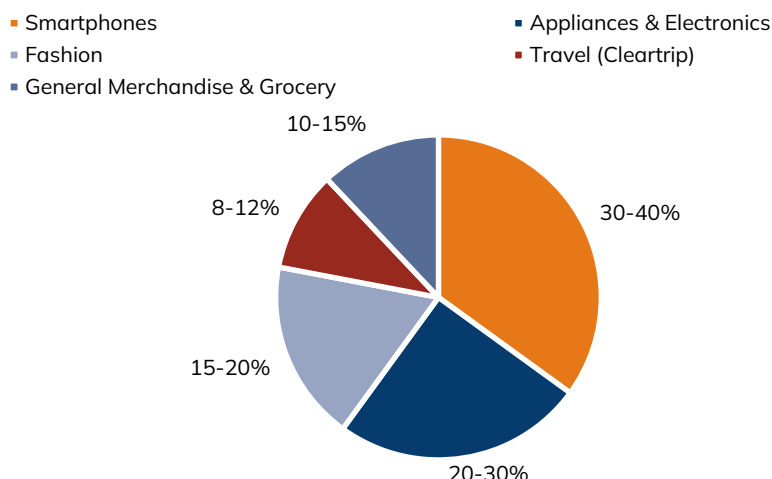
Source: I-Sec research, Meesho DRHP, Shiprocket, Media reports

Exhibit 34: Monthly active users of leading E-commerce companies in India (# mn)



Source: I-Sec Research, Channel checks

Exhibit 35: E-commerce sector GMV breakdown



Source: I-Sec research, Channel checks

Flipkart (market leader)

- Monthly active users: 220–240mn vs. total internet users in India: 850mn
- Growth strategy: Cross-categorisation and upselling existing users rather than new acquisition
- Strength: High ASP categories (smartphones, appliances, electronics 63-64%)
- Appliances have lower household penetration (<20% for washing machines), indicating growth potential

Amazon

- Amazon India is the second-largest player by GMV. The platform offers ~180mn products
- Strength: Beauty and personal care, general merchandise, FMCG (~50-60% share in these)
- Weakness: Lower share in smartphones/electronics (35-36% vs Flipkart's 63-64%)
- Geography: Stronger in metros (45% share vs Flipkart's 35%)
- Quick commerce: Amazon Now launched

Meesho

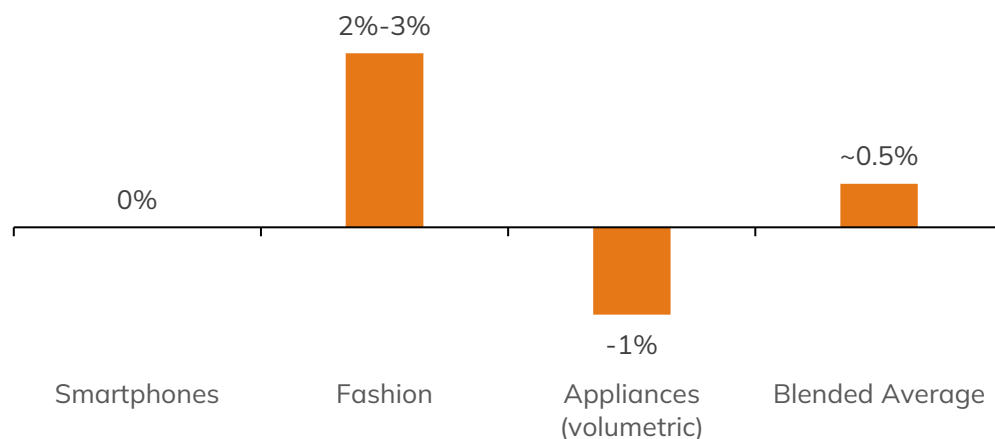
- Positioning: Ultra-low price point/entry price point specialist
- In India, hyper-value commerce's contribution to e-retail has scaled from around 5% of e-retail GMV in 2021 to ~ 10% in 2025.
- Target market: Value-conscious consumers in tier 2 or smaller cities
- Category focus: Fashion and general merchandise
- Unit economics: Challenged by low ticket sizes (INR 200-300 items with INR 30-40 delivery cost)
- Competitive moat: Strong differentiation; Flipkart/Amazon cannot replicate without hurting brand perception
- Successful IPO listing in 2025

Profitability

Profitability of leading E-commerce players

- Current EBITDA margin: -4% to -5%
- Steady-state contribution margin goal: 1.5-2%
- Expected EBITDA margin at profitability: ~0.5%

Exhibit 36: Contribution margin by categories

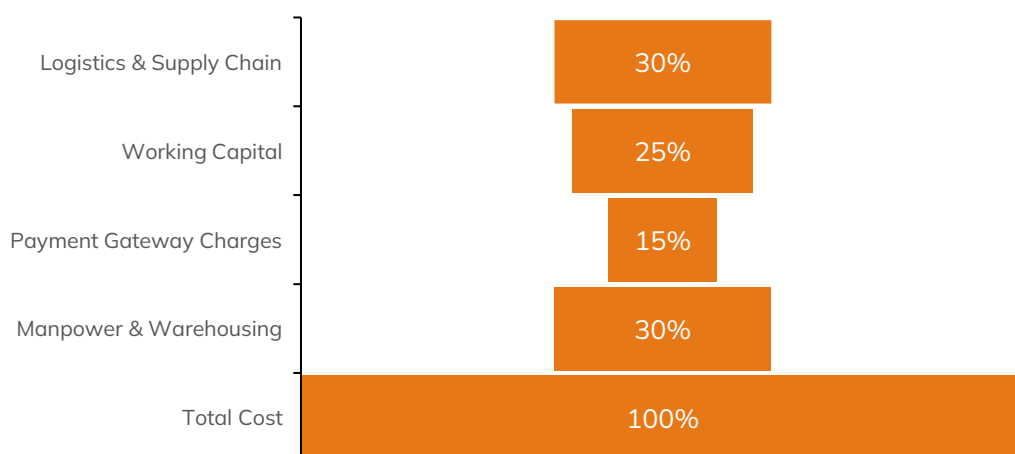


Source: I-Sec research, Channel checks

Marketing spend breakdown: Moving from user acquisition to better segmentation and targeting of existing user base

- Performance marketing: 7-8% of costs
- Brand marketing: 6-7% of costs
- Optimisation focus: Reducing performance marketing as major E-commerce players already have 220-240mn monthly active users

Exhibit 37: Cost structure – breakdown (excluding marketing cost)



Source: I-Sec research, Channel checks

Logistics and supply chain operations

Delivery infrastructure

- Serviceable pin codes: 19k across India
- In-house fulfilment (eKart): 90% of all orders
- Third-party logistics (3PL): 10% via Shadowfax, Delhivery for remote locations or marketplace sellers
- Logistics cost per parcel: INR 30-40 (blended), INR 100-150 for large items (TVs, washing machines)

Delivery speed metrics

- D0 (same-day delivery): 20% of orders, primarily in metro zones
- D0 + D1 (next-day delivery): 40% of total orders
- Hub-and-spoke model: Master warehouses → city hubs → last-mile delivery centres
- Same-day delivery requirement: Inventory must be held in-house (inventory model only)

Inventory management

- Average inventory holding period: 25-30 days (normal), up to 40 days during sales events
- Payment terms for marketplace model: 40-45 days credit period to sellers
- Inventory model: Upfront payment to brands/suppliers
- Strategic inventory placement: Based on demand prediction for faster delivery in key locations

Path to profitability

- Increase in ASP from current levels of ~INR 1.8k-2.5k, Smartphones INR 15k-20k
- Commission increases: Annual negotiations with suppliers for better terms
- Product mix optimisation: Shift to higher-margin categories
- Supply chain efficiency: Shift from 3PL to in-house eKart (90% fulfilment achieved)
- Marketing reduction: Lower performance marketing spends given large existing user base
- Platform fees: Consumer-facing charges (INR 5 fee for orders <INR 500)

Monetisation and take rates

Marketplace model

- Commission rate: 20-25% of GMV (varies by category)
- Advertisement income: 1-1.5% for high ASP categories, 3-3.5% for fashion
- Platform fees: 60-70 basis points (included in commission structure)
- Blended take rate: ~23% (20% commission + 2-3% ads)

Inventory model (grocery/quick commerce): Operates on gross margin model instead of commission

- Perishables (bread, eggs, dairy): 5-6% gross margin
- FMCG products: 12-13% gross margin
- Consumer electronics: 13-15% gross margin
- Advertisement: Additional 2-3% of revenue

Hybrid model: Super Just-In-Time (SJIT)

- Inventory: Remains with marketplace partner/brand
- Platform involvement: Takes over mid-mile and last-mile delivery
- Benefit: Reduces delivery time by 1-2 days vs. standard marketplace
- Fee structure: Higher nominal fee charged to seller for expedited service
- Example: Puma inventory at their warehouse, Flipkart handles hub-to-customer delivery

Consumer behaviour insights

- High ASP categories (smartphones, TVs, appliances): 40% of consumers research for 10+ days before purchase
- Quick commerce opportunity: Impulse purchases (FMCG/grocery) with immediate need-based use cases
- Customer acquisition: Grocery serves as entry point; upselling to higher-value categories follows
- Cross-categorisation strategy: Focus on upgrading existing users to new product categories

Exhibit 38: E-commerce segment – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strengths	• Convenience and value delivery at users' fingertips • Endless aisle vs. limited physical store inventory • Growing internet penetration (~350mn users) thanks to Jio data revolution • Rising purchasing power parity and demographic dividend • Efficient pricing through reduced intermediation costs
Weaknesses	• Lack of physical experience for high-ticket items (TVs, appliances - customers want to touch/test) • Counterfeit and quality issues (soap bars delivered instead of smartphones, etc.) • Last-mile pilferage and supply chain integrity challenges • Capital-intensive operations with low margins
Opportunities	• Untapped user base: Only 240mn of 350mn internet users are active on e-commerce • Cross-categorization: Many existing users haven't purchased high-value items yet • Geographic expansion: Tier-2/3+ cities remain underpenetrated in multiple categories • Quick commerce disruption: New delivery models creating additional market segments • Grocery penetration: Currently only 12-13% of market in top cities, massive upside
Threats	• Gig worker strikes and labour issues impacting operations • FDI policy changes and regulatory uncertainty (inventory vs. marketplace model ambiguity) • Global supply chain disruptions (semiconductor shortages, rare earth metal price increases) • Macro-economic factors impacting consumer spending

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

FDI framework and model

Current rules restrict foreign-funded platforms from owning inventory, yet "preferred vendor" structures often trigger regulatory scrutiny. Providing further clarification on the FDI framework could help establish distinct boundaries between inventory and marketplace models, effectively minimising regulatory ambiguity and fostering a more predictable investment environment

Gig worker policy and cost predictability

Fragmented state rules and frequent strikes create unpredictable labour costs and operational risks. A unified national policy on social security and benefits could stabilize unit economics and ensure long-term workforce sustainability.

MSME and D2C policy support

Small sellers face high advertising costs and working capital crunches that limit their growth on digital marketplaces. Policy-driven credit access and simplified tax compliance could help formalize these sellers and expand the e-commerce supply base.

GST stability and tax predictability

Frequent tax rate shifts and complex TCS reconciliation processes create friction for platforms and small vendors. More stable tax structures and streamlined filing mechanisms could help maintain seller participation.

Companies in E-commerce

Flipkart

Company overview

Flipkart is India's homegrown e-commerce major (founded 2007), now majority-owned by Walmart; it runs marketplaces (Flipkart, Myntra, Shopsy), logistics (Ekart) and fintech/quick-commerce initiatives.

Business model and value proposition

Marketplace + retail + services: 3P seller marketplace (commissions, ads), 1P retail, subscription (Plus), financial products, advertising and quick commerce (Flipkart Minutes). Monetisation blends marketplace fees, ads and platform services.

Exhibit 39: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	827.9 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(52) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	12,000-15,000
Last known valuation (USD mn)	36,000
Notable investors	Walmart, Tiger Global Management, SoftBank, Accel, GIC

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Sachin Bansal and Binny Bansal** (IIT Delhi alumni). Today Flipkart is run by senior management (Kalyan Krishnamurthy, a prominent CEO figure) under Walmart's ownership.



Sachin Bansal
Founder



Binny Bansal
Co-Founder

Amazon

Company overview

Amazon India is the Indian arm of Amazon Inc., operating one of India's largest e-commerce marketplace and an extensive fulfilment, cloud (AWS) and seller ecosystem across the country. It runs marketplace, retail, Prime, AWS and ads businesses tailored to Indian customers.

Business model and value proposition

Operates a mixed model: a consumer marketplace (3P sellers + limited 1P retail), subscription (Prime), advertising, payments/financing products and AWS for enterprise customers; monetisation mixes commissions, fees, subscriptions and cloud revenues.

Exhibit 40: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	405 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(15) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	40,000
Last known valuation (USD mn)	Not disclosed
Notable investors	Amazon (Global)

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Global founder: Jeff Bezos (Amazon Inc.). India leadership has included long-tenured Amazon executives (Amit Agarwal, Samir Kumar named India head in 2024) who run local strategy, operations and large investments in logistics and tech.



Jeff Bezos
Founder

Meesho

Company overview

Meesho is a horizontal e-commerce platform, focused on serving price-sensitive consumers and micro-entrepreneurs in Tier-2, Tier-3 and rural markets. Founded in 2015 and headquartered in Bengaluru, it enables small sellers to reach millions of buyers through a low-cost, mobile-first marketplace model.

Business model and value proposition

Meesho operates a zero-commission, asset-light marketplace model, monetising primarily through advertising, logistics services and value-added seller tools rather than commissions. The platform focuses on affordability, unbranded/value goods, and supply aggregation to drive high order volumes and user retention.

Exhibit 41: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	94 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(39) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	-
Last known valuation (USD mn)	9,000
Notable investors	SBI MF, Elevation capital, Westbridge capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Vidit Aatrey** and **Sanjeev Barnwal** (both IIT Delhi alumni), Meesho's founders bring strong product and engineering backgrounds. Vidit Aatrey (CEO) has been the driving force behind Meesho's pivot from social commerce to a full-fledged marketplace tailored for India.



Vidit Aatrey
Founder and CEO



Sanjeev Barnwal
Co-Founder and CTO

Nykaa

Company Overview

Nykaa is India's leading **beauty, personal care and fashion e-commerce platform**, operating across digital and physical retail. Founded in 2012 and headquartered in Mumbai, Nykaa has built a trusted destination for premium and mass beauty brands.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows an **inventory-led and content-driven retail model**, allowing greater control over assortment, authenticity and pricing. Revenue is generated through **product sales, private labels, advertising and offline store expansion**, with strong gross margins relative to horizontal e-commerce peers.

Exhibit 42: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	80 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	8,400
Notable investors	SBI MF, Mirae MF, ICICI pru MF, Nippon MF

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Falguni Nayar**, a former investment banker and MD at Kotak Mahindra Capital, Nykaa's leadership is known for disciplined execution and brand-first scaling. Falguni Nayar's financial background has shaped Nykaa's focus on profitability and capital efficiency.



Falguni Nayar
Founder and CEO

Lenskart

Company Overview

Lenskart is India's largest **omnichannel eyewear retailer**, offering prescription glasses, sunglasses and contact lenses. Founded in 2010 and headquartered in Gurugram, Lenskart has expanded aggressively across India and select international markets.

Business model and value proposition

Lenskart operates a **vertically integrated, D2C-led omnichannel model**, owning manufacturing, lens technology and retail distribution. Revenue is driven by **high-margin eyewear sales**, supported by private labels, technology-enabled eye testing and a dense offline store network.

Exhibit 43: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	66.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	2.9 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	8,500
Notable investors	SoftBank Vision Fund, Temasek, KKR, Alpha Wave Global (Falcon Edge), T Rowe Price, BlackRock, Fidelity, Goldman Sachs, and JP Morgan

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Peyush Bansal, Neha Bansal, Amit Chaudhary and Sumeet Kapahi**, Lenskart's leadership combines product vision and execution excellence. Peyush Bansal (CEO), an IIT Delhi and IIM Bangalore alumnus, is widely recognised for building Lenskart into a category-defining consumer brand and for his public role on Shark Tank India.



Peyush Bansal
Co-Founder and
CEO



Neha Bansal
Co-Founder and
Global Head of
Merchandising



Amit Chaudhary
Co-Founder and
Global Head of
Expansion



Sumeet Kapahi
Co-Founder and
Global Head of
Sourcing

Blissclub

Company Overview

Blissclub is an Indian D2C activewear brand founded to deliver technical, comfortable performance apparel for women; it has scaled rapidly through D2C, marketplaces and growing offline experience stores.

Business model and value proposition

D2C-first apparel brand with omnichannel distribution (own site + marketplaces + retail), monetising via product sales, private labels and limited subscription/loyalty offerings; emphasis on product R&D and offline experience to drive higher AOV.

Exhibit 44: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.2)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	26
Last known valuation (USD mn)	67
Notable investors	Elevation Capital, Eight Roads Venture

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Minu Margaret** (young founder, featured on Hurun/Avendus U35 lists), who brings product obsession and experiential retail focus; leadership mixes brand, product and retail execution skills.



Minu Margeret
Founder and CEO

CityMall

Company overview

CityMall is a value-commerce and community-driven grocery/household e-commerce platform focused on smaller towns and price-sensitive shoppers, combining app, WhatsApp and micro-entrepreneur led distribution.

Business model and value proposition

Operates via curated SKUs, private labels, micro-entrepreneurs and group/merchant networks to keep prices low while driving high frequency purchases. Monetises via product margins and marketplace fees.

Exhibit 45: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.6 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.6) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	165
Last known valuation (USD mn)	320
Notable investors	Elevation Capital, Accel Partners, WaterBridge Ventures, General Catalyst Partners, Jungle Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Angad Kikla and Naisheel Verdhan team combines marketplace product experience and Bharat go-to-market expertise.



Angad Kikla
Co-Founder



Naisheel Verdhan
Co-Founder

Recent developments

Raised a USD 47mn round in 2025 to scale value e-commerce across non-metro India, reported sharp GMV and revenue growth (FY25).

Shopclues

Company overview

ShopClues is an Indian value-focused e-commerce marketplace that primarily serves budget-conscious consumers across electronics, lifestyle and general merchandise. It gained early traction in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.

Business model and value proposition

The platform follows a discount-led marketplace model, monetising via seller commissions and advertising, though scale and competitiveness have weakened over time due to intense competition.

Exhibit 46: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.59 (FY22)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.5) (FY22)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	257
Last known valuation (USD mn)	100
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Singapore's sovereign wealth fund GIC, Nexus Venture Partners, Helion Venture Partners, Unilazer Ventures
	Acquired by Singapore-based e-commerce platform Qoo10 in an all-stock deal announced in late 2019

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Business Standard

Founders and leadership

Founded by Sandeep Aggarwal, Radhika Aggarwal, Sanjay Sethi, ShopClues was one of India's early e-commerce unicorns before being acquired by Singapore-based Qoo10.



Sandeep Aggarwal
Co-Founder



Radhika Aggarwal
Co-Founder



Sanjay Sethi
Co-Founder

Cashify

Company Overview

Cashify is India's leading recommerce and device lifecycle management platform, focused on buying, selling, repairing and recycling used smartphones, laptops and consumer electronics. Founded in 2013 and headquartered in Gurugram, it operates both online and through a growing network of offline retail stores across India.

Business model and value proposition

Cashify runs a full-stack recommerce model, sourcing used devices directly from consumers, refurbishing or grading them, and reselling via B2C and B2B channels. Revenue is generated through device resale margins, repair services, enterprise buyback programs and partnerships with OEMs and e-commerce platforms, making it a key beneficiary of circular economy trends.

Exhibit 47: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	10.96 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.1) FY25
Total funding raised (USD mn)	223
Last known valuation (USD mn)	250
Notable investors	Bessemer Venture Partners, Olympus Capital Asia and Blume Ventures. AEPim is the largest institutional investor in the company. Vivek Khare is only Angel Investor in the company.

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Cashify was founded by Mandeep Manocha, Amit Sethi, Nakul Kumar, Siddhant Dhingra. The founding team brings experience across operations, supply chains and digital platforms, and has successfully built one of India's largest organised secondary electronics marketplaces.



Mandeep Manocha
Co-Founder, CEO



Amit Sethi
Co-Founder



Nakul Kumar
Co-Founder, CMO



Siddhant Dhingra
Co-Founder, Chief
Business Officer

Drools

Company overview

Drools is one of India's largest pet food manufacturers, focused primarily on dog nutrition across dry food, treats and specialised formulations. Founded in 2010 and headquartered in Bengaluru, Drools has built a strong pan-India distribution network across pet stores, veterinary clinics, e-commerce platforms and modern trade.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a manufacturing-led FMCG model, with in-house production facilities and vertically integrated sourcing. Revenue is driven by product sales through offline retail, distributors and e-commerce, with improving margins supported by scale, private manufacturing and repeat consumption in a fast-growing pet care category.

Exhibit 48: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	7.14 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.14) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	60
Last known valuation (USD mn)	600
Notable investors	L Catterton, Nestle

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

The founder of Drools Pet Food Private Limited is **Fahim Sultan Ali**, who launched the brand in India in 2010 to offer affordable, nutritious alternatives to expensive imported pet foods. While Fahim Sultan founded the company, **Dr. Shashank Sinha** serves as the CEO and a key leader driving its growth and innovation in the pet nutrition market.



Fahim Sultan Ali
Founder



Dr. Shashank Sinha
CEO

FirstCry

Company Overview

FirstCry is an omnichannel retailer for baby, kids and maternity products, offering apparel, toys, diapers, feeding essentials and accessories. Founded in 2010 and headquartered in Pune, FirstCry serves millions of parents across online platforms and a large offline franchise network.

Business model and value proposition

FirstCry follows a hybrid marketplace + inventory-led retail model, combining private labels, third-party brands and exclusive distribution partnerships. It monetises through product margins, private label sales and franchise fees, supported by strong repeat demand in the baby care category.

Exhibit 49: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	77 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.6) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,500
Notable investors	SBI MF, ICICI Pru MF, Government of Singapore, Premji Invest

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Supam Maheshwari and Amitava Saha**, the leadership blends consumer retail, supply-chain and e-commerce experience. Supam Maheshwari (CEO) has been central to building FirstCry's omnichannel strategy and private-label portfolio.



Supam Maheshwari
Founder, MD & CEO



Amitava Saha
Co-Founder

Purplle

Company Overview

Purplle is a beauty and personal care e-commerce platform offering mass and premium cosmetics, skincare and wellness products. Founded in 2012, it serves a broad customer base with strong traction in non-metro markets.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a marketplace + private label model, earning through third-party brand commissions, advertising and sales of owned brands. Its data-driven discovery engine helps personalise beauty recommendations.

Exhibit 50: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	13.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.7) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	560
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,300
Notable investors	Goldman Sachs, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), Premji Invest, Sequoia Capital (now Peak XV Partners), Nexus Venture Partners, Kedaara Capital, Blume Ventures, JSW Ventures, Verlinvest, and Sharrp Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Manish Taneja**, **Rahul Dash** and **Suyash Katyayani**, Purplle's leadership brings experience in consulting, operations and digital commerce, helping the platform scale both private labels and third-party brand partnerships.



Manish Taneja
Co-Founder, CEO



Rahul Dash
Co-Founder, COO



Suyash Katyayani
CTO

RENEE Cosmetics

Company overview

RENEE Cosmetics is a fast-growing D2C beauty brand offering clean, cruelty-free cosmetics targeted at young Indian consumers. The brand is positioned around minimalism, innovation and affordability.

Business model and value proposition

RENEE operates a D2C-first omnichannel model, monetising through online sales, marketplaces and rapid offline retail expansion, with a strong focus on hero products and influencer-driven marketing.

Exhibit 51: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.9 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.6) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	78
Last known valuation (USD mn)	200
Notable investors	Evolve India, Edelweiss Group, Equanimity Investments, 100Unicorns (formerly 9Unicorns), Playbook Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Aashka Goradia Goble**, a well-known entrepreneur and former television personality, with co-founders **Priyank Shah**, **Ashutosh Valani** RENEE benefits from strong brand storytelling, consumer insight and marketing-led growth.



Aashka Goradia Goble
Founder



Priyank Shah
Co-Founder



Ashutosh Valani
Co-Founder

Sugar

Company overview

SUGAR Cosmetics is a leading Indian D2C beauty brand known for bold, youth-centric makeup products designed for Indian skin tones and climate. Founded in 2015, it has built strong brand recall among urban millennials and Gen-Z.

Business model and value proposition

SUGAR operates an omnichannel D2C model, combining own website, marketplaces and a rapidly expanding offline retail network. Revenue is driven by high-margin cosmetics sales and strong repeat usage.

Exhibit 52: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.67) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	90
Last known valuation (USD mn)	355
Notable investors	L Catterton, A91 Partners, Elevation Capital, India Quotient, Anicut Capital, and Stride Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TheArcWeb

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Vineeta Singh** and **Kaushik Mukherjee**, Vineeta (IIT Madras, IIM Ahmedabad alum) is the public face and CEO, known for disciplined execution and brand-first scaling; she is also widely recognised via Shark Tank India.



Vineeta Singh
Co-Founder, CEO



Kaushik Mukherjee
Co-Founder, COO

Country Delight

Company Overview

Country Delight is a Gurugram-based D2C fresh food delivery brand specializing in premium, minimally processed dairy, fruits, vegetables and pantry essentials delivered directly to consumers via subscription-based supply chain technology.

Business model and value proposition

Operates an integrated farm-to-home D2C supply-chain model with direct sourcing, quality testing, cold storage, packaging and last-mile delivery, monetising through subscription revenue and wallet prepayments.

Exhibit 53: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	13.8 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	Not available
Total funding raised (USD mn)	221
Last known valuation (USD mn)	820
Notable investors	Venturi Partners, Elevation Capital, Alteria Capital, Matrix Partners India, Orios Venture Partners, Temasek

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2015 by Chakradhar Gade (CEO) and Nitin Kaushal, both IIM graduates who built the brand to solve quality gaps in India's dairy and fresh-essentials ecosystem; Gade is an IIT Delhi and IIM Ahmedabad alumnus.



Chakradhar Gade
Co-Founder, CEO



Nitin Kaushal
Co-Founder

Recent developments

In Mar'25, the company raised ~USD 25mn in a growth round led by Temasek's affiliate, expanded quick commerce pilots and strengthened its presence in 25+ cities with ~1.5mn customers.

FreshToHome

Company Overview

FreshToHome is a D2C fresh meat and seafood e-commerce company (founded 2015) that sources and sells chemical-free fish, meat and seafood with an end-to-end cold chain and omnichannel presence.

Business model and value proposition

Full-stack D2C food platform: direct sourcing from fishermen/farmers, cold-chain fulfilment, own inventory/warehouses, and B2C sales via app + marketplaces; monetises via product sales and B2B channel partnerships.

Exhibit 54: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.46) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	256
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Kortschak Investmesnts, Das Capital, Iron Pillar, Abu Dhabi Investment Office, Crescent Enterprises Venture Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Co-founded by **Shan Kadavil, Mathew Joseph, Jayesh Jose**; Kadavil serves as CEO and has led large fundraises and rapid city expansion backed by consumer experience and supply-chain focus.



Shan Kadavil
Co-Founder, CEO



Mathew Joseph
Co-Founder



Jayesh Jose
Co-Founder

Giva

Company overview

GIVA Jewellery is a Bengaluru-based D2C jewellery brand offering a range of silver, gold and lab-grown diamond jewellery, with an omnichannel presence across online and retail outlets.

Business model and value proposition

Functions as a D2C and omnichannel jewellery platform, monetising via direct sales of hallmark silver, gold and lab-grown diamond pieces, expanding retail footprint alongside e-commerce.

Exhibit 55: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.7) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	545
Notable investors	Premji Invest, Creaegis, Epiq Capital, A91 Partners, Edelweiss Discovery Fund

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2019 by Ishendra Agarwal (Co-founder and CEO), Nikita Prasad, Sachin Shetty and Aditya Labroo, with Agarwal focusing on strategy and operations, Prasad on design and creative direction, and Shetty contributing to business scaling.



Ishendra Agarwal
Co-Founder, CEO



Nikita Prasad
Co-Founder



Sachin Shetty
Co-Founder



Aditya Labroo
Co-Founder

Hopscotch

Company overview

Hopscotch is an Indian kids' fashion and lifestyle brand offering apparel, footwear, toys and accessories via a tech-enabled online platform and partner marketplace for parents across the country.

Business model and value proposition

Operates a D2C fashion marketplace model, curating trends and inventory from global and local brands for kids' wear and related lifestyle products, earning through product sales and marketplace fees.

Exhibit 56: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.35 (FY22)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.17 (FY22)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Amazon, LionRock Capital, Rise Capital, and RPG Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Rahul Anand** in 2012; Anand is a Harvard Business School alumnus who built Hopscotch into a digitally-driven brand with pan-India reach.



Rahul Anand
Founder, CEO

Licious

Company Overview

Licious is a D2C fresh meat and seafood brand (founded 2015) that operates vertically integrated supply chain for fresh and processed protein products and has evolved into a nationwide omnichannel player.

Business model and value proposition

Vertically integrated D2C model: sources and processes meat and seafood, sells direct to consumers (app/website), supplies select B2B customers and uses dark stores/warehouses for cold fulfilment; monetises via product margins and scaled distribution.

Exhibit 57: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	8.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.1) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	450-490
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,500
Notable investors	Temasek, Amansa Capital, Vertex Ventures, Multiples Alternate Asset Management, and Kotak PE.

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Reuters

Founders and leadership

Co-founded by **Abhay Hanjura** and **Vivek Gupta** (and other early team members); leadership has driven product innovation and national expansion; company is often cited as a leading D2C food unicorn.



Abhay Hanjura
Co-Founder



Vivek Gupta
Co-Founder

mCaffeine

Company overview

mcaffeine is a D2C personal care brand known for caffeinated skincare and haircare products tailored for the Indian market, focusing on natural and toxin-free formulations.

Business model and value proposition

Monetises via online D2C sales, marketplace distribution and retail partnerships, with product revenue from skincare, hair care, body care and grooming lines; built around a “clean, caffeinated” brand identity.

Exhibit 58: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.02 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.85) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	40
Last known valuation (USD mn)	80
Notable investors	Paragon Partners India, RPSG Capital Ventures, Sharrp Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Tarun Sharma, Vikas Lachhwani, Vaishali Gupta, Mohit Jain, and Saurabh Singhal, who positioned mcaffeine as a millennial-driven, natural-ingredient personal care brand leveraging social media and omnichannel retail.



Tarun Sharma
Co-Founder & CEO



Vikas Lachhwani
Co-Founder &
Chief Innovation
Officer



Vaishali Gupta
Co-Founder &
Chief Growth
Officer



Mohit Jain
Co-Founder &
Head of Finance



Saurabh Singhal
Co-Founder &
Chief Supply
Officer

Mensa Brands

Company overview

Mensa Brands is a house-of-brands consumer platform that acquires, scales and operates high-growth D2C brands across fashion, beauty, home and lifestyle categories. Founded in 2021, Mensa focuses on building digital-first brands with strong online traction.

Business model and value proposition

Mensa follows an acquisition-led brand roll-up model, acquiring majority stakes in digital brands and centralising functions such as supply chain, marketing, analytics and offline expansion. Revenue is generated through product sales across owned brand portfolios.

Exhibit 59: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	300
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	Accel Partners, Prosus, Tiger Global, Alteria Capital, InnoVen Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TheArcWeb

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Ananth Narayanan** (former Myntra CEO), Mensa benefits from deep consumer internet and fashion retail expertise. Narayanan's experience in scaling Myntra lends credibility to Mensa's omnichannel and brand-building strategy.



Ananth Narayanan
Founder

Snitch

Company overview

Snitch is a D2C fashion and lifestyle brand catering primarily to men's apparel and expanding into quick commerce delivery segments.

Business model and value proposition

Operates an omnichannel D2C retail model with own stores and online channels, monetising through apparel sales and lifestyle-category expansion.

Exhibit 60: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.9 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.02) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	53
Last known valuation (USD mn)	300
Notable investors	360 ONE Asset, SWC Global, IvyCap Ventures.

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entrackr

Founders and leadership

Founded by Siddharth Dungarwal in 2019, Snitch has scaled rapidly through offline retail and digital channels.



Siddharth Dungarwal
Founder

Wakefit

Company overview

Wakefit Innovations Ltd is a Bengaluru-based D2C home and sleep solutions brand, originally focused on mattresses and now diversified into furniture, bedding, décor and home furnishing products via an omnichannel model.

Business model and value proposition

Wakefit operates an omnichannel D2C and offline retail strategy, combining direct sales through its own e-commerce platform, marketplaces and a growing network of experience centres and retail outlets, monetising through product sales across mattresses, furniture and lifestyle solutions.

Exhibit 61: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	12.7 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.35) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	550
Notable investors	Peak XV Partners (formerly Sequoia Capital), Verinvest, Investcorp, and Redwood Trust

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2016 by Ankit Garg (Co-founder and Director) and Chaitanya Ramalingegowda (Co-founder), with Ankit an IIT Roorkee chemical engineer and Chaitanya an MBA from ISB, combining product engineering and startup scaling expertise.



Ankit Garg
Co-Founder &
Director



Chaitanya Ramalingegowda
Co-Founder

Plum

Company Overview

Plum is an Indian clean beauty and skincare D2C brand offering dermatologist-inspired products formulated without harmful chemicals.

Business model and value proposition

Monetises via online direct sales and marketplace distribution, focusing on clean, vegan skincare and personal care products targeting conscious consumers.

Exhibit 62: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.25 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	50
Last known valuation (USD mn)	250
Notable investors	A91 Partners, Unilever Ventures, and Faering Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, VC Circle

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Shankar Prasad**, Plum has established itself as a leading clean beauty platform with strong digital engagement.



Shankar Prasad
Founder

Wow Skin Science

Company Overview

WOW Skin Science is a Bengaluru-based personal care and beauty brand offering a broad portfolio of skincare, haircare, grooming and wellness products formulated with natural and toxin-free ingredients, sold through e-commerce and retail channels.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows a D2C + marketplace + retail distribution model, monetising through online sales (own site, marketplaces) and offline retail presence, with a product range spanning shampoos, lotions, serums, essential oils and grooming kits.

Exhibit 63: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.3 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.3) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	98
Last known valuation (USD mn)	250
Notable investors	ChrysCapital, GIC

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2014 by Manish Chowdhary and Karan Chowdhary, and Ashwin Sokke and Arvind Sokke, the brand's leadership combined product innovation and business scaling expertise to focus on clean, natural beauty products.



Manish Chowdhary
Co-Founder



Karan Chowdhary
Co-Founder



Ashwin Sokke
Co-Founder



Arvind Sokke
Co-Founder

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Chapter 5: Deep dive into Quick Commerce

Quick commerce – sector overview

The rise of Just-in-Time (JIT) commerce

Quick commerce (QC) has become a strong alternative to mid-premium modern retail and e-commerce in metro and tier-1 cities. Initially focused on groceries and daily essentials, QC has expanded into higher-margin categories such as beauty, electronics, pet care, and toys, making it a key emerging segment in organised retail.

As per a Redseer report, QC commands market share of 0.6% in total retail and penetration of 8.9% in online retail in FY25. By FY30, penetration is expected to reach 30-33% in online retail and 4% in total retail, driving QC's market size from INR 5.3trn (USD 6.2bn) to INR 4.5–6.0trn (USD 53-71bn).

As consumer expectations evolved from “fast” to “instant,” the next structural shift emerged: Quick Commerce (Q-commerce). Unlike traditional e-commerce, which operates through large fulfilment centres and 2–3-day delivery timelines, Q-commerce is built on hyperlocal dark stores—strategically located micro-warehouses designed exclusively for online orders.

Dark stores prioritise high-demand SKUs, enable faster picking and packing, and reduce last-mile distances. Deliveries are typically completed within 60 minutes, often through in-house logistics networks and two-wheeler fleets, rather than third-party courier systems.

Exhibit 64: This model represents the third generation of E-commerce evolution

Generation	Model	Delivery Timeline	Infrastructure
1st Gen Commerce	Self-service	Instant (store visit)	Physical stores
2nd Gen E-commerce	Centralised fulfilment	2–3 days	Mega warehouses + courier networks
3rd Gen Q-commerce	Hyperlocal fulfilment	<60 minutes	Dark stores + in-house riders

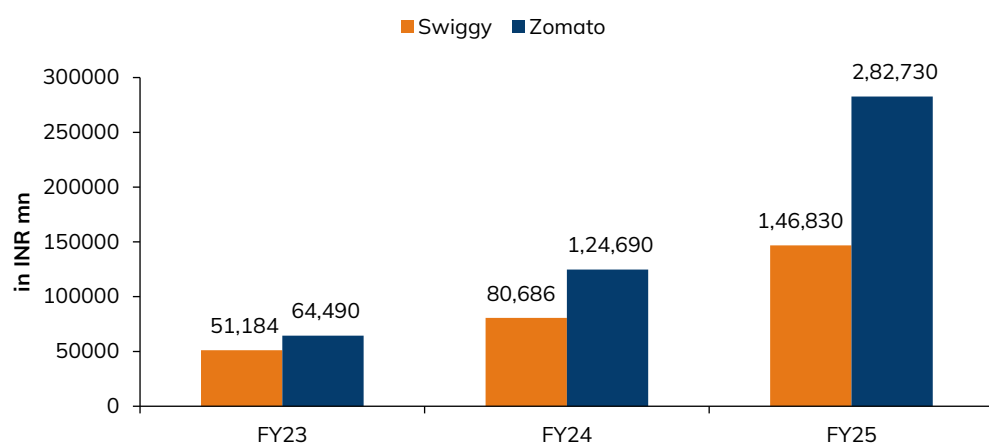
Source: I-Sec research, Company data

From expansion to scale consolidation

The GOV trajectory over the last three years reflects a clear inflection from early build-out to aggressive scale expansion in Quick Commerce. Growth has not been linear but accelerating, particularly in the most recent year, indicating that the model is benefiting from improving order density, higher repeat behaviour, and stronger dark store productivity rather than just network expansion.

Overall, the trend signals that Quick Commerce is transitioning from a high-investment growth phase to a scale-led consolidation phase, where operating leverage and unit economics could become the key drivers of long-term value creation.

Exhibit 65: GOV of Instamart and Blinkit



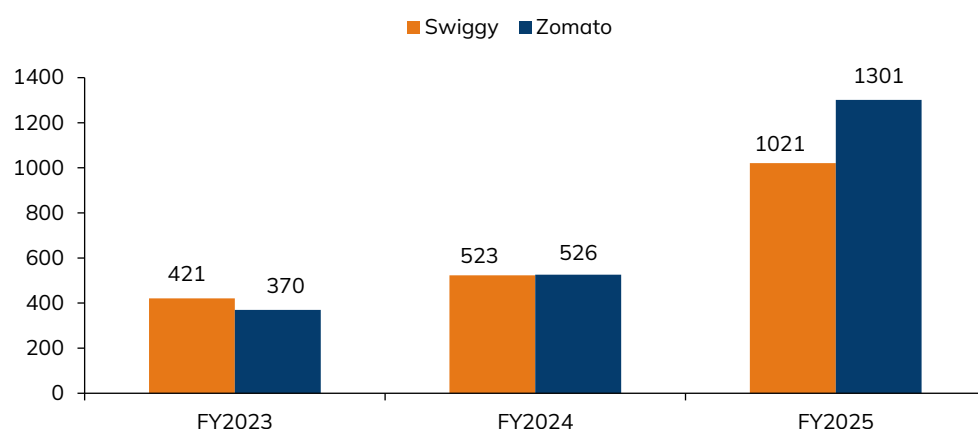
Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Dark stores – the infrastructure powering quick commerce

Dark stores have emerged as the backbone of India's quick commerce ecosystem, functioning as dedicated fulfilment centres catering exclusively to online orders. Typically spanning 3,000–8,000sq.ft., these micro-warehouses are strategically located in densely populated urban clusters and stock a curated assortment of high-velocity SKUs, including groceries and FMCG products. Unlike conventional retail outlets, dark stores are not customer-facing; instead, they are optimised for speed, inventory efficiency, and last-mile dispatch, enabling delivery timelines of 30 minutes or less, and in some cases as low as 10–15 minutes.

Technology plays a central role in the dark store model. Advanced inventory management systems, data-driven demand forecasting, and optimised picking routes enhance operational efficiency. Their compact format allows lower rental overheads relative to traditional retail while improving fulfilment speed through proximity to customers.

Exhibit 66: Growth of active dark stores



Source: Company Data, I-Sec research

Pandemic catalyst and structural shift

The COVID-19 pandemic acted as a major inflection point for dark stores. Lockdowns and safety concerns accelerated online adoption for essential purchases, normalising the habit of ordering daily-use items digitally. The convenience of rapid delivery, wide assortment, and seamless payments drove sustained behavioural change, even post-pandemic.

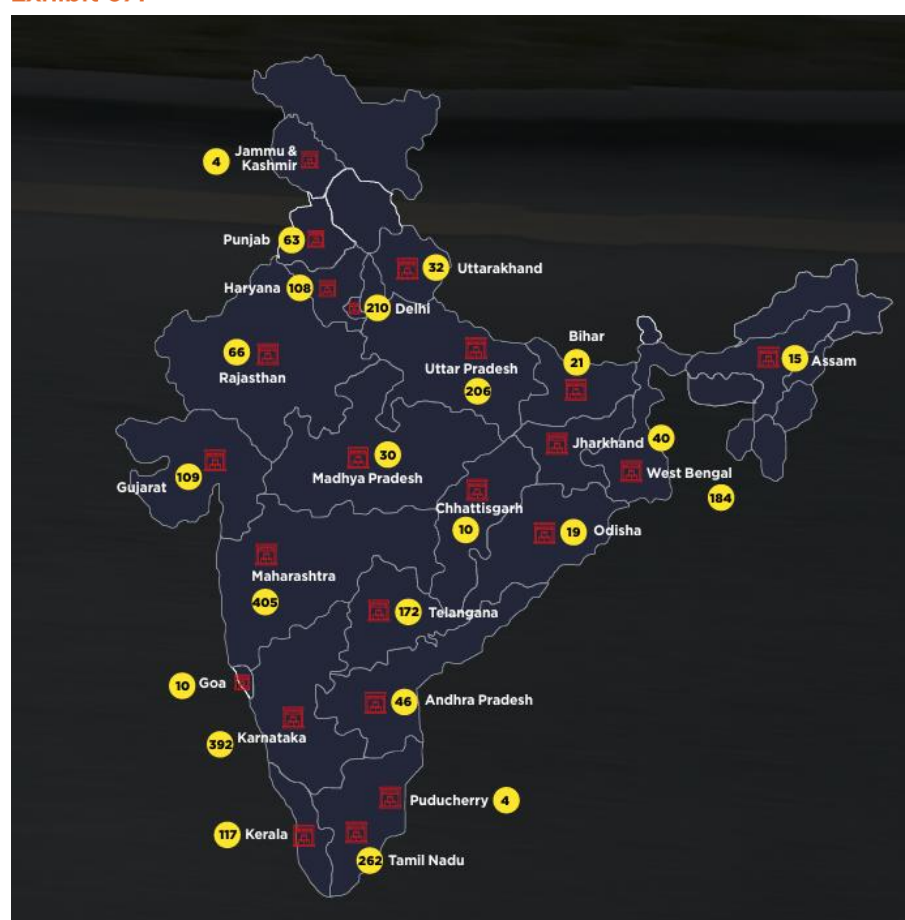
As a result, dark stores scaled rapidly across metropolitan markets and are increasingly penetrating Tier-II and Tier-III cities, supported by improving logistics infrastructure and digital penetration.

Dark store footprint expanding across India

Dark stores in India are witnessing rapid expansion, driven by the structural growth of quick commerce. Initially concentrated in high-density metropolitan markets such as Delhi-NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Pune, Ahmedabad and Kolkata, the model has demonstrated strong operational viability in urban clusters with high order density and demand intensity.

Leading platforms have now scaled their networks to over 100 Tier-II and Tier-III cities, extending faster delivery services beyond metros. This geographical diversification not only broadens the addressable market but also improves order density economics in emerging consumption hubs. The expanding dark store footprint underscores the structural role of hyperlocal fulfilment infrastructure in reshaping India's retail landscape and enabling the rapid scaling of Q-commerce.

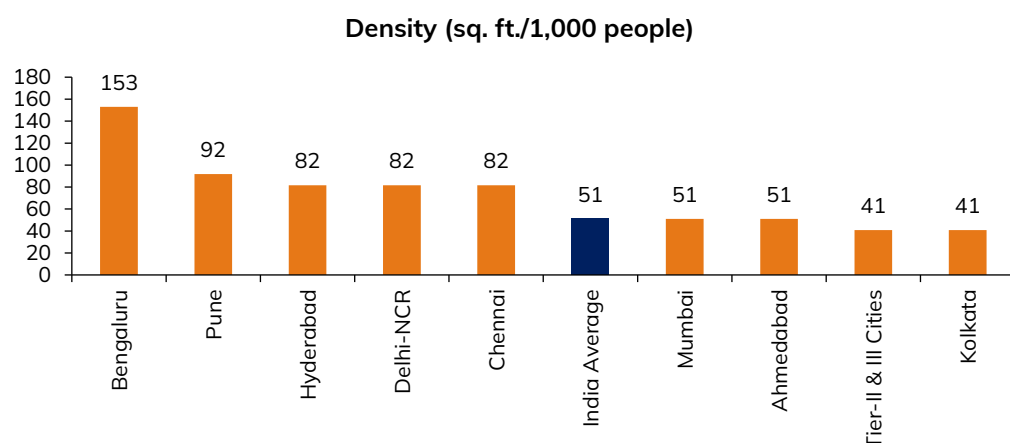
Exhibit 67: Dark store count across states



Source: Savills India

Dark store density highlights early-stage penetration

Using population estimates and operational area, India's average dark store space stands at ~50sq.ft. per 1,000 people, indicating that the sector remains in a relatively early stage of penetration. Bengaluru leads with ~150sq.ft. per 1,000 people, reflecting high digital adoption and strong Q-commerce penetration. Cities such as Pune, Hyderabad, Delhi-NCR and Chennai range between ~80–90sq.ft., suggesting further headroom for scaling. In contrast, Tier-II and III cities average ~40sq.ft., primarily due to lower penetration levels and infrastructure readiness.

Exhibit 68: Dark store space density (sq. ft./1,000 people)

Source: Savills India, I-Sec research

Emerging trends in quick commerce – the next phase of evolution

India's quick commerce (Q-commerce) landscape is entering its next phase of structural evolution, driven by platform convergence, technological experimentation, and increasing consumer demand for speed and convenience. What began as a hyperlocal grocery delivery model is now expanding into a broader, innovation-led ecosystem.

Convergence of dark stores and cloud kitchens

One of the most visible structural trends is the emergence of a dual-platform ecosystem combining dark stores and cloud kitchens. While dark stores are optimised for rapid delivery of groceries and daily essentials, cloud kitchens focus on freshly prepared, ready-to-eat meals. Increasingly, Q-commerce players are integrating both models to unlock operational synergies and maximise asset utilisation.

Single-brand and multi-brand cloud kitchen operators are setting up kitchen infrastructure within or adjacent to dark store networks, enabling faster fulfilment and leveraging existing delivery fleets. This convergence is reshaping urban consumption patterns, allowing platforms to serve both essential and food-service demand through a unified logistics backbone. For investors, this reflects improving asset efficiency and higher potential throughput per fulfilment node.

Drone deliveries – the speed frontier

Drone-based delivery is emerging as a potential long-term disruptor in last-mile logistics. Globally, companies in markets such as the US, China, Japan and Australia have already demonstrated the viability of ultra-fast grocery deliveries through pilot programs. In India, initial pilots, particularly in Bengaluru, have shown promise, with targeted delivery times under 10 minutes for select use cases.

The key drivers behind drone adoption include demand for instant fulfilment, reduction in carbon footprint, and cost optimisation over time. However, scalability remains contingent on regulatory clarity, airspace management policies, safety standards, and payload constraints. While not yet mainstream, drone logistics represent a strategic optionality for Q-commerce operators seeking to further compress delivery timelines.

AI and robotics in last-mile fulfilment

Artificial intelligence and robotics are increasingly being explored to optimise last-mile delivery. Autonomous vehicles, route optimisation algorithms, predictive demand modelling, and warehouse robotics are being piloted to enhance operational efficiency.

Globally, such models are more advanced, particularly in developed markets, but India is gradually experimenting with AI-led logistics in dense urban clusters.

Challenges persist in the form of traffic complexity, infrastructure gaps, and regulatory restrictions. However, as smart-city initiatives and urban digitisation improve, AI-driven fulfilment systems could meaningfully reduce delivery costs and improve service reliability. Over time, this could enhance contribution margins by improving rider productivity and lowering variable costs per order.

Exhibit 69: Quick commerce sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	- Strong structural tailwinds from urbanisation, nuclear families, dual-income households, and time-constrained consumers. - High frequency and habit formation driven by grocery-led use cases with rapid expansion into higher ASP non-grocery categories. - Improving unit economics supported by delivery density, dark-store maturity, higher AOVs, and advertising monetisation. - Deep integration into everyday consumption missions, making platforms sticky and defensible over time.
Weakness	- Capital-intensive model, especially for inventory-led players due to working capital requirements and dark-store expansion. - Thin margins in core grocery categories, requiring scale and non-grocery mix to achieve sustainable profitability. - High operational complexity at the micro-market level, with execution risk around assortment planning and demand forecasting.
Opportunity	- Significant headroom as online grocery penetration remains low (~2% in FY25, expected to reach only 6–7% by FY30). - Rapid growth potential in Tier-1 and Tier-2+ cities, where adoption is accelerating faster than metros. - Expansion of retail media and brand advertising, with superior RoAS at point-of-purchase compared to traditional e-commerce. - Ability to become a default discovery and search platform for everyday products, expanding monetisation levers beyond delivery.
Threat	- Intensifying competition leading to potential price wars, higher incentives, or elevated customer acquisition costs. - Regulatory risks related to labour, dark-store zoning, and last-mile employment structures.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

1) Clear, balanced and uniform gig worker regulation across states

A dedicated, modern gig labour framework that builds on the labour codes but:

- Clear rights and standards for wages and hours
- Defined platform liability vs contractor status
- Simplified compliance for platforms while protecting worker security
- Uniformity across all states to ensure common market dynamics

2) Stable taxation policy to reduce retrospective liabilities

- Clarity and stability in tax norms so platforms can forecast cost structures without periodic reclassification or retrospective liabilities.

3) Food safety and API-friendly regulatory compliance

- Streamlined FSSAI compliance pathways for delivery ecosystem players, especially smaller cloud kitchens and kitchens built primarily for delivery, with standardized electronic processing, risk-based inspection, and centralized audits.
- Guidance for cold-chain and last-mile quality standards tailored to app-based delivery contexts, not just traditional retail or dine-in models.

Simpler, digital-first compliance could reduce onboarding friction, lower compliance costs, and enhance consumer trust, which drives supply augmentation.

4) Digital and infrastructure support

The following enablers could materially help the sector:

- Digital ID / e-shrams integration for gig workers to simplify social security benefits enrolment and data reporting.
- Incentives for green mobility (e-scooters, bikes), subsidies for delivery partners to adopt electric vehicles could reduce operating cost and emissions.
- Urban planning support for micro-hubs/dark store zones with designated spaces, reducing rent inflation and improving density economics.

Companies in quick commerce

Blinkit

Company Overview

Blinkit is a leading quick commerce platform, offering groceries and daily essentials through a dense network of dark stores in major Indian cities. It was acquired by Zomato (now Eterna) in 2022.

Business model and value proposition

Blinkit follows a dark-store-led, inventory-owned quick commerce model, monetising through product margins, delivery fees and advertising. High order frequency, basket expansion and store-level efficiency are key levers for improving profitability.

Exhibit 70: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Zomato (now Eterna), SoftBank, Tiger Global Management, Peak XV India, Trifecta Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by Albinder Dhindsa and Saurabh Kumar (as Grofers), Blinkit's pivot to ultra-fast delivery reshaped the category. Albinder Dhindsa continues to lead Blinkit under Eterna, with strong execution focus on store density and cost discipline.



Albinder Dhindsa
Co-Founder



Saurabh Kumar
Co-Founder

Swiggy

Company Overview

Swiggy is an on-demand convenience platform, spanning food delivery, quick commerce (Instamart), dining-out discovery and hyperlocal logistics.

Business model and value proposition

It runs a multi-vertical marketplace model, earning through food delivery commissions, delivery fees, advertising, Instamart product margins and subscription programs (Swiggy One). Scale and logistics efficiency are central to margin expansion.

Exhibit 71: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	152 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(31) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	9,000
Notable investors	Kotak MF, ICICI pru MF, SBI MF, Mirae MF, Inveso MF, Nippon MF, Prosus, Softbank, Accel, Norwest Venture Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Sriharsha Majety, Nandan Reddy and Rahul Jaimini**, the founding team blended product, operations and engineering expertise. Majety (CEO) has steered Swiggy through aggressive expansion and later consolidation.



Sriharsha Majety
Co-Founder, CEO



Nandan Reddy
Co-Founder, Head
of Innovation



Rahul Jaimini
Co-Founder

BigBasket

Company Overview

BigBasket is an online grocery and food essentials platform, founded in 2011 and headquartered in Bengaluru. It offers a wide assortment of staples, fresh produce, FMCG and private labels, serving customers across major urban centres and select Tier-2 cities.

Business model and value proposition

BigBasket operates a hybrid inventory-led and private label model, sourcing directly from farmers and FMCG brands, operating dark stores and fulfilment centres, and monetising through product margins, private labels and subscription offerings (BB Star). Its model emphasises supply-chain control and basket-level profitability.

Exhibit 72: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	100.6 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(14.2) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	1,500
Last known valuation (USD mn)	3,200 (Dec 2022)
Notable investors	Alibaba Group, Tata Digital, Mirae Asset Global Investments, CDC Group, Bessemer Venture Partners, British International Investment (BII), Ascent Capital, Helion Ventures, Trifecta Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Times of India

Founders and leadership

Founded by Hari Menon, V.S. Sudhakar, V.S. Ramesh, Vipul Parekh, Abhinay Choudhari, the team brought deep experience in FMCG, logistics and technology. Hari Menon (former Tesco executive) has been central to building BigBasket's sourcing and private-label strategy.



Hari Menon
Co-Founder & CEO



V.S. Sudhakar
Co-Founder



V.S. Ramesh
Co-Founder



Vipul Parekh
Co-Founder



Abhinay Choudhari
Co-Founder

Zepto

Company Overview

Zepto is a quick commerce startup, delivering groceries and essentials in minutes through a highly optimised dark-store network.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows an inventory-heavy, high-density quick commerce model, monetising through product margins and delivery fees. Its competitive edge lies in rapid store rollout, high throughput and tech-driven demand forecasting.

Exhibit 73: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	96.68 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(33.7) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	2,300
Last known valuation (USD mn)	7,000
Notable investors	Glade Brook Capital Partners, Nexus Venture Partners, Lightspeed Venture Partners, Y Combinator, Contrary Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Upstox

Founders and leadership

Founded by Aadit Palicha and Kaivalya Vohra, both Stanford dropouts, Zepto's founders represent a new generation of high-velocity startup execution, focused aggressively on scale and market leadership.



Aadit Palicha
Co-Founder, CEO



Kaivalya Vohra
Co-Founder, CTO

Recent developments

In FY25, Zepto raised large late-stage funding rounds, crossed USD 1bn annualised GMV, expanded aggressively across metros, and invested heavily in supply-chain automation while still prioritising growth over near-term profitability.

Urban Company

Company overview

Urban Company is a home services marketplace, offering beauty, cleaning, repair and appliance services via a tech-enabled platform connecting professionals with consumers.

Business model and value proposition

Urban Company operates a managed marketplace model, controlling service quality, pricing, training and consumables. Revenue is generated through service commissions, product sales to professionals and subscription-based offerings.

Exhibit 74: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	11.4 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	2.4 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	2,400
Notable investors	SBI MF, Elevation capital, Prosus, Accel, steadview, Bessemer

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

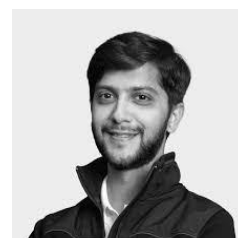
Founded by Abhiraj Singh Bhal, Varun Khaitan, and Raghav Chandra, the founders bring consulting and product backgrounds, enabling Urban Company to standardise traditionally unorganised service categories.



Abhiraj Singh Bhal
Co-Founder, CEO



Varun Khaitan
Co-Founder, COO



Raghav Chandra
Co-Founder, CTPO

Chapter 6: Deep dive into B2B E-commerce

B2B E-commerce – sector overview

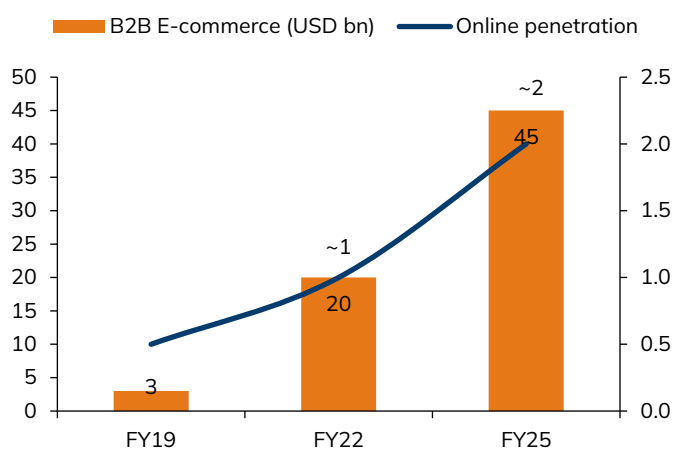
Indian B2B market is one of the largest and the fastest growing globally and is expected to reach USD 2.5trn by 2030E, as per our estimates. Digital penetration today in B2B commerce is still under 2%, indicating massive headroom for scalable digital-first platforms. The TAM for the B2B e-commerce segment as of CY25 is ~USD 45-50bn as per our estimates.

While businesses have embraced digital tools like GST filing and UPI payments, procurement remains largely offline, localised, and dependent on intermediaries. Despite rising demand, MSMEs that power India's B2B sector remain constrained by fragmented supply chains, opaque pricing, credit bottlenecks, and low digital adoption. The ecosystem remains intermediary-heavy, offline-first, and hyper-localised, with limited presence of scaled distributors or digital platforms. These frictions erode margins, reduce competitiveness, and inhibit scale. However, this complexity also presents white space for full-stack, tech-led solutions to manage end-to-end needs of buyers and sellers.

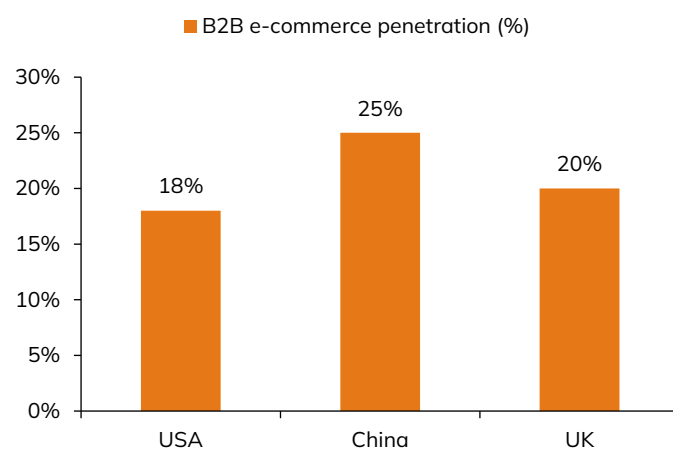
Just as B2C evolved from unstructured marketplaces to integrated platforms, B2B is expected to move from listing-based models to full-stack procurement ecosystems with embedded credit, tech-enabled fulfilment, and category expansion. A unified, end-to-end digital experience will likely be a game changer.

Exhibit 75: B2B e-commerce is estimated to be USD 45-50bn, accounting for <2% of India B2B market

Exhibit 76: B2B e-commerce penetration globally



Source: I-Sec research



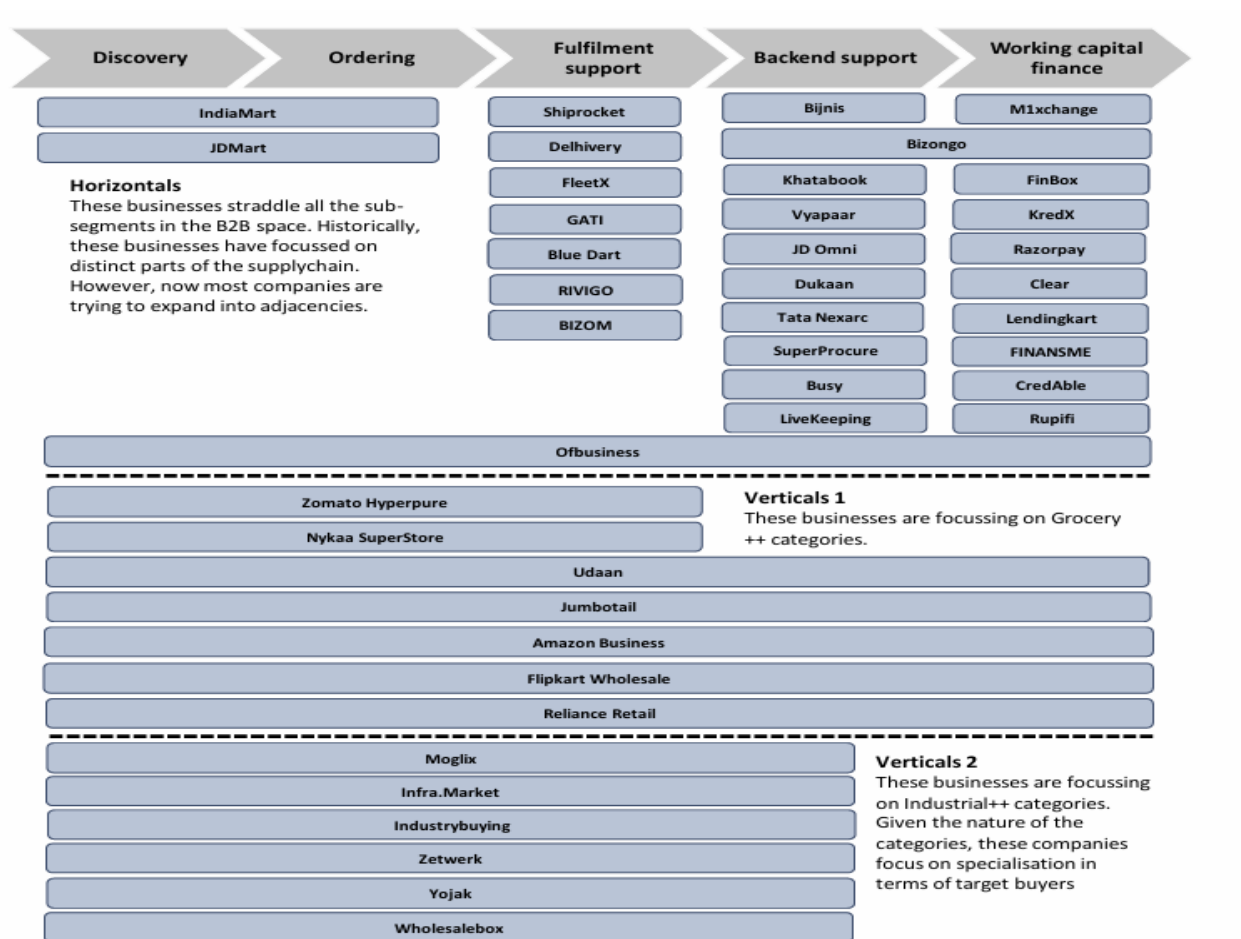
Source: I-Sec research

B2B e-commerce industry structure

B2B e-commerce market can be loosely structured as horizontals and verticals.

- Horizontals are generally marketplace models which span the entire breadth of the value chain. These companies aim to cater to basic customer needs in the transactional layer, such as discovery and ordering or backend processes. The breadth of segments catered to, allows such businesses to scale meaningfully.
- Verticals, on the other hand, focus on specific segments. This allows them to cater to more complex customer needs such as ordering and fulfilment. Broadly, we divide the verticals segment into two sub-segments: grocery++ and industrial++. While the horizontals are generally marketplaces, verticals can be a hybrid of marketplace and inventory-led models.

Exhibit 77: B2B e-commerce industry structure



Source: I-Sec research

Business models within the B2B e-commerce

The B2B landscape in India is largely fragmented with millions of unorganized MSMEs, distributors and wholesalers operating throughout the country. B2B e-commerce, on the other hand, attempts to bring all these players onto a single platform with an aim to aggregate demand and supply. B2B e-commerce players have started building platforms for SMEs and traders. While there are several B2B e-commerce platforms with different operating models, they can be broadly categorized under three broad business models

Exhibit 78: Comparing business models within the B2B e-commerce space

	Discovery/Classifieds	Ordering and Fulfilment	Backend support
	Limited	High	Medium
Revenue potential	Take rates for these business models are typically <1%	Take rates for these business models can range between 10-25% for pure market places and goes up further as the proportion of inventory based sales goes up	Revenue potential in the range of 1-3%
	Medium	Limited	High
Margin potential	Steady state operating margins in the range of 30-35%	Steady state operating margins in the range of 8-15%	Steady state operating margins can be in the range of 35-40%
	High	Limited	Medium
Capital efficiency	Low capex requirements and negative cash conversion cycles result in high capital efficiency	High capex requirements and high working capital requirement (in order to provide credit to buyers in some cases) results in subdued capital efficiency	Medium capex requirement in order to build out products and working capital requirements
	High	Low	NA
Seller loyalty	Sellers prefer such businesses due to no conflict of interest, as the company is not competing with them	Sellers are sometimes hesitant due to perceived conflict of interest, as the company maybe competing with them	
	Low	Medium	High
Buyer loyalty	Buyers are price sensitive and given the low contact nature of the business model, buyer loyalty is low	Buyers are price sensitive but this somewhat mitigated by the fact that the entire customer experience piece is controlled by the company. Resultant buyer loyalty is medium.	Buyer price sensitivity is low given the need for steady performance is crucial to business continuity for buyer

Source: I-Sec research

1) Discovery and classifieds

Given the changes to the regulatory framework in India post GST implementation and the subsequent disruptions, Indian MSMEs have realized the need for expanding their catchment beyond traditional customer base. There is also a much wider appreciation of authentic price discovery across cities and sometimes across states. GST makes it much easier to conduct inter-state transactions and a significantly improved logistics network has made such transactions more cost efficient than before.

Online B2B classifieds provide a cost effective and convenient channel for exchange of goods and services by connecting buyers and suppliers. They primarily operate on the following revenue streams:

- Subscription – B2B classifieds offer a number subscription packages to sellers in exchange for increasing their visibility on the platform
- Pay per lead – Platforms also offer certain requirements posted by buyers as 'paid leads' to suppliers. These paid leads can be purchased by the suppliers over and above their subscription packages.
- Advertising – Suppliers buying space for display advertising on the platform. Some of the major online B2B classified platforms in India include IndiaMart, TradeIndia, Exporters India, Alibaba India and JD Business.

2) Ordering and fulfilment (marketplace)

This is by far the largest revenue model in the B2B e-commerce segment and unsurprisingly has seen greatest participation from different sets of financial investors. Companies operating in this space work on commissions from transactions facilitated and sometimes from direct sales to customers.

Given the deeper complexity of customer needs in the space, it is unlikely that one company can cater to the entire segment on its own. Therefore, we analyze the space into two sub-categories:

Grocery++

This sub-segment comprises milk and milk products, fruits and vegetables, animal protein, food staples, FMCG, lifestyle products, electronics and pharma. The grocery++ sub-segment is dominated by Udaan followed by JioMart, Amazon Business, Flipkart Wholesale, Jumbotail, Zomato Hyperpure, and Nykaa Super Store.

Industrials++

This sub-segment comprises construction materials and equipment, home improvement and décor, auto and components, machinery and spares, packaging, chemicals, etc.

The industrials++ sub-segment has key players including Ofbusiness, Infra.market, Zetwerk, Moglix, etc.

Some of the corporate players have entered in this space, including Birla Pivot and JSW One platform.

Exhibit 79: B2B e-commerce – Ordering and fulfilment

Grocery++	Industrials++
Ticket-size in the range of INR 2,000-12,000.	Typically >INR 5,000. May increase multi-fold for some categories such as heavy machinery etc.
EBITDA potential in the range of 5-8% in steady state.	EBITDA potential in the range of 5-15% in steady state.
Value-addition potential lower due to regulatory challenges in sourcing directly from farmers in staples and perishable categories.	Value addition potential higher because of presence in highly complex product categories with limited suppliers - such as complex industrial machinery.
Branding of staples and efficient sourcing of apparel products likely to be key drivers of growth in the space.	Formalisation of building materials such as ready-mix concrete and efficient sourcing of machine parts likely to be key drivers of growth in the space.
Supply of credit will likely continue to be the key reason for digital adoption growing among retailers.	Price discovery will likely continue to be the key reason for digital adoption growing among buyers. Marketing and lead generation will likely continue to be the key reason for digital adoption growing among sellers. Supply of credit will likely be a very important enabler to the above triggers.

Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Transaction based B2B platforms function in a similar manner to the B2C platforms where buyers can compare and purchase products offered by multiple sellers directly. However, unlike B2C, B2B transaction-based platforms have features specific to B2B requirements like applying for bulk orders, quantity discounts, ability to edit a purchase order online, quotations and RFPs for orders, pricing by customer, ability to accept different payment types like bank transfers and scheduled payments, ability to provide basic dashboards for seeing a consolidated view of purchases and sales, etc.

The B2B transaction-based platforms may have the following monetisation models:

- Commission in a marketplace model – Charging a specified commission (percentage) on every transaction
- Inventory based model – Profits earned on re-selling inventory purchased beforehand from sellers
- Advertising – Platforms also monetise through selling space on the website for display advertising Some of the major online B2B transaction-based platforms in India include Udaan, ShopX, Jumotail, Ninjacart, Industry Buying, Power2SME, Amazon Business and Moglix.

3) Backend support (ex-logistics)

This segment, though lower in size than the 'ordering and fulfilment support' revenue model in the B2B e-commerce segment, has a significant profit potential given higher operating margin atypical of the segment. Companies operating in this space work on subscription model in most cases.

This segment is too fragmented to have meaningful revenue market shares. IndiaMART has made some acquisitions in the space to capture the revenue opportunity arising in the segment. The list includes Vyapar, BIZOM, M1exchange, Busy, Realbooks and Livekeeping.

Exhibit 80: B2B E-commerce sector - SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	Market Scale and Network Effects: Rapid digitisation of MSMEs and wholesalers is driving multi-billion-dollar GMV growth, creating powerful network effects as more buyers and sellers move procurement online.
	Regulatory and Fintech Synergy: GST reforms have simplified cross-state trade, while integrated supply-chain financing and digital payments improve order conversion and vendor stickiness.
	Maturing Logistics: The expansion of professional express networks and B2B-specific fulfilment solutions has lowered historical barriers to entry and enabled efficient bulk movement.
Weakness	Seller Fragmentation: A vast base of micro-merchants with low digital maturity necessitates high investment in onboarding, cataloguing, and quality control, which thins operational margins.
	Logistics Complexity: High costs for bulk/irregular shipments and inconsistent serviceability in Tier-2+ cities remain structural constraints that challenge unit economics.
	Credit and Collection Risks: Heavily reliant on trade credit, platforms face significant receivable risks, KYC friction, and working-capital pressures due to delayed payment cycles.
Opportunity	Uncaptured MSME Demand: The ongoing formalisation of small retailers and 'kirana' stores provides a massive, repeatable runway for high-frequency procurement spend across diverse categories.
	Vertical Specialisation: Category-specific marketplaces (e.g., Pharma, FMCG) can command higher margins by embedding domain-specific compliance, financing, and value-added services.
	Cross-Border and AI Efficiency: Digital stacks can facilitate global exports for Indian suppliers, while AI-driven demand forecasting reduces stockouts and optimises working capital for all participants.
Threat	Regulatory Compliance: Sudden shifts in product safety standards, licensing, or platform liability—especially for regulated goods—pose significant execution and delisting risks.
	Competitive Consolidation: Large horizontal players with deep pockets may aggressively enter the B2B space, leading to price wars and the commoditisation of basic product categories.
	Macroeconomic Sensitivity: Economic slowdowns can tighten buyer budgets and lengthen payment cycles, exposing platforms to heightened default risks and liquidity stress.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- MSMEs face frictions in registration, tax compliance and periodic filings across registrations (MSME/Udyam, GST, trade licences). Several industry bodies and reports have highlighted the onboarding friction for MSMEs as a key cost driver.
- Given high logistics costs and poor rural/remote express connectivity, government support (capex incentives, shared dark-store logistics clusters, subsidised cross-dock hubs, or tax relief for warehousing in underserved regions) would improve serviceability and lower unit economics for B2B shipments beyond tier-1 cities.
- A government-backed receivables registry (or stronger e-invoicing interoperability plus a legal framework for invoice-level securitisation) could let lenders underwrite receivables more cheaply, lowering the cost of working-capital finance for MSMEs and enabling platforms to scale embedded credit without excessive risk.
- Rather than one-size-fits-all enforcement, regulators could consider issuing category-wise, risk-based compliance guidelines (e.g., for chemicals, pharma inputs, industrial machinery) that specify labelling, testing and trade documentation for B2B sales. Clear standards help reduce platform uncertainty, help automated compliance checks and speed lawful trade while protecting safety.
- Open standards/APIs for procurement data (catalogue schemas, vendor attributes, product specs) would let marketplaces interoperate with government procurement portals, industry associations and fintech lenders, reducing integration costs and improving discoverability for MSMEs.
- A formal sandbox for new invoice-discounting, dynamic discounting and supply-chain finance models would let innovators test credit products for B2B buyers/sellers under regulator supervision, with safeguards for systemic risk. This could mobilise private capital behind receivables finance and reduce reliance on platforms' balance sheets.
- Government-sponsored (or co-funded) seller enablement programmes, covering catalogue creation, digital payments, packaging, GST/e-invoicing training and basic logistics practices, could increase digital readiness among suppliers and reduce the need for platforms to bear the full cost of onboarding.

Companies in B2B E-commerce sector

Jumbotail

Company overview

Jumbotail is a Bengaluru-based B2B e-commerce and supply-chain platform focused on serving kirana stores and small retailers, enabling efficient sourcing of grocery and FMCG products through a tech-enabled marketplace.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a managed B2B commerce model, combining direct sourcing, warehousing, logistics and credit enablement, earning through product margins and value-added services while optimising supply reliability for small retailers.

Exhibit 81: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	8.2 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	Not available
Total funding raised (USD mn)	263
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	Nexus Venture Partners, Kalaari Capital, Arkam Ventures, Alteria Capital, InnoVen Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by S. Karthik Venkateswaran (CEO) and Ashish Jhina (COO), the leadership brings deep expertise in large-scale supply chains, ecommerce operations and technology-driven retail transformation.



S. Karthik
Venkateswaran
Co-Founder, CEO



Ashish Jhina
Co-Founder, COO

Infra.Market

Company overview

Infra.Market is a Mumbai-based construction materials and infrastructure solutions platform supplying concrete, steel, aggregates and value-added building products to infrastructure and real-estate developers across India.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a B2B sourcing and manufacturing-led model, combining own manufacturing units with a digital procurement platform, earning via product margins and long-term supply contracts.

Exhibit 82: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	184.7 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	2.2 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Accel, Nexus Venture Partners, Evolve India Fund, Fundamental GmbH, Mars Growth Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Souvik Sengupta and Aaditya Sharda, the founders bring strong execution capability in infrastructure procurement, supply-chain optimisation and large-scale project delivery.



Souvik Sengupta
Co-Founder, CEO



Aaditya Sharda
Co-Founder, COO

JSW One Platforms

Company overview

JSW One Platforms is the B2B e-commerce and digital services arm of the JSW Group, offering integrated sourcing solutions for steel, cement, construction materials and MSME services.

Business model and value proposition

JSW One operates a digital procurement and services marketplace, monetising through product sales, distribution margins and embedded services such as financing, logistics and project support.

Exhibit 83: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	39.8 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	Not available
Total funding raised (USD mn)	65
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	State Bank of India (SBI), Principal Asset Management, One-Up, International Conveyors (ICL), Scarlett Ventures, JSW Steel

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, New India Express

Founders and leadership

Backed and promoted by the JSW Group, the platform benefits from strong industrial pedigree, balance-sheet strength and leadership with deep experience in metals, infrastructure and B2B commerce.



Gaurav Sachdeva
CEO

Moglix

Company overview

Moglix is a Singapore-headquartered, India-focused B2B industrial ecommerce platform serving manufacturing, infrastructure and enterprise customers with MRO, safety, electricals and industrial supplies.

Business model and value proposition

Moglix follows a managed marketplace and private-label model, earning via product margins, enterprise contracts and SaaS-led procurement solutions, with increasing focus on manufacturing clients.

Exhibit 84: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	49.6 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.9) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	2,600
Notable investors	Accel, IFC (International Finance Corporation), Jungle Ventures, Alpha Wave Global, Peak XV, Tiger Global Management, Harvard Management company

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

Founded by Rahul Garg (former Google executive), the leadership brings strong product, enterprise sales and global ecommerce experience.



Rahul Garg
Founder

Ofbusiness

Company overview

OfBusiness is a New Delhi-based B2B commerce and fintech platform that supplies raw materials (metals, polymers, chemicals) to MSMEs while offering embedded working-capital financing.

Business model and value proposition

It runs an integrated commerce + credit model, monetising through trading margins and financing income, with strong data-driven underwriting and repeat MSME relationships.

Exhibit 85: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	192.9 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	6.03 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	890
Last known valuation (USD mn)	5,000
Notable investors	Tiger Global, SoftBank, Norwest Venture Partners, Matrix Partners, Alpha Wave Global, and Creation Investments, Falcon Edge Capital, Zodius, Marshall Wace, Cornerstone Ventures, 4DX Ventures, Blume Ventures, Alteria Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Asish Mohapatra, Ruchi Kalra, Bhuvan Gupta, Vasant Sridhar, Nitin Jain, Srinath Ramakkrushnan, the leadership combines consulting, credit analytics and supply-chain expertise, making OfBusiness one of India's most scaled B2B fintech-commerce hybrids.



Asish Mohapatra
Co-Founder, CEO



Ruchi Kalra
Co-Founder



Vasant Sridhar
Co-Founder, CSO



Bhuvan Gupta
Co-Founder, CTO



Srinath
Ramakkrushnan
Co-Founder



Nitin Jain
Co-Founder

Udaan

Company overview

Udaan is a Bengaluru-based B2B trade platform connecting manufacturers, brands, traders and retailers across categories such as FMCG, electronics, lifestyle and staples.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a full-stack B2B commerce model with logistics, warehousing and credit, monetising through product margins while bearing higher operational complexity and capital intensity.

Exhibit 86: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	45.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(10.6) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,800
Notable investors	Microsoft, DST Global, Lightspeed Venture Partners, MandG Investments, Lighthouse Canton Innovent Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Times of India

Founders and leadership

Founded by Vaibhav Gupta, Amod Malviya and Sujeet Kumar (former Flipkart leaders), the founding team brings deep ecommerce scaling and marketplace execution experience.



Vaibhav Gupta
Co-Founder



Amod Malviya
Co-Founder



Sujeet Kumar
Co-Founder

Metalbook

Company overview

Metalbook is a full-stack digital supply-chain platform for the metals industry. Founded in 2020 and headquartered in Gurugram, India, it operates a B2B marketplace that connects buyers, suppliers, and other stakeholders in a single ecosystem.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows an asset-light, managed marketplace model that generates revenue primarily from the sale of ferrous and non-ferrous commodities. It acts as a one-stop-shop for buying, selling and e-auctioning metals (steel, aluminium, copper). Metalbook's value proposition addresses key inefficiencies in the traditional metal industry, such as opaque pricing and fragmented logistics.

Exhibit 87: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	13.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.09) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Axilor, Foundamental, and RTP Global

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Metalbook was founded in 2021 by Pulkit Baldev, Aman Tibrewal, and Raghavendra Pratap Singh. The leadership team combines deep domain expertise from the traditional steel industry with experience from high-growth tech platforms like Uber and Tata Steel.



Pulkit Baldev
Co-founder and CEO



Aman Tibrewal
Co-founder



Raghavendra Pratap Singh
Co-founder

Recent Developments

Beyond its core ferrous (steel) products, Metalbook has launched verticals for non-ferrous metals (copper, aluminium, zinc, and nickel) and metal recycling. The platform has expanded into specialised sectors, including Renewable Energy (solar panels, inverters, and battery storage) and Aerospace.

Bizongo

Company overview

Bizongo is a B2B supply chain and procurement platform focused on packaging, textiles, and raw materials, helping enterprises digitize sourcing and vendor management.

Business model and value proposition

The company combines B2B marketplace, SaaS and financing, generating revenue through transaction margins, subscription fees for digital tools, and supply chain financing. It is transitioning toward a more asset-light, SaaS-led model.

Exhibit 88: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.7 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.9) (FY23)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	307
Last known valuation (USD mn)	980
Notable investors	Accel, Tiger Global Management, British International Investment, Mars growth capital,

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

Bizongo was founded by Sachin Agrawal. Sachin Agrawal, the CEO, has prior experience in consulting and startups, and leads strategy, enterprise relationships, and fundraising.

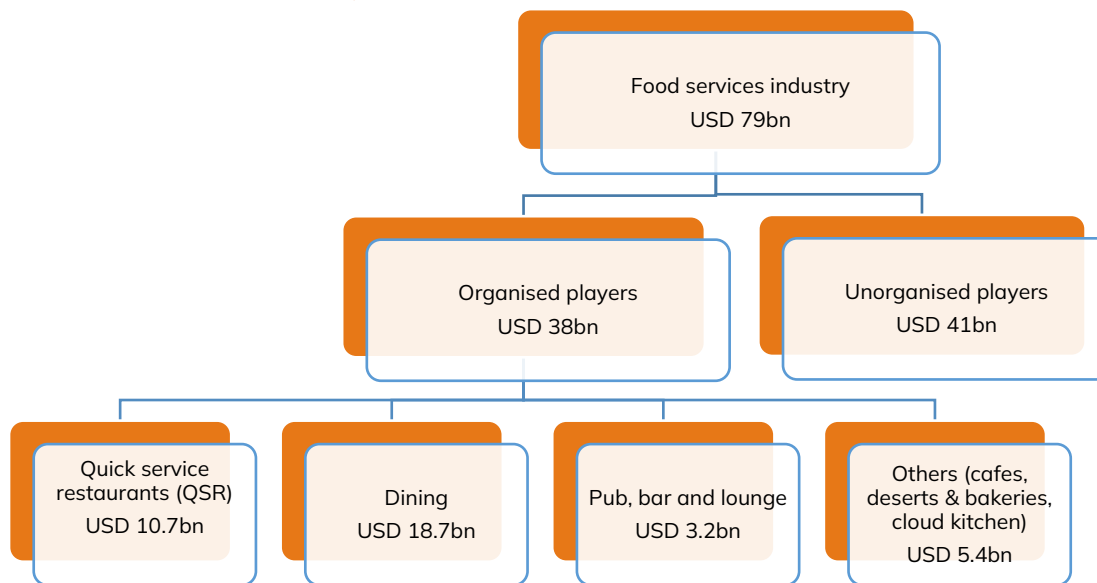


Sachin Agarwal
Co-founder & CEO

Chapter 7: Deep dive into Food Delivery

Food Delivery – sector overview

Exhibit 89: Total food services industry market size in FY25



Source: I-Sec research

India's food services industry has delivered steady growth over the past five years, expanding at ~9% CAGR between FY20–25 from ~INR 4trn (~USD 52bn) in FY20 to ~INR 7trn (~USD 79bn) in FY25. The incremental growth is increasingly being driven by the organised segment, which has grown at a faster 12–17% CAGR over FY20–25.

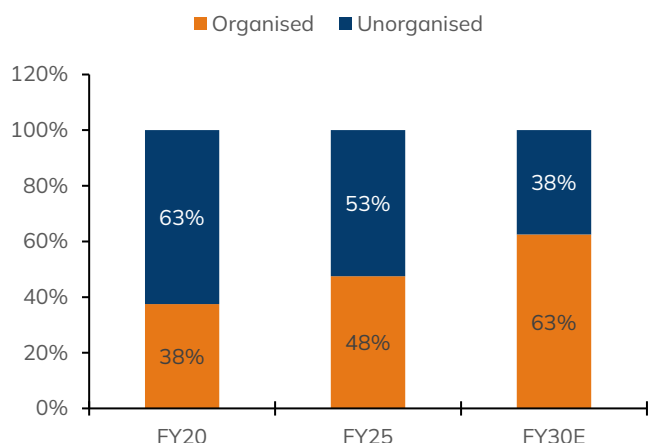
According to Redseer Research, the sector is projected to scale further to ~INR 11–12trn (~USD 135–140bn) by FY30P, implying an accelerated CAGR of ~11–12% over FY25–30P, majorly driven by the organised segment.

The organised food services market (licensed, branded restaurant chains) has seen its share rise from ~38% in FY20 to ~48% in FY25 and is expected to reach ~63% by FY30P. In absolute terms, the organised segment stands at ~INR 3.2trn (~USD 38bn) in FY25 and is projected to nearly double to ~INR 6.6trn (~USD 86bn) by FY30P.

The next phase of growth in organised food services is likely to be driven by deeper penetration beyond tier-2 cities, where branded formats still remain underrepresented. As disposable incomes rise and consumption formalises in smaller towns, organised players are expanding into these markets with calibrated store formats. At the same time, the emergence of strong regional brands is broadening the competitive landscape and accelerating formalisation. The increasing adoption of cloud kitchens is improving capital efficiency and enabling brands to scale without significant front-end real estate investments.

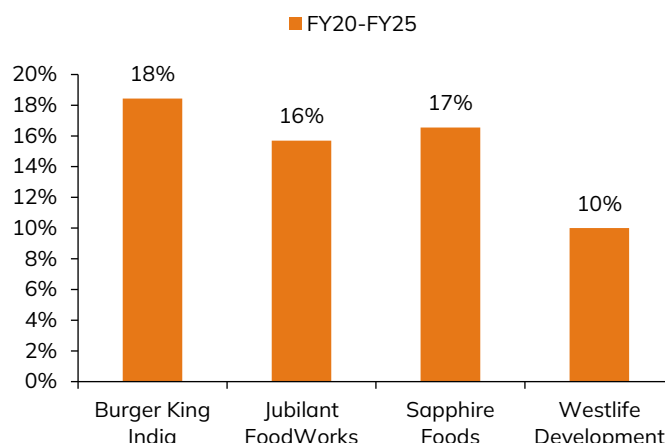
Continuous menu innovation, focused on affordability and healthier alternatives are further helping brands expand their addressable consumer base and drive higher frequency.

Exhibit 90: The organised segment has been the key driver of incremental growth, expanding at a CAGR of 12-17% over FY20-25



Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 91: Growth rate of major QSR players between FY20-25



Source: I-Sec research

The structural growth opportunity is reflected in the expansion plans of listed QSR operators. Jubilant FoodWorks has guided for ~ 1,000 new stores over the medium term, underscoring its confidence in sustained demand.

Devyani International and Sapphire Foods are each targeting annual additions of around 100–120 KFC stores, while Restaurant Brands Asia aims to scale to roughly 800 stores by FY29. Importantly, nearly 60–80% of QSR outlets remain concentrated in Tier-1 and metro cities, suggesting meaningful white space in tier-2/3 markets. This aggressive rollout strategy indicates that organised players are positioning themselves early to capture incremental demand as formalisation deepens across the country.

Online food delivery – from hyper-growth to duopoly

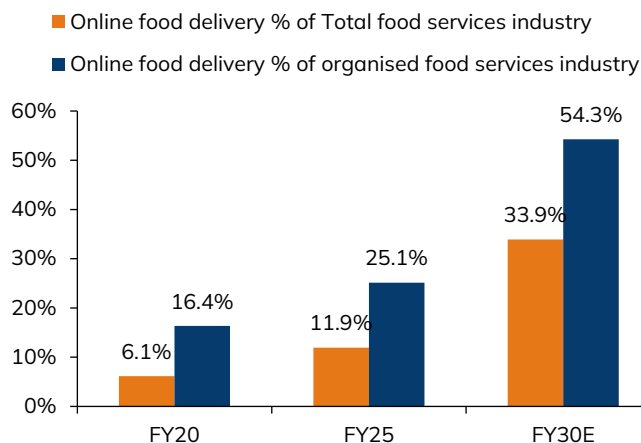
Online food delivery has emerged as a meaningful sub-segment within India's food services industry, accounting for ~12% of total food services and ~25% of the organised segment as of FY25. The category began gaining traction around 2015, supported by rapid smartphone penetration, affordable mobile data, and intuitive app-based interfaces that significantly lowered friction in ordering. The COVID-19 pandemic acted as a structural accelerator, pushing consumer adoption and normalising digital ordering behaviour across demographics.

In value terms, India's online food delivery market expanded from ~INR 0.27trn (~USD 3bn) in FY20 to ~INR 0.8trn (~USD 9bn) in FY25. The market is projected to scale further to ~INR 1.7–2.2trn (~USD 20–26bn) by FY30P (Source: Redseer Research), implying a robust CAGR of ~17–23% over FY25–30P. This growth trajectory suggests that online food delivery will likely continue to outpace overall food services growth, gradually increasing its penetration within both the total and organised markets.

From a competitive standpoint, the industry has transitioned from a fragmented, capital-intensive phase to a consolidated structure. Following an intense competitive period between FY15–18, when multiple players such as Zomato, Swiggy, Faasos, Foodpanda, and Uber Eats competed aggressively, the market has effectively settled into a duopoly. According to our estimates, as on FY26E, Zomato and Swiggy together command ~85% market share, with most other competitors either acquired or having exited the market.

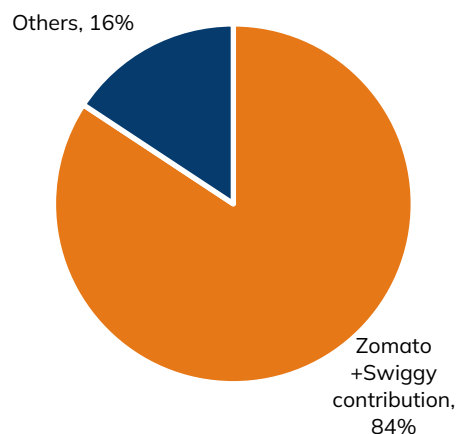
The current structure provides improved pricing discipline, better unit economics, and a clearer pathway to sustainable profitability compared to the earlier growth-at-all-costs phase.

Exhibit 92: Online food delivery penetration of total food services market



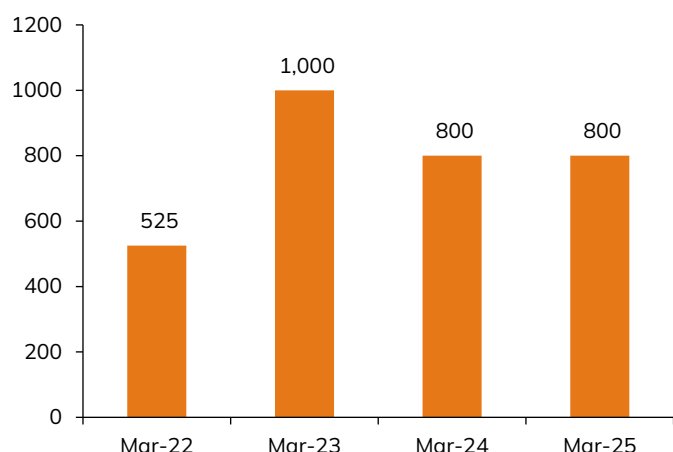
Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 93: Zomato + Swiggy GOV have 85% of market share in online food delivery



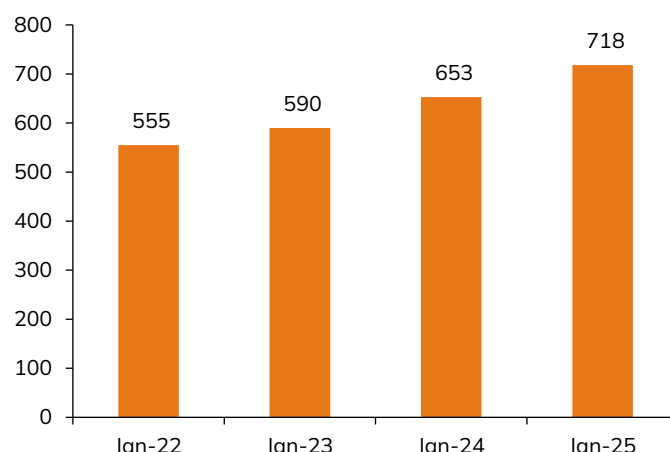
Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 94: Eternal's food delivery's city presence over time



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 95: Swiggy's food delivery's city presence over time



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Growth drivers – tier-2+ expansion and rising frequency

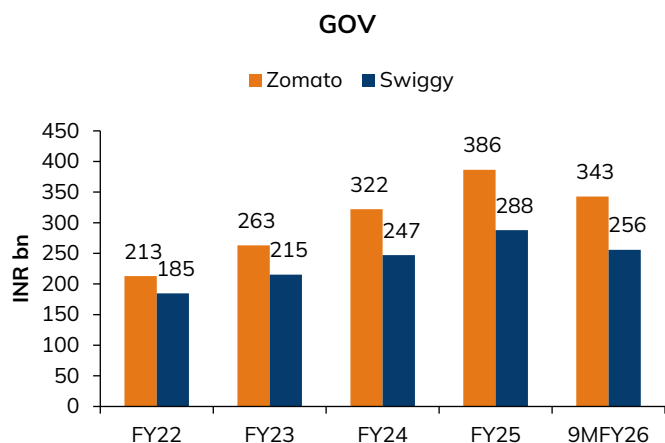
The next phase of growth in online food delivery is expected to be driven by deeper penetration into Tier-2 and smaller cities, along with a structural increase in ordering frequency. As of FY24, Tier-2+ cities account for ~20–25% of overall food delivery Gross Order Value (GOV), defined as the total monetary value of all orders before discounts, excluding tips, and inclusive of taxes and delivery charges on non-loyalty orders. This relatively low contribution underscores significant headroom for expansion as platforms deepen restaurant supply, improve delivery logistics, and scale marketing efforts in these markets.

At a structural level, GOV growth is likely to be supported by two core levers: expansion in Monthly Transacting Customers (MTC) and a rise in high-frequency or 'power' users (customers ordering more than 50 times annually). As more Annual Transacting Customers (ATC) begin ordering consistently every month, conversion from ATC to MTC should improve, driving higher annual order frequency. Simultaneously, continued

new customer acquisition, particularly in underpenetrated cities, will likely expand the user base, further strengthening the MTC cohort.

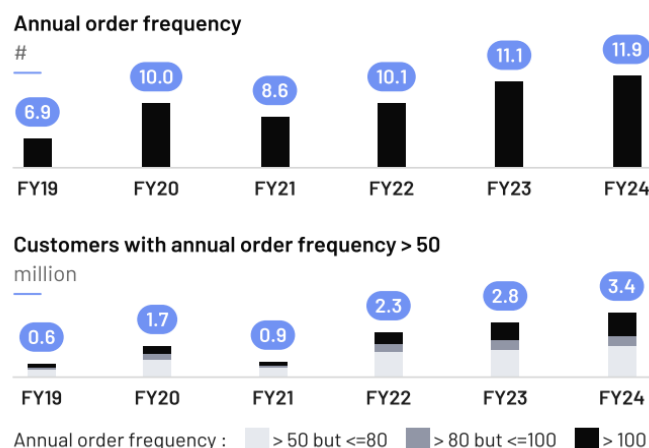
In essence, the growth algorithm for the sector remains a combination of user addition, improved engagement, and increasing order intensity per user, with Tier-2+ cities representing the largest incremental opportunity over the medium term.

Exhibit 96: GOV break up (Eternal vs. Swiggy)



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 97: Power user



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 98: Online food delivery – MTU and ATU

Metric	Unit	FY20	FY25	FY30P	CAGR FY20–25	CAGR FY25–30P
Monthly Transacting Users (MTU)	mn	12–18	25–35	44–65	14% – 16%	12% – 13%
Annual Transacting Users (ATU)	mn	50–60	90–105	145–170	~12%	~10%
MTU / ATU	%	24–30%	28–33%	31–38%		

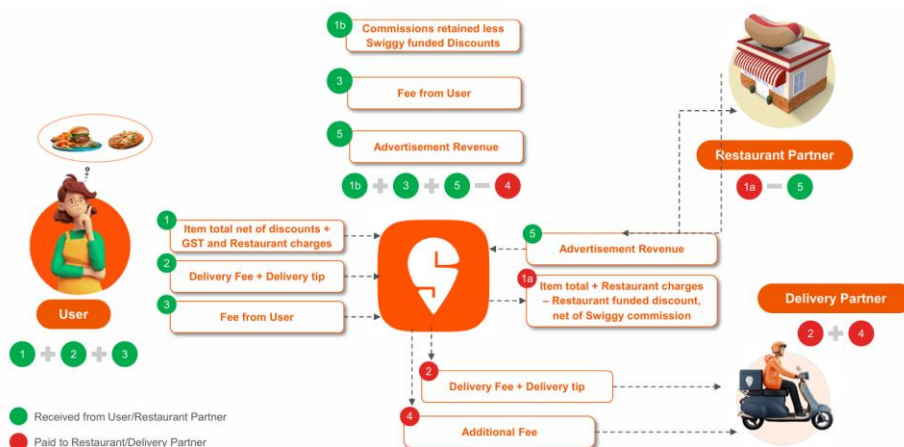
Source: Redseer Research, I-Sec research

Food delivery sector's unit economics

A density-led marketplace model: Food delivery operates as a three-sided marketplace connecting users, restaurants and delivery partners. The platform aggregates demand, facilitates discovery, processes payments and manages last-mile logistics. At a unit level, profitability is determined by the balance between monetisation levers (commission, user fees, advertising) and fulfilment costs (delivery payouts and discounts).

The sector has transitioned from a discount-led acquisition model to a monetisation-and-efficiency-driven framework, where contribution margin per order is the key driver of sustainable EBITDA expansion.

Exhibit 99: Food Delivery sector – platform economics



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

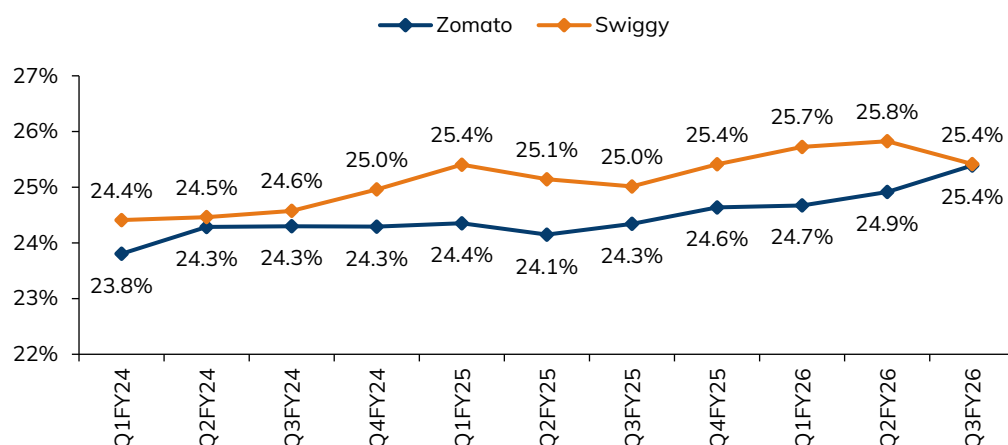
Take-rate convergence suggests a more rational competitive phase

The Indian food delivery sector is witnessing gradual convergence in take rates between Zomato and Swiggy, signalling improving pricing discipline and structural maturity. Over Q1FY24 to Q3FY26, Zomato's take rate has expanded from ~23.8% to ~25.4%, while Swiggy's, which historically operated at a modest premium in the 24.4–25.8% range, has moderated to ~25.4%. In our view, the earlier differential of ~50–100bps has largely closed, with both platforms now operating at comparable monetisation levels.

We believe this convergence reflects a more rational competitive environment, where the strategic focus appears to have shifted from aggressive market share expansion to profitability and margin stability. With a stable duopoly structure in place, neither player seems incentivised to materially undercut commissions. In our view, rising contribution from advertising income and platform fees have also strengthened blended monetisation, reducing reliance on headline commission rates as a primary competitive tool.

Going forward, we believe take-rate stability, around 25% levels, provides improved visibility on contribution margins. In our assessment, incremental margin expansion is more likely to be driven by improvements in average order value, ad revenue penetration, delivery efficiency and operating leverage, rather than further meaningful take rate hikes. Overall, we believe the convergence in take rates supports the thesis that the sector has entered a more disciplined, profitability-oriented phase.

Exhibit 100: Take rates – Zomato and Swiggy

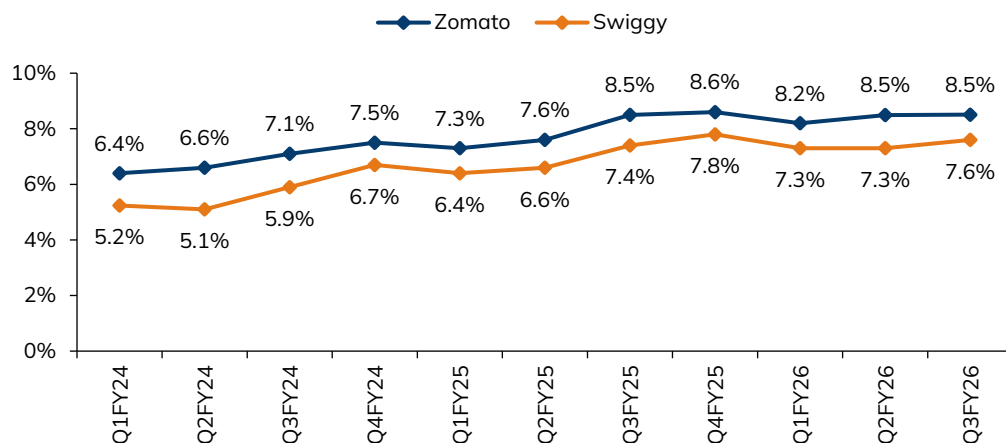


Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Contribution margin trends indicate improving operating leverage, with Zomato maintaining a structural edge

We believe contribution margin trends across Zomato and Swiggy have been reflecting steady operating leverage and improving unit economics over the past two years. From Q1FY24 to Q3FY26, Zomato's contribution margin expanded from ~6.4% to ~8.5%, while Swiggy's improved from ~5.2% to ~7.6%. The overall trajectory suggests that both platforms have been able to structurally enhance per-order profitability, despite a relatively stable competitive environment.

Exhibit 101: Contribution margin



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

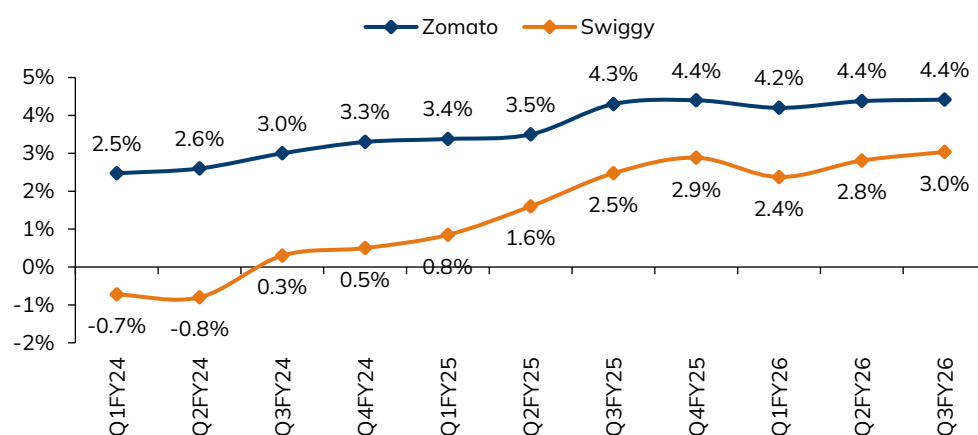
From cash burn to cash discipline – the march toward sustainable margins

India's online food delivery sector is gradually transitioning from a growth-at-all-costs model to a profitability-driven framework, with a medium- to long-term target of achieving ~5% EBITDA margin (as a percentage of GOV).

After nearly a decade of sustained cash burn, both Zomato and Swiggy have turned EBITDA positive. Zomato currently leads on profitability, benefiting from superior fixed cost absorption driven by the scale of its broader operations. In Q3FY26, Zomato reported an EBITDA margin (as % of GOV) of ~4.4%, compared to ~3.0% for Swiggy, highlighting the advantage of operating leverage at scale.

Importantly, the competitive environment has become relatively benign, with stable market shares and limited irrational discounting. This structural shift allows both players to prioritise margin expansion and unit economics over aggressive market share capture in the near term. As a result, incremental improvements in take rates, delivery efficiency, and customer mix are expected to gradually support progression toward the ~5% EBITDA margin aspiration over the medium term.

Exhibit 102: EBITDA margins



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Trends in food delivery sector

Ozempic and appetite-altering drugs – implications for food delivery demand

The recent surge in use of GLP-1 appetite-suppressing drugs such as Ozempic, Wegovy and Mounjaro is beginning to shift eating patterns and spending behaviour in ways that may affect food delivery demand.

Evidence from recent studies at Cornell, and consumer surveys show that within six months of starting a GLP-1 medication, households reduce grocery spending by an average of 5.3%. Among higher-income households, the drop is even steeper, at more than 8%. Spending at fast-food restaurants, coffee shops and other limited-service eateries falls by ~8%.

In US, households using these drugs have reduced overall grocery and dining-out spending, including fast-food and limited-service restaurant visits, by noticeable margins within six months of treatment initiation, with many respondents reporting an increase in home-cooked meals and reduced orders of calorie-dense foods.

As portion sizes shrink and preference shifts toward nutrient-dense options, order frequency and average order value on food delivery platforms could be compressed, particularly for discretionary and indulgent food categories.

Broad adoption of these drugs over the medium term could translate into more selective ordering behaviour, with consumers favouring smaller, healthier meal options or reducing the number of delivery occasions overall, presenting both headwinds and a potential opportunity for platforms to innovate healthier menu offerings and segmented product strategies.

Cloud kitchens – strategic role and sector dynamics

Cloud kitchens have emerged as a pivotal structural element in the food delivery ecosystem, addressing both supply-side constraints and changing consumer demand patterns. By decoupling kitchen capacity from high-cost real estate and dine-in infrastructure, cloud kitchens enable brands to scale rapidly in key demand corridors while offering diverse cuisines with improved delivery efficiency.

They also help platforms and restaurant partners optimise unit economics by clustering multiple brands and menus under one operational footprint, reducing overhead and improving order fulfilment speed. This model is particularly attractive in urban clusters where delivery density is high but real estate costs are prohibitive, enabling more competitive pricing and faster delivery times.

Cloud kitchens have also facilitated innovation in menu customisation, localised offerings, and co-located multi-brand strategies that enhance monetisation and customer choice.

As delivery penetration continues to deepen beyond core zones and brands seek cost-efficient expansion, cloud kitchens are likely to play an increasing role in shaping competitive dynamics, creating differentiated value propositions, and improving contribution margins across both platform and partner restaurant economics.

Micro delivery players – brands building proprietary delivery capabilities

In response to high third-party platform commissions and the desire for stronger brand control and direct customer relationships, an increasing number of restaurant chains and food brands are developing their own delivery fleets or direct delivery channels.

Traditionally, quick-service brands like Domino's and McDonald's have operated proprietary delivery infrastructure at scale, enabling them to capture higher share of order value and maintain control over delivery quality and customer experience. Domino's has long used its own app and fleet to ensure fast delivery and direct customer contact. Similarly, Pizza Hut operates its own digital channels to maintain a branded experience. By doing so, these companies avoid relying exclusively on third-party aggregators.

Beyond global QSRs, other full-service and casual dining brands globally are experimenting with self-delivery or hybrid models, reflecting a broader shift in off-premise strategy. Some chains have introduced proprietary platforms or direct ordering apps that either operate their own delivery logistics or control the customer interface even when leveraging a third-party logistics partner for fulfilment. These include US casual dining names such as Olive Garden, which recently expanded direct delivery through its own ordering system, and brands exploring hybrid strategies to balance brand control with cost efficiencies.

This trend is further reinforced by restaurant owners independently building online ordering and delivery systems to reduce dependency on marketplace platforms, retain pricing power, and strengthen customer loyalty through direct engagement. Food delivery has transitioned from a peripheral convenience into a primary revenue driver. Consequently, restaurant brands are deploying micro-delivery fleets through in-house or hybrid models to secure strategic advantages. These initiatives optimise unit economics and protect margins while differentiating the customer experience within an increasingly competitive landscape.

Exhibit 103: Food delivery sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	High-frequency habit potential: Food delivery already shows improved engagement metrics (MTU/ATU rising), so incremental frequency gains translate directly to revenue with limited incremental fixed cost.
	Large under-penetrated TAM: Out-of-home / organized food penetration is low vs peers, structural room for orders-per-capita to rise as incomes and urbanization increase.
	Strong demand aggregation and monetisation levers: Platforms can capture commission + platform fees + ad revenue; ad revenue and platform fees provide higher-margin upside than pure commissions.
	Deep logistics and scale advantage: Market incumbents have invested multi-year in routing, supply partnerships and partnerships (kitchens/cloud models). This creates a barrier for late entrants.
Weakness	Delivery cost sensitivity: Per-order delivery is a structurally large variable cost; wage inflation or rider shortage directly compresses margins with limited pass-through. Recent results and commentary show volatility in last-mile economics.
	Frequency ceiling risk and cultural elasticity: India's home-cooking preference implies a lower natural frequency ceiling than some developed markets; incremental frequency gains may be harder and more expensive.
Opportunity	Ad / commerce monetisation expansion: Point-of-purchase ad inventory, promoted listings, and cross-sell to dining/reservations are higher-margin adjacencies that can scale as GOV rises.
	Adjacencies and verticals: Integrating delivery with grocery/QC, dining reservations, and B2B supply (Hyperpure-like) creates cross-sell and higher-AOV mixes. Zomato/Eternal disclosures show this optionality.
	Tier 2/3 digitalisation: Faster online adoption in smaller cities can grow user base, but success depends on proving micro-market economics (CAC, retention, throughput).
	Product differentiation via verticalization: Own kitchens, branded quick-snacks, or proprietary FMCG SKUs can create pricing power and margin capture if executed at scale.
Threat	Regulatory and social pressure on rider safety / delivery speed: Government interventions (e.g., curbs on ultra-fast 10-minute promises, rider welfare measures) can raise costs or constrain quick-delivery tactics.
	Intensifying competition / new entrants: Large e-commerce or retail groups can leverage logistics and capital to pressure take rates and real estate.
	Gig-worker cost inflation and labour rules: Policy shifts and unionization or mandated benefits increase structural wage costs for last-mile delivery, compressing margins.

Source: I-Sec Research

Potential policy pathways

1) Clear, balanced and uniform gig worker regulation across states

A dedicated, modern gig labour framework that builds on the labour codes but:

- Clear rights and standards for wages and hours
- Defined platform liability vs contractor status
- Simplified compliance for platforms while protecting worker security
- Uniformity across all states to ensure common market dynamics

2) Stable taxation policy to reduce retrospective liabilities

- Clarity and stability in tax norms so platforms can forecast cost structures without periodic reclassification or retrospective liabilities.

3) Food safety regulatory compliance

- Streamlined FSSAI compliance pathways for delivery ecosystem players, especially smaller cloud kitchens and kitchens built primarily for delivery, with standardized electronic processing, risk-based inspection, and centralized audits.
- Guidance for cold-chain and last-mile quality standards tailored to app-based delivery contexts, not just traditional retail or dine-in models.

Simpler, digital-first compliance reduces onboarding friction, lowers compliance costs, and enhances consumer trust, which drives supply augmentation.

4) Digital and infrastructure support

The following enablers could materially help the sector:

- Digital ID / e-shrams integration for gig workers to simplify social security benefits enrolment and data reporting.
- Incentives for green mobility (e-scooters, bikes), subsidies for delivery partners to adopt electric vehicles could reduce operating cost and emissions.
- Urban planning support for micro-hubs/dark store zones with designated spaces could reduce rent inflation and improving density economics.

This might help in lowering operating costs and facilitating easy digital integration; more efficient logistics networks strengthen unit economics for platforms and help expand sustainably into tier-2/3 cities.

Companies in food delivery sector

Eternal

Company overview

Eternal is a listed Indian consumer internet company housing Zomato (food delivery), Blinkit (quick commerce) and adjacent initiatives. The rebranding to Eternal reflects its ambition to be a long-term consumer platform beyond food delivery.

Business model and value proposition

Eternal operates multiple consumer marketplaces, monetising via delivery commissions, platform fees, advertising, subscriptions (Gold) and quick-commerce margins. The diversified portfolio allows cross-subsidisation and operating leverage across businesses.

Exhibit 104: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	202 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	5.3 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	30,000
Notable investors	Infoedge, SBI MF, Kotak MF, HDFC MF, Axis MF, ICICI pru MF

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Deepinder Goyal** and **Pankaj Chaddah**, Eternal's leadership has driven disciplined capital allocation and sharp focus on profitability post-IPO, especially after exiting cash-burning international markets.



Deepinder Goyal
Co-Founder



Pankaj Chaddah
Co-Founder

EatClub Brands (Box8)

Company overview

EatClub Brands (Box8) is a technology-centric, full-stack cloud kitchen company headquartered in Mumbai, operating one of Asia's largest multi-brand cloud kitchen networks. Founded originally as Box8 in 2012, the company has scaled to hundreds of kitchens across major Indian cities and a portfolio of diverse quick-service food brands.

Business model and value proposition

EatClub owns and operates a multi-brand cloud kitchen ecosystem, preparing and fulfilling orders for a portfolio of proprietary brands (e.g., Box8, Mojo Pizza, Itminaan Biryani, NH1 Bowls) from shared kitchen infrastructure. It integrates direct ordering via its own app and presence on delivery aggregators while controlling procurement, preparation and last-mile consistency.

Exhibit 105: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.15 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.16) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	104
Last known valuation (USD mn)	540
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Mayfield Fund, Trifecta Capital, IIFL, A91 Partners, 360One Asset Management

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entrackr

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Anshul Gupta** and **Amit Raj** in 2012, the leadership team leveraged strong operational and product backgrounds to build a scalable food-tech platform. Both founders have emerged from technically robust educational backgrounds (both IIT) and have driven EatClub's evolution from a single-brand kitchen to a multi-brand cloud kitchen network.



Anshul Gupta (L) and Amit Raj (R)
Co-Founders

Rebel Foods

Company overview

Rebel Foods is one of the world's largest cloud kitchen companies, founded in 2011 in Mumbai. What began as a single quick-service brand (Faasos) has grown into a global food-tech platform operating 400+ cloud kitchens across India and international markets, serving multiple cuisine brands under a unified technology stack.

Business model and value proposition

Rebel Foods operates a multi-brand, tech-orchestrated kitchen network, incubating and scaling diverse food brands (e.g., Faasos, Behrouz Biryani, Oven Story Pizza, The Good Bowl) from centrally managed kitchens. It drives efficiency via shared real-estate, inventory and data, catering through its EatSure platform and aggregators, while licensing technology and cloud kitchen infrastructure to partners.

Exhibit 106: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	16.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(3.4) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	770
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,400
Notable investors	Temasek, Qatar Investment Authority (QIA), KKR, Sequoia Capital (now Peak XV Partners), Coatue, Evolve, Lightbox

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Rebel Foods was co-founded in 2011 by **Jaydeep Barman** and **Kallol Banerjee** — both IIM Lucknow alumni and **Ankush Grover** an IIT Bombay alumnus, who pivoted the company from a single-brand QSR to a cloud kitchen powerhouse. Their leadership has steered Rebel Foods through aggressive brand expansion and global footprint scaling, backed by marquee investors like Sequoia, Coatue and Lightbox Ventures.



Jaydeep Barman
Co-Founder, Chairman



Ankush Grover
Co-Founder, CEO



Kallol Banerjee
Co-Founder

Chaayos

Company overview

Chaayos is an **organised tea café chain** in India, focused on serving customised chai and complementary food offerings in an urban café format. Founded in 2012 and headquartered in Gurugram, Chaayos operates across major Indian cities with a strong presence in high-footfall business and residential locations.

Business model and value proposition

Chaayos follows a **company-owned café model** combined with **delivery and digital ordering**, monetising through in-store consumption, takeaway and online platforms. Its differentiated offering lies in **customisable tea, standardised recipes and tech-enabled operations**, driving repeat consumption and higher customer lifetime value.

Exhibit 107: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.25) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	90
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, SAIF Partners, Think Investments, Alpha Wave Ventures, Elevation Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Nitin Saluja and Raghav Verma**, Chaayos' leadership blends consulting, operations and consumer brand expertise. The team has focused on building a scalable, process-driven café business in a traditionally unorganised tea market.



Nitin Saluja
Founder, CEO



Raghav Verma
Co-Founder

Chapter 8: Deep dive into Travel-tech

Travel-tech – sector overview

Indian travel market and OTA market

The Indian travel industry has experienced a strong rebound post-COVID, driven by pent-up demand. Domestic tourism, outbound travel, and foreign tourist arrivals (FTAs) witnessed substantial growth in CY22 (at over 100% YoY) due to the low base effect from pandemic-induced restrictions in CY21. By CY23, domestic visits and Indian national departure (outbound tourism) surpassed pre-Covid-19 levels (CY19), demonstrating a complete recovery; FTAs (inbound tourism) remain below pre-pandemic levels.

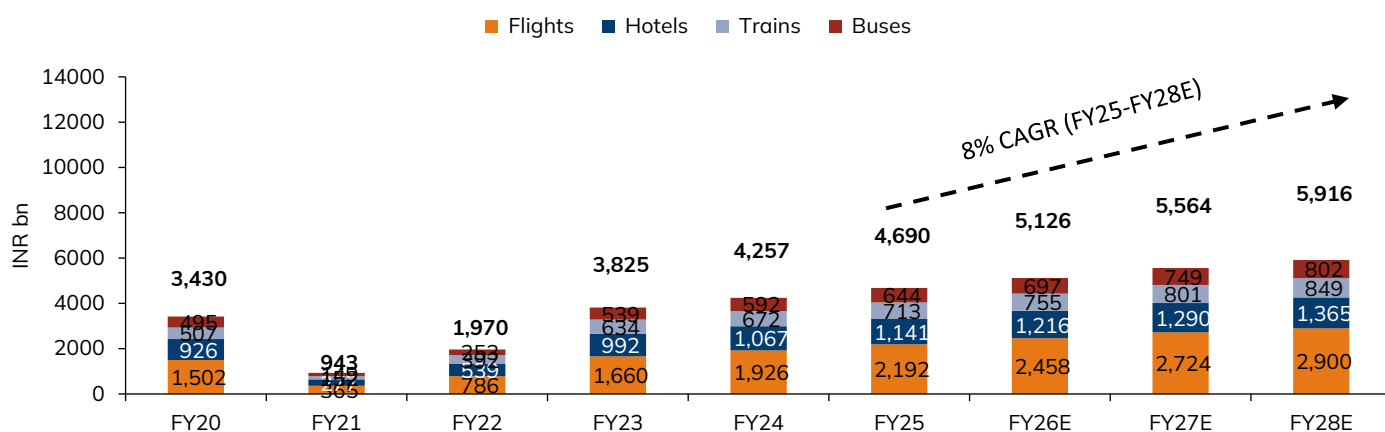
In CY24, domestic tourism spending grew 5% YoY and was 17% above pre-Covid-19 levels (CY19). Overseas travel spends (outbound tourism) under the liberalised remittance scheme (LRS) surged 144% above FY19 pre-Covid levels, as per RBI data.

Indian travel market to register 8% CAGR (FY25-28E)

We think travel industry has largely recovered in CY23/FY24. Growth is expected to normalise and likely be driven by increased discretionary spending on travel.

We estimate Indian travel market for air, buses and hotels at ~ INR 5trn in FY25 and expect it to grow to ~INR 6trn in FY28E, at a CAGR of ~8% over FY25-28E.

Exhibit 108: India travel market (INR bn)



Source: I-Sec research

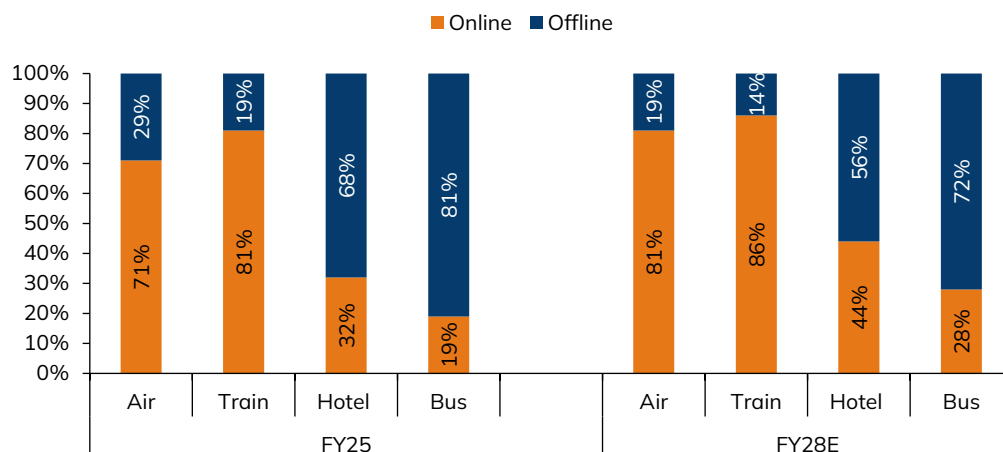
Online penetration in travel market

According to our estimates, air ticketing had high online penetration at 69–72% in FY25; it is projected to increase to 81% by FY28E. This is followed by railways at 80–82% which is expected to reach 86% by FY28E. Hotel bookings have lower online penetration (32% in FY25) due to the fragmented nature of the sector but are expected to improve to 44% by FY28 as more hotels adopt digital platforms. Bus ticketing also has low penetration (19% in FY25), with growth potential to reach 28% by FY28.

Online purchases can be made by travellers via captive websites of airlines, rail, hotels or buses or through the aggregator platform of OTAs. In FY24, the Indian OTA industry's market share in the overall online Indian travel segment was 63%, with the remaining 37% comprising direct suppliers within each of the individual modal segments.

Despite the captive platforms, OTAs will likely continue to play a key role due to the perishable nature of hotel occupancy and airline passenger load. While peak seasons may allow properties and airlines to rely on direct channels, off-season periods necessitate broader distribution to maintain utilisation levels. OTAs provide the reach and scale needed to fill this gap, ensuring their continued relevance as a distribution partner.

Exhibit 109: Online penetration across various travel products

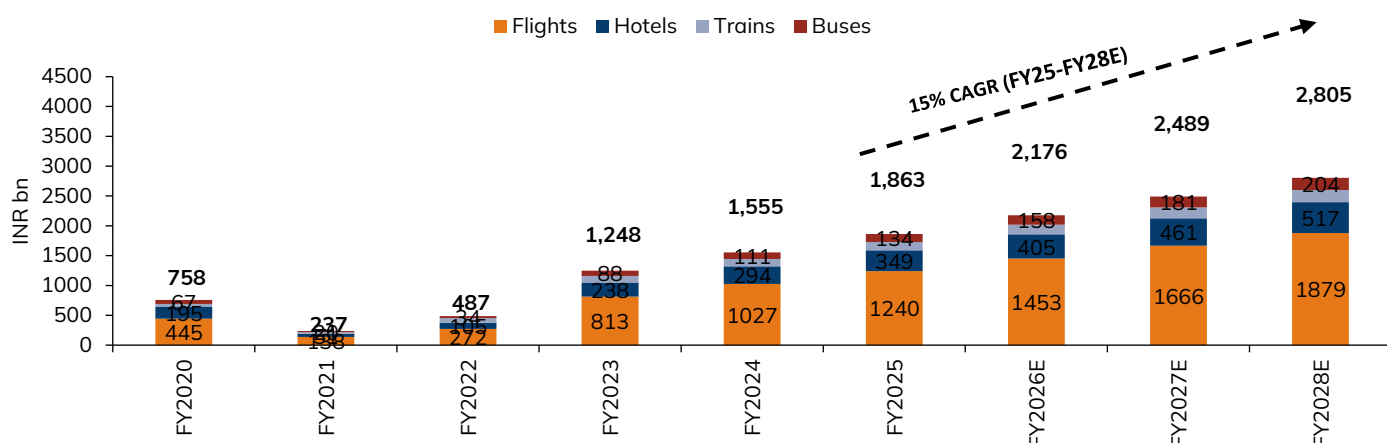


Source: I-Sec research

Indian OTA market to register 15% CAGR (FY25-28E)

OTA industry experienced high growth in FY23 and FY24, buoyed by the overall resurgence in travel demand. Going forward, we anticipate the gross booking revenue of the OTA industry to grow at a CAGR of ~15% over FY25-28E, supported by: 1) robust travel demand; 2) increasing online penetration; 3) gain of market share from captive websites; and 4) expansion into underpenetrated segments, such as hotels and buses.

Exhibit 110: Indian OTA industry



Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 111: Indian travel market size and OTA share

Summary	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	CAGR (FY25-28E)
Indian Travel Market (INR bn)										
Flights	1,502	365	786	1660	1926	2192	2458	2724	2900	10%
Hotel	926	277	539	992	1067	1141	1216	1290	1365	6%
Trains	507	152	392	634	672	713	755	801	849	6%
Buses	495	149	253	539	592	644	697	749	802	8%
Total	3,430	943	1970	3,825	4,257	4,690	5,126	5,564	5,916	8%
OTAs GBR (INR bn)										
Flights	445	138	272	813	1027	1240	1453	1666	1879	15%
Hotel	195	51	105	238	294	349	405	461	517	14%
Trains	51	28	76	109	123	140	160	181	205	14%
Buses	67	20	34	88	111	134	158	181	204	15%
Total	758	237	487	1248	1555	1863	2176	2489	2805	15%
OTAs share in overall market GBR (%)										
Flights	30%	38%	35%	49%	53%	57%	59%	61%	65%	
Hotel	21%	18%	19%	24%	28%	31%	33%	36%	38%	
Trains	10%	19%	19%	17%	18%	20%	21%	23%	24%	
Buses	14%	13%	13%	16%	19%	21%	23%	24%	25%	
Overall	22%	25%	25%	33%	37%	40%	42%	45%	47%	

Source: I-Sec research

Competition in the OTA industry is moderate with majority of the players already listed, creating scope for profitable growth. Among domestic OTAs, MMYT is the dominant player with ~50% market share (in terms of gross booking revenue or GBR), while Ixigo have gained share in recent years.

We estimate OTA industry's revenue to grow from INR 172bn in FY25 to INR 258bn by FY28, at a CAGR of 14% over FY25-28E.

Exhibit 112: Comparison between various travel products

	Air	Train	Hotel	Bus
Revenue potential	Take rates for these business models are typically 7-9% of GBR	Take rates are ~6.5% of GBR, no discount	Take rates are ~ 17-25% of GBR	Take rates are ~10-11% of GBR
Contribution margin	Bringing contribution margin to 2-3% of GBR, OTA fund discounts ~ 4-5%	Contribution margin is 2-3%, no discount has to be provided	Contribution margin is 12-13% of GBR, OTA fund discounts ~ 5-6%	Contribution margin to 9% of GBR, OTA fund discounts ~ 2%
Online penetration	Online penetration is high around 70 %	Penetration is high, around 80%. OTA share is low due to dominance of IRCTC	Online penetration is low, much of the market in underpenetrated	Online penetration is low, much of the market in underpenetrated

Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 113: Revenue opportunity within the OTA industry

Revenue OTA (INR bn)	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	CAGR (FY25-28E)
Flights	27	8	16	49	62	87	102	117	132	15%
Hotels	27	7	16	38	53	63	73	83	93	14%
Trains	3	2	5	7	8	9	10	12	13	13%
Buses	6	2	3	8	11	13	16	18	20	15%
Total	63	19	40	102	134	172	201	229	258	14%

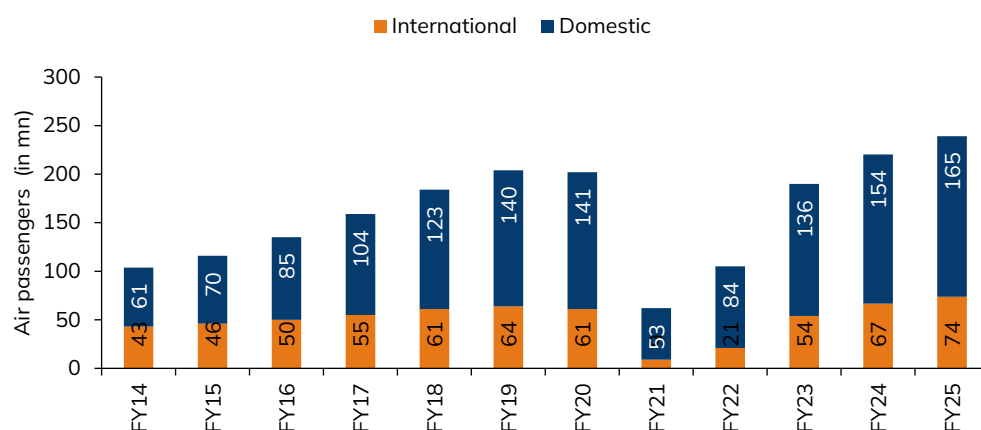
Source: I-Sec research

Air ticketing

India ranks as the third-largest domestic aviation market and is among the fastest-growing major aviation markets worldwide. The airline business in India is dominated by the Indian carrier Indigo with ~64-65% market share, followed by Air India, with a share of ~15% as of Dec'25.

In FY25, domestic air passenger traffic grew by 8% YoY to 165mn, while international air passenger traffic saw a 11% increase YoY, totalling 74mn. Domestic passenger traffic had recovered to 121% of pre-Covid-19 levels, while international traffic had reached 117% of pre-pandemic levels and indicating a full recovery.

Exhibit 114: Passenger traffic in India



Source: DGCA

Airport infrastructure is improving

Over FY16–25, operational airports in India have increased to 138 airports, from 77 airports. This expansion has enhanced connectivity across India, making air travel more accessible to a larger population. Improved infrastructure and increased regional connectivity have facilitated easier and more efficient travel, leading to a rise in domestic passenger volumes. This addition is expected to come in the form of newer airports in tier-2 and tier-3 cities. In addition, establishment of new airports in metro cities is anticipated to contribute to the overall increase in new developments

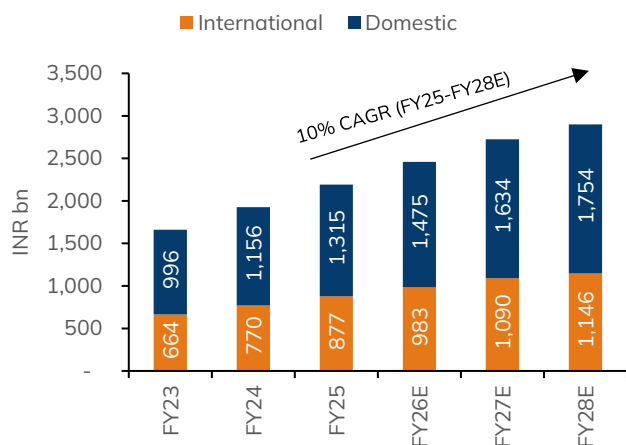
Supply-side push: Indian airlines have placed orders for ~2,400 aircraft, which is about 3x current capacity

An expanding aircraft fleet supports the future growth of air passenger traffic in India. With rising passenger numbers, increased aircraft capacity has become essential. India's fleet has grown significantly, from 372 aircraft in FY13 to 753 in FY24 and 795 as of October 2024, making up about 3% of the global aircraft fleet. To keep pace with growing air travel demand, Indian airlines have added capacity and placed orders for around 2,400 new aircraft

Indian airlines have placed orders for ~2,400 aircraft and about 1,800 aircraft are expected to be delivered in the coming decade between FY24–34. In 2023 alone, Airbus and Boeing together received net orders for 3,408 aircraft, out of which 970 were from Air India (now Tata Airlines Group) and Indigo, making up 28.5% of total net global orders.

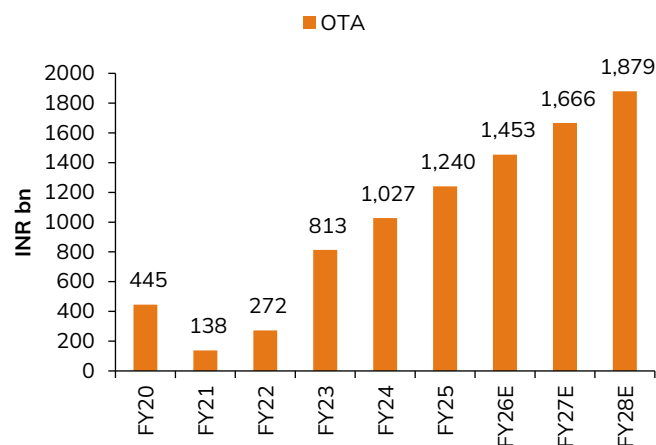
Airline constitutes largest segment in terms of GBR (INR 2,192bn in FY25) in the Indian travel space. We expect airlines market GBR to grow at 10% CAGR over FY25-28E, led by increasing number of airports in India, rising number of flights and rise in outbound travel. We expect OTA GBR for flights to register 15% CAGR over FY25-28E.

Exhibit 115: Overall flights ticketing market size (INR bn)



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 116: We expect OTA GBR for flights to register 15% CAGR over FY25-28E

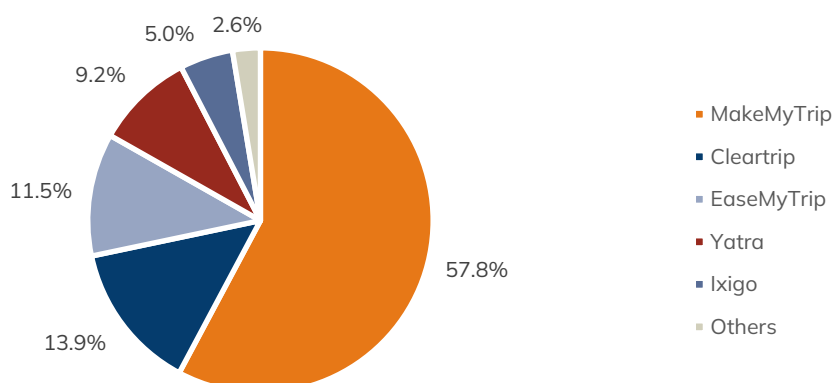


Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Competitive dynamics

The margins for OTAs in airlines are very thin and the competition is purely price based and very fierce due to price sensitivity of the Indian consumer. MMT Group is the market leader in the air category with a 57.8% share of the total OTA air GBV in FY24, maintaining its leadership position by wide distance. Cleartrip accounted for 13.9% of the OTA air GBV closely followed by EaseMyTrip at 11.5%. Meanwhile, Yatra has managed to corner 9.2% of the OTA air GBV riding on the leisure travel wave. Others, including global OTAs and the long tail, cumulatively managed the remainder.

Exhibit 117: Market share of air ticketing



Source: VIDEDEC

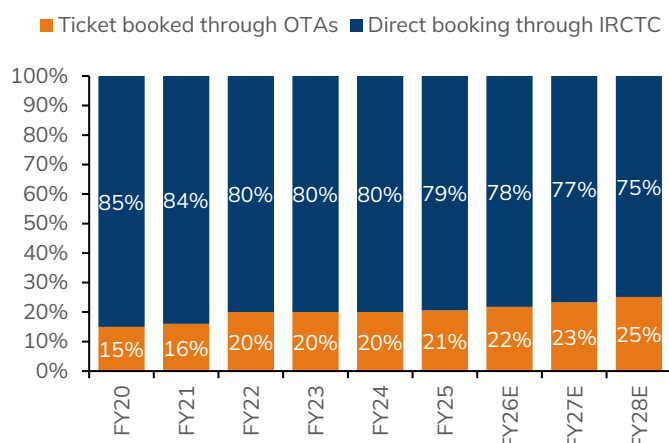
Train ticketing

Indian Railways (IR) operates an extensive network spanning over 68,584 route kilometres and employs 1.3mn individuals, making it the fourth largest network in the world under single management as of 31 Mar'24.

Over the past five years, capital expenditure on Indian Railways has surged by 77%, reaching INR 2,620bn in FY24. Introduction of the 'Vande Bharat' Express trains of Indian Railways in 2022, which are semi high-speed trains have significantly upgraded the travel experience of train passengers. Online penetration for train ticketing in India is started by IRCTC, which started online rail ticketing in India in 2002.

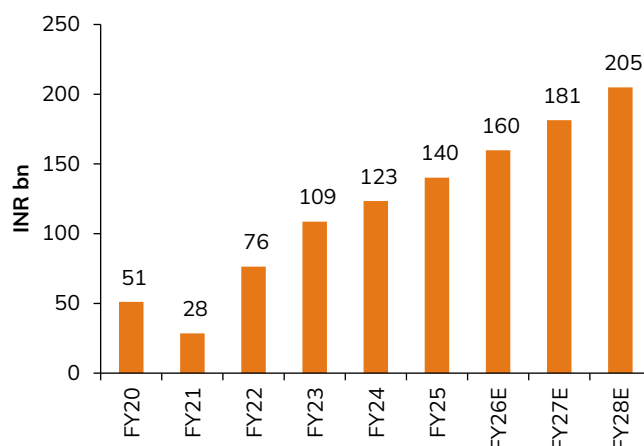
The IRCTC dominates online rail ticketing (~80% as of FY25 as per our estimates), as it is the only supplier of train tickets. Although some OTAs have ventured into the rail ticketing segment, bookings are routed via the IRCTC platform itself. We expect OTA's share to increase to 25% of online train booking by FY28E. As a result, we expect OTAs GBR to increase at 14% CAGR over FY25-28E.

Exhibit 118: Spilt between IRCTC and OTAs



Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 119: OTA train's GBR to grow 14% CAGR over FY25-FY28E

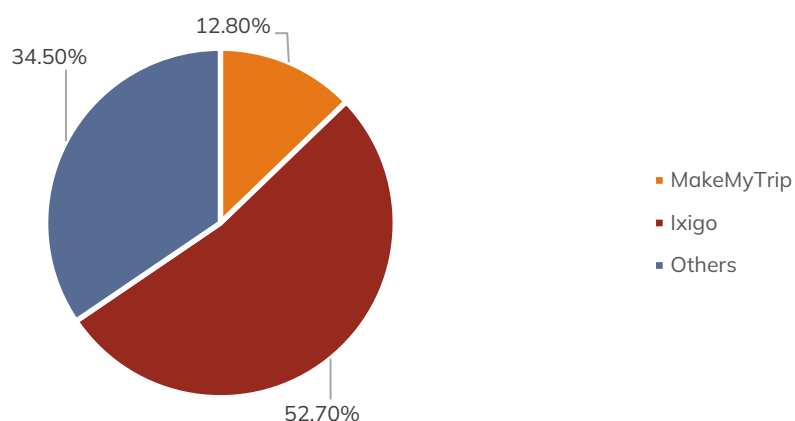


Source: I-Sec research

Competitive dynamics

OTA penetration for train is low due to dominant position of IRCTC in online train ticketing. Ixigo and MakeMyTrip are the key OTAs in the online ticketing space. Usually, OTAs only view train ticket bookings from the completion of an offering rather than from the perspective of a source of revenue or profit.

Ixigo Group combined had the largest market share in India of ~53% within OTAs at the end of FY24, growing from 45% as of the end of FY22, in terms of rail bookings, among OTAs and B2C distributors of the IRCTC in the train segment. They are the largest train ticket distributor in the OTA rail market. Ixigo's acquisition of ConfirmTkt in FY21 has further strengthened its foothold in the train travel segment.

Exhibit 120: Market share of competitors

Source: VIDECA

The private OTA business model is flat service fee-based, earning INR 20–40 per ticket. OTAs add aggregator's service charge and payment gateway charge on the top of IRCTC service charge.

Exhibit 121: Comparison between IRCTC and different OTA's

INR	IRCTC's service charge (non-AC) (a)	Aggregator's service charge (b)	Payment gateway charge (c)	Cost to the passenger per ticket (a+b+c)
IRCTC	17.7	NA	0	17.7
MakeMyTrip	17.7	19	NA	36.7
Yatra	17.7	20	6	43.7
Cleartrip	17.7	20	6	43.7
Paytm	17.7	9	7	33.7

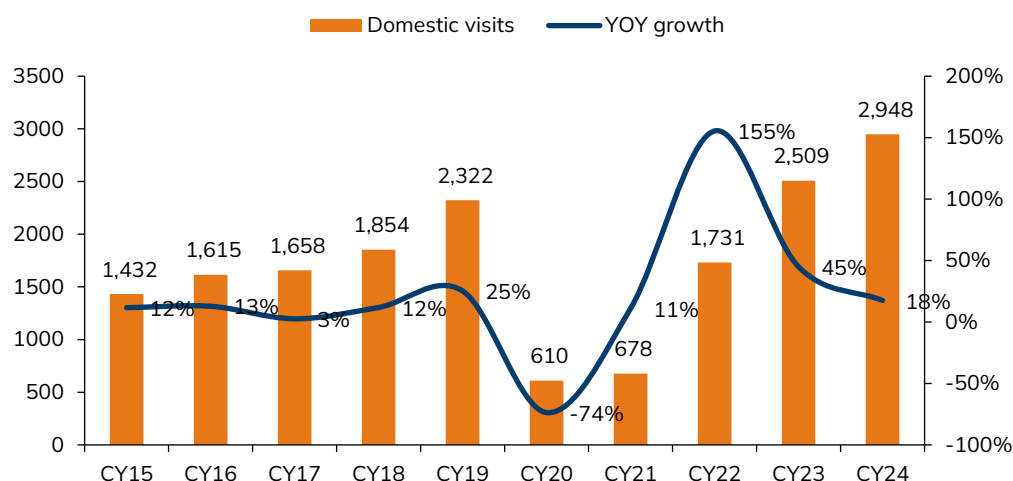
Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Hotel bookings

Hotels is the second largest segment in terms of GBR in the Indian travel space. The Indian hospitality industry is driven by demand from foreign and domestic travellers who visit the country for leisure and business purpose

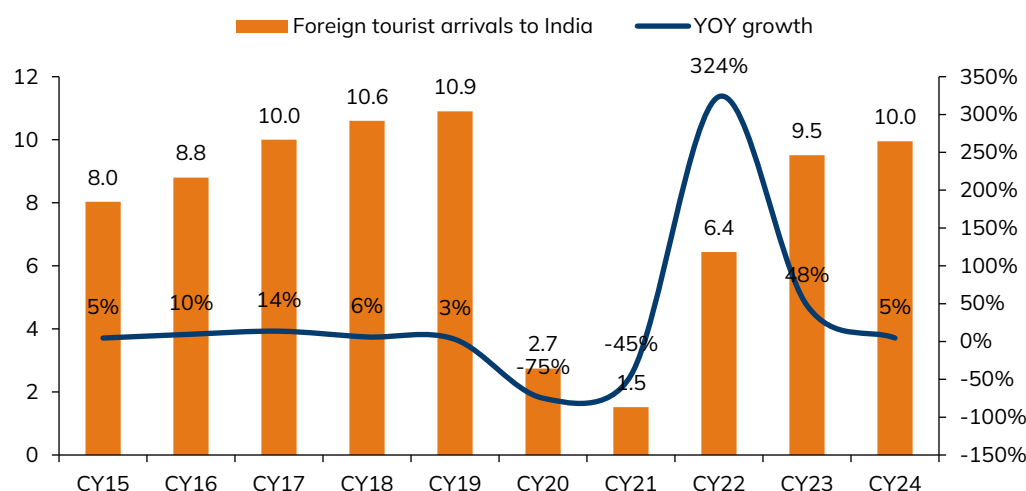
Foreign and domestic tourist arrivals in India were growing at a fast pace pre-Covid-19, with foreign/domestic tourist arrivals growing at 8%/13% over CY13-19. By CY23, domestic visits surpassed pre-Covid-19 levels (CY19), demonstrating a robust recovery.

Exhibit 122: Domestic visits (# mn)



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

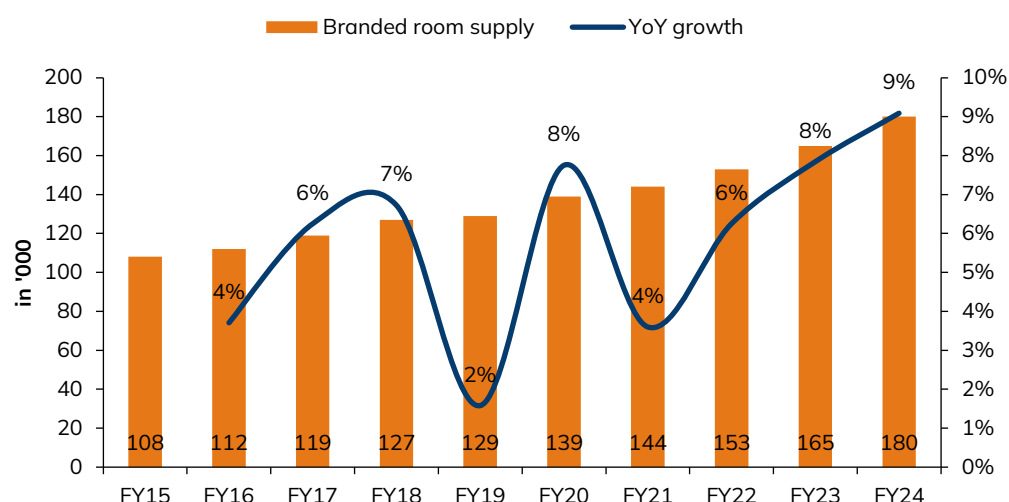
Exhibit 123: Foreign tourist arrivals to India (# mns)



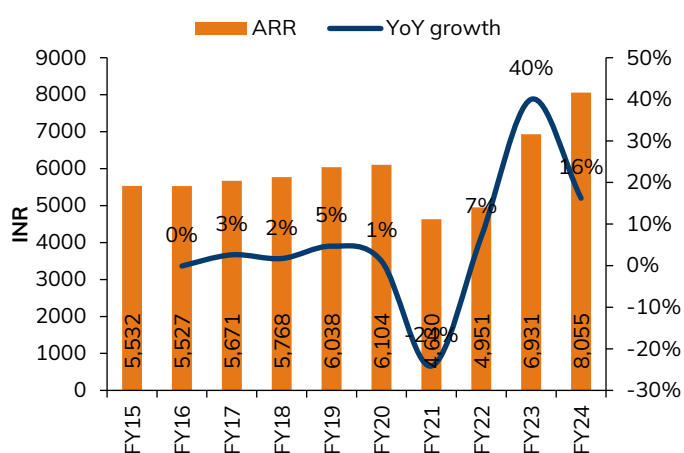
Source: I-Sec research, Company data

The Indian hotel market is fragmented with unbranded and independent supply dominating the landscape. In FY24, it was estimated that there were ~2mn rooms in India. Out of the total room inventory, ~72% of the rooms were operating in the independent hotel segment, and ~5–7% of the rooms were operating in the branded hotel segment. The remaining rooms fell under alternate accommodation and platforms, such as OYO, Treebo, and Fabhotels.

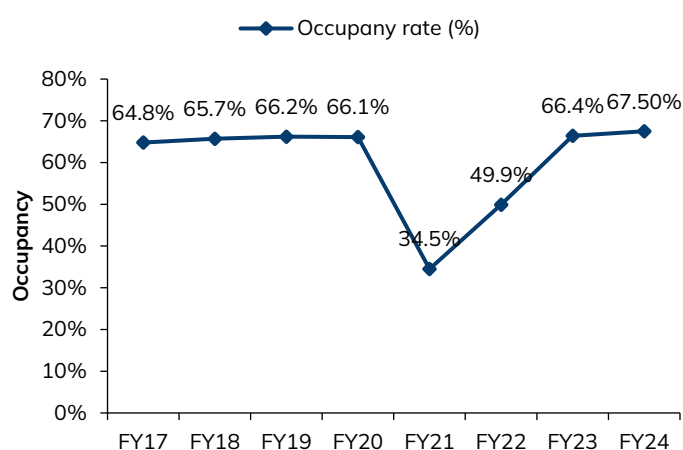
In FY24, the total branded supply in India was estimated at ~180k rooms; it will likely grow at a CAGR ~6.6% over FY24-29E to ~248k rooms.

Exhibit 124: Branded room supply and YoY growth trend

Source: Hotelivate

Exhibit 125: Average room rate improved over FY15-24

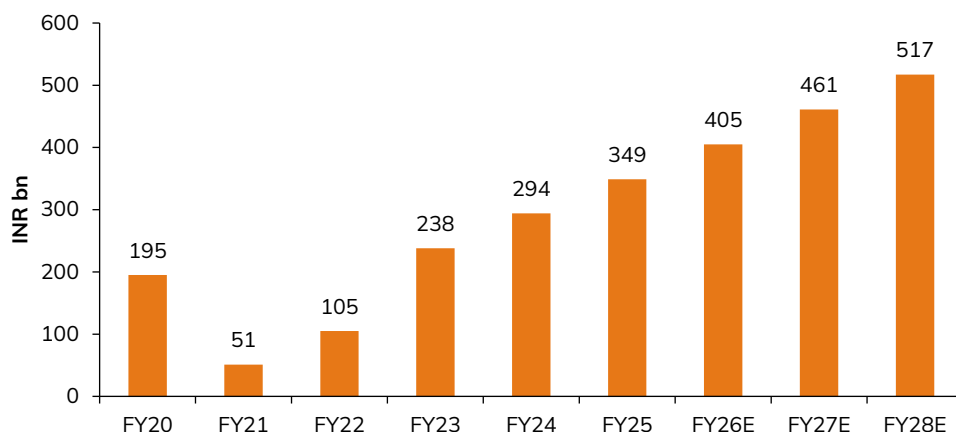
Source: Hotelivate

Exhibit 126: Average room rate improved over FY15-24

Source: Hotelivate

As per estimates, the online penetration in the Indian hospitality segment was low ~20% in FY20 but grew to 32% in FY25 due to the increased penetration across all modes; it is expected to further increase to 44% by FY28.

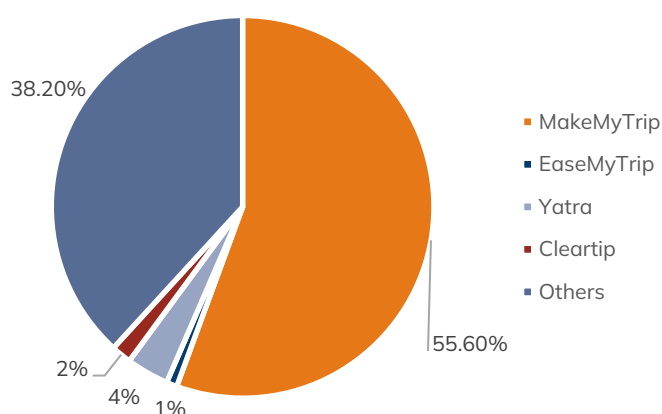
We estimate overall hotel bookings to grow at a CAGR of 6% over FY25-28. OTA share in hospitality business is expected to grow at a CAGR of 14% between FY25 to FY28E, from INR 349bn in FY25 to INR 517bn in FY28E.

Exhibit 127: OTA GBR for hotels to register 14% CAGR over FY25-28E


Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Competitive dynamics

MMT Group's 55.6% share of the OTA hotel GBV further underscores its dominance in the country's OTA landscape and its deep penetration in non-air categories. Yatra is a distant second with a 4% market share of the Indian OTA hotel GBV. Global OTAs have a meaningful role to play in the Indian online hotel category, with an edge in outbound and inbound hotel segments. Booking Holdings comprising Booking.com and Agoda, and Expedia Group, comprising Expedia and Hotels.com, along with the long tail, collectively account for 38% share of the Indian OTA hotel GBV. All other Indian OTAs are aspiring to build their hotel GBV. Cleartrip and EaseMyTrip cumulatively accounted for the rest of the OTA hotel GBV. Moreover, compared with airline ticketing, margins in hotel bookings are higher, thus making it a lucrative segment for OTAs to focus on. However, recent industry interactions indicate larger hotel chains are now encouraging customers to book via captive websites in order to counter the high commissions of OTAs.

Exhibit 128: India OTA Hotel Gross Bookings (GBV), share by top OTAs (%)


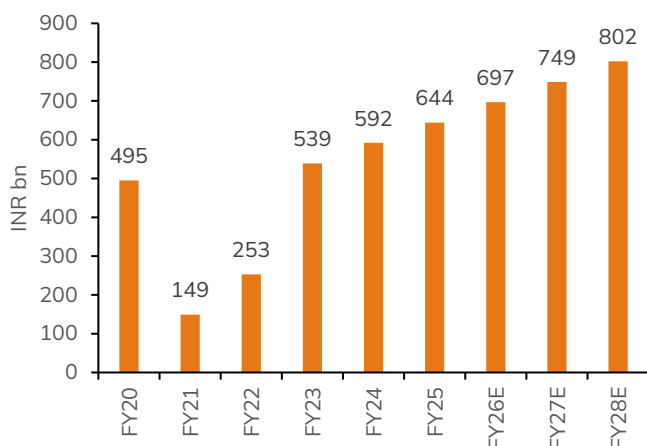
Source: VIDECA

Bus ticketing

As per our estimates, the overall intercity bus industry could recover at a CAGR of 8% during FY25 and FY28, with its online penetration to increase from 19% to 28% during the same period. The OTA market in FY25 is estimated at INR 134bn; it is expected to reach INR 204bn in FY28 at a CAGR of 15%.

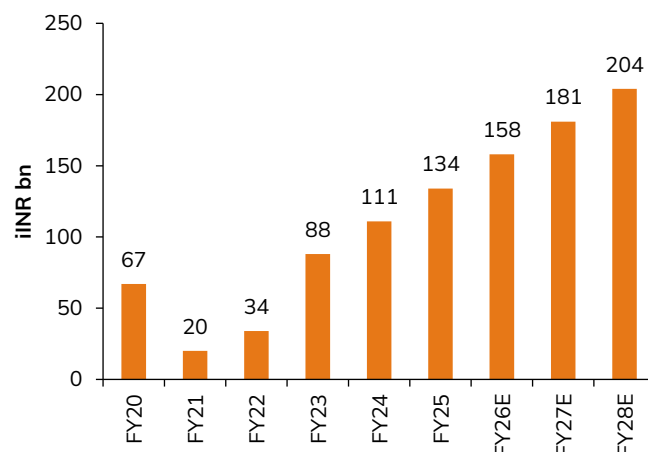
In case of bus ticketing, OTA penetration is low as a large proportion of tickets are still booked offline, though this gives the OTAs room to increase their share in this segment.

Exhibit 129: Bus ticketing GBR to see 8% CAGR over FY25-28E



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 130: OTA bus ticketing GBR to see 15% CAGR over FY25-28E

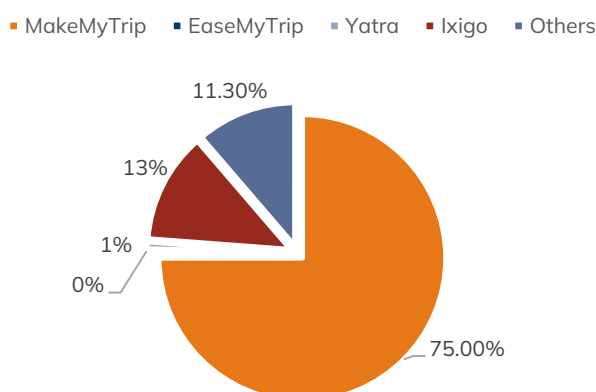


Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Competitive dynamics

Red Bus (owned by MakeMyTrip) and Abhibus (owned by Ixigo) are the dominant bus-ticketing OTA with 75% and 13% share, respectively, as on FY24. E-commerce players such as Paytm and Amazon, and others, accounted for more than 11% of the OTA intercity bus GBV.

Exhibit 131: Market share in bus ticketing



Source: VIDEA

The bus OTA model is totally volume centric. The OTA model for buses is commission based and varies between 6% to 20% based on the operators. The value-added buses are more expensive, and revenue contribution and margin from bus segment is higher.

Exhibit 132: Travel-tech sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	• Rising online penetration in buses and hotels creates structural growth beyond underlying travel demand. • Diversified monetisation across flights, rail, buses and hotels balances margin profiles. • Ancillary products (free cancellation, travel guarantee, airport transfers) enhance take rates and retention.
	• Growth in air and rail is constrained by supply limitations (aircraft deliveries, stagnant train capacity). • Heavy dependence on airlines and IRCTC limits pricing power and operational control. • Profitability remains sensitive to discounting and performance marketing intensity.
	• Further digitisation of buses and hotels offers double growth (market growth + channel shift).
Opportunity	• Premiumisation in hotels supports higher ADRs and stable high take rates. • Cross-sell across verticals could improve customer lifetime value and operating leverage.
	• Airline direct channels may gradually reduce OTA share in air travel.
Threat	• Regulatory uncertainty in aviation capacity and IRCTC platform rules creates unpredictability. • A resurgence of competitive discounting could compress margins, especially in hotels.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways
1. Opening unreserved rail ticketing to OTAs

Unreserved ticketing remains largely outside OTA participation. Allowing OTAs to distribute unreserved tickets could meaningfully increase digital penetration and provide customers with unified booking access.

2. GST rationalisation and clarity in hospitality

Recent GST adjustments in hotels have supported premium demand. Continued rationalisation, clarity in tax slabs and input tax credit (on capex) could further encourage formalisation and digital bookings.

3. Stable and reliable API infrastructure (rail)

Frequent API disruptions impact transaction success rates and customer experience. Strengthening backend systems and providing stable, transparent integration frameworks could reduce operational friction.

4. Sustained support to airline industry growth

Volatility from airline schedule changes, pilot shortages and regulatory interventions underscores the need for clear aviation capacity policies, faster aircraft deliveries, stronger pilot training infrastructure and continued airport and highway expansion to ease supply constraints, support travel demand and provide better visibility for the broader ecosystem, including OTAs.

Companies in Travel-tech

Chalo

Company overview

Chalo is a **public transport technology company** focused on digitising bus-based mobility in Indian cities. Founded in 2014 and headquartered in Mumbai, Chalo works closely with state transport undertakings (STUs) and private bus operators to improve reliability, ridership and commuter experience.

Business model and value proposition

Chalo operates a **B2G + B2B SaaS and transaction-led model**, offering solutions such as live bus tracking, digital ticketing, mobile passes and fleet management systems. Revenue is generated through **technology fees from operators, ticketing commissions and advertising**, with strong operating leverage as deployments scale.

Exhibit 133: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.38 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.35) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	105
Last known valuation (USD mn)	450
Notable investors	Lightrock India, Avataar Ventures, Filter Capital, WaterBridge Ventures, Trifecta Capital, and Stride Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Mohit Dubey, Vinayak Bhavnani, Priya Singh, Dhruv Chopra**, the leadership brings experience in operations, public transport systems and technology-led service design. Mohit Dubey (CEO) has been instrumental in navigating complex government partnerships and scaling Chalo across multiple Indian cities.



Mohit Dubey
Co-Founder, CEO



Vinayak Bhavnani
Co-Founder, CTO



Priya Singh
Co-Founder



Dhruv Chopra
Co-Founder

EaseMyTrip

Company overview

EaseMyTrip is one of India's largest **online travel agencies (OTAs)**, offering flight, hotel, holiday and bus bookings. Founded in 2008 and headquartered in New Delhi, EaseMyTrip is known for its asset-light, profitable growth approach.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows a **low-cost OTA model**, monetising through **commissions from airlines and hotels, convenience fees and ancillary services**, while keeping customer acquisition costs low through organic traffic and repeat users.

Exhibit 134: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.9 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.09 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	300
Notable investors	LIC

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Nishant Pitti, Rikant Pittie and Prashant Pitti**, the founders have deep experience in travel distribution and pricing. Nishant Pitti (CEO) has positioned EaseMyTrip as a cost-efficient, profitable alternative to heavily discount-driven OTAs.



Nishant Pitti
Co-Founder,
Chairman & MD



Rikant Pittie
Co-Founder, CEO



Prashant Pitti
Co-Founder

Ixigo

Company overview

Ixigo is a leading **travel meta-search and OTA platform**, offering train, flight and bus bookings with strong dominance in rail travel. Founded in 2007 and headquartered in Gurugram, Ixigo has built deep penetration among value-conscious Indian travellers.

Business model and value proposition

Ixigo operates a **meta-search + transaction hybrid model**, earning through **booking commissions, advertising and ancillary services**, particularly in trains and buses where competition is relatively limited and engagement is high.

Exhibit 135: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	9.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.6 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	900
Notable investors	Government of Singapore, Morgan Stanley, Tata Investment Corp, Sequoia Capital, Fosun RZ Capital, MakeMyTrip, WhiteOak, Bay Capital, SBI Mutual Fund, HDFC Mutual Fund

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Aloke Bajpai and Rajnish Kumar**, both IIT Kanpur alumni, the leadership combines product, data science and consumer internet expertise. Aloke Bajpai has driven Ixigo's focus on utility-led travel products.



Aloke Bajpai
Co-Founder,
Chairman, MD &
Group CEO



Rajnish Kumar
Co-Founder,
Director & Group
Co-CEO

MakeMyTrip

Company overview

MakeMyTrip is an online travel company, offering flights, hotels, holidays, rail and bus bookings. Founded in 2000, it is listed on NASDAQ and operates across India and international markets.

Business model and value proposition

MakeMyTrip follows a full-service OTA model, monetising via commissions, convenience fees, advertising and packaged travel, supported by strong supplier relationships and high brand recall.

Exhibit 136: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	90 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	8.7 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	4,565
Notable investors	Not available

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Yahoo Finance

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Deep Kalra**, MakeMyTrip is now led by **Rajesh Magow (Group CEO)**, with Kalra as Chairman. The leadership brings decades of experience in scaling travel marketplaces and managing cyclical demand.



Deep Kalra
Founder, Chairman



Rajesh Magow
Co-Founder, Group CEO

OYO

Company overview

OYO is a global **hospitality technology company** offering branded and franchised budget hotels across multiple geographies. Founded in 2013 and headquartered in Gurugram, OYO partners with hotel owners to standardise and improve occupancy.

Business model and value proposition

OYO operates a **franchise and asset-light hospitality model**, earning through **commissions, franchise fees and software services**, while leveraging dynamic pricing and distribution to improve partner hotel revenues.

Exhibit 137: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	62.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	24.4 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	RedSpring Innovation Partners, Patient Capital, SoftBank, Microsoft, JP Morgan Chase

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Ritesh Agarwal**, an early entrepreneur and Thiel Fellow, OYO's leadership has navigated rapid global expansion followed by consolidation and profitability-focused restructuring.



Ritesh Agarwal
Founder

Tbo.com

Company overview

TBO.com is a global B2B travel distribution platform, providing hotels, air and ancillary travel inventory to travel agents worldwide. Founded in 2006, it serves thousands of agents across 100+ countries.

Business model and value proposition

It follows a B2B aggregation and distribution model, monetising through commissions, mark-ups and subscription-based services, with a strong focus on agent enablement and technology-led scale.

Exhibit 138: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	17.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	2.3 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	Not available
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,503
Notable investors	General Atlantic, Affirma Capital, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority, Government Pension Fund Global

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Ankush Nijhawan**, **Gaurav Bhatnagar**, both with deep travel industry experience, the leadership has built TBO into a global travel-tech platform with strong enterprise relationships.



Ankush Nijhawan
Co-Founder



Gaurav Bhatnagar
Co-Founder

Yatra

Company overview

Yatra is an established **online travel company** offering flights, hotels, holidays and corporate travel services. Founded in 2006, Yatra has a strong presence in enterprise and government travel.

Business model and value proposition

Yatra operates a mixed B2C + B2B travel model, earning through commissions, service fees and corporate travel management contracts, which provide relatively stable and recurring revenues.

Exhibit 139: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	8 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.4 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	203
Notable investors	ICICI Prudential AMC, Bandhan MF, Tata MF, UTI MF

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Dhruv Shringi**, **Manish Amin**, and **Sabina Chopra**, the leadership brings long-standing experience in consumer and corporate travel services. Siddhartha is the Chief Executive Officer of Yatra.



Dhruv Shringi
Co-Founder, Exec
Chairman



Manish Amin
Co-Founder, CTO



Sabina Chopra
Co-Founder,
COO-Corporate



Siddhartha Gupta,
CEO

Treebo

Company overview

Treebo Hotels (Treebo Hospitality Ventures) is a prominent Indian digital hotel chain founded in 2015 by Sidharth Gupta, Rahul Chaudhary and Kadam Jeet Jain, offering quality, branded accommodation in the budget and premium-budget segment. Based in Bangalore, it operates over 600–800+ hotels across 100+ cities using a franchise model, often recognised for high guest satisfaction and cleanliness.

Business model and value proposition

Treebo operates an asset-light, full-inventory franchise model in India's budget hotel segment, focusing on quality standardisation. They partner with independent hotels, offering branding, technology (SaaS), marketing, and operational training to improve occupancy and service, in exchange for a revenue-share model.

Exhibit 140: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.1 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	Not available
Total funding raised (USD mn)	70
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Accor, Elevation Capital, Matrix Partners, and Bertelsmann

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, SalesTools

Founders and leadership

Treebo Hotels was founded in 2015 by Sidharth Gupta, Rahul Chaudhary, and Kadam Jeet Jain. The founders are former McKinsey & Company and Myntra executives who aimed to organize the budget hospitality sector in India through a high-quality, tech-driven hotel brand.



Sidharth Gupta
Co-founder and CEO



Rahul Chaudhary
Co-founder



Kadam Jeet Jain
Co-founder

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Chapter 9: Deep dive into New-age Logistics

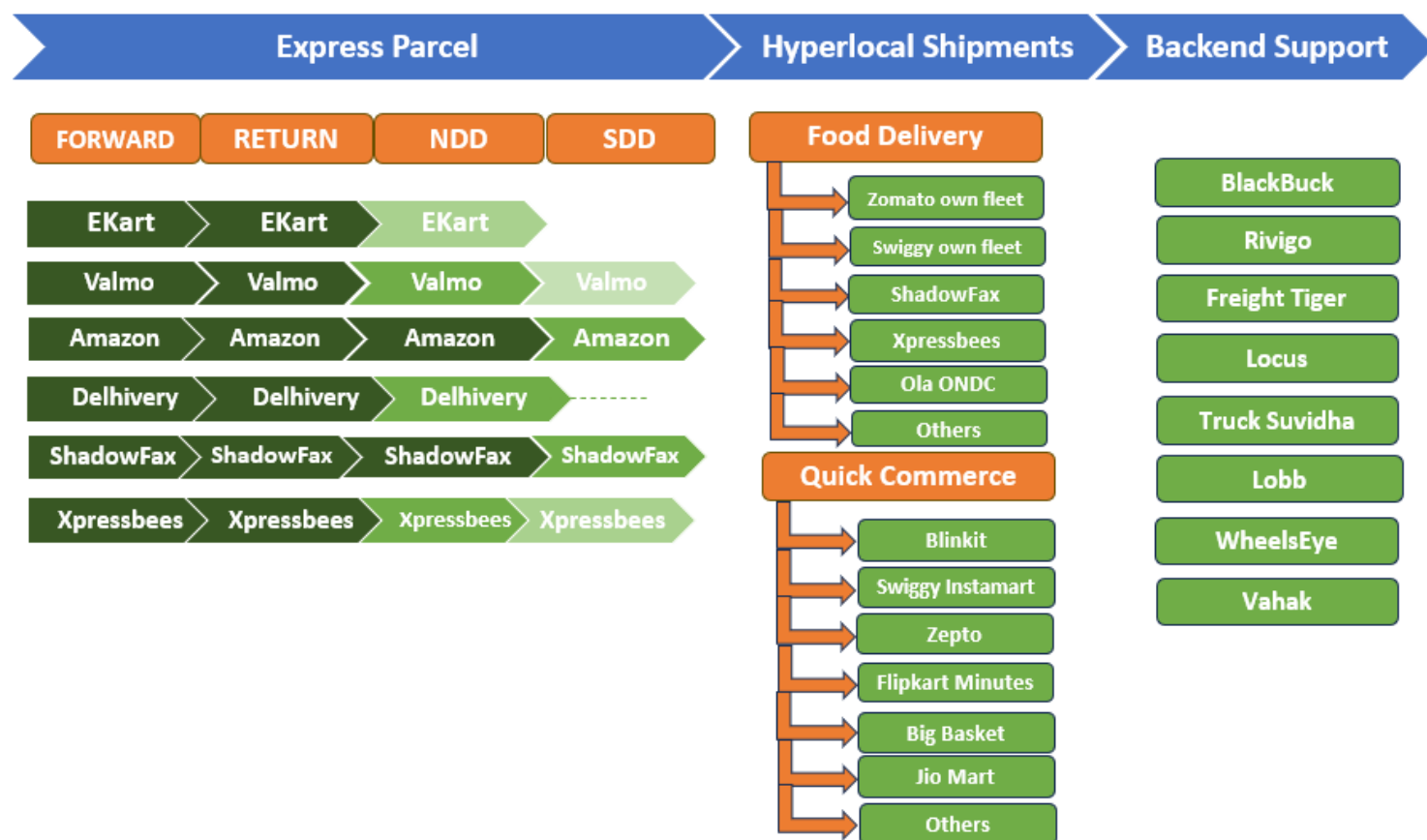
New-age logistics – sector overview

This sector is evolving into three broad segments:

- Express parcel** – This refers to B2C shipments that are used by e-commerce platforms. Here the customer experience is completely managed by the logistics company and its platforms. This is further divided into four sub categories:
 - 1) Forward express, 2) Return logistics, 3) Next day delivery (NDD) and 4) Same day delivery (SDD).
- Hyperlocal shipments** – This refers to <1-hour deliveries with a delivery radius of <10 kms from pickup point to the customer's doorstep. Here the customer experience is partially managed by the delivery partners of the logistics companies while the platforms are that of the demand origination app. This is further divided into two sub categories:
 - Food delivery
 - Quick commerce
- Backend support** – This refers to business models which do not deliver themselves but are service / product providers enabling efficiency improvement and modernisation in an industry which is highly fragmented with a large proportion of semi formal legacy players.

Below displays industry players in each of these segments and the shading indicates their relevance in each sub-segment.

Exhibit 141: New-age logistics – overview



Source: I-Sec research

Parcel delivery overview

India's parcel delivery ecosystem is rapidly evolving, driven by the growth of digital commerce, rising consumer expectations for faster deliveries, and expanding reach into tier 2/3 markets. Express parcel delivery remains the dominant segment, with companies focusing on reducing delivery times, increasing reliability and managing peak-load operations. Automation in sorting, route optimisation and AI/ML-driven demand forecasting are becoming standard across top players. The industry can be broadly classified into Business-to-Consumer (B2C), B2B Logistics and Consumer-to-Consumer (C2C) segments, each with distinct operating models, logistics needs and growth trajectories.

B2C logistics

B2C parcel delivery

B2C delivery involves parcels shipped from businesses to end consumers. This is the largest segment in India's parcel logistics market and is seeing rapid diversification across several sub-models.

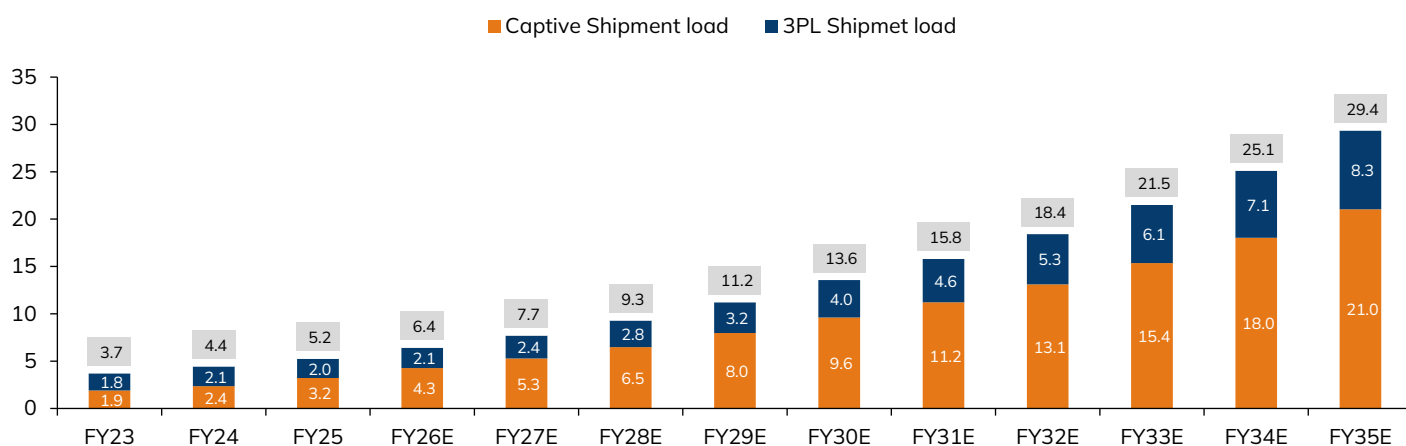
- **Traditional retail logistics** refers to the movement of parcels from brick-and-mortar stores or distribution partners to consumers, typically via courier or express logistics providers. These deliveries are often manually tracked, with less automation and longer delivery timelines. The segment is still relevant, especially for regional brands, appliance deliveries, and business distribution channels.
- **E-commerce logistics** has emerged as the dominant force in B2C parcel growth. It is further divided into horizontal platforms (like Amazon, Flipkart, Meesho), which cater to a wide range of categories, and vertical platforms (such as Nykaa in beauty, Lenskart in eyewear, and Pepperfry in furniture), which are more specialised. Horizontals tend to operate at scale and often rely on in-house logistics or strong third-party partners. Verticals, in contrast, require specialised handling, temperature control (e.g., for cosmetics), or installation services. Many are increasingly investing in hybrid logistics models to balance cost and customer experience.
- Leading players like Delhivery, Xpressbees, and Ekart have built pan-India networks with deep reach, technology-driven tracking systems, and automated hubs to support high-speed parcel movement. These players typically offer express delivery, COD support, returns management and integrations with seller platforms.
- The rise of D2C brands has created a new layer within B2C delivery. These brands—often digitally native—bypass traditional intermediaries to deliver directly to consumers, offering greater control over packaging, delivery experience, and data. Logistics for D2C is more customised, focusing on brand identity, personalisation, and reliable delivery timelines. Many brands partner with full-stack e-commerce logistics players like Shiprocket, NimbusPost or pick 3PL providers based on region and SLA needs.
- Reverse logistics is a critical yet cost-intensive component of B2C logistics, especially for categories like fashion and electronics where return rates can exceed 25–30%. Managing returns efficiently—whether via doorstep pickup or hub drop offs—requires robust tech infrastructure and inventory re-integration capabilities.

Exhibit 142: Online B2C logistics

Shipment categories	E-commerce shipments			B2C hyperlocal deliveries	
Description	Orders from horizontal and vertical B2C platforms	D2C brands D2C brands, social commerce, omnichannel retailers	Reverse logistics (returns, replacements)	Quick commerce: 30min- 2hr deliveries	Slotted deliveries: Pre-scheduled deliveries
Examples	Amazon, Flipkart, Nykaa and Lenskart	Mamaearth, Sugar cosmetics	Return and exchanges on e-commerce sites	ONDC, Apollo 24*7, ONDC	BigBasket, Amazon Fresh
Categories	Electronics, Fashion, beauty and personal care, furniture, home and décor, general merchandise			Groceries, general merchandise, Home, medicine	
Players	Captive logistics arms:			In-House Logistics:	
	Amazon Transportation Services (ATS) – Amazon, Ekart – Flipkart, Valmo – Meesho			Blinkit, Zepto, Instamart, BigBasket	
	Third-Party Logistics (3PL) Partners:			Third-Party Logistics (3PL) Partners:	
	Delhivery, XpressBees, Shadowfax, Bluedart			Shadowfax, Loadshare, Elastic Run, XpressBees	

Source: I-Sec research

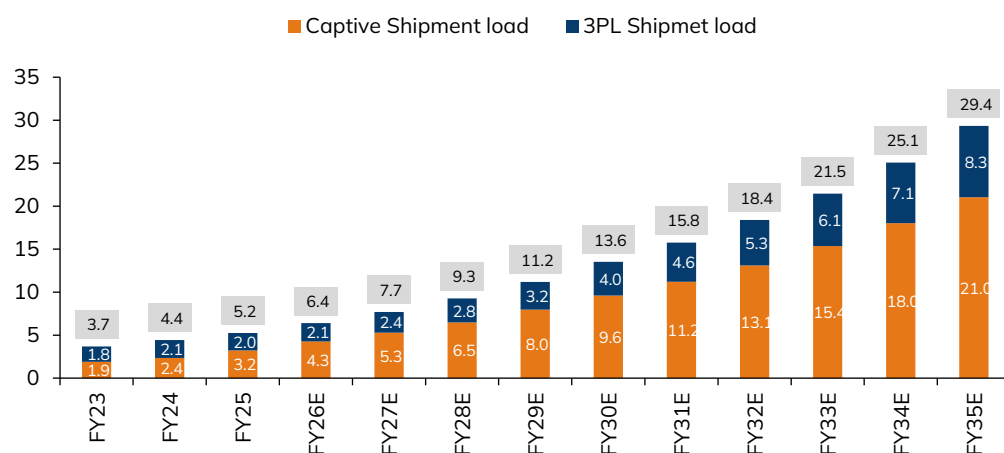
Exhibit 143: Big 3 e-commerce platforms contributed ~80% of e-commerce shipment volume (# bn)



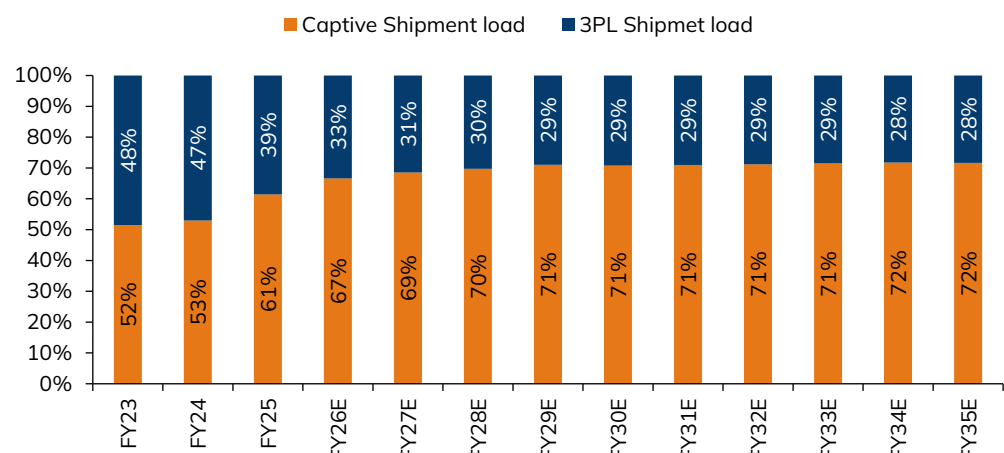
Source: I-Sec research

Share of captive logistics arms in B2C e-commerce shipments

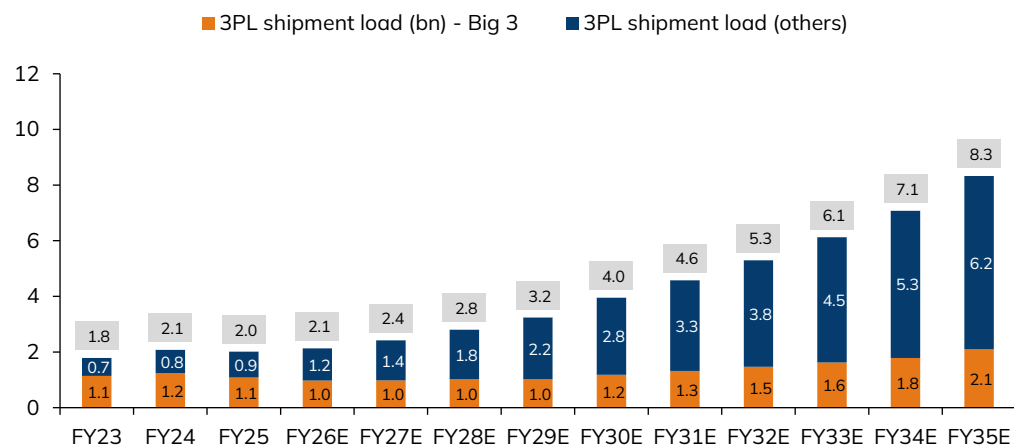
E-commerce logistics includes end-to-end solutions for order fulfilment, warehousing, and last-mile delivery. Leading B2C e-commerce players, such as Amazon (Amazon Transfer Services - ATS), Flipkart (Ekart), and Meesho (Valmo, launched in FY24), leverage a combination of captive logistics networks and third-party logistics (3PL) partners to fulfil their shipments. Captive logistics accounted for ~52% of total shipments in FY23, with a notable increase to ~61% in FY25, largely driven by Meesho's expansion into in-house logistics with Valmo. Meanwhile, 3PL providers handled ~47% of last-mile deliveries in FY24.

Exhibit 144: Captive vs. 3PL share in e-commerce shipments load (# bn)

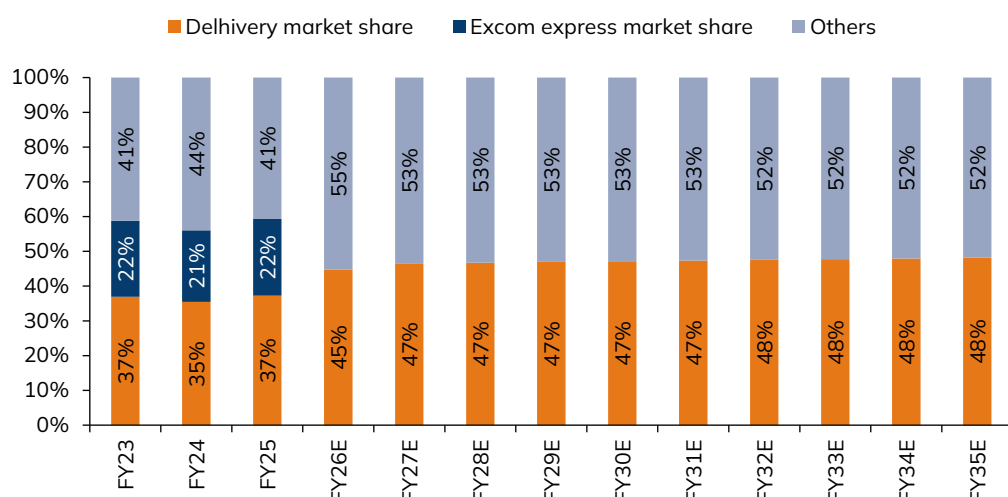
Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 145: Captive vs. 3PL share (%) in e-commerce shipment loads

Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 146: Big-3's volume contribution in 3PL shipment loads

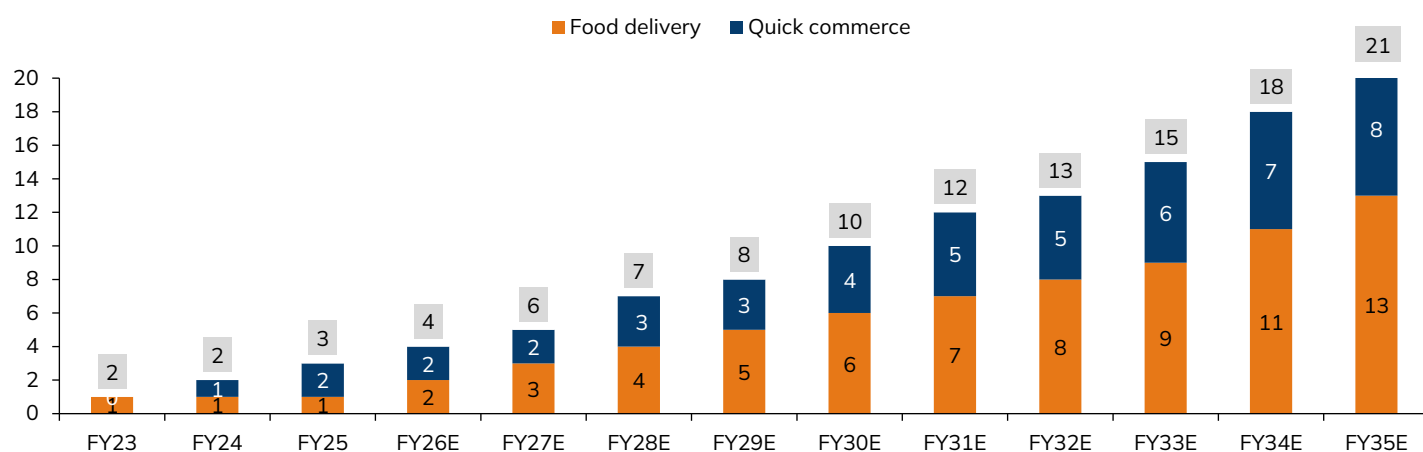
Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 147: Market share (%) of players within 3PL shipment load

Source: I-Sec research

Hyperlocal shipments

Hyperlocal delivery is another fast-growing sub-segment. This segment was dominated by food delivery till FY24; however, given the rapid scaling up of quick commerce in FY25, we think QC volumes should overtake FD by FY26E. Overall, we believe FD shipments may grow at 5-year CAGR of 18.9% YoY, while QC shipments are likely to grow at 5-year CAGR of 38.6% YoY. We note Shadowfax, Xpressbees and Ola are the 3PL operators currently partaking in this opportunity which is dominated by the captive fleet of existing hyperlocal aggregators

Exhibit 148: Hyperlocal shipments – food delivery and quick commerce (# bn)

Source: I-Sec research

B2B logistics

B2B logistics focuses on large-scale movement of goods across manufacturers, suppliers, distributors, and retailers, ensuring smooth industrial and commercial operations

B2B logistics—though not directly consumer-facing—underpins the B2C supply chain by facilitating inventory movement from brands or manufacturers to warehouses, distributors, or kirana stores. This segment is gaining prominence with the expansion of omnichannel retail and new models like eB2B commerce (e.g., Udaan, Jumbotail).

Players like Delhivery and TCI Express offer mid-mile and line-haul capabilities, often operating in tandem with last-mile providers to ensure seamless fulfilment.

It includes:

- **FTL (Full Truckload) and PTL (Partial Truckload) freight services** – used for bulk cargo movement, where FTL transports entire truckloads for a single client, while PTL allows multiple shippers to share truck space.
- **Warehousing and fulfilment** – storage, inventory management and order processing for businesses.
- **Value-added services** – supply-chain analytics, fleet management and automation tools for efficiency.

FTL and PTL logistics segments remain highly fragmented, with over 75% of fleet owners operating 20-40 trucks as of FY24. Most of these trucks are older, 2-axle rigid body vehicles, which are smaller than the advanced trucking fleets in developed markets.

FTL and PTL markets remain dominated by unorganised players, with an estimated 90-92% of FTL and 60-70% of PTL operations falling within the unorganised sector.

C2C logistics

C2C logistics enables peer-to-peer shipments, primarily relying on:

- **Courier and express parcel services** – used for individual parcel deliveries through postal and private courier networks.
- **App-based platforms** – digital solutions that allow users to send and receive packages conveniently.

Exhibit 149: Logistics companies in B2C logistics

	Delhivery	XpressBees	Bluedart	TCI Express	Loadshare	Shadowfax
Express Parcel	Market Leader with 18.5k+ pin codes covered	Faster growth trajectory with historical focus on larger cities	Extensive pin code coverage, recently started to win e-commerce orders	Extensive pin code coverage but does not operate in e-commerce space	Primary strength in Northeast India and 10k+ pin codes covered	Coverage in 15k+ pin codes
PTL Express	Top 5 player	Minimal presence	No presence	Top 5 Player	~350 tonnes per day	No presence
FTL	Launched in FY20	Minimal presence	No presence	No presence	Minimal presence	No presence
Supply Chain Services	Upselling to existing customers	Recent foray	No presence	No presence	Yes	No presence
Hyperlocal Last-mile	No presence	No presence	No presence	No presence	Presence across dark stores and delivery	Strong partner for quick commerce

Source: I-Sec research

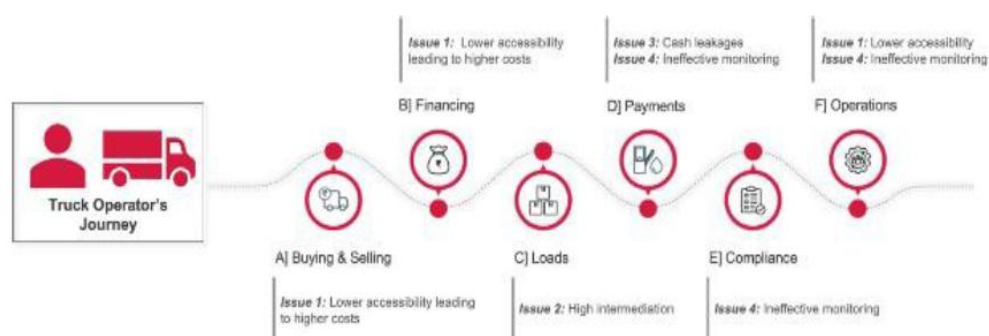
Exhibit 150: Players in traditional retail, B2B logistics and C2C logistics

	Offline B2C Logistics	B2B logistics	C2C Logistics
Players	TCI Express: Express parcel delivery for offline retail businesses	TCI (Transport Corporation of India): Multimodal logistics and supply chain services	India Post: Government-run postal and parcel service
	VRL Logistics: Leading service provider in parcel transportation	DHL Supply Chain India: Comprehensive supply chain solutions for businesses	DTDC: Domestic and international courier service provider
	Gati Ltd.: Logistics partner for small businesses and offline retailers	Delhivery (B2B Segment): Warehousing, fulfilment, and express cargo for enterprises	Blue Dart Express: Premium express courier and logistics company
		BlackBuck: Digital freight marketplace connecting truck owners with businesses	FedEx India: International and domestic shipping solutions
		Rivigo: Relay trucking model for faster deliveries and reduced driver fatigue	Shiprocket: AI-driven logistics aggregator for small businesses and individuals

Source: I-Sec research

Tech disruption in logistics industry – backend support

The logistics sector is undergoing significant technological transformation, driven by logistics tech companies that are streamlining operations and enhancing efficiency. While B2C e-commerce logistics has largely become organised, the Full Truckload (FTL) and Partial Truckload (PTL) markets remain fragmented, with an estimated 90-92% of FTL and 60-70% of PTL operations still dominated by unorganised players.

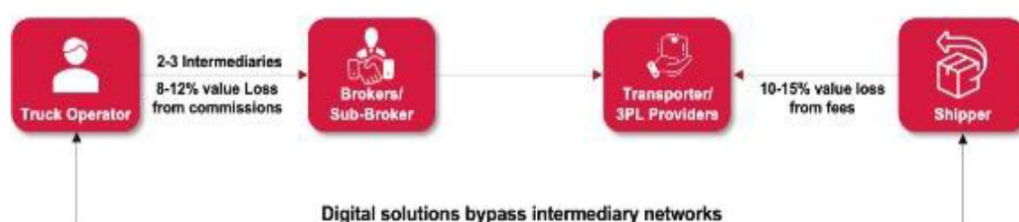
Exhibit 151: Challenges for Indian trucking industry


Source(s): Redseer analysis

Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 152: High intermediation leading to higher inefficiencies
Intermediary network in trucking industry

Descriptive



Source(s): Redseer analysis

Source: I-Sec research

Logistics tech companies are playing a crucial role in bridging this gap by offering solutions that help small fleet owners with real-time tracking, digital payments and load optimisation to minimise empty runs. The rise of digital freight platforms and AI-driven route planning is further improving cost efficiency and fleet utilisation. Additionally, embedded finance solutions are enabling small transporters to access working capital, enhancing liquidity in the sector. As technology adoption grows, the logistics industry is moving towards greater transparency, efficiency and sustainability.

Several logistics tech companies are driving innovation in the sector, particularly in organising the unstructured FTL and PTL markets.

Exhibit 153: Logistics backend support companies

Company	Core Focus	Target Audience	Key Features	Differentiation
BlackBuck	Digital freight marketplace, Freight brokerage marketplace	Businesses, truckers	AI-based load matching, digital payments, fuel and toll solutions	Large-scale freight matching, does not own fleets
Rivigo	Relay trucking	FMCG, e-commerce, pharma, auto industries	IoT-based tracking, data analytics, high-speed trucking	Relay trucking model, focuses on speed and reduced driver fatigue
Freight Tiger	Supply chain visibility	Logistics service providers, manufacturers	Real-time shipment tracking, predictive analytics, automation	SaaS platform for enhanced visibility and efficiency
Locus	Route optimisation and warehouse automation	Retail, e-commerce, FMCG, 3PL	AI/ML-based route planning, fleet optimisation	Software solutions for optimising logistics operations, focuses on last-mile
TruckSuvidha	Online marketplace for truck booking	Small and medium transporters, businesses, truck owners	Load posting, truck searching, freight availability	Caters specifically to small and medium transporters, focuses on connecting them
Lobb	B2B logistics aggregator	Fleet owners, transporters, businesses	AI-powered demand-supply matching	Acts as a network enabler, ensures continuous loads for truck owners
WheelsEye	Fleet management digitisation	Small fleet operators, owner-drivers	GPS tracking, vehicle financing, fuel management	Focuses on digitising fleet operations for small truck owners
Vahak	Online transport marketplace	Shippers, transporters, truck owners	Direct connections, load booking, transporter directory	Focuses on direct transactions, building a large transporter network, and commission free transactions

Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 154: New-age logistics sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	- Market Scale: Rapid growth in e-commerce and manufacturing drives massive demand, enabling scale for digital platforms and automation. - Supportive Policy: Government initiatives like PM Gati Shakti enhance multimodal integration and create a fertile environment for tech-enabled logistics.
Weakness	- Extreme Fragmentation: A large informal sector of small fleet owners slows down digitisation and limits end-to-end visibility. - Low Tech Maturity: Many MSMEs and small operators lack the capital and skilled talent required to adopt advanced automation tools.
Opportunity	- Warehouse Automation: Rising labor costs and SKU complexity offer a major growth runway for cost-reducing robotics and AMRs. - Digital Orchestration: Tech-driven freight marketplaces and IoT-enabled visibility could drastically reduce "empty miles" and operational inefficiencies. - Green Logistics: The shift toward EVs and carbon reporting creates new revenue streams in charging infrastructure and route planning.
Threat	- Regulatory Hurdles: Varying state-level laws and taxes create execution risks and delays for national infrastructure rollouts. - Margin Pressure: High consumer expectations for "fast and free" delivery, combined with rising fuel costs, threaten the survival of capital-intensive models.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- Targeted incentives (tax credits, capex subsidy or accelerated depreciation) for MSME truckers and small warehouse operators who adopt accredited digital tools (TMS/WMS/telematics)**

This could reduce the fragmentation problem by lowering the economic hurdle for digitisation.

- National programs (vocational + higher-end) to certify workers in warehouse robotics, maintenance of AMRs, data analytics and multimodal operations**

Industry commentary flags skill shortages as an adoption bottleneck; public-private skilling will likely reduce rollout frictions.

Companies in New-age logistics

Porter

Company overview

Porter is an on-demand intra-city logistics and goods transport platform headquartered in Bengaluru, India. It connects customers and businesses with a network of partner drivers to provide reliable transportation of goods using trucks, tempos, mini-trucks and two-wheelers. Porter offers both B2C and B2B logistics solutions, including goods delivery, relocation services, courier and enterprise logistics support across Indian cities.

Business model and value proposition

Porter operates an asset-light, tech-enabled marketplace model where partner drivers provide goods transport services booked through the Porter platform. The company earns by charging a share of the billed amount from deliveries booked on the platform, enabling scalable growth without owning the fleet.

It serves both MSMEs and individual customers, offering a blend of last-mile delivery, relocation and enterprise logistics.

Exhibit 155: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	43 (FY25)
Profit (INR bn)	0.5 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	300
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,200 (2025)
Notable investors	Sequoia Capital (Peak XV Partners), Vitruvian Partners, Lightrock, Mahindra Group, Kedaara Capital, Wellington Management, Kae Capital, Elev8 Partners, Venrock, Soma Capital, and Y Combinator

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Porter was founded in 2014 by IIT alumni **Pranav Goel, Uttam Digga and Vikas Choudhary**. Inspired by Uber's model, the company began as a manual, google-sheet managed platform in Mumbai.



Uttam Digga
Co-Founder, CEO



Pranav Goel
Co-Founder, Executive
Vice Chairman



Vikas Choudhary
Co-Founder

Shadowfax

Company overview

Shadowfax is a new-age, technology-led third-party logistics ("3PL") company, and leverage technology to facilitate digital commerce, with its service network encompassing 14,758 Indian pin codes as of Sep 30, 2025. It is the only player of scale to service last mile and end-to-end delivery for e-commerce, and last-mile delivery for quick commerce, food delivery and other hyperlocal services as of Q1FY26. Additionally, Shadowfax is the only 3rd party logistics company amongst the peer set to offer 2W fleet to online mobility platforms. Its broad portfolio of services has enabled to strengthen the relationship and increase the wallet share with its digital commerce clients.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a technology-driven, asset-light logistics model that combines a gig-partner delivery network with proprietary routing, tracking and fulfillment software. Revenue is generated primarily through pay-per-delivery fees, service charges for express and quick commerce deliveries, reverse logistics services, and contractual enterprise logistics services. Its value proposition lies in speed, reliability and network density, enabling same-day and next-day deliveries across categories ranging from parcels and heavy goods to quick commerce essentials.

Exhibit 156: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	24.8 (FY25)
Profit (INR bn)	0.06 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1012
Notable investors	Bank of America, ICICI Prudential, Mirae Asset, Nippon Life India

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Shadowfax was co-founded by Abhishek Bansal and Vaibhav Khandelwal in 2015, later joined by Praharsh Chandra and Gaurav Jaithlia in the early founding team. Abhishek Bansal has been the company's Chief Executive Officer, steering its evolution from a hyperlocal delivery startup into a leading 3PL player in India's logistics ecosystem. Vaibhav Khandelwal serves as Co-Founder and CTO, focusing on technology and platform architecture to handle India's complex delivery challenges.



Abhishek Bansal
Co-Founder, MD & CEO



Vaibhav Khandelwal
Co-Founder, CTO

Ripplr

Company overview

Ripplr (Intelligent Retail Private Limited) is a Bengaluru-based B2B retail technology and distribution-as-a-service platform that digitises and streamlines FMCG and consumer brand distribution, warehouse management, logistics, inventory intelligence and retailer reach across India, serving ~1,00,000+ retailers with real-time visibility and data-driven supply-chain solutions.

Business model and value proposition

Ripplr operates a full-stack, tech-enabled distribution network offering Distribution as a Service (DaaS) to FMCG and consumer brands, integrating logistics execution, on-ground sales fulfilment, inventory management and retailer engagement into one platform to improve fill rates, speed and visibility while reducing traditional distribution inefficiencies.

Exhibit 157: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	11.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.9) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	250
Notable investors	SBI, Sojitz Corporation, 3one4 Capital, Zephyr Peacock, Fireside Ventures, Northern Arc, Stride Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2019 by **Abhishek Nehru** and **Santosh Dabke**, Ripplr's leadership combines expertise in supply-chain operations, distribution business strategy and tech-driven logistics execution, aiming to build India's largest digital distribution infrastructure for brands.



Abhishek Nehru
Co-Founder



Santosh Dabke
Co-Founder

Rivigo

Company overview

Rivigo is a technology-driven surface logistics company founded in 2014 (originally as TrucksFirst), known for pioneering the relay trucking model in India; it now operates as part of Mahindra Logistics' express and surface logistics vertical, offering FTL, PTL and express services across India with a strong focus on speed, reliability and tech-enabled execution.

Business model and value proposition

Rivigo operates a tech-enabled relay trucking and express logistics model, where long-haul journeys are broken into shorter legs with driver handovers at relay points, improving asset utilisation, turnaround time and driver welfare, supported by proprietary telematics, data analytics and network optimisation tools, and integrated into Mahindra Logistics' B2B express ecosystem.

Exhibit 158: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	6 (FY22)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.8) (FY22)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Warburg Pincus, SAIF Partners, Elevation Capital (formerly SAIF), SoftBank Vision Fund, Trifecta Capital, Spring Canter Investment, KB Global Platform Fund
	In late 2022, Mahindra Logistics (MLL) acquired Rivigo's entire B2B express business for around USD 28mn

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Rivigo was co-founded by **Deepak Garg** (IIT Kanpur graduate, MBA from ISB; former McKinsey and Company consultant with deep logistics and automotive expertise) and **Gazal Kalra** (IIT Delhi alumna, MBA from Stanford Graduate School of Business and MPA from Harvard Kennedy School; featured in Fortune India 40 Under 40), giving the company a rare combination of elite technical, strategic and global policy exposure at the founding level.



Deepak Garg
Co-Founder



Gazal Kalra
Co-Founder

Shiprocket

Company overview

Shiprocket is a New Delhi-based eCommerce-enablement and logistics platform offering a tech-driven shipping and order-fulfilment ecosystem that helps online sellers and MSMEs streamline shipping, track deliveries, manage returns, and scale operations across India and internationally using a single integrated interface.

Business model and value proposition

Shiprocket's business model revolves around a technology-powered logistics aggregator and enablement platform that integrates multiple courier partners, provides per-shipment charges, subscription-based solutions, value-added services (order management, tracking APIs, analytics, warehouse fulfilment) and AI-driven logistics tools to simplify end-to-end eCommerce fulfilment without owning physical fleets.

Exhibit 159: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	16.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.74) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Zomato, Temasek, Lightrock India, Bertelsmann India Investments (BII), and Info Edge Ventures, Moore Strategic Ventures, 9unicorns, KdT Ventures, and Tribe Capital

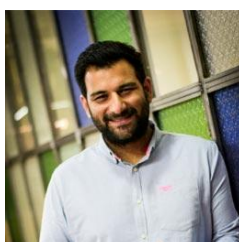
Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Shiprocket was founded in 2017 by Saahil Goel, Gautam Kapoor, Akshay Ghulati and Vishesh Khurana. Saahil Goel (MD and CEO) studied Computer Science at Drexel University and completed his MS + MBA from the University of Pittsburgh, later returning to India to build tech platforms for SMBs; the founders collectively bring strong tech, product and logistics expertise, having scaled Shiprocket into one of India's largest eCommerce logistics enablers.



Saahil Goel
Co-Founder, CEO



Gautam Kapoor
Co-Founder, COO



Akshay Ghulati
Co-Founder, CEO
- International
Shipping



Vishesh Khurana
Co-Founder

Recent developments

- **IPO and regulatory progress:** Shiprocket is reportedly looking to raise about INR 25bn, comprising a fresh issue worth INR 12–14bn and the remaining amount through an OFS.
- **Product innovation:** Shiprocket introduced RevProtect, a predictable revenue solution for MSMEs to mitigate the impact of shipping delays and RTO losses, strengthening seller support and retention in the core platform.

Unicommerce

Company overview

Unicommerce is a Gurugram-based e-commerce supply-chain SaaS platform incorporated in 2012, providing end-to-end solutions for inventory, order, warehouse and multi-channel management that streamline back-end operations for 7,000+ brands and sellers and power ecommerce logistics workflows across India, the Middle East and Southeast Asia.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2B SaaS model that generates revenue through subscription fees and value-added services by offering a unified ecommerce operations suite, including warehouse management, order processing, inventory sync, returns management and analytics, that integrates with marketplaces, logistics partners and seller platforms to automate and optimise ecommerce fulfilment.

Exhibit 160: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.35 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.18 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	125
Notable investors	SoftBank, Tiger Global Management, Nexus Venture Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

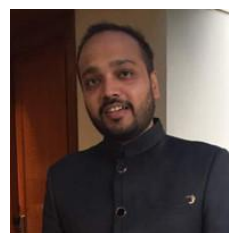
Founded in 2012 by Ankit Pruthi, Karun Singla, Vibhu Garg and Manish Gupta, all of whom were early tech and ecommerce leaders (with the first three being IIT Delhi alumni), Unicommerce was later acquired by Snapdeal; its current MD and CEO is Kapil Makhija, an IIT Delhi and IIM Bangalore alumnus with deep experience in strategy, operations and ecommerce platforms.



Ankit Pruthi
Co-Founder



Karun Singla
Co-Founder



Vibhu Garg
Co-Founder



Manish Gupta
Co-Founder

Recent developments

- Acquisition consolidation:** The company completed full ownership of Shipway (logistics automation platform), aiding product portfolio expansion and operational synergies.
- Capital infusion:** In Sep 2025, the board approved raising INR 0.2bn via a preferential share issue from promoter Acevector to strengthen resources.
- International profitability:** Unicommerce's international business turned operationally profitable across six markets in early FY26, supporting global expansion.

BlackBuck

Company overview

BlackBuck is India's largest digital trucking and logistics platform, founded in 2015 and headquartered in Bengaluru, that digitises and streamlines the trucking ecosystem by connecting shippers and truck operators with a technology-led marketplace covering payments, telematics, load matching, fleet services and financial tools to improve efficiency across India's freight network.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates an asset-light, tech-enabled B2B and B2C logistics marketplace where it connects shippers with truck operators using a digital platform and monetises via transaction commissions, subscription/fee-based offerings, telematics and value-added services like payments, fuel management and vehicle financing, making freight booking and operations more efficient for fleet owners and shippers.

Exhibit 161: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.09) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,250
Notable investors	SBI Mutual Fund, Bandhan Mutual Fund, Hornbill Orchid India Fund, Nomura

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

BlackBuck was founded by Rajesh Kumar Naidu Yabaji, Chanakya Hridaya and Ramasubramaniam B.

Rajesh Yabaji (Co-founder and CEO) holds a B.Tech in Metallurgical and Materials Engineering and an MBA from IIT Kharagpur and previously worked at ITC in supply chain and logistics, bringing deep industry insight.

Chanakya Hridaya also studied at IIT Kharagpur, with engineering credentials, and contributes technical and operational leadership.

Ramasubramaniam B brings product and consulting experience to the team.



Rajesh Yabaji
Co-Founder, CEO



Chanakya Hridaya
Co-Founder, COO



Ramasubramaniam B
Co-Founder, Head of
New Initiatives

Recent developments

Stakeholder transactions: In 2025, the co-founders sold 3.6mn shares (INR 2.44bn) in a block deal, indicating shareholder liquidity events.

Strategic moves and office relocation: The company announced plans to relocate its Bengaluru office due to infrastructure challenges, and received outreach from Andhra Pradesh leadership to relocate operations, highlighting macro-business environment considerations.

Borzo

Company overview

Borzo is a Mumbai-headquartered global same-day intracity delivery and logistics platform, formerly known as WeFast, that enables businesses and individuals to book on-demand deliveries via a mobile/web app, connecting them with nearby couriers for fast, flexible delivery of parcels, documents and retail goods across major Indian cities and multiple international markets.

Business model and value proposition

Borzo operates an on-demand logistics marketplace that matches customers with independent courier partners using a tech-enabled algorithm for real-time dispatch, routing and delivery optimisation, monetising via delivery fees and subscriptions while catering to both B2B and B2C segments with express, scheduled and multi-drop delivery services.

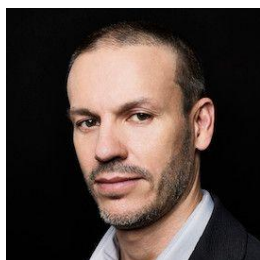
Exhibit 162: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.5 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Mubadala Capital, VNV Global, Flashpoint VC, Russian Direct Investment Fund

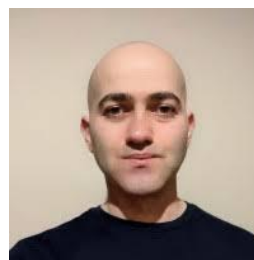
Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2012 by Mike Alexandrovski and Aleks Shamis, Borzo initially built a global same-day delivery network spanning 10+ countries; in recent strategic shifts, Alina Kisina, a seasoned logistics and sales leader with cross-industry experience, has been appointed CEO and leads growth from Borzo's Mumbai headquarters, emphasising India as a core market.



Mike Alexandrovski
Founder



Aleks Shamis
Co-Founder

FarEye

Company overview

FarEye (operated by RoboticWares Private Limited) is a Noida-based global logistics SaaS and delivery management platform that enables enterprises to orchestrate, track and optimize end-to-end logistics operations, from first-mile to last-mile delivery, using real-time visibility, automation and AI-driven insights to improve customer experience and supply-chain performance.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2B SaaS delivery and logistics orchestration model, offering cloud-native solutions for route planning, predictive delivery, real-time tracking and delivery experience management, monetising through subscription fees and tiered service offerings to global enterprises seeking digital supply-chain execution at scale.

Exhibit 163: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.97 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	Not available
Total funding raised (USD mn)	150
Last known valuation (USD mn)	400
Notable investors	TCV, M12 Venture Fund, Indian Angel Network, Elevation Capital, Eight Roads Ventures India

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

FarEye was founded in 2013 by Kushal Nahata, Gautam Kumar, Gaurav Srivastava, who combined logistics domain experience with deep software and product expertise to build a predictive logistics platform that serves enterprises worldwide; the current CEO Kushal Nahata continues to drive its global strategy.



Kushal Nahata
Co-Founder, CEO



Gautam Kumar
Co-Founder, COO



Gaurav Srivastava
Co-Founder, CPTO

Recent developments

Global enterprise traction: More than 90% of revenue now comes from international customers, evidencing global SaaS adoption.

Netradyne

Company overview

Netradyne is a San Diego, CA-headquartered AI and edge computing SaaS company that builds advanced fleet safety and driver performance solutions (such as its flagship Driver •i platform) to help commercial fleets reduce accidents, enhance driver behaviour and optimise operations globally.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2B SaaS model offering AI-powered fleet telematics and safety solutions, including real-time video analysis, driver behaviour scoring and predictive alerts, monetising through enterprise subscriptions and platform deployments that improve compliance, reduce costs, and boost operational performance for commercial fleets worldwide.

Exhibit 164: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	Not available
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	Not available
Total funding raised (USD mn)	308
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,300
Notable investors	SoftBank Vision Fund, Point72 Ventures, Reliance Industries, Qualcomm Ventures, Pavilion Capital, Silicon Valley Bank

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2015 by Avneesh Agrawal and David Julian, both former Qualcomm technologists, Netradyne's leadership blends deep expertise in AI, edge computing and transportation tech; the team has driven the company to global deployment with extensive patent activity and enterprise traction.



Avneesh Agrawal
Co-Founder, CEO



David Julian
Co-Founder, CTO

Recent developments

Series D funding and Unicorn status: In Jan'25, Netradyne raised USD 90mn in Series D funding led by Point72 Private Investments with participation from Qualcomm Ventures and Pavilion Capital.

Product Innovation: In 2025, Netradyne launched advanced safety solutions including the Driver•i D-450 drowsiness and risk detection AI platform and later the Driver•i D-810 360° AI system, enhancing real-time driver monitoring and fleet insights.

Delhivery

Company overview

Delhivery is an integrated logistics and supply-chain services company, founded in 2011 and headquartered in Gurugram. It offers end-to-end solutions across express parcel, heavy goods, part truckload (PTL), full truckload (FTL), warehousing and cross-border logistics, serving e-commerce, SMEs and large enterprises.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a network-led, asset-heavy logistics model, combining owned infrastructure (sorting centres, line-haul capacity) with partner fleets. Revenue is driven by per-shipment pricing, enterprise contracts and value-added supply-chain services, with scale, automation and network density being key levers for margin expansion.

Exhibit 165: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	89.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.6 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	3,800
Notable investors	Softbank, Nexus ventures partners, SBI MF, Mirae MF, HDFC MF, Nippon MF

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Since its inception in 2011, Delhivery's leadership has focused on building a technology-driven logistics backbone for India. Sahil Barua (CEO) has been central to Delhivery's IPO journey and post-listing profitability push.



Sahil Barua
MD & CEO



Kapil Bharati
Exec Director, CTO



Suraj Saharan
Exec Director, CPO

ElasticRun

Company overview

ElasticRun is a Pune-based B2B commerce and logistics platform focused on serving kirana stores and FMCG distributors in Tier-2, Tier-3 and rural markets. Founded in 2016, ElasticRun enables efficient last-mile distribution using a crowdsourced logistics network.

Business model and value proposition

ElasticRun operates an asset-light, tech-enabled B2B distribution model, leveraging underutilised transport capacity (kirana-linked vehicles) to move goods from FMCG brands to retailers. It monetises through distribution margins, logistics fees and private-label offerings, with negative working capital dynamics.

Exhibit 166: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	26.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.45) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	800 (2024)
Notable investors	SoftBank, SoftBank Group, Goldman Sachs Investment Partners, Prosus, Avataar Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

ElasticRun was founded by Sandeep Deshmukh (CEO), Shitiz Bansal (CTO) and Saurabh Nigam (COO) in 2016 - visionaries who combined their deep experience in logistics and tech from companies like Amazon to build a B2B platform connecting rural India's vast retail network with formal supply chains.



Sandeep Deshmukh
Co-Founder, CEO



Shitiz Bansal
Co-Founder, CTO



Saurabh Nigam
Co-Founder, COO

Xpressbees

Company overview

Xpressbees is a leading end-to-end logistics and express delivery company, founded in 2015 as a Spin-off from FirstCry and headquartered in Pune. It serves e-commerce marketplaces, D2C brands and enterprises across India.

Business model and value proposition

Xpressbees runs a hybrid asset-heavy logistics model, offering express parcel, cross-border logistics, freight and fulfilment services. Revenue is generated through shipment-based pricing and enterprise contracts, with investments in automation and regional hubs to improve throughput.

Exhibit 167: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	28.7 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(3.7) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,500
Notable investors	Blackstone, TPG Growth, ChrysCapital, Alibaba Group, Investcorp, Norwest Venture Partners, Khazanah Nasional Berhad, Gaja Capital, Elevation Capital, SAIF Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Amitava Saha and Supam Maheshwari**, Xpressbees' leadership has leveraged strong ties with the e-commerce ecosystem, especially FirstCry, to scale rapidly. The management team has focused on balancing growth with network reliability and service quality.



Amitava Saha
Co-Founder, CEO



Supam Maheshwari
Co-Founder

Loadshare

Company overview

LoadShare Networks is a Bengaluru-based, technology-driven logistics startup founded in 2017 that provides end-to-end, asset-light logistics services, including last-mile delivery, regional line haul, and warehousing for e-commerce, food, and FMCG sectors. It has a strong presence in the East and North East India, covering over 10,000 pin codes with a 500,000-shipment daily capacity.

Business model and value proposition

LoadShare Networks operates an asset-light, technology-enabled, franchise-based logistics marketplace in India, specialising in last-mile delivery, regional line-haul, and B2B services. They aggregate small-to-medium logistics service providers (LSPs) on a tech platform—dubbed "Atlas"—improving efficiency in underserved regions, particularly in East and North East India. Instead of owning large fleets, LoadShare franchises regional logistics partners and provides them with technology, demand, and brand access.

Exhibit 168: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.8 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.1) (FY23)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	65
Last known valuation (USD mn)	162 (as of Jan'22)
Notable investors	Lightspeed Venture Partners, Zomato, Samsung Venture Investment, and WaterBridge Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, YourStory

Founders and leadership

LoadShare Networks was founded in 2017 by Raghuram Talluri (CEO), Pramod Nair (CTO) and Rakib Ahmed.



Raghuram Talluri
Co-founder and CEO



Pramod Nair
Co-founder & CTO



Rakib Ahmed
Co-founder

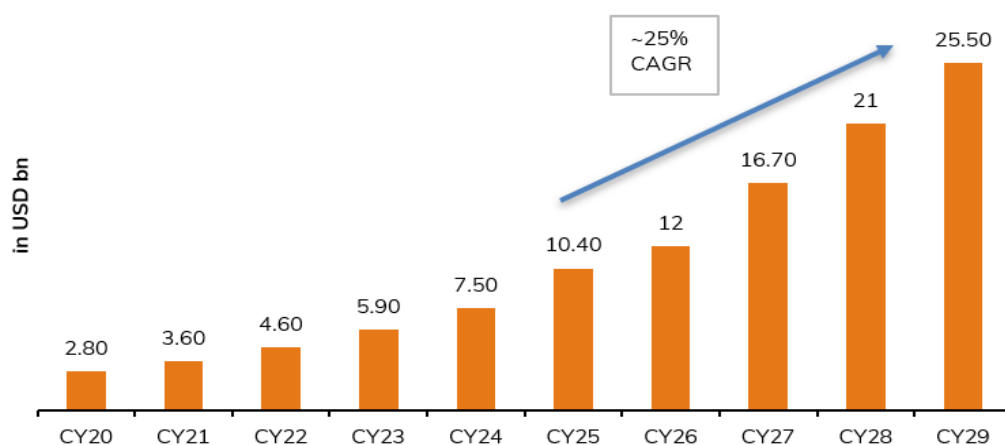
Chapter 10: Deep dive into Ed-tech

Ed-tech – sector overview

The Indian Ed-tech sector has evolved from offering basic test preparation to providing immersive, skill-oriented and personalized learning experiences.

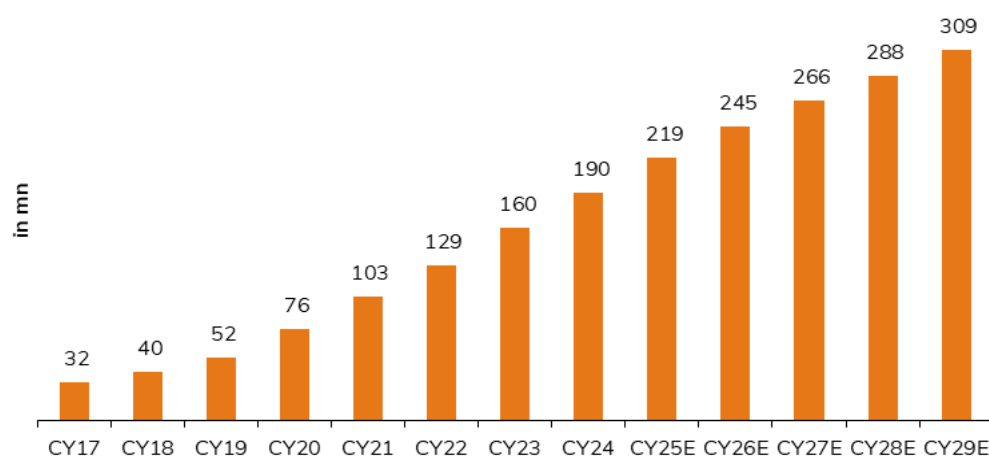
- **Valuation:** Valued at ~USD 10bn, as of CY25
- **Future projection:** Expected to reach USD 25bn by CY29, expanding at a CAGR of ~25%
- **Global standing:** India is the third-highest funded Ed-tech ecosystem globally (after US and China); and is home to 17k+ ed-tech companies

Exhibit 169: Estimated market size of Ed-tech sector in India



Source: Statista, I-Sec research

Exhibit 170: Number of users in the online education market India 2017–29P



Source: Statista, I-Sec research

Key segments

The convenience, flexibility and personalized offerings by Ed-tech companies make it a preferred choice for new-age students and corporate employees. The market is divided into 4 distinct segments, each with unique operational nuances and consumer behaviours.

Exhibit 171: Key Segments in the Ed-tech sector

Segment	Target Audience	Key Nuances and Characteristics	LTV/CAC Dynamics	Market size (USD bn)
K-12 (Primary and Secondary) → K-8 and 9-12	Students aged 3-14 and 14-18 years	K-10 is the largest segment. Focuses on supplemental curriculum support. Combines product (apps/games) with services (live tutoring). Highly fragmented with many niche sub-segment players. High churn potential at transition years.	High CAC; needs high retention for ROI	~4
Test Preparation	Grades 9-12 and Graduates	Highly service-oriented and outcomes-driven (JEE, NEET, UPSC). Mature segment with large players, high brand loyalty and intensive daily usage (>5 hours). Margin challenge; segment being built, money has to be poured in. A good mix of async and sync content could help mitigate margin challenges.	Clear outcomes lead to strong word-of-mouth (low organic CAC)	~4
Upskilling	Working professionals	Focused on employability (Coding, AI, Data Science). High intent for career transition; 87% of users believe it aids job readiness.	High ticket size compensates for shorter LTV.	~0.6
Online Certification	Students and Professionals	Driven by partnerships where Ed-techs handle distribution/marketing and Universities handle academic delivery.	Multi-year revenue streams with lower churn	~1.5

Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 172: Key companies in various Ed-tech segments

K12	TEST PREPARATION	EDTECH SAAS	ONLINE CERTIFICATION	ONLINE DISCOVERY	SKILL DEVELOPMENT
PHYSICS WALLAH Vedantu BYJU'S CUEMATH SplashLearn BrightChamps YELLOW CLASS CAMPK12 doubtnut filo bhanzu	Adda247 unacademy tannr LEAP SCHOLAR testbook.com Meritnation NeoStencil Springboard CultureAlley EMBIBE JIGSAW ACADEMY	LEAD Classplus impartus Ei iP QUIZIZZ Mips SchoolGuru UOLO	upGrad ERUDITUS NURTURE SUNSTONE eduversity simplilearn IMARTICUS LEARNING EDUPRISTINE	CollegeDekho UrbanPro leverage edu EduKart 	SCALER CODING NINJAS pesto masai Learning Mate

Source: I-Sec Research

Strategic insight: Regional economics and operational efficiency in Indian Ed-tech

Success in this market is increasingly defined by a company's ability to map pricing to regional economic realities and ability to optimize unit economics.

1. The north-south divide: Propensity to Pay (PTP)

India's Ed-tech market exhibits sharp regional variances in price elasticity and curriculum standards:

- **Southern Resilience:** Markets in South India show a significantly higher propensity to pay (PTP). Even state board students (eg: Tamil Nadu) frequently invest > INR 25k in supplemental learning on par with CBSE/ICSE students, making these high-value consumers.
- **Northern/Eastern Price Sensitivity:** In states like Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, the threshold for online courses is lower and often caps at INR 30k. To capture this volume, players like PhysicsWallah have successfully deployed a "micro-product" strategy—offering bite-sized courses priced between INR 500–1,000 to cater to students where even an INR 10k price point is a barrier.

2. The AI-driven structural reset in unit economics

The integration of AI is fundamentally altering the cost structure of academic delivery:

- **Teacher-Student Ratios:** In the pre-AI era, operational efficiency was capped at 1:50 ratio. AI-enabled hyper-personalisation and automated doubt-clearing have expanded this to 1:100 or even 1:150 without compromising learning outcomes.
- **High-Scale Models:** Market leaders are now proving that "massive open classes" (up to 1,000 students per group) can be financially viable if supported by a robust tech stack, driving high-margin outcomes.

3. Consumer persona and financial engineering

India is characterized by a high willingness to invest in education, a demand for value-for-money and a strong preference for competitive exam prep and skill acquisition. Availability of financing options further expands the pool of Ed-tech customers.

- **Case Study:** For a child with an annual school fee of INR 70k, parents (assuming salary INR1.2-1.5mn) are increasingly comfortable adding a 30–40% "supplementary premium" (approx. INR 30k) for Ed-tech.
- **Financing as an Enabler:** Growth is no longer dependent on upfront payments. The proliferation of 6-month EMIs and specialized education financing has converted high-ticket sizes into manageable monthly operational expenses for parents.

4. Emerging growth moats: benchmarking and olympiads

There is a shifting demand from "remedial" tutoring to "competitive" benchmarking. Parents are increasingly investing in Olympiad prep programs not just for the content, but for the data—seeking to understand how their child ranks against a national pool of peers. This benchmarking trend creates a high-stickiness pull factor for platforms.

5. Margin analysis (CM2 profiles)

Operating margins vary significantly by grade level, dictated by the "Push vs. Pull" nature of the sale:

- **K-5 (20–25% Margin):** Primarily a "push" business requiring high marketing spend to convince parents of the value of early-age digital learning. This is also a very fragmented market with several small players.

- Grades 6–10 (40–45% Margin): A healthier mix of "push" and "pull" as competitive pressure begins to drive organic demand.
- The Organic Advantage: Companies like Vedantu have achieved 45%+ organic revenue by investing in "star teachers" rather than celebrity ads, significantly reducing the CAC burden. Post-Covid, the adoption of permanent WFH models for tutors has further reduced corporate overheads and office rentals, structurally improving the margin profile.

Exhibit 173: Ed-tech sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	• Tech Stack Excellence: Robust productization of the learning ecosystem allows for scalable, data-driven outcomes.
	• High ROI Models: Online/hybrid business models allow for better margins compared to traditional infrastructure-heavy education.
	• Demographic Dividend: Over 65% of India's population is under 35, providing a massive, tech-savvy consumer base.
Weakness	• High Acquisition Costs (CAC): Marketing and sales expenses remain a major hurdle to achieving bottom-line profitability.
	• The "Open Loop" Problem: Lack of physical discipline and personal attention in purely online formats could lead to lower completion rates.
	• Tax Burden: A high 18% GST (9% CGST + 9% SGST) makes these services more expensive for the end-user.
	• Regional diversity requires extensive localization
	• In K-12, the person paying (parent) is not the person using the product (student). Balancing the parent's demand for results with the student's demand for engagement is a constant struggle.
	• While data costs are low, access to high-quality devices and stable internet in rural India remain an obstacle to universal accessibility.
Opportunity	• Transparency in reporting actual learning outcomes and the validity of certifications compared to traditional degrees.
	• Generative AI: Massive potential for hyper-personalized learning paths and 1-on-1 AI tutoring.
	• Hybrid Models: Merging the trust of offline centers with the tech-efficiency of online platforms.
	• Vernacular Content: Tapping into Tier-2/3 cities by moving beyond English-medium instruction.
Threat	• Regulatory Scrutiny: Potential for government-mandated fee caps and stricter guidelines for coaching centers.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

To bridge the gap between private innovation and public benefit, the following measures are suggested:

- **Unified regulatory framework:** Establishing an integrated national framework for the coaching sector could harmonize fragmented state-level guidelines and establish standardized benchmarks for fee structures. Such a unified approach could mitigate the risks of predatory marketing and excessive pricing, ensuring a more equitable and transparent educational environment.
- **GST rationalisation:** Rationalisation of GST on Ed-tech services from the current 18% to align with essential educational services could significantly improve affordability and digital inclusion for lower-income quintiles.
- **Credential recognition:** Creating a standardized national recognition system and formal digital architectures for online certifications could ensure interoperability across academic institutions and the corporate sector, effectively reducing information asymmetry regarding candidate qualifications.

Companies in Ed-tech

PhysicsWallah

Company overview

PhysicsWallah is India's most prominent mass-market Ed-tech platform, focused on JEE, NEET and school education at highly affordable price points. Founded in 2020 (after years as a YouTube channel), PhysicsWallah scaled rapidly by prioritising accessibility over premium pricing.

Business model and value proposition

PhysicsWallah operates a low-cost, high-volume hybrid model, combining free YouTube content, paid online courses and a fast-expanding network of offline coaching centres. Revenue is driven by large student volumes, tight cost control and minimal marketing spend.

Exhibit 174: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	28.8 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.4) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	3,300
Notable investors	WestBridge Capital, GSV Ventures, Hornbill Capital, and Lightspeed Venture Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by Alakh Pandey (educator) and Prateek Maheshwari (startup operator), the leadership blends strong student connects with operational execution. Pandey's credibility as a teacher is a key moat, while Maheshwari has driven disciplined scaling and profitability.



Alakh Pandey
Founder & CEO



Prateek Maheshwari
Co-Founder

Adda247

Company overview

Adda247 is a vernacular-first test preparation platforms, focused on government job exams such as banking, SSC, railways, teaching and defence. Founded in 2016, Adda247 built scale by addressing aspirants in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities through regional language content, mobile-first delivery and affordable pricing.

Business model and value proposition

Adda247 operates a subscription-led digital learning model, offering live classes, recorded courses, test series and doubt-solving across 12+ Indian languages. Revenue is driven primarily through paid course subscriptions, with additional monetisation from books, mock tests and selective offline centres.

Exhibit 175: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.04) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	67
Last known valuation (USD mn)	175 (2022)
Notable investors	Google, Asha Impact, Info Edge Ventures, Westbridge Capital, JM Financial, MMPL Trust, STL

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, VC Circle

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Anil Nagar (IIT Delhi alumnus)** and **Saurabh Bansal**, Adda247's leadership brings deep understanding of India's government-exam ecosystem and mass-market education demand. Anil Nagar has been recognised for building one of India's most scalable vernacular Ed-tech platforms with capital-efficient growth.



Anil Nagar
Co-Founder, CEO



Saurabh Bansal
Co-Founder, COO

BrightCHAMPS

Company overview

BrightCHAMPS is a global kids-focused Ed-tech platform offering coding, finance, communication and life-skills courses to students aged 6–16. Founded in 2020, it scaled rapidly through international expansion, especially in the US, Middle East and Southeast Asia.

Business model and value proposition

It follows a live, instructor-led premium subscription model, delivering small-group and one-on-one classes. Revenue is generated via course packages and long-term learning plans, with high ARPU driven by global markets.

Exhibit 176: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.2 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.6) (FY23)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	63
Last known valuation (USD mn)	650
Notable investors	PremjiInvest, GSV Ventures, BEENEXT, 021 Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded by Ravi Bhushan, the leadership blends consulting and startup experience. Bhushan previously worked at BCG and built BrightCHAMPS with a global-first mindset, backed by marquee investors.



Ravi Bhushan
Founder, CEO

Classplus

Company overview

Classplus is a B2B SaaS platform that enables coaching institutes and tutors to digitise operations, manage students and sell courses online. Founded in 2018, Classplus positioned itself as the “Shopify for educators.”

Business model and value proposition

Classplus earns through subscription fees, transaction commissions and value-added SaaS services such as payments, CRM and content hosting. The model is asset-light with strong operating leverage.

Exhibit 177: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.6 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.1) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	160
Last known valuation (USD mn)	600
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Sequoia Capital, Blume Ventures, RTP Global, Alpha Wave Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

The company was founded in 2018 by Mukul Rustagi and Bhaswat Agarwal, to empower educators with white-labeled apps and digital tools. Based in Noida, India, the company helps teachers, content creators, and coaching centers digitize their businesses, enabling them to launch apps, manage live classes, and sell courses



Mukul Rustagi
Co-Founder, CEO



Bhaswat Agarwal
Co-Founder



Nikhil Goel
Co-Founder



Vatsal Rustagi
Co-Founder

CueMath

Company overview

Cuemath is a **math-focused learning platform** targeting students from KG to Class 12, with a strong emphasis on conceptual understanding rather than rote learning.

Business model and value proposition

It follows a **premium subscription model**, combining structured curriculum, trained tutors and personalised learning paths. Revenue is driven by monthly and annual subscriptions.

Exhibit 178: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.3 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.3) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	126
Last known valuation (USD mn)	400
Notable investors	Sequoia Capital, Alpha Wave Incubation, Manta Ray Ventures, Trifecta Capital Advisors, CapitalG, Peak XV

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

The company was founded by Manan Khurma (IIT Delhi) and Dr. Jagjit Khurma in 2013, its leadership brings product and pedagogy focus, positioning math as a long-term skill rather than exam prep.



Manan Khurma
Founder, CEO



Jagjit Khurma
Co-Founder (Cue Learn)

Eruditus

Company overview

Eruditus is an Ed-tech company that partners with top universities like Harvard, MIT, and INSEAD to offer online professional education (executive education, certificates, short courses) to working professionals worldwide.

Business model and value proposition

Eruditus operates a **B2B2C executive education model**, earning revenue through **high-ticket program fees** shared with partner universities. The model enjoys high margins and global demand.

Exhibit 179: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	37.3 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	1,464
Last known valuation (USD mn)	3,100
Notable investors	Accel, SoftBank, Peak XV Partners, Bertelsmann India Investments, TPG, Chan Zuckerberg initiative, Prosus ventures, CPPIB

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Ashwin Damera, the Co-Founder and CEO, brought a strong background in finance and business, holding an MBA from Harvard Business School. Chaitanya Kalipatnapu, the Co-Founder and Executive Director, contributed expertise in information systems and business management, with an MBA from INSEAD. Their combined vision was to make executive education more accessible to a global audience, especially working professionals.



Ashwin Damera
Co-Founder, CEO



Chaitanya Kalipatnapu
Co-Founder, Director

LEAD School

Company overview

LEAD School is a school transformation and education solutions provider focused on affordable private schools across India. Founded in 2012, LEAD partners with K-12 schools to modernise curriculum delivery, teacher training, assessments and school operations, targeting consistent learning outcomes rather than direct-to-student monetisation.

Business model and value proposition

LEAD operates a B2B annual contract model, charging schools on a per-student, per-year basis. Its offerings include academic curriculum, digital classrooms, teacher certification, assessments and school management systems, creating sticky, recurring revenues with low churn and predictable cash flows.

Exhibit 180: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.5 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.4) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	190
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,100 (2022)
Notable investors	WestBridge Capital, GSV Ventures, Elevar Equity, Alteria Capital and Stride Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Lead School

Founders and leadership

Founded by Sumeet Mehta and Smita Deorah, LEAD's leadership blends consulting rigor with grassroots education experience. The founders focus on systemic reform in school education rather than consumer marketing-led scale, making LEAD one of the more defensible B2B Ed-tech models.



Sumeet Mehta
Co-Founder, CEO



Smita Deorah
Co-Founder, Co-CEO

Leap

Company overview

Leap is a study-abroad and international education platform that supports Indian students through the entire overseas education lifecycle, from counselling and test prep to admissions, visas and financing. Founded in 2019, Leap targets the fast-growing outbound education market.

Business model and value proposition

Leap follows an integrated services + fintech model, monetising via admission counselling fees, test-prep subscriptions, university partnerships and education loan commissions. Its embedded financing capability improves conversion rates and monetisation per student.

Exhibit 181: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.7 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.4 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	317
Last known valuation (USD mn)	850-900
Notable investors	HSBC, Peak XV Partners, Apis Partners, Owl Ventures, Jungle Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded by Arnav Kumar and Vaibhav Singh, Leap's leadership combines experience in education services, fintech and cross-border operations. Kumar has positioned Leap as a full-stack platform rather than a pure counselling intermediary, enabling higher lifetime value per student.



Arnav Kumar (L) & Vaibhav Singh (R)
Co-Founders

Scaler Academy

Company overview

Scaler Academy is a career-focused upskilling platform offering long-duration programs in software engineering, data science and AI. Founded in 2019, Scaler targets early- to mid-career professionals seeking high-paying tech roles.

Business model and value proposition

Scaler follows a premium outcome-based education model, charging high course fees justified by placement outcomes. It leverages live instruction, mentorship, structured curriculum and hiring partnerships to drive strong student ROI.

Exhibit 182: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.02) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	76
Last known valuation (USD mn)	700 (2022)
Notable investors	Lightrock India, Tiger Global Management, Peak XV Partners, Global Founders Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Abhimanyu Saxena and Anshuman Singh, Scaler is led by a team of industry veterans from top tech firms.



Abhimanyu Saxena (L) & Anshuman Singh (R)
Co-Founders

UpGrad

Company overview

upGrad is a **higher education and professional learning platform** focused on degrees, certifications and executive programs in partnership with global universities. Founded in 2015, upGrad targets working professionals rather than mass student cohorts.

Business model and value proposition

upGrad operates a **revenue-sharing university partnership model**, earning from **tuition fees and program enrolments**. Longer program durations and premium pricing result in higher ARPU but also higher acquisition and servicing costs.

Exhibit 183: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	16.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	EBITDA profit of INR 0.15bn (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	770
Last known valuation (USD mn)	2,250 (2024)
Notable investors	Temasek, Bodhi Tree, ETS Global, IIFL Finance, and Lupa Systems, Kaizen Management Advisors, Narotam Sekhsaria Family Office, Artian Investments

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Times of India

Founders and leadership

Founded by Ronnie Screwvala, Mayank Kumar, Phalgun Kompalli, Ravijot Chugh, upGrad benefits from strong capital markets, media and education expertise. Screwvala's experience in scaling consumer businesses has shaped upGrad's structured, brand-led approach.



Ronnie Screwvala
Co-Founder & Chairman



Mayank Kumar
Co-Founder



Phalgun Kompalli
Co-Founder



Ravijot Chugh
Co-Founder

Vedantu

Company overview

Vedantu is a **live online tutoring platform** offering interactive classes for school students and competitive exam aspirants. Founded in 2011, Vedantu pioneered live two-way online teaching in India.

Business model and value proposition

It follows a **live-class subscription model**, monetising through course fees for small-group and one-on-one classes. The model delivers strong learning outcomes but carries higher instructor and delivery costs.

Exhibit 184: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.2) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	348
Last known valuation (USD mn)	912
Notable investors	Accel, Tiger Global Management, Omidyar Network, ABC World Asia, WestBridge Capital, Coatue, and TAL Education Group

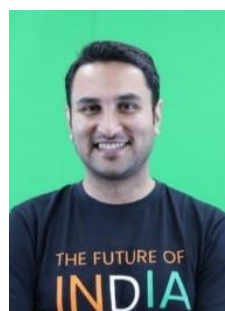
Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded by Vamsi Krishna, Pulkit Jain, Anand Prakash, all former educators and IIT alumni, Vedantu's leadership is deeply rooted in pedagogy and classroom innovation rather than pure platform scale.



Vamsi Krishna
Co-Founder, CEO



Pulkit Jain
Co-Founder, Head of
Product



Anand Prakash
Co-Founder, Head of
Academics

Leverage Edu

Company overview

Leverage Edu is an AI-enabled marketplace designed to help students with their higher education and career growth plans. Leverage Edu helps Indian students' study overseas in the UK, US, Canada, Australia and Europe. Prospective students work with LeverageEdu's platform for tutoring and test prep, discovery of the best courses that guarantee job outcomes, interaction with university recruiters, application life-cycle tracking and increasingly, financial services.

Business model and value proposition

Leverage Edu connects students with universities, offering end-to-end services from counseling to visa assistance, leveraging commissions from universities (90% of revenue) and, increasingly, student financial services (Fly Finance) to achieve profitability.

Exhibit 185: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.7 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.1) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	70
Last known valuation (USD mn)	150
Notable investors	Blume ventures, DSG consumer partners, Tomorrow Capital, Artha India Ventures, DSP invest, NB ventures, Trifecta capital, 9 unicorns, Kaizeinvest

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Leverage Edu was founded by Akshay Chaturvedi, who serves as CEO. He is a former Teach for India fellow and has built the company with a strong focus on mentorship-led education and global student mobility. Aman Arora leads technology and product as CTO, driving the development of AI-led counselling tools and platform scalability. The broader leadership team includes professionals across counselling operations, growth, and financial services, reflecting the company's evolution into a full-stack education and career platform.



Akshay Chaturvedi
Founder & CEO



Aman Arora
Co-Founder, Chief of
Growth & Tech

Imarticus Learning

Company overview

Imarticus Learning is a professional education company focused on upskilling in finance, analytics, and technology, targeting both fresh graduates and working professionals.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a hybrid model (online + offline) with revenues from course fees, corporate training programs, and placement-linked courses. Partnerships with universities and corporates enhance credibility and placement outcomes.

Exhibit 186: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	15
Last known valuation (USD mn)	150
Notable investors	Caspian, Global Ivy Ventures and BLinC Invest

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

Imarticus Learning was founded by Nikhil Barshikhar and Sonya Hooja. Nikhil, the CEO, with deep expertise in finance and training, and he drives strategy and industry partnerships. Sonya Hooja focuses on academic delivery and curriculum design, ensuring alignment with industry requirements.



Nikhil Barshikhar
Co-founder & CEO



Sonya Hooja
Co-founder & President

Chapter 11: Deep dive into Auto-tech

Auto-tech – sector overview

Structural transformation – from offline to digital discovery

The automotive industry has undergone a structural transformation, moving from traditional offline methods to a landscape where discovery is now decidedly digital. This shift is not a temporary trend but a fundamental change in market dynamics. Consequently, online discovery has evolved from a competitive differentiator into a basic entry requirement.

Digital dominance in discovery

Online discovery has evolved from a differentiator to a basic entry requirement.

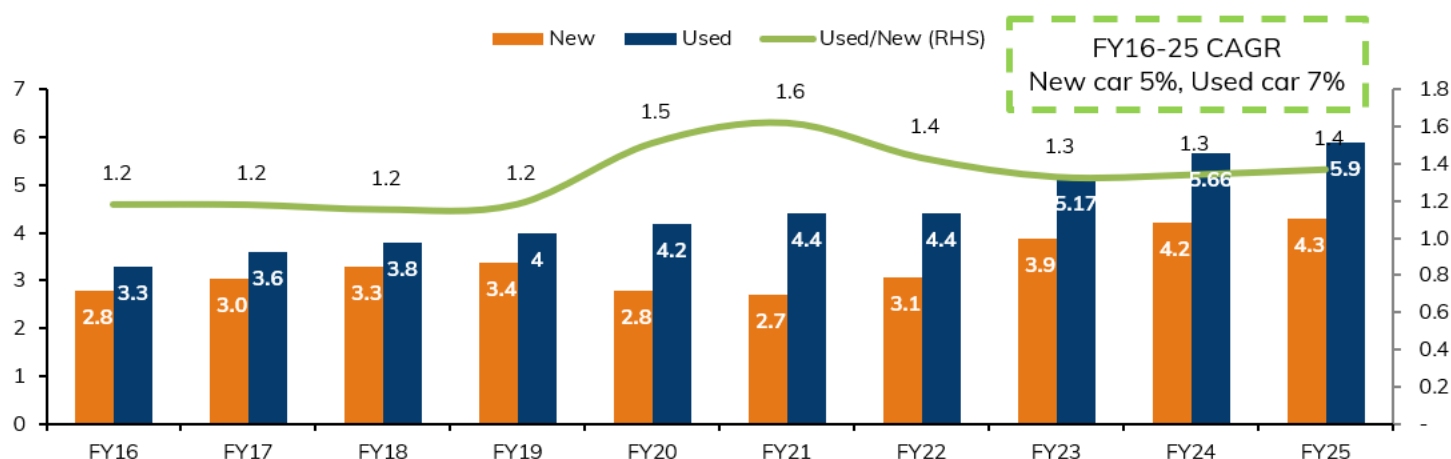
- **Move towards Hybrid mode:** Today, 92% of new car buyers and 85% of used car buyers begin their purchase journey online, a dramatic leap from just 20–30% five years ago. While discovery is digital, the fulfilment remains "phygital," relying on dealer ecosystems for the final transaction.
- **Low Barriers, High Competition:** Entry barriers at the discovery stage are low, forcing OEMs, dealers, lenders, insurers, and marketplaces to compete aggressively for the same digital attention before a transaction even begins.
- **Personal Mobility Surge:** Post-pandemic shifts have intensified the preference for personal mobility over corporate or B2B solutions, further accelerating individual digital research.

Used cars: The primary engine of growth

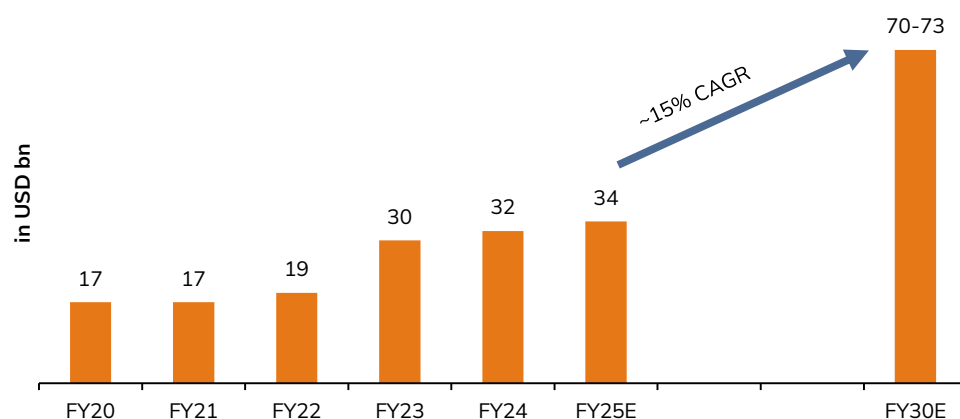
The real opportunity for auto-tech disruption has shifted toward the used car market, driven by favourable volume dynamics, a widening affordability gap, and a fragmented landscape ripe for innovation.

- **Volume dynamics:** The used-to-new car sales ratio has surged to 1.4x (up from <1x five years ago) and is expected to hit a 1.7:1 ratio within the next 4–5 years, growing at an 8–10% CAGR. Used car market size currently stands at ~USD 34bn (FY25) and is expected to reach ~USD70bn by FY30, growing at a ~15% CAGR.

Exhibit 187: New vs. used car sales (in mn) and used/new car sales trend



Source: CarAndBike

Exhibit 188: Market value of used cars in India from FY20-30E


Source: I-Sec research, Statista

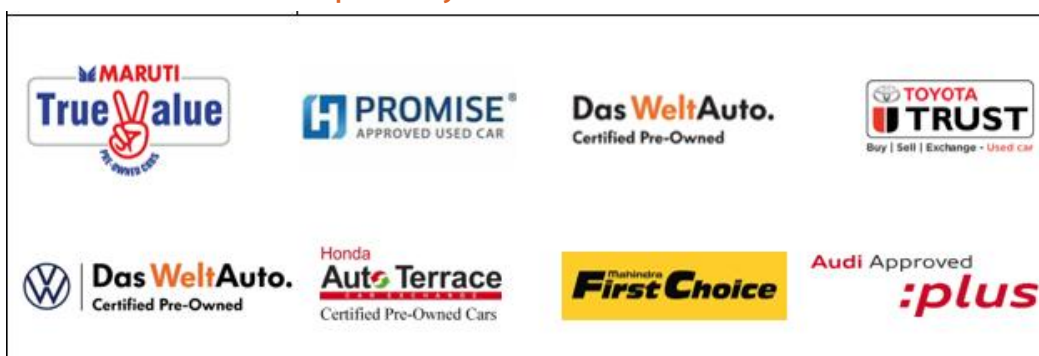
- **A widening and structural affordability gap:** The ASP for new cars has jumped from INR 800k to ~INR 1,100k, led by road tax hikes, BS6/regulatory compliance, and commodity costs. In this period, used cars ASP has risen from INR 450k to ~INR 600k. A steep price increase in new cars has led to a share of the customer segment being priced out of the new car market. This, along with persistent price difference of ~INR 500k vs used cars, is altering consumer preferences towards used cars.
- **Low barriers to tech disruption:** Unlike the new car segment, which is tightly controlled by OEMs and established dealer networks, the used car market is uniquely positioned for tech intervention:
 - **Fragmentation vs. control:** New cars are locked into OEM-led warranties and dealer dominance for several years. Used cars suffer from fragmented supply and a significant trust deficit.
 - **Service gaps:** Buyers still navigate a fragmented landscape of dealers, lenders, and insurers with no single entity owning the end-to-end responsibility. There are massive opportunities for tech platforms to intervene in areas where traditional players struggle.
 - Refurbishment: Standardizing quality in a non-standardized market.
 - Financing and Insurance: Bridging the gap for buyers who lack traditional credit profiles.
 - Warranties: Providing peace of mind in a market previously defined by "buyer beware."

Exhibit 189: Global used car start-ups dominating across geographies



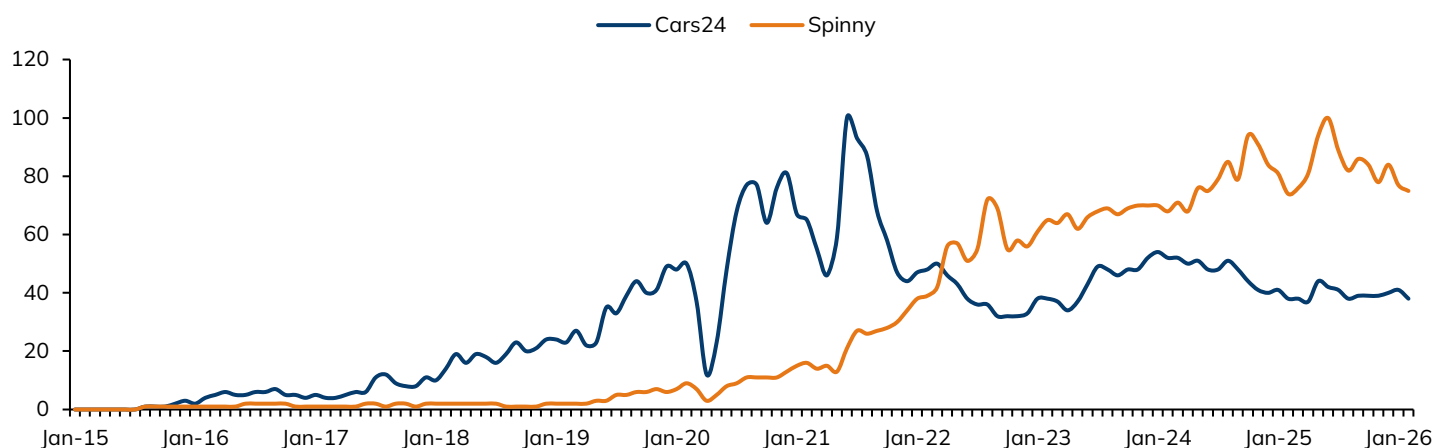
Source: I-Sec Research

Exhibit 190: Used car companies by OEMs in India



Source: I-Sec Research

Exhibit 191: Google search trends for the words Cars24, Spinny indicate increasing interest over time (#)



Source: I-Sec research, Google trends

Business model mechanics: Classifieds vs. full-stack

In India, major digital platforms include Cartrade, Cardekho, Cars24, Spinny, etc. While digital platforms have successfully empowered buyers, the backend infrastructure remains fragmented. The industry is split between high-volume, low-margin discovery and high-trust, capital-intensive transactions.

Exhibit 192: Car sales portals primarily operate via two models – classifieds and full stack

Classifieds	Full-stack
• Monetize through dealer subscriptions and lead generation. • They enjoy traffic dominance but face "replacement risk" as they don't own the transaction. • Examples: CarTrade, CarDekho	• These players own inventory and refurbish vehicles. • This model offers pricing power and consumer trust but requires massive capital and operational scale. • Examples: Spinny, Cars24

Source: I-Sec Research

Demand-side maturity: Problem solved

Digital platforms have effectively eliminated the historical hurdles facing the modern car buyer. Through mature digital ecosystems, the industry has solved for:

Information asymmetry: Buyers no longer rely on salespeople for basic specifications or market pricing.

Research depth: Comprehensive comparisons, feature breakdowns, and expert video reviews are now ubiquitous.

High intent: Customers now arrive at dealerships (digital or physical) with extreme clarity, having completed the majority of their decision-making process online.

Supply-side chaos: The core bottleneck

Despite high demand, the supply chain and fulfilment experience still remain unstructured. The core issues include:

Standardisation and quality: There is no universal benchmark for vehicle condition, particularly in the used car segment, leading to inconsistent quality.

Fragmented accountability: The consumer journey is currently split between a series of disconnected entities:

- Marketplaces: Handle discovery only.
- Dealers: Control physical inventory and pricing.
- OEMs: Provide the brand promise and base warranty.
- Lenders and Insurers: Operate as siloed financial layers.

There is an ownership vacuum, as no single entity owns the customer experience end-to-end. This lack of a single point of responsibility leads to friction, mistrust, and poor post-sale support. We believe there is scope for players to move beyond mere discovery to offer integrated fulfilment.

Financing as a growth lever: ~60% of used-car buyers are sub-prime, making financing the ultimate conversion tool. Banks and NBFCs are increasingly attracted by ROIs of 14–20% in this segment.

Exhibit 193: Auto-tech and used car segment – SWOT analysis

Category	Details
Strengths	• Structural shift to online discovery: ~85% of used-car and ~92% of new-car discovery now happens online, up from ~20–30% five years ago. This shift is structural and irreversible, ensuring sustained digital traffic for platforms. • Faster growth of used-car market: Used cars are growing at ~8–10% CAGR versus ~5–7% for new cars. Volume ratios are shifting sharply in favour of used cars (from ~1:1.3 today to potentially 1:1.7 in 4–5 years). • Large unorganised market: ~70% of the market remains unorganised, with potential for platforms to formalise supply, standardise quality and build pan India brands. • Multiple monetisation touchpoints: Each vehicle enables monetisation across discovery, financing, insurance, warranty, service, refurbishment, and resale, leading to high lifecycle monetisation potential.
Weaknesses	• Thin unit economics: Discovery-led models have low margins, while transaction-led models are capital- and operations-intensive, making profitability difficult without scale. • Low transaction visibility: Classified platforms often do not know whether a transaction occurred, as dealer reporting is trust-based and not system-enforced. • Trust and fraud issues: Used-car ecosystem faces issues such as quality misrepresentation, odometer tampering, and post-sale disputes, which could impact customer confidence. • Skilled labour shortage: Traditional garages lack expertise in EVs, ADAS, and digitally complex vehicles, constraining service scalability. • High capital intensity: Inventory ownership, yards, refurbishment, logistics, and customer support require heavy upfront and ongoing capital investment.
Opportunities	• End-to-end lifecycle ownership: Owning the journey from discovery to post-sale service and upgrade is the largest value creation lever, as no single entity currently owns the customer end-to-end. • EV-specific services: White spaces exist in EV resale pricing, battery health certification, diagnostics and subscription-based health monitoring, with no established standards yet. • Financing expansion: ~60% of used-car buyers are sub-prime. Increasing participation by banks and NBFCs, attracted by 14–20% ROIs, could significantly expand transaction volumes. • Tier-2 and Tier-3 city penetration: Tier-2/3 cities have huge demand potential and are driving incremental demand and digital adoption. Share of inquiries from Tier-1 cities has fallen from ~40% about 5 years back to ~25% currently. • B2B and fleet verticals: Growth in Fleet and B2B servicing, which offer higher ticket sizes, subscription-like revenues and more predictable demand compared to individual retail transactions. • Consolidation-led scale benefits: M&A (e.g., classifieds consolidation) could drive rapid market share gains, cost efficiencies and sustained profitability.
Threats	• OEM vertical integration: OEMs are entering financing, used cars, certification, and services. They control warranties, genuine parts, and software access, giving them structural power. If OEM portals or dealer-led platforms gain traction, third-party marketplaces risk losing relevance beyond discovery. • Price wars: Dealer margin flexibility allows aggressive undercutting, leading to value destruction across platforms. • Regulatory ambiguity: Lack of standardised vehicle certification and enforcement weakens trust and allows poor-quality supply to persist. • Capital exhaustion risk: Many transaction-heavy players may fail before reaching the scale required for breakeven due to sustained losses and cash burn.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

RC Transfer Standardisation and Liability Clarity:

- A more consistent state-level implementation of the RC transfer process could help create significant operational benefit for organised used-vehicle platforms. Mandating uniform, time-bound transfer completion within 30–45 days across all RTOs — alongside full adoption of the ADRV (Authorised Dealer of Registered Vehicles) framework — could establish clear liability boundaries between sellers, platforms, and buyers, fostering a more predictable and trust-driven transaction environment.

Unified Digital Vehicle History Repository:

- A centralised, API-accessible repository integrating service history, accident records, loan encumbrances, and RTO data — accessible to licensed auto-tech platforms — could help further formalise the sector, reduce disputes, and support India's broader digital public infrastructure goals.

Companies in Auto-tech

Cardekho

Company overview

CarDekho is a leading auto-tech marketplace founded in 2008 and headquartered in Gurugram, offering digital solutions across new and used car discovery, financing, insurance and dealer enablement through platforms such as CarDekho, BikeDekho and ZigWheels.

Business model and value proposition

CarDekho operates a multi-vertical auto-commerce platform, monetising through OEM and dealer advertising, lead generation, commissions from car sales, financing and insurance distribution, and SaaS tools for dealers, creating an end-to-end digital automotive ecosystem.

Exhibit 194: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	27.9 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.6) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	752
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1200 (2021)
Notable investors	Google Capital (CapitalG), Sequoia Capital, Hillhouse Capital, Tybourne Capital, LeapFrog Investments, Mirae Asset, and HDFC Bank

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, ET, CB Insights

Founders and leadership

Founded by Amit Jain and Anurag Jain (IIT Delhi alumni, former Trilogy professionals), the founders bring strong product and scaling expertise; Amit Jain also gained mainstream recognition as a Shark Tank India investor, enhancing brand visibility and founder credibility.



Amit Jain
Co-Founder, CEO



Anurag Jain
Co-Founder, COO

Cars24

Company overview

Cars24 is a global digital marketplace for used vehicles, founded in 2015 and headquartered in Gurugram, enabling individuals and dealers to buy, sell, finance and manage used cars across India, Australia, UAE and select international markets.

Business model and value proposition

It follows a transaction-led marketplace model, earning through seller commissions, dealer subscriptions, value-added services (RC transfer, inspections), and fintech products such as car loans and consumer financing.

Exhibit 195: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	62.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(5.4) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Peak XV, DST Global, SoftBank, Alpha Wave Global, Exor Seeds

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded by Vikram Chopra, Gajendra Jangid, Mehul Agrawal and Ruchit Agarwal, the team brings backgrounds in consulting, product and operations, with Vikram Chopra driving global expansion and fintech integration as CEO.



Vikram Chopra
Co-Founder,
Group CEO



Gajendra Jangid
Co-Founder, CMO



Mehul Agrawal
Co-Founder, COO



Ruchit Agarwal
Co-Founder,
Group CFO

Cartrade Tech

Company overview

CarTrade Tech is a listed auto-tech company operating platforms such as CarTrade, BikeWale, CarWale and Shriram Automall, serving OEMs, dealers and consumers across new and used vehicle transactions.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a B2B + B2C digital marketplace, monetising via subscription fees, dealer services, auction commissions, classifieds and SaaS solutions, with a strong presence in used vehicle auctions through Shriram Automall.

Exhibit 196: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	6.4 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.45 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	950
Notable investors	Temasek, Warburg Pincus, JPMorgan, and March Capital, Malabar Investments, IIFL Finance, and Tiger Global Management

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by Vinay Sanghi (former McKinsey consultant), the leadership combines consulting discipline with platform execution; the company is backed by marquee investors such as Warburg Pincus and Temasek.



Vinay Sanghi
Founder, Chairman & MD

Droom

Company overview

Droom is an online automobile marketplace founded in 2014, providing solutions for buying and selling new and used vehicles, along with ancillary services such as inspections, pricing analytics and vehicle history reports.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a transaction-based marketplace, generating revenue via listing fees, commissions, inspection services (Droom History), pricing tools and dealer solutions, though scale and monetisation have been more limited versus peers.

Exhibit 197: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.85 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.4) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Toyota Tsusho Corporation, Digital Garage, Lightbox, Recruit, Beenext, 57 Stars, India Accelerator, Finvolve

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Sandeep Aggarwal (IIT Delhi alumnus, former Google executive), the leadership brought early digital marketplace experience, though the company has faced execution and scale challenges over time.



Sandeep Aggarwal
Founder & CEO

Spinny

Company overview

Spinny is a full-stack used-car retail platform founded in 2015, offering a quality-controlled, inventory-led buying and selling experience focused on trust, transparency and customer experience.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows an inventory-owned, consumer-focused retail model, monetising through used car sales margins, financing, warranties and add-on services, with higher capital intensity but superior customer control.

Exhibit 198: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	46.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(4.2) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	676
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,800
Notable investors	Accel, Elevation Capital, General Catalyst, Tiger Global Management, Blume Ventures, Fundamentum, Alteria Capital, Think Investments, WestBridge Capital, ADQ, Avenir Growth

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TheArcWeb

Founders and leadership

Founded by Niraj Singh and Ramanshu Mahaur, the leadership blends consulting, product and operational experience, with a clear emphasis on brand trust and experience-led differentiation.



Niraj Singh
Founder & CEO



Ramanshu Mahaur
Co-Founder & CTO

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Chapter 12: Deep dive into Mobility

Mobility sector – overview

Market sizing and growth outlook

The Indian ride-hailing market has matured from a fledgling digital service into a critical pillar of urban infrastructure.

- **Current market size (FY25):** The market is valued at ~USD 22bn, with digital aggregators (Uber, Ola, Rapido, Namma Yatri, etc.) contributing the lion's share of retail mobility (~USD 11bn); Corporate travel is ~USD11bn.
- **Growth rate:** The segment is projected to grow at a CAGR of 19% over next five years, as per our channel checks.
- **Penetration:** Despite players such as Uber and Ola having been around for years, user penetration is still at ~19% in 2025, according to Statista. This is expected to touch ~26% by 2030.
- **2026 forecast:** Total market revenue is expected to hit USD 24bn by the end of 2026, driven by the expansion of bike-taxis and the premiumisation of the four-wheeler segment.

Overall industry growth is healthy 10–13%, but there is divergence between segments:

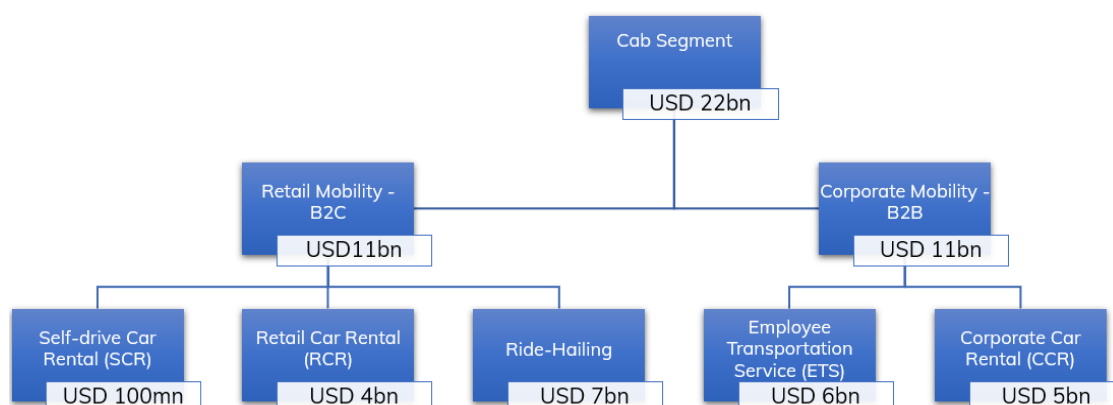
- **4Ws:** 7–9%. This segment is maturing, with growth now driven more by Premiumisation (example Uber Black) rather than new user acquisition.
- **2Ws/3Ws:** ~20% - this growth is powered by the Last Mile gap and the mass-market adoption of bike-taxis in Tier-2/3 cities.

Exhibit 199: Key features across different segments of the ride-hailing market

Metric	4-Wheeler (Cabs)	Auto (3-Wheeler)	Bike-Taxi (2-Wheeler)
Market Size (Value)	USD 2.5–USD 2.7 bn	USD 1.5–USD 2 bn	USD0.7–USD1 bn
Market Share (Vol)	~25% of total rides	~40% of total rides	~35% of total rides
Avg. Trip Value	USD 3.0 (INR 270–INR 280)	USD1.7 (INR 150–INR 160)	USD 0.85 (INR 70–INR 80)
Cost per Km	INR 25–INR 27	INR 16–INR 18	INR 10–INR 12
Primary User Base	Corporate, Families, Airport	Daily Commuters, Students	Solo commuters, Quick-commerce

Source: I-Sec research, Channel checks

Exhibit 200: Market size of the cab segment in India



Source: I-Sec research, Channel checks

Industry nuances

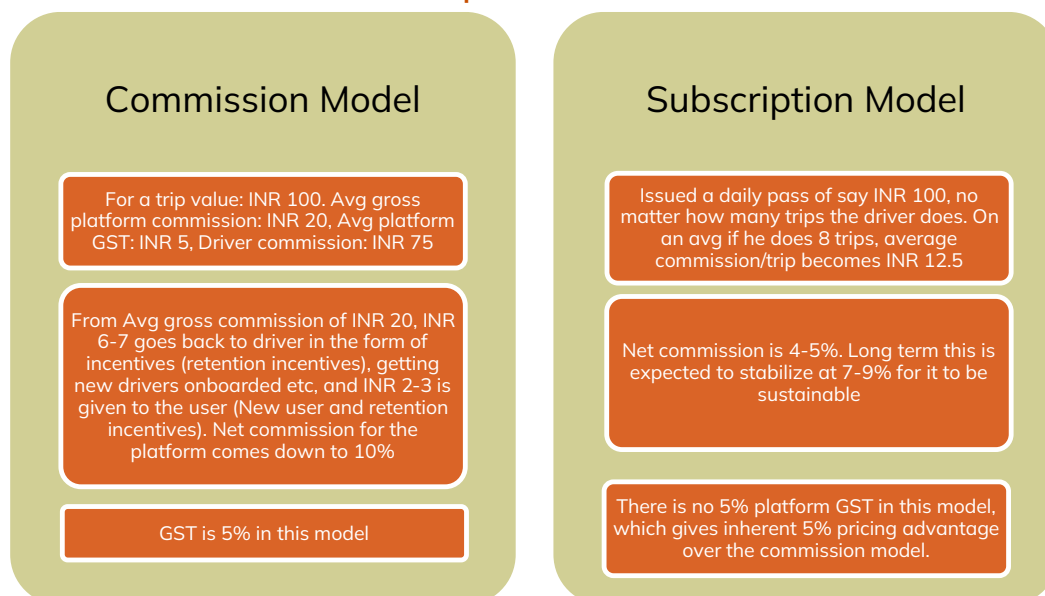
Exhibit 201: Comparison of revenue model across key players

Company	Model	Commission/Subscription	Additional Revenue
Uber	Hybrid (Commission + Subscription)	Commission (10% weight): Typically, 20-30% of each ride fare; drivers receive the remaining 70 to 80% Subscription (90% weight)-Subscription INR/day ~INR 100	Uber One subscriptions; rentals, bus services, advertising and partnerships
Ola	Zero commission, subscription-based	Subscription: Flat daily fee (INR 67 per day)	Logistics services like parcel, food delivery, rentals and outstation
Rapido	Hybrid (commission + subscription)	Subscription: Flat daily fee (starting at INR 10 per day)	Logistics services, food delivery piloting under Ownly
Namma Yatri	Zero commission, subscription-based; 'House of brands' approach (separate apps per city)	Driver Fees: INR 25/day for auto drivers; INR 90/day for cab drivers. Driver Earnings: 100% of fare, negotiated directly with passengers	Revenue Source: Subscription fees only
inDrive	Negotiation-based + low commission	Fare Model: Passengers propose fare; drivers accept or counter. Commission: 5-10%, lower than traditional platforms	Premium features, expansion into delivery and freight

Source: Forbes, I-Sec Research

- The three-way battle:** The market has shifted from an Uber-Ola duopoly to a fierce competition between Uber, Ola, and Rapido. Notably, Rapido has surged to the #2 position in market share, leveraging its dominance in the high-frequency bike and auto categories. Broadly, the market share is as below (in terms of value): Uber: 45-50%, Rapido: 25-30% (most of the GOV rise is from taking over from Ola), Ola: 15-20%, as per our channel checks. High market share has a self-reinforcing effect as high market share → low ETA → lesser cancellations/more successful bookings → market share gains
- Growth in the 2W segment:** The bike taxi segment in India is a rapidly growing vertical, primarily driven by the need for affordable, high frequency last-mile connectivity and navigating severe traffic congestion. Beyond its immediate utility, this segment serves as a crucial entry point, effectively building a user base that eventually could graduate to higher-tier car or auto-taxi services.
- Commission to subscription:** Traditionally, Ola and Uber have followed a commission-based revenue model where the platform keeps a share of the fare for every ride as commission or booking fee and passes on the rest to driver partners. Under the subscription model, the ride-hailing platforms charge a per-day or per-week fee to driver partners to get discovered by customers looking to book a ride. Namma Yatri introduced subscription-based model in 2022 and Rapido/Uber/Ola followed suit. While Uber continues to operate on a commission-based model globally, in India it has adopted a subscription-based approach for 2W and 3Ws.

Exhibit 202: Unit economics – commission vs. subscription model



Source: I-Sec research

A decade ago, the industry was defined by a high-subsidy era, where peak incentives were aggressively used to fuel both demand and supply. During this hyper-growth phase, incentives accounted for 50–60% of GOV. As the market has matured, this has significantly tapered:

- **Commission model:** Incentives have rationalized to a sustainable 8–9% of GOV.
- **Subscription model:** In the newer SaaS-led models, incentives have been almost entirely phased out, reaching near-zero levels as driver earnings are stabilized through lower platform fees rather than direct payouts

Key players and market positioning

The Uber perspective

India as the 'Innovation & Competition' Lab

India remains one of Uber's most important markets, not just for mobility, but also for technology and product innovation.

- **Market share fragmentation:** In many international markets, Uber operates in a comfortable duopoly or near-monopoly. In India, the "duopoly" of Uber and Ola has been broken by the rise of Rapido and Namma Yatri.
- **The subscription reset:** Uber adopted a subscription-based model in India to counter local competition. In most other global regions, including the US, UK, Europe and Australia, it mostly operates under its traditional commission-based model.
- **EV and premium pivot:** Despite relatively lower margins, India is a 'Star Market' for Uber and it serves as a massive scale-up laboratory for two global priorities:
 - Green mobility: In 2025, Indians travelled over 365mn kilometres in Uber EVs. This supports Uber's global 'Zero Emissions' goal by 2040.
 - Premiumisation (Uber Black): There is a growing 'Tier 1' consumer base within India. The company relaunched Uber Black in India in 2024 to cater to this demand. Uber Black logged over 34mn kilometres in 2025, showing traction in a high-margin premium segment within the low-margin Indian ecosystem.

Exhibit 203: Comparison of Uber's markets globally

Tier 1	Tier 2	Tier 2.5
USA, Canada	UK, Germany, Australia	India
High average order value (AOV) and mature regulatory frameworks	Decently sized and fairly profitable. In value terms, the city of London often generates more annual revenue for Uber than the entirety of India. This is due to the significantly higher fare per kilometre in the UK.	High Volume, Low Value: India logs massive trip counts (~1.25 billion trips annually) but has low AOV. Operated with 0-2% EBITDA margin in the pre-subscription era

Source: I-Sec research

Rapido

Rapido's ascent in the Indian mobility market was driven by focusing on the untapped moto segment, pivot to subscription model and aggressive cost optimisation.

- **Strategic regulatory advantage:** Rapido benefited from a first-mover advantage in the white-plate (private registration) bike taxi market between 2014 and 2015. Unlike Uber and Ola, which risked their entire multi-modal licenses if banned in one category.
- **Lean operational engineering:** The Moto segment struggles with profitability due to low AOV, high driver incentives to compete with delivery platforms, and inability to take fare hikes due to price-sensitive consumers. To combat the low margins of the bike taxi segment, Rapido aggressively reduced fixed costs:
 - **Mapping and tech:** They bypassed expensive Google Maps APIs in favour of OpenStreetMap, saving INR2–4 per trip.
 - **Payment rails:** By transitioning almost exclusively to UPI, they eliminated credit card gateway fees.
 - **Support rationalisation:** They significantly lowered overheads by optimising customer support services, maintaining a leaner cost structure than traditional ride-hailing giants.
- **Switch to subscription model:** The company moved from a per-ride commission to a SaaS-based subscription model for drivers, which improved driver retention despite competition from high-earning sectors like quick commerce.

Exhibit 204: Ride-hailing market in India – SWOT analysis

	Comments
Strengths	- Adoption of ride hailing category across India, more than 50mn users have tried ride hailing across modes and they are fairly sticky. - Regulatory policy recently like gig worker category classification. The fact that 1% of revenue has to be set off which is very low for ride hailing but very high for QC. - GST rates for auto have also been dropped for commercial vehicles, improving the earning profiles for the drivers. - Improving CNG pumps density across some cities such as Delhi. Driving for 70hrs/week, earnings of a driver on CNG = INR 27-30K are higher vs Diesel cars (INR 15-20K).
Weaknesses	- High Driver Turnover: Heavy reliance on driver-partners, with high churn rates leading to operational instability. - Low CNG penetration in major markets such as Bangalore - so most of the cars are diesel, where profitability is relatively lower. - Regulatory and Legal Issues: Continuous challenges from local governments and transport authorities. - Inconsistent Profitability: Despite high revenues, the cost of driver incentives and customer discounts has pressured profitability.
Opportunities	- Uber driver partners are used in India for data labelling work for AI which improves their earning profile. This could help drivers make money in downtime, typically if a driver is online on Uber for 1 hour they are driving for about 40 mins, 20 mins they are idle. So, they can make money through data labelling. - Lot of focus on ads to improve revenue on profits for these platforms. Since net effective commissions are much lower now platforms like Uber, Ola, Rapido have to look at non-platform work to improve their effective revenue. - In ride hailing, in a steady state around 1-2% of GOV could come through. - Financial services distribution specially for driver partner for loans could contribute another 1-2% of GOV.
Threats	- Car supply cliff: most of the cars were added in 2015-17 when the incentives were very high and lifespan of a commercial car is roughly 4-7 years. That's been causing a drop in supply in the 4W category. - In the subscription model, the effective commissions being lower are contributing to service degradation which could lead to increase in safety incidence (assault). - Increasingly govt in India or other countries are trying to cap surge prices/commissions which makes a lot harder for the category to work. For example, in Indonesia they have introduced a ruling to cap the commission at 10%. In India, Karnataka banned surge pricing and mandated prices only as per the taxi meter. - Specially because of QC, delivery partner can now make net INR 20-25K (without any capital investment); In moto and Uber INR 17-20K. (Similar to auto and cars in Uber)

Source: I-Sec Research

Potential policy pathways

- Scale-up of white plate (private) vehicles for shared mobility**

Scaling the utilisation of private vehicles would augment supply cliff in the mobility space over the next 3-4 years. A Standardized Digital Permit system that allows private vehicle owners to opt into shared mobility without the friction of commercial registration would aid affordable mobility growth through better utilisation of vehicles.

- Transition to unified national mobility regulations**

Replacing the current patchwork of state-level restrictions with a Unified National Mobility Framework would eliminate operational inconsistencies across regional borders. Implementation of a "One Nation, One Permit" architecture for aggregators—including bike taxis and ride-hailing services—is essential to provide a predictable investment environment and ensure uniform service standards nationwide.

- GST rationalisation: Levelling the SaaS vs. commission playing field**

The industry is seeing a structural shift from commission-based models (Uber/Ola) to SaaS-based subscription models (Rapido/Namma Yatri). However, there is inconsistency in terms of GST rates - Commission Model: applies 5% GST on the total ride fare (collected by the platform), SaaS Model: Only the subscription fee paid by the driver is taxed (usually at 18%), while the passenger ride fare often escapes GST as the platform claims it is not the service provider. Rationalisation of GST across different business models to establish tax parity could prevent competitive advantages driven by tax arbitrage.

Companies in Mobility

Ola Electric

Company overview

Ola is a mobility and transportation platforms, operating across ride-hailing, electric mobility, financial services and logistics. Founded in 2010 and headquartered in Bengaluru, Ola has evolved from a cab-aggregator into a broader mobility ecosystem with domestic and international ambitions.

Business model and value proposition

Ola follows a platform-led marketplace model in ride-hailing, earning commissions from driver-partners, surge pricing and ancillary services. Over time, it expanded into EV manufacturing (Ola Electric), fintech and logistics, aiming to build an integrated mobility stack spanning transport, energy and payments.

Exhibit 205: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	45.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(22.8) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,800
Notable investors	Arrow Capital, Axis Mutual Fund, Segantii Capital Management, Hero Corp, IIFL Finance

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Ola was founded by **Bhavish Aggarwal** an IIT Bombay alumnus. He has been the public face and strategic driver of Ola's aggressive expansion into electric vehicles and next-gen mobility.



Bhavish Aggarwal
Founder, Chairman
& MD

Ola Consumer

Company overview

Ola Consumer represents Ola's core ride-hailing and consumer services business, including cab aggregation, auto-rickshaws, bikes, and adjacent offerings such as Ola Foods (largely scaled down) and financial services integrations.

Business model and value proposition

Ola Consumer operates a two-sided marketplace, connecting riders with driver-partners across categories (cabs, autos, bikes). Revenue is generated via commissions, service fees, dynamic pricing and subscriptions, with a strong focus on improving driver utilisation and ride economics.

Exhibit 206: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	23.68 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	Not available
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	SoftBank, Tiger Global, Tencent, Temasek, Matrix Partners (Z47), and Alpha Wave Global

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Bhavish Aggarwal serves as the Co-Founder and CEO of Ola Consumer (formerly Ola Cabs), driving its transition into a broader consumer technology platform. Under his leadership, the company focuses on mobility, digital services, and AI initiatives.



Bhavish Aggarwal
Co-Founder, CEO

Rapido

Company overview

Rapido is popularly a bike-taxi and cab mobility platform, offering affordable and quick point-to-point transportation across 100+ cities. Founded in 2015, Rapido has emerged as a strong challenger to traditional cab aggregators.

Business model and value proposition

Rapido operates a light-asset, high-frequency mobility marketplace, connecting riders with bike captains and auto drivers. It monetises through commissions per ride, with a structurally lower cost base than cab aggregators due to two-wheeler economics and faster trip turnaround.

Exhibit 207: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	9.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.6) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	574
Last known valuation (USD mn)	2,300
Notable investors	WestBridge Capital, Nexus Venture Partners, Prosus Ventures, TVS Motor Company

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TechCrunch

Founders and leadership

Founded by Aravind Sanka, Pavan Guntupalli, Rishikesh SR, all IIT alumni, Rapido's founding team brings strong engineering and operations expertise. Pavan Guntupalli has been instrumental in positioning Rapido as a mass-market, affordability-first mobility solution.



Aravind Sanka
Co-Founder, CEO



Pavan Guntupalli
Co-Founder



Rishikesh SR
Co-Founder

Euler

Company overview

Euler Motors is an Indian electric vehicle manufacturer founded in 2018, specialising in high-performance commercial three-wheeler and four-wheeler cargo EVs. Headquartered in Delhi, the company focuses on accelerating India's transition to electric commercial mobility with durable vehicles designed for Indian road conditions.

Business model and value proposition

Euler Motors is a specialised commercial EV OEM focused on designing, manufacturing, and servicing high-load electric three-wheelers (HiLoad) for last-mile logistics in India. Their business model revolves around a full-stack approach—combining vehicle sales with charging infrastructure (Charge Points) and Annual Maintenance Contracts (AMC), promoting high performance and lowering total cost of ownership (TCO) compared to diesel.

Exhibit 208: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.9 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.0) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	229
Last known valuation (USD mn)	176 (as of Jan'22)
Notable investors	Lightrock, Hero MotoCorp, Blume Ventures, British International Investment, and GIC

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entrackr, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Euler Motors was founded by Saurav Kumar, a serial entrepreneur and alumnus of Delhi College of Engineering and Cornell University, with a mission to advance India's commercial EV segment. As CEO, Kumar leads the company's focus on full-stack EV technology, including advanced battery engineering and last-mile logistics solutions.



Saurav Kumar
Founder and CEO

Recent Developments

Key developments include launching the Storm EV—India's first ADAS-equipped electric LCV—and expanding its presence into the 4-wheel, 1-tonne cargo segment. Secured partnerships with firms like Jio-bp for charging infrastructure and logistics platforms like Pickup.io. Euler is expanding from ~40 cities to over 100 cities with a strong focus on tier-2 markets.

BlaBlaCar

Company overview

BlaBlaCar is a global mobility platform that enables long-distance carpooling by connecting drivers with empty seats to passengers traveling similar routes.

Business model and value proposition

It operates an asset-light marketplace model, charging commissions on bookings. The platform benefits from strong network effects, and has expanded into adjacent offerings like bus aggregation to increase supply density and monetisation.

Exhibit 209: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (USD bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (USD bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Accel Partners, Insight Venture Partners, Index Ventures, Lead Edge Capital, VNV Global, Otiva J/F AB, and FMZ Ventures.

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

BlaBlaCar was founded by Frédéric Mazzella, Nicolas Brusson, and Francis Nappéz. Frédéric Mazzella, the CEO, is an engineer and entrepreneur who built the company from concept to a global mobility platform. Nicolas Brusson, with a background in consulting and private equity, drives business expansion, monetisation, and financial discipline. Francis Nappéz leads technology as CTO, focusing on platform scalability and product development.



Frédéric Mazzella
Co-Founder



Nicolas Brusson
Co-Founder



Francis Nappéz
Co-Founder

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Chapter 13: Deep dive into Media

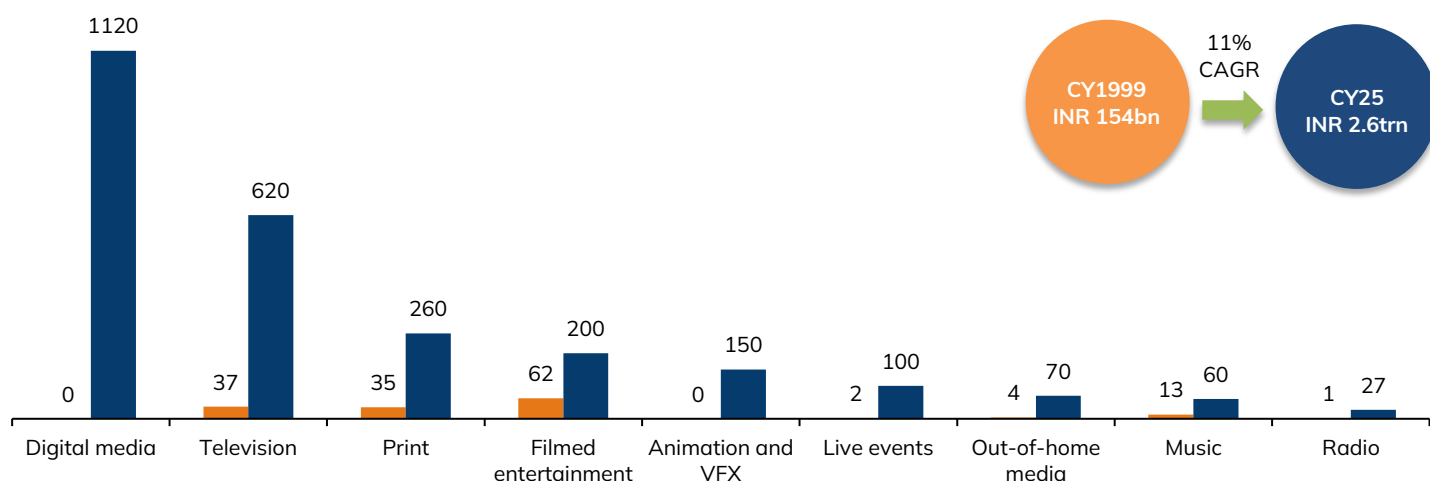
Media sector – overview

The Indian Media and Entertainment (M&E) sector grew ~5%/13% to INR2.3trn (USD 26 bn)/ INR2.6trn (USD 28bn) in CY24/CY25.

Exhibit 210: M&E sector grew at 11% CAGR over CY1999-CY2025, increasing from INR 154bn in CY19 to INR 2.6trn in CY2025

M&E sector revenues in CY1999 and CY2025 (in INR bn)

■ CY1999 ■ CY2025



Source: I-Sec research, Channel checks

Exhibit 211: M&E sector in India by segments

Media Segment (values in INR bn)	CY22	CY23	CY24	CY25	CY27E
Digital media	580	690	800	1120	1,110
Television	730	700	690	620	680
Print	250	260	260	260	270
Filmed entertainment	170	200	190	200	215
Animation and VFX	110	115	105	150	150
Live events	75	90	100	100	180
Out-of-home media	50	55	60	70	80
Music	50	55	55	60	80
Radio	20	20	25	27	30
Total	2,035	2,185	2,285	2,607	2,795
Growth	23%	7%	5%	13%	

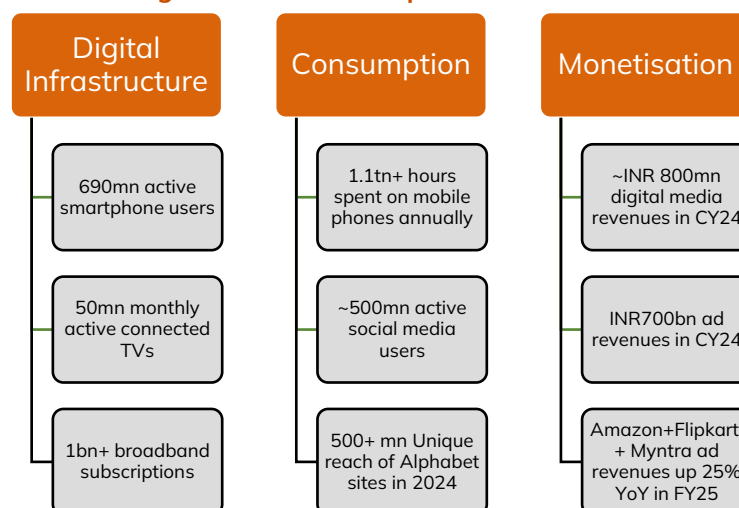
Source: I-Sec research, Channel checks

Digital media segment surpassed Television in CY24, achieving a market size of ~INR800bn. Traditional media (television, print, radio and music): share of the total M&E sector stands at ~37% in CY25. Outside the home media (comprising filmed entertainment, live events and out-of-home media): contributes ~15% of the total M&E sector.

Digital media

The Digital Media sector is expected to see steady growth of ~14% CAGR from CY25-28, driven by a young population, cheap data, and high smartphone usage. Digital media has overtaken television as the largest segment in CY24, with online gaming, OTT, and animation also growing rapidly, led by shifting consumer behaviours.

Exhibit 212: Digital media landscape in India



Source: I-Sec research

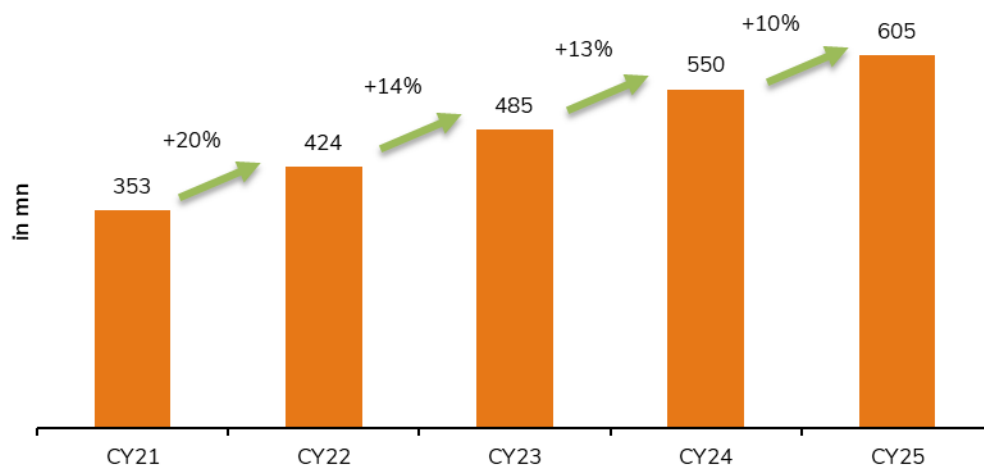
Despite seeing rapid growth, subscription revenue makes up just ~15% of the digital market, which continues to be heavily reliant on advertising. Key drivers of this ad-focused market include tech giants such as Google and Meta, as well as increasing ad spending from e-commerce platforms. Digital advertising contributes ~55% of total advertising revenues.

Advertising revenues: New media now accounts for ~55% of total advertising (vs 31% share in CY19), and has overtaken traditional media advertising (~45%). Television advertising saw degrowth with current contribution at 23% (vs 36% in CY19), led by a decline in ad volumes and shift in viewership to connected TVs, whose revenues are counted under digital media. This can also be seen in the spending pattern of FMCG companies - FMCG companies now allocate 55-60% of their ad budgets to digital, up from ~30% in FY20. This includes content creator collaborations, targeted ads and other digital formats. E-commerce players are doubling down on paid search and social media to capture high-intent buyers and maintain product discovery. We expect the share of new media to increase further, in line with global trends.

OTT

OTT audience (number of people who have watched OTT at least once in the last month) stands at ~605mn in 2025, +10% YoY. Of these, unique users would be 450-500mn. India's OTT penetration now stands at 41% of the country's population, up from 37% last year. Active paid OTT subscriptions, including those via telecom bundles and aggregators, stand at 148mn.

Exhibit 213: India's OTT audience universe



Source: I-Sec Research

Strong growth in India's OTT audience – rising from ~350mn CY21 to ~605mn in CY25 – has been led by increased smartphone accessibility, affordable data, and strategic domestic-international collaborations. In addition, high-profile live sports, such as IPL 2025 and the ICC T20 World Cup continue to drive user acquisition and sustained engagement. Simultaneously, specialised regional SVOD platforms like aha, Hoichoi, and Sun NXT are enhancing their hyper-local libraries, thereby increasing engagement.

Key sector nuances

- Revenue model:** In India, the OTT market thrives on affordable, mobile-only plans that frequently include ads. While 'pay-lite' and free options drive growth the most, high-end, ad-free subscription tiers are yet to gain widespread popularity. Disney+ Hotstar has successfully used ad-supported models, particularly for high-traffic live sports, while Amazon Prime Video expanded its own AVOD offering to the Indian market in Jun'25, following its international rollout.
- Connected TVs (CTVs):** CTVs have crossed the 65mn household mark in CY25 (vs. ~15mn in CY21), and expected to continue seeing strong growth ahead. CTV allows platforms to charge higher CPMs (Cost Per Thousand impressions) because it offers high-quality, full-screen, unskippable video ads that achieve near-perfect completion rates. CTV ad revenues are estimated at INR 15bn in FY25, supported by strong adoption in Tier-2/3 regions (Source: Ormax Media report).
- Regional languages:** Regional stories drove production trends in 2024, representing 48% of total content volume. Platforms maximised their reach by adopting a core eight-language distribution model, ensuring that original titles were localised for every major regional market simultaneously.

Exhibit 214: Media sector – SWOT analysis

	Comments
Strengths	- Strong growth potential driven by a young population, cheap data, and high smartphone usage - High-growth areas like OTT streaming, online gaming, and animation/VFX are expanding at a CAGR exceeding 15%
Weaknesses	- Tech ecosystem abilities (for most companies except Netflix) are sub-optimal - Intense competition keeps content development costs elevated. Viewership fragmentation necessitates platform-agnostic content strategies - The Indian advertising sector maintains a high correlation with broader macroeconomic fluctuations. Consequently, establishing a robust operational framework is imperative to mitigate systemic risks and ensure long-term stability - Notwithstanding the maturation of digital security protocols, the evasive nature of online piracy continues to pose a formidable challenge to global intellectual property enforcement
Opportunities	- Newer formats like micro dramas (mobile-first short form story telling) and more, are unlocking fresh audience engagement models and monetisation opportunities - Localised storytelling in regional languages, hyperlocal news and dubbed versions of global franchises will likely further drive audience engagement
Threats	Rapid technological advancements may lead to the obsolescence of current content production infrastructure, viewing platforms and may even lead to changes in consumer behaviour

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- Regulatory unity:** Replacing of fragmented rules with an integrated National M&E policy that covers TV, OTT, and digital under a 'same content, same rules' logic.
- IP protection:** Modernizing copyright frameworks and implementing robust digital enforcement protocols are essential to combat the scale of digital piracy. Strengthening intellectual property protections could safeguard creative capital and unlock higher monetisation potential across the digital ecosystem.
- AVGC support:** Establishing National Centres of Excellence and specialized regulatory bodies could accelerate growth in the Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, and Comics (AVGC) sector. These institutions would provide the necessary infrastructure, talent pipelines, and standardized guidelines to formalize the sector and enhance global competitiveness.

Companies in Media

InShorts

Company overview

Inshorts is a Noida-based news aggregator and digital media platform that delivers bite-sized, 60-word news summaries via its mobile app and also operates the social user-generated content platform Public App.

Business model and value proposition

The platform monetises primarily through advertising and sponsored content, leveraging high user engagement with short-form news and video consumption.

Exhibit 215: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.8 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.3) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	165
Last known valuation (USD mn)	550 (2021)
Notable investors	A91 Partners, Addition, Tiger Global Management, Vy Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TechCrunch

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2013 by Azhar Iqubal, Deepit Purkayastha and Anunay Pandey, three classmates from IIT, the team combined product, engineering and editorial expertise early on.



Azhar Iqubal
Co-Founder, Chairman



Deepit Purkayastha
Co-Founder, CEO



Anunay Pandey
Co-Founder

JioHotstar

Company overview

JioHotstar (formerly Hotstar) is India's largest video streaming and OTT entertainment service, offering premium TV shows, movies, sports and originals in multiple Indian languages.

Business model and value proposition

Operates on a freemium and subscription + advertising model, with revenue from paid subscriptions (VIP/Premium), ad inventory and strategic partnerships, especially around live sports.

Exhibit 216: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, AngelOne

Founders and leadership

Launched in 2015 by Star India (now part of Disney) and later integrated into Jio Platforms/Disney Star, leadership draws on global digital streaming expertise from Disney and Reliance, scaling video strategy in India's competitive OTT market.

KukuFM

Company overview

KukuFM is a leading Indian audio content platform that produces and distributes audiobooks, stories, courses and entertainment in multiple languages via mobile apps.

Business model and value proposition

The company monetises through freemium subscriptions, in-app purchases and premium content offerings, focusing on local language audio formats in genres like fiction, self-help and spirituality.

Exhibit 217: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.4 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.5) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	156
Last known valuation (USD mn)	500
Notable investors	Granite Asia (lead investor in the latest round), Vertex Growth Fund, Krafton, IFC (World Bank Group), Paramark Ventures, Tribe Capital India, Bitkraft Ventures, and early backer Google

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Angel One

Founders and leadership

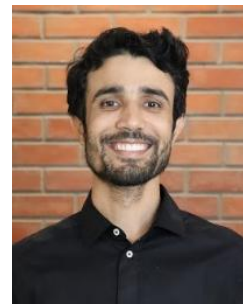
Founded in 2018 by Lal Chand Bisu (Co-founder and CEO), alongside Vikas Goyal (CTO) and Vinod Kumar Meena, the leadership team brings combined expertise in tech, content and product execution.



Lal Chand Bisu
Co-Founder, CEO



Vikas Goyal
Co-Founder, CTO



Vinod Kumar Meena
Co-Founder, COO

PocketFM

Company overview

PocketFM is an Indian audio entertainment platform that specialises in serialized audio shows, stories and podcasts in multiple languages, gaining traction for long-form and episodic content.

Business model and value proposition

Operates a freemium model with episode-level purchases and subscription tiers, expanding internationally and forging strong creator partnerships to scale library and engagement.

Exhibit 218: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	17.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	196
Last known valuation (USD mn)	750
Notable investors	Lightspeed India, Tencent, Naver, Goodwater Capital, StepStone Group, The Times Group (Brand Capital), Tanglin Venture Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2018 by Rohan Nayak, Nishanth K S, Prateek Dixit, all with strong tech/product backgrounds including IIT-Kharagpur ties, they pivoted through multiple product iterations to establish product-market fit.



Rohan Nayak
Co-Founder, CEO



Prateek Dixit
Co-Founder



Nishanth S
Co-Founder

ShareChat

Company overview

Vernacular social media company, providing platforms for users to connect, share content, and express themselves in their native Indian languages, with its main offerings being the ShareChat app (a multilingual social network) and the popular short video app Moj.

Business model and value proposition

Monetises through advertising, creator monetisation products and premium content features, focusing on a regional language user base often underserved by global social platforms.

Exhibit 219: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	7.1 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(18.9) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	1,200
Last known valuation (USD mn)	2,000
Notable investors	Temasek, Lightspeed India, Tiger Global, Alkeon Capital, and Moore Strategic Ventures, Tencent, Google, India Quotient, Touchstone Partners, Brand Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entrackr

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2015 by Ankush Sachdeva, Bhanu Pratap Singh and Farid Ahsan, all graduates from IIT Kanpur, the team built ShareChat with deep roots in tech, product and regional internet behaviour.



Ankush Sachdeva
Co-Founder, CEO



Bhanu Pratap Singh
Co-Founder



Farid Ahsan
Co-Founder

Stage

Company overview

STAGE is an Indian regional OTT platform founded in 2019, focused on creating and distributing hyperlocal content (movies, series) in languages like Haryanvi, Rajasthani, and Bhojpuri, aiming to build cultural pride through authentic storytelling, positioning itself as a "Netflix for Bharat" with significant user growth.

Business model and value proposition

Stage operates a subscription-led OTT model, complemented by selective advertising and partnerships, depending on content format and audience scale. Its core value proposition lies in deep cultural relevance.

Exhibit 220: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.28) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	23.7
Last known valuation (USD mn)	80
Notable investors	Goodwater Capital, Blume Ventures, Physis Capital, Mumbai Angels, The Chennai Angels, Venture Catalysts, IPV (Inflection Point Ventures), and NB Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Vinay Kumar Singhal (Co-Founder and CEO): A native of a small village in Haryana, Vinay previously built **WittyFeed** (along with Shashank and Parveen).

Parveen Singhal (Co-Founder and CCO): Co-founder and Chief Content Officer, managing the creation of original regional content.

Shashank Vaishnav (Co-Founder and CTO): Co-founder of WittyFeed and Vatsana Technologies, focusing on technical infrastructure and product development.



Vinay Kumar Singhal
Co-Founder, CEO



Parveen Singhal
Co-Founder, CCO



Shashank Vaishnav
Co-Founder, CTO

Amagi Media Labs

Company overview

Amagi Media Labs is a global cloud-native SaaS media technology provider that enables broadcasters, OTT platforms and content owners to distribute, monetise and manage video content at scale.

Business model and value proposition

Amagi earns through software subscriptions, managed playout services, FAST channel creation and analytics, powering end-to-end broadcast and streaming operations globally from its cloud platform.

Exhibit 221: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	11.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.7) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	880
Notable investors	Accel, Norwest Venture Partners, Premji Invest (via PI Opportunities Fund), and Avataar Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2008 by Baskar Subramanian, Srividhya Srinivasan and Srinivasan KA, the team previously exited a tech venture and brought deep media tech and cloud innovation expertise to build Amagi into a unicorn-scale SaaS entity.



Baskar Subramanian
Co-Founder, MD &
CEO



Srividhya Srinivasan
Co-Founder, CTO



Srinivasan KA
Co-Founder, Director and
President - Global
Business

Chapter 14: Deep dive into Prop-tech

Prop-tech sector – overview

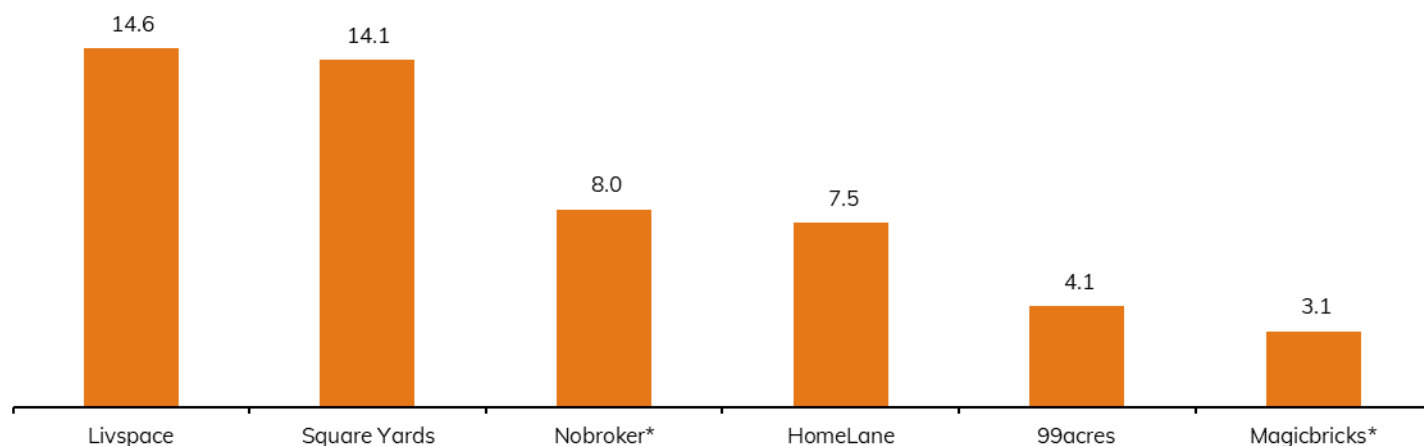
The Prop-tech market is divided into four distinct stages of the customer journey. This value-chain segmentation is important because each stage has very different economics, competitive dynamics, take rates, and profitability profiles. The total online proptech revenue is estimated at ~USD 1.5bn in CY25, and is expected to grow to ~USD 3bn by CY30, growing at a CAGR of ~15%, as per our channel checks.

Exhibit 222: Prop-tech market in India – key segments

Stage	Details	TAM	Online market size	Key Companies
Top of Funnel (Discovery)	Digital classifieds, listings, lead generation	INR 50bn–60bn	INR 12bn–15bn	99acres, MagicBricks, Housing.com, NoBroker (listings segment)
Bottom of Funnel (Transaction)	Brokerage services, property closures, commission-based transactions.	INR 200bn	INR 20bn–25bn	Square Yards, NoBroker, Anarock, Property Pistol
Ancillary – FinTech / Financing	Mortgage origination, home loan DSA brokerage.	INR 45bn–50bn	~INR12bn–15bn	Urban Money (Square Yards), PaisaBazaar, BankBazaar, NoBroker Loans
Ancillary – post-transaction	Interiors, furniture, legal, packers and movers, repairs, painting.	INR 4trn (total sector)	~INR 25bn–30bn	LivSpace, Urban Company, NoBroker Home Services
Others	Long rental stays, hostels, etc.	-	INR40bn–45bn	Stanza Living, Nestaway

Source: I-Sec research, channel checks

Exhibit 223: Leading Prop-tech companies in India in terms of revenue (FY25 values, INR bn)



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

*Nobroker revenue is for FY24, Magicbricks revenues is for FY23

Overall market size – key numbers

The breakdown of the addressable market as below:

Total real estate transaction market

- Residential sales (top 7–10 cities, 2025 estimate): ~INR 6–6.5trn
- Adding rental transactions brings the total estimated market across India to ~INR 10trn
- The actual monetisable pool for Prop-tech players is a small fraction of this.

Top of funnel: Digital advertising and classifieds market

- Total market size (all digital real estate advertising including portals, Google, Meta): ~INR 50–60bn annually

- Specialized Prop-tech portals (99acres, MagicBricks, Housing.com, etc.) collectively capture: ~INR 10–12bn
- The remaining INR 40–50bn goes to Google, Facebook/Meta and other generalist digital advertising platforms

Prop-tech portals compete directly with Google and Meta for developer and broker advertising budgets. Google/Meta offer superior reach and brand awareness. Portals can offer high-intent customers in theory, but listing duplication (multiple brokers listing the same property) dilutes quality. As a result, the incremental value of a portal listing is constrained.

Exhibit 224: Prop-tech classifieds segment – key players

Company / Entity	Estimated Revenue	Comments
	~INR 3bn–4bn (est.)	Listed company; largest dedicated portal
	~INR 3bn–4bn (est.)	REA Group-backed
	~INR 3bn (est.)	Times Internet-owned
Other portals	~INR1bn	Various smaller players
Total – Portals	~INR 10bn–12bn	Combined capture
 +  + Others	~INR 38bn–48bn	Majority of digital ad spend
Total Digital Ad Market	~INR 50bn–60bn	Full addressable pool

Source: I-Sec research

Advertising model: How these platforms charge

- CPC (Cost Per Click): Similar to Google/Meta but negotiated as a package upfront. Advertisers commit a budget (e.g., INR 500k/month) and the portal estimates the number of clicks they'll get. Unlike Google/Meta where billing is post-campaign, here the deal is agreed in advance.
- CPL (Cost Per Lead): The more common model in Prop-tech. The developer/marketer specifies a budget and a target number of leads (e.g., INR 200k budget = 500 leads). The portal then designs a listing + advertising package to hit that lead count.

Bottom of funnel: Brokerage/transaction market

This segment covers platforms and brokers who facilitate the actual purchase or rental transaction and earn a commission. The total commission pool is large (~INR 200bn) but it is deeply fragmented across thousands of brokers nationally.

- Implied total brokerage pool: ~INR 200bn (2% of INR 10trn total sales)
- Digital/online brokers are capturing ~INR16bn of this pool
- This means online players have captured only ~8% of the total brokerage market — still a very small share

- Brokerage commission rates: 2% (standard), rising to 2.5–3% for high-volume channel partners via developer-offered slabs. Effective take rate after discounting: 1.5–1.75% due to price competition between brokers

Exhibit 225: Brokerage/Transaction segment – key players and revenues

Company / Entity	Estimated Revenue	Comments
Square Yards	~INR 2bn–3bn (real estate only)	~40–50% of their total is real estate; rest is FinServ
NoBroker	~INR 6bn (real estate)	Reported INR 8bn total; RE portion ~75%
Anarock	~INR 3.5bn (real estate)	60–70% of reported INR 5.5bn total is pure RE
Property Pistol	~INR 2bn–2.5bn (est.)	Does not publicly disclose numbers
PropTiger / Roof&Floor	~INR 1.5bn combined	Smaller players
Total — Online Brokers	~INR 16bn–17bn	~8% of the INR 200bn total pool

Source: I-Sec research

Ancillary Fin-tech: Home loan DSA market

Prop-tech platforms act as Direct Selling Agents (DSAs) — they originate home loan applications and earn a commission from the bank or NBFC that actually disburses the loan. The customer gets their home loan; the bank gets a qualified borrower; the platform earns 0.5–1% of the disbursed amount.

Market sizing

- Total residential sales: ~INR 10trn
- ~60% financed via home loans = ~INR 6trn in disbursals
- DSA commission at 0.5–1% = INR 45trn–50trn total pool
- Digital platforms capturing: ~INR12–13bn

Risk profile

Loans originated through these digital DSA platforms tend to be riskier in nature.

Exhibit 226: Home loan DSA market – key players

Company / Entity	Estimated Revenue	Comments
Urban Money (Square Yards subsidiary)	~INR 6bn–7bn	~50% of Square Yards total revenue
NoBroker Loans / Insurance / Rent Pay	~INR 1.5–2bn	Bundled financial services
PaisaBazaar / BankBazaar	~INR 2.5bn–3bn each	Generalist loan marketplaces with RE exposure
MagicLoans (MagicBricks)	~INR 0.4–0.5bn	Small; not a core focus
Others (assorted)	INR1bn	Various smaller DSAs

Source: I-Sec research

Ancillary post-transaction — interiors, furniture and home services

Market size and players

Total market estimate: ~INR 4trn (includes interiors, design, furniture, packers and movers, legal, painting, repair, etc.)

Exhibit 227: Home décor/interiors segment – key players

Company / Entity	Estimated Revenue	Notes
LivSpace	~INR 14bn (reported USD170M)	Largest player; full-service interiors
Urban Company	~INR 4bn (home services portion)	Total revenue ~INR 20bn; ~20% from relevant home services
NoBroker Home Services	~INR 1.2bn–1.5bn	Painting, cleaning, repair, moving
Square Yards Interiors	Very small	Not a meaningful contributor
Others	Each <INR 1bn	Various small players

Source: I-Sec research

Several major Prop-tech platforms are trying to enter this segment as (i) Platforms already acquire customers who are in the home-buying journey and who have a demonstrable upcoming need for interior and home services and (ii) having already invested in CAC (customer acquisition cost) to win this person as a home buyer/renter, the logical extension is to monetize them further in adjacent services.

Profitability

Exhibit 228: Profitability across key Prop-tech segments

Segment	Profitability Profile
Listings / Classifieds (top of funnel)	Take rate <0.5%. No physical delivery. Recurring revenue potential. Revenue per customer INR 3k-15k per listing
Transaction Brokerage (bottom of funnel)	Largely unprofitable or marginally profitable. Revenue is one-time per transaction. Heavy CAC (call centre, field staff, portal spend). Commission is competed away by multi-broker customer situations. Most players are running losses in their core RE transaction business.
FinTech / DSA	Moderate. Margins depend on volume. Square Yards' Urban Money appears to be their most profitable segment. Commission is 0.5-1% with relatively low marginal cost per additional loan originated.
Post-Transaction / Interiors	Weak unit economics. Very high CAC, low LTV, low NPS, heavy offline competition, discount-driven environment.

Source: I-Sec research

Why 99acres and Housing.com haven't turned profitable despite the housing boom

Two key factors: (1) They are specialized advertising platforms — unlike Meta/Google, they can only show one category of ads, severely limiting value-per-eyeball. (2) Their revenue is highly correlated to real estate cycles - any downturn immediately hits their revenue. The combination of specialisation and cyclicity makes steady-state profitability difficult to achieve without meaningful diversification.

Other insights

- **The diversification imperative:** A common theme across all segments is the diversification imperative — the fact that every Prop-tech business that has grown to any meaningful scale has been forced to add revenue streams outside its core business:
 - Square Yards: Started as RE brokerage → added FinServ (Urban Money) which is now ~50% of revenue → added interiors
 - NoBroker: Started as a no-broker rental classifieds platform → added transaction brokerage → added loans, insurance, rent payment → added home services
 - Anarock: Core is developer mandate sales → added market intelligence / advisory services

The pattern is consistent: core RE services hit a ceiling, triggering diversification. But diversification into ancillary services faces its own structural challenges.

- **Consolidation possibility in top-of-funnel:** Consolidation alone would not fix the structural problem: even a merged entity would still be a specialized advertiser competing against Google and Meta. We believe the only real path to profitability involves genuine revenue diversification beyond the listings core.
- **Regional dynamics:** Channel partner penetration and preference vary significantly by geography:

Exhibit 229: Channel partner dynamics across major markets in India

Market	Channel Partner Dynamics
Delhi NCR / North India	90%+ of transactions via channel partners. Local offline brokers dominate. Digital players like Square Yards and NoBroker have limited footprint. Extremely fragmented — few local players do volumes that national digital platforms achieve pan-India.
Bangalore	Channel partner share was 30–40% in 2020. Has jumped to ~70% by 2024–25 as larger developers aggressively expanded distribution. Digital platforms have more presence here.
Mumbai	Now ~75–80% channel partner dominated. High developer activity and large transaction volumes make it a significant market.
Pune	~75–80% channel partner dominated. Similar trajectory to Mumbai.

Source: I-Sec research

Exhibit 230: Prop-tech sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strengths	- Low marginal cost of digital distribution: Once a platform is built, the incremental cost of reaching the next customer online is very low. This is a classic digital business advantage. - Scalable tech infrastructure: Digital setup is relatively easy to establish and run at scale. - Founder domain expertise in some cases: Square Yards' founder Tanuj Shori had prior real estate experience. NoBroker's Saurabh Garg had a real estate adjacent background with his earlier business.
Weaknesses	- Low barrier to entry: Any well-funded new entrant can replicate the core listing/transaction platform. There is no significant technical or regulatory moat protecting incumbents. - Broken unit economics in transaction and ancillary segments: The cost of acquiring customers consistently outweighs the revenue generated from them, especially in brokerage and interiors. This is a structural, not a temporary, problem. - Heavy dependence on the underlying real estate cycle: Revenue moves up and down directly with residential sales volumes, making consistent profitability difficult when the market cools.
Opportunities	- AI-enabled customer discovery: AI has transformed consumer experiences in many other sectors, but Prop-tech has barely adopted it beyond basic virtual call centres. Major opportunity to build AI-powered home search experiences, personalised recommendations, automated lead qualification, and virtual property walkthroughs — all of which could improve conversion rates and customer delight. - Tier 2/3 city expansion: Significant untapped digital populations exist in smaller cities. However, success here requires two things the current platforms lack: (1) better, more modern UI/UX (current platforms are outdated), and (2) sufficient listing depth to be useful — which is harder in smaller cities where the total property inventory in any given neighbourhood may be very small.
Threats	- Dominance of Google and Meta: These platforms continue to capture the majority of digital real estate advertising spend and are getting better at targeting high-intent users. Specialized portals are fighting an uphill battle for advertising share. - Structural cap on digital brokerage growth: Developers are structurally incentivized to fragment their broker base, preventing any digital player from achieving dominant market share in transactions. - Cyclicality risk: Any significant real estate downcycle could significantly hit the revenues of listing and transaction platforms, given their lack of revenue diversification.

Sources: I-Sec Research

Potential policy pathways

- Information asymmetry — pre-RERA launch advertising**
 To ensure a level-playing field, regulators could implement rigorous ground-level audits and enhanced enforcement mechanisms to curb informal information flows between developers and preferred channel partners prior to RERA approval. Addressing the unauthorized dissemination of project specifications could reduce information asymmetry and prevent the distortion of market competition by favoured brokers.
- Establish open data standards**
 Scaling standardized digital architectures and open APIs is critical to enabling seamless interoperability across disparate property management systems and public agencies. This digital layer could foster a more transparent and efficient real estate ecosystem through the unification of property data standards.
- Developer commitment dilution — RERA delivery timelines**
 To prevent the dilution of developer commitments, regulators could mandate absolute consistency between RERA-registered completion dates and those communicated in marketing material. Standardizing these disclosures across all physical and digital channels could eliminate discrepancies between verbal promises and regulatory filings, ensuring greater accountability and consumer protection.

Companies in Prop-tech

Homelane

Company overview

HomeLane is a leading **tech-enabled home interiors and renovation platform** in India, focused on modular kitchens, wardrobes and full-home interiors. Founded in 2014 and headquartered in Bengaluru, HomeLane serves urban homeowners through a mix of online design tools and offline experience centres.

Business model and value proposition

HomeLane operates an asset-light, managed marketplace model, connecting customers with a curated network of designers, manufacturers and installation partners. It monetises through project margins, while leveraging standardised designs, fixed pricing and predictable timelines to reduce execution risk and working capital intensity.

Exhibit 231: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	7.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.8) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	190
Last known valuation (USD mn)	360
Notable investors	WestBridge Capital, Hero Enterprise (Sunil Kant Munjal), Accel Partners, Sequoia Capital, Pidilite, Evolve India Fund, JSW Ventures, and Stride Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Homelane

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Srikanth Iyer and Tanuj Choudhry**, the leadership blends consulting, technology and execution experience. Srikanth Iyer has been central to building HomeLane's design-to-delivery operating model and scaling it across Indian metros.



Srikanth Iyer
Co-Founder, CEO



Tanuj Choudhry
Co-Founder, COO

Housing.com

Company overview

Housing.com is a major online real estate classifieds and discovery platform, offering residential and commercial property listings, price analytics and market insights. Founded in 2012, Housing.com operates as part of the REA India group.

Business model and value proposition

Housing.com follows a listing- and advertising-led marketplace model, generating revenue from developers, brokers and property owners through premium listings, branding solutions and lead-generation services, supported by data and analytics tools.

Exhibit 232: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	SoftBank, Falcon Edge, Nexus Venture Partners, and Qualcomm Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Originally founded in 2012 by a group of 12 IIT Bombay students, including Rahul Yadav, Advitiya Sharma, Amrit Raj. Housing.com later transitioned to professional management under REA Group (Australia) ownership. Current leadership focuses on operational discipline and synergy across REA India's platforms.

Livspace

Company overview

Livspace is one of India's full-stack home interiors platforms, offering end-to-end design, manufacturing and installation services. Founded in 2014 and headquartered in Bengaluru, Livspace operates across India and select international markets.

Business model and value proposition

The company runs a hybrid asset-heavy model, combining proprietary design software, owned manufacturing partnerships and managed project execution. Revenue is earned through interior project value, though the model carries higher working capital and execution complexity.

Exhibit 233: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	14.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.4) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	527
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,100
Notable investors	KKR, Goldman Sachs, TPG Growth, Jungle Ventures, EDBI

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TheArcWeb, TexAu

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Anuj Srivastava and Ramakant Sharma**, both with backgrounds in e-commerce and technology, the leadership has focused on building scale, brand trust and standardisation in a fragmented interiors market.



Anuj Srivastava
Co-Founder, Chairman



Ramakant Sharma
Co-Founder, CEO

Magicbricks

Company overview

Magicbricks is a property classifieds platform, offering listings for buying, selling and renting residential and commercial real estate. Founded in 2006, it operates as part of the Times Group.

Business model and value proposition

Magicbricks operates a classifieds and subscription-based model, monetising through paid listings, developer advertising, data services and market intelligence tools, supported by strong brand recall and high organic traffic.

Exhibit 234: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.08 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.19) (FY23)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Times Internet, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the Bennett, Coleman & Co. Ltd. (The Times Group)

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Doesn't have a single "founder" in the traditional sense but is a venture of Times Internet Limited (part of The Times Group). However, The CEO of Magicbricks is Sudhir Pai, who has led the company for many years.



Sudhir Pai
CEO

NoBroker

Company overview

NoBroker is a brokerage-free real estate platform, enabling users to rent, buy or sell property directly with owners. Founded in 2014, it also offers home services, loans and legal assistance.

Business model and value proposition

NoBroker runs a freemium platform model, monetising through subscription plans, home services, moving services and financial products, while eliminating traditional brokerage commissions.

Exhibit 235: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	8.03 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(4.1) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	360
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000 (2021)
Notable investors	General Atlantic, Tiger Global Management, Elevation Capital (formerly SAIF Partners), Google, KTB Ventures, Beenext, and Moore Strategic Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entrackr, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Amit Agarwal**, **Akhil Gupta**, **Saurabh Garg**, all IIT alumni, the leadership combines product, engineering and marketplace expertise, with a strong focus on consumer pain-point elimination.



Amit Agarwal
Co-Founder, CEO



Akhil Gupta
Co-Founder, CTPO



Saurabh Garg
Co-Founder, CBO

Square Yards

Company overview

Square Yards is a real estate transaction and advisory platform, operating across India, the Middle East, Australia and North America. Founded in 2014, it combines brokerage, digital discovery and financial services.

Business model and value proposition

Square Yards follows a transaction-led brokerage model, earning commissions on property sales, especially in primary residential markets, while also offering mortgages, valuation and data services.

Exhibit 236: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	14.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	113
Last known valuation (USD mn)	935
Notable investors	Smilegate Investment, Bennett Coleman and Co Ltd (Times Group), ADM Capital, Alto Partners, DBS Securities, and Genkai Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Kanika Gupta Shori, Tanuj Shori, the leadership brings strong backgrounds in consulting, analytics and real estate advisory, enabling Square Yards to scale internationally.



Kanika Gupta Shori & Tanuj Shori
COO & CEO

Stanza Living

Company overview

Stanza Living is a managed student and co-living accommodation platform, providing purpose-built housing for students and young professionals. Founded in 2017, it operates across major education and employment hubs.

Business model and value proposition

Stanza Living operates an asset-light, managed leasing model, partnering with property owners to lease, furnish and operate residences, monetising through monthly rentals and value-added services.

Exhibit 237: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.3 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	230
Last known valuation (USD mn)	320
Notable investors	Sequoia Capital (now Peak XV Partners), Accel, Matrix Partners, Falcon Edge Capital (Alpha Wave Global), and Equity International

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Anindya Dutta and Sandeep Dalmia, the leadership combines consulting, operations and real-estate execution expertise, with a focus on standardised living experiences.



Anindya Dutta & Sandeep Dalmia
Co-Founders

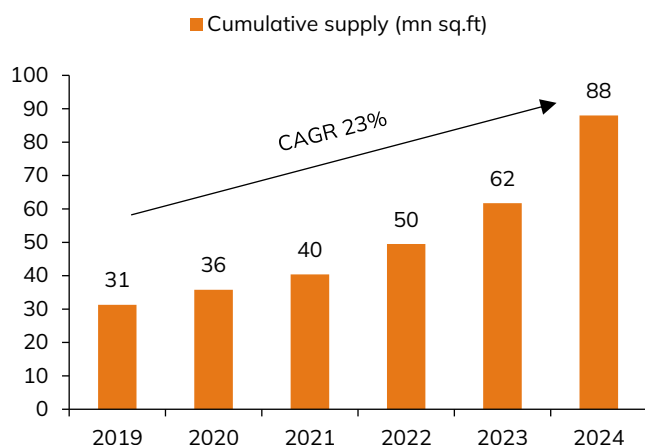
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Chapter 15: Deep dive into Co-working Space

Co-working space – overview

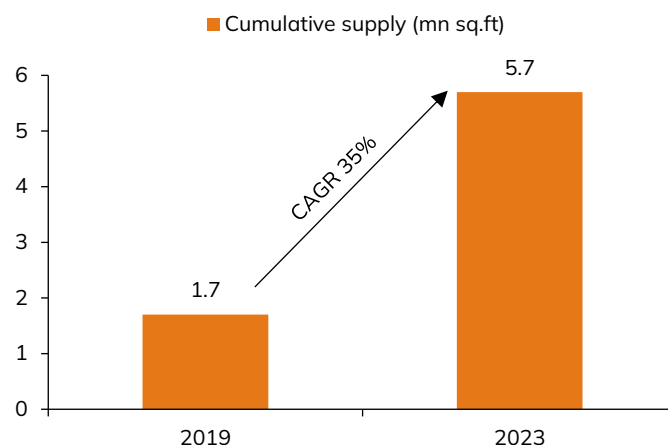
India's flexible workspace industry has entered a structural growth phase underpinned by strong macroeconomic momentum, Global Capability Centre (GCC) expansion, enterprise adoption of hybrid work, and domestic corporate growth. Total flex stock stood at ~96–100mnsq.ft. as of Q1CY25, representing around 10–12% of total office stock. The sector has grown meaningfully over the past three years, with CY24 alone adding ~18–22mn sq.ft., exceeding the cumulative additions during 2019–21.

Exhibit 238: Supply (cumulative) of flexible workspaces (tier-1 cities in India)



Source: I-Sec research, Industry data

Exhibit 239: Total market size of flexible workspace segment in tier-2 cities



Source: I-Sec research, Industry data

Flexible workspace now accounts for 18–23% of Grade A leasing in CY2024, establishing itself as the second-largest demand contributor in India's commercial office market. The Total Addressable Market is estimated at INR 730–960bn by CY27, with flex penetration expected to rise toward 15–17% by that period (Source: Redseer Research).

Exhibit 240: City-wise landscape (Q1CY25)

City	Flex stock (mn sq.ft.)	% of total stock	Unique centres (nos.)	Primary demand sectors
Bengaluru	27.0 - 29.0	11-13%	445+	IT/Tech, BFSI, Consulting
Gurugram	10.4 - 11.4	11-13%	205+	IT/Tech, E-Commerce, BFSI
Pune	11.5 - 12.5	13-15%	170+	IT, E&M, BFSI, Pharma
Hyderabad	11.4 - 12.4	8-10%	170+	IT/Tech, BFSI, Consulting
Mumbai	8.4 - 9.4	5-7%	235+	BFSI, IT/Tech, E&M
Chennai	6.5 - 7.5	7-9%	135+	IT/Tech, E&M, BFSI
Noida	6.4 - 7.4	13-15%	130+	IT/Tech, BFSI, Consulting
Delhi	2.0 - 2.5	14-16%	120+	BFSI, Advertising, IT
Kolkata	1.5 - 2.0	5-7%	45+	Outsourcing, IT, E&M

Source: I-Sec research, Industry data

Bengaluru remains the undisputed leader, accounting for ~30% of total tier-1 flexible workspace stock. Pune and Noida punch above their weight with flex penetration rates of 13-15%, indicating strong enterprise adoption in these markets.

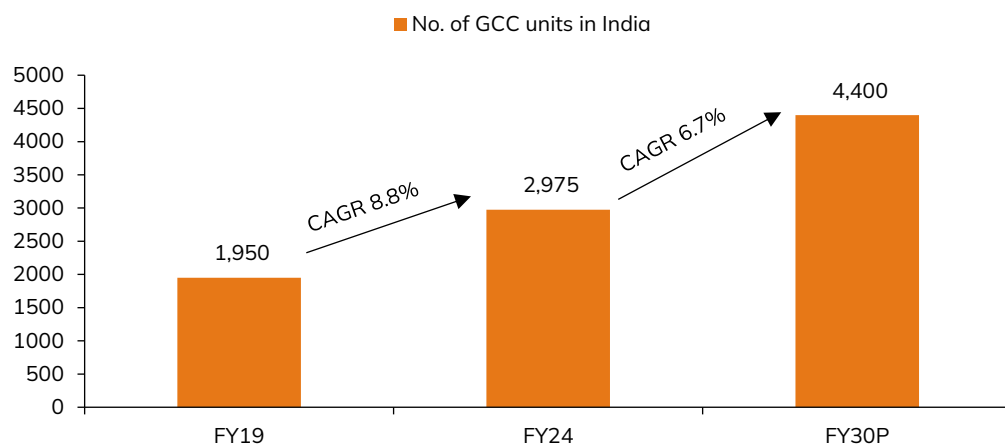
Key growth drivers

GCC expansion — the dominant tailwind

India now hosts 2,975+ GCC units as of FY24 (up from 1,950+ in FY19, CAGR 8.8%), and is expected to cross 4,300–4,400 GCCs by FY30 (Source: Redseer Research). GCC leasing grew 19% from 19mn sq.ft. (CY22) to 29mn sq.ft. (CY24).

Critically, new GCC entrants, especially mid-sized global firms, are actively evaluating flexible workspaces to test India before committing to long-term leases.

Exhibit 241: Growth of GCC units

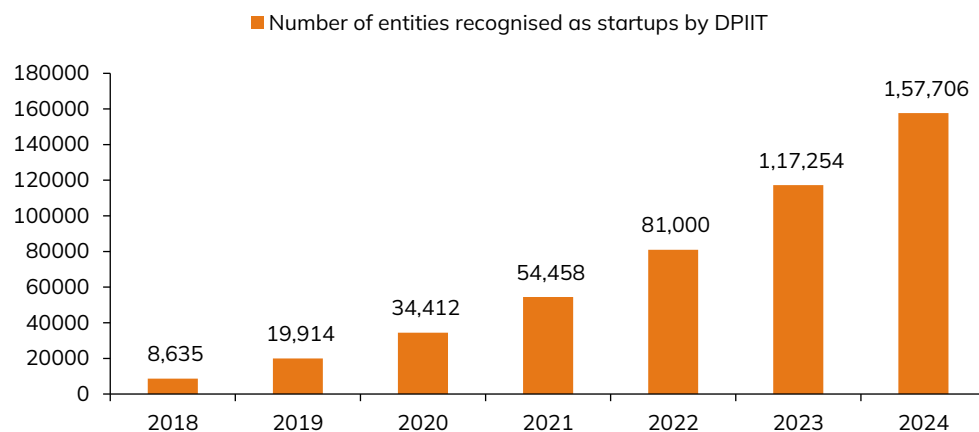


Source: I-Sec research, CBRE Report, Industry data

Startup ecosystem

The startup ecosystem has also expanded materially, with DPIIT-recognized startups increasing from 8,635 in 2018 to 1,57,706 in 2024, reinforcing demand for low-capex, scalable office formats. Favourable demographics, competitive labor costs of ~USD 10,000 per annum for certain roles, and sustained infrastructure spending at 3.3% of GDP further strengthen the macro foundation for office demand. Tier 2 cities are emerging as incremental growth drivers due to reverse migration trends and lower operating costs.

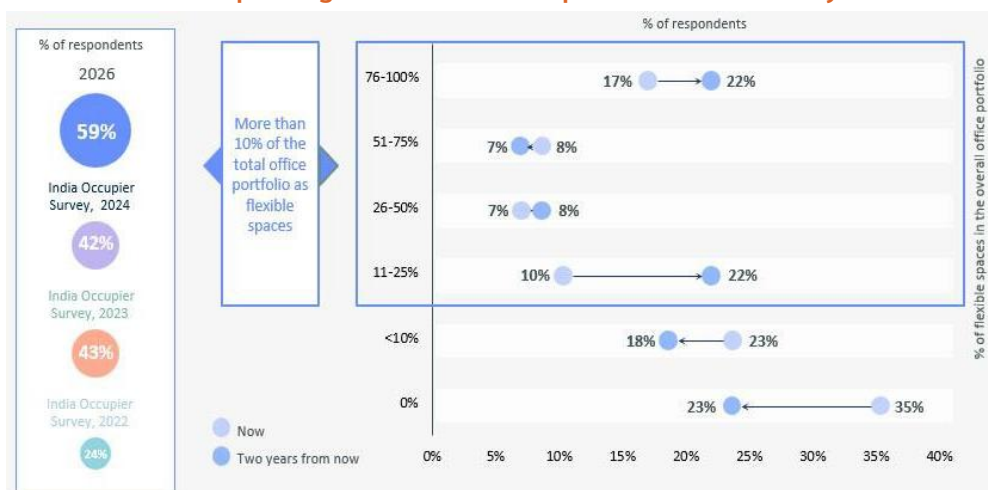
Exhibit 242: Entities recognised as startups by DPIIT



Source: DPIIT Feb'24, Ministry of Commerce & Industry Feb'25, I-Sec research

Hybrid work — structural, not cyclical

90% of Indian occupiers now prefer at least 3 days in-office per week. Companies are adopting 'Core+Flex' strategies, retaining a traditional leased headquarters while using flex for overflow, distributed offices, and project-based teams. 42% of companies already have >10% of their portfolio in flexible space (2024), expected to jump to 59% by 2026.

Exhibit 243: Anticipated growth of flexible spaces over next two years


Source: WeWork RHP

Unit economics and profitability
Portfolio-level profit trajectory

Operating leverage is the key differentiator as operators scale. Fixed costs (rent, management headcount) are largely absorbed once a centre stabilizes, while incremental revenue from occupancy growth falls almost entirely to EBITDA. The industry revenue-to-rent multiple typically ranges 1.9x-2.5x — operators who build premium products, strong enterprise client bases and sticky long-term managed office contracts operate at the higher end.

Adjusted EBITDA (after lease payments to landlords) is the true measure of economic value creation, and here, incumbents with scale, diversified client bases, and high-quality real estate have a decisive advantage over new entrants.

Exhibit 244: Standard centre economics (1,00,00 sq.ft. centre, tier-1 city)

Parameter	Assumption / Benchmark
Fit-out cost	INR 2,400/sq.ft.
Rental to landlord	INR 102/sq.ft. per month
Cam charges	INR 15/sq.ft. per month
Operating expenses	INR 35/sq.ft. per month
Revenue-to-rent multiple	1.9x-2.5x (centre avg ~2.4x)
Stabilized occupancy target	85%
Stabilization period	11-12 months
Average EBITDA margin	~28-29% (post refurbishment)
Payback period	~48-52 months from operations start
Rent escalation (operator)	15% every 3 years
Revenue escalation	~5% annually

Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 245: SWOT analysis of co-working sector

SWOT	Comments
Strength	• Strong structural demand: India's services-led economy and steady GDP growth support office demand. Flexible workspace now contributes 18–23% of Grade A leasing (CY24), showing it is a core part of corporate real estate strategy.
	• Enterprise and GCC adoption: India has 2,975+ GCCs, expected to rise significantly by FY30. Companies are increasing flex allocation in portfolios, making demand more stable and recurring.
	• Scalable unit economics: Revenue-to-rent multiples range from 1.9x–2.5x, with premium players higher. Stabilized occupancy targets are ~85%, and EBITDA margins average 28–29%, indicating healthy economics at scale.
	• Large growth runway: Flex stock is 96–100mn sq.ft. (Q1CY25) and projected at 140–144mn sq.ft. by CY27. TAM is estimated at INR 730–960bn by 2027, suggesting continued expansion potential.
Weakness	• Lease commitment risk: Operators sign long-term leases but offer shorter customer contracts. If occupancy drops, rental costs remain fixed.
	• High upfront capital: Fit-out costs are ~INR 2,400/sq.ft., with 48–52-month payback. This makes expansion capital-intensive.
	• Tier-1 concentration: ~90% of stock is concentrated in nine major cities, limiting geographic diversification.
	• Occupancy sensitivity: Margins depend heavily on maintaining ~85% occupancy. A drop below this level impacts profitability quickly.
Opportunity	• Tier-2 expansion: Emerging cities remain underpenetrated and offer the next phase of growth.
	• Higher enterprise mix: Larger, long-term enterprise contracts could improve stability and reduce churn.
	• Ancillary revenue growth: Value-added services currently contribute up to 10% of revenue, with room to scale further.
	• Capital market access: The SM-REIT framework (2024) improves monetization options and liquidity for assets.
Threat	• Economic or GCC slowdown: A decline in global or IT demand could slow leasing momentum.
	• Rental escalation pressure: Rent typically escalates 15% every three years, which could compress margins if pricing does not keep pace.
	• Developer-led competition: Large real estate developers launching their own flex platforms may increase pricing pressure.
	• Cost inflation: Rising fit-out and operating costs could reduce project returns.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways
Regulatory framework modernisation

- **Zoning:** Flex-Specific Zoning Norms: Current zoning laws conflate traditional office leasing with flex workspace operations. A dedicated 'Flex Office' category in town planning regulations could enable operators to set up in more locations, particularly in mixed-use zones, at lower real estate cost.
- **Licensing:** Simplified Licensing: Flex operators currently navigate complex webs of municipal licenses, fire NOCs, and shop-and-establishment acts, often duplicative and state-specific. A single-window clearance mechanism, akin to what has been implemented for startups under Start-up India, could meaningfully reduce operator entry costs and timelines.

Tax and financial incentives

- **GST reform:** GST Input Credit Parity – operators pay GST on fit-out costs and rent but face structural GST input credit mismatches. Rationalisation of GST treatment, particularly allowing full input tax credit on fit-out and capital expenditure, could improve unit economics and accelerate sector growth.
- **Credit access:** Priority Sector Status for Flex Operators: Similar to how IT parks received priority treatment, extending infrastructure status or priority sector lending to flex workspace operators could improve access to capital at lower cost, enabling faster geographical and product expansion.

Non-tier-1 city development

- **GCC policy:** GCC Incentives in Tier 2/3 Cities: State governments offering GCC incentives (as Telangana and Karnataka do) have seen disproportionate GCC inflows. A national GCC promotion policy with fiscal incentives for locating in Tier 2 cities (Kochi, Jaipur, Coimbatore, Indore, Ahmedabad) could help distribute economic growth and create demand for flex workspaces beyond the 9 Tier 1 markets.
- **Infrastructure:** Infrastructure Development in Emerging Hubs: Physical and digital infrastructure (metro connectivity, fiber broadband, power reliability) in Tier 2 markets is the primary bottleneck for flex operator expansion. Accelerated PM Gati Shakti implementation in identified emerging business corridors could directly catalyse flex demand.

Data and standards

- **Data:** Standardised flex workspace data tracking – currently there is no official database for uniform tracking of flex workspace stock, occupancy, and transactions. A joint MoU between MoHUA and NASSCOM/CII to establish a National Flex Workspace Registry could improve market transparency, facilitate policy formulation, and enable better capital allocation decisions.
- **Standards:** Quality Certification Standards: Establishing a Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) certification for flex workspace quality (covering physical safety, data security, sustainability, and service standards) could differentiate compliant operators, improve occupier confidence, and set a minimum quality floor in a fragmented market.

Companies in the Co-working space

Awfis

Company overview

Awfis Space Solutions Ltd is a leading Indian flexible workspace and managed office solutions provider founded in 2015, offering coworking spaces, enterprise offices, managed workspaces and allied services across major cities in India. It has a wide network of centres and seats, serving startups, SMEs and large enterprises.

Business model and value proposition

It follows a managed aggregation model, partnering with property owners to convert and operate workspaces, monetising through space rentals, membership fees, enterprise solutions and ancillary offerings like concierge, cafes and enterprise services.

Exhibit 246: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	12.08 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.68 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	280
Notable investors	Sequoia Capital, ChrysCapital, HDFC Mutual Fund, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, Invesco, Link REIT, and Nippon India Mutual Fund

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Amit Ramani** (Chairman and MD), who leads the company's strategic growth in India's flexible workspace sector. He has been recognised for pioneering digital pricing, workspace aggregation and hybrid office solutions.



Amit Ramani
Chairman & MD

IndiQube Spaces

Company overview

IndiQube Spaces Ltd is a tech-enabled managed workspace and flexible office solutions company that leases, configures and operates high-quality office space across India's key business hubs, serving enterprises with scalable, customizable work environments.

Business model and value proposition

It operates an asset-light managed office model, leasing entire buildings or floors from landlords and converting them into flexible workspaces with integrated amenities and workspace services, generating recurring revenue through space rentals and value-added services.

Exhibit 247: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	10.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.4) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	380
Notable investors	WestBridge Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2015 by Rishi Das and Meghna Agarwal, IndiQube's leadership is focused on scaling workspace solutions for enterprises, combining expertise in real estate, operations and tech-enabled service delivery.



Rishi Das
Co-Founder &
Chairman



Meghna Agarwal
Co-Founder

WeWork India

Company overview

WeWork India is the Indian operator and exclusive licensee of the WeWork global brand (launched in 2017), providing premium flexible workspaces, private offices, shared desks and enterprise solutions in major Indian cities under long-term leases.

Business model and value proposition

It leases Grade-A commercial space from property owners, fits and operates these offices as flexible, on-demand work environments, monetising through memberships, desk sales, enterprise contracts and long-term client engagements.

Exhibit 248: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	19 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.3 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	800
Notable investors	We work global, UBS, Goldman Sachs, HDFC MF, Invesco MF, ICICI Pru MF

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

The Indian arm was launched by Jitendra Mohandas Virwani and Karan Virwani, with Karan Virwani serving as CEO and Managing Director. The company leverages Embassy Group's real estate expertise while operating under the global WeWork licence.



Karan Virwani
MD & CEO

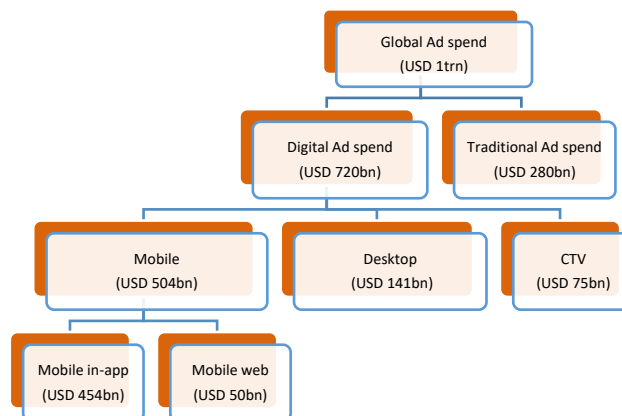
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Chapter 16: Deep dive into Ad-tech sector

Ad-tech sector – overview

Global advertising market

Exhibit 249: Digital accounting for ~70–75% of global ad spends in 2024. Mobile in-app accounts for 44% of total global ad market



Source: I-Sec research

According to our channel checks, the global advertising market reached USD 1trn in CY24, continuing to outpace global GDP growth, and is projected to expand to ~1% of global GDP by CY29.

Digital remains the key growth driver, accounting for ~70–75% of global ad spends in 2024, with share expected to rise further to 80–85% by 2029. Mobile has emerged as the primary medium, attracting ~70% of global digital ad spends, with in-app formats commanding close to 90% share.

Exhibit 250: 5G adoption in leading and EMs by 2030

Leading 5G Markets

	No. of Connections (millions)	% of Total Connections
GCC States	98	95%
Developed Asia Pacific	305	93%
North America	459	89%
Greater China	1810	88%
Europe	651	81%

Emerging 5G Markets

	No. of Connections (millions)	% of Total Connections
Latin America	417	53%
Rest of Asia Pacific	1,250	45%
Rest of MENA	331	43%
Eurasia	143	41%
Sub-Saharan Africa	247	17%

Source: I-Sec research, Affle FY25 annual report

Regionally, while North America makes up the majority of advertising spend and shows steady growth, the Asia-Pacific region is poised to grow faster on the back of emerging countries like India, which are expanding rapidly, fuelled by broader consumption growth, demographic tailwinds, and favourable digital trends.

In mature markets such as the US, Europe, and China, digital ad penetration has reached ~75–80%, leading to a natural tapering of growth rates to high-single digits. For example, the US took 8–10 years (2012–22) to scale from ~40% penetration to ~75%, while China took 7–8 years (2013–20) to reach ~70%. With limited incremental headroom, these markets are expected to deliver only modest, GDP-like growth going forward.

By contrast, India and other emerging markets (EMs) remain firmly in the growth phase. We believe digital penetration across India, Southeast Asia, MENA, and Latam remains at ~50–60%, implying they are still 5–7 years behind the US/China adoption curve. We expect these markets to sustain 10–15% CAGR over the next 5-7 years, before digital penetration converges to ~70–80%.

India's growth potential

As per media reports ([link](#)), India total ad market is USD 16-18bn; Digital ad market accounts for 50-60% of total Indian ad market valued at USD 8-10bn. It stands out as one of the fastest growing digital advertising markets globally.

Our channel checks with agencies and advertisers suggest digital ad spends will likely grow at ~15–16% CAGR over CY24–29E, with penetration rising from ~55–60% sized at USD 8-10bn currently to ~68–70% by 2029 amounting to USD 27–29bn.

Given digital channels' higher measurability and RoI, we believe they could capture a disproportionate share of this incremental spend, accelerating investment into ad-tech platforms and strengthening their role in the advertising value chain.

Beyond structural drivers like rising internet penetration and digital media adoption, we believe India's fiscal and monetary measures may provide an additional boost to discretionary consumption and advertising demand. Initiatives such as tax relief, higher government salaries under the 8th Pay Commission, GST rationalisation, and RBI rate cuts are all supportive of household spending and sectoral growth in FMCG, retail, travel, and durables. While the recent ban on advertising for real-money gaming presents a short-term headwind, we expect the broader uplift in consumer demand to drive a recovery in overall advertising budgets.

While we see strong structural drivers for digital advertising, it remains inherently cyclical and sensitive to consumption trends. Periods of weak discretionary demand, inflationary pressures, or external shocks typically result in advertisers cutting or deferring budgets, with digital channels also impacted despite their higher ROI measurability. We believe such cyclical volatility may create short-term swings in growth, but the longer-term structural trend of rising digital penetration and performance-led spending remains intact, providing a multi-year runway for ad-tech platforms.

Ad-tech value chain

The advertising value chain entails many players, each with distinct roles. Brands and agency partners define campaign goals, budgets, and target audiences. Publishers publish and trigger ads and provide select audience details. Ad-tech intermediaries, including DSPs, ad exchanges, and SSPs, assist with listing published ads, routing ad requests to brands, and bidding to win and place ads on platforms. These ad-tech players (e.g., AppLovin, PubMatic, InMobi) form the “open system” where brands transact programmatically with the broader ecosystem of publishers. In contrast, large publishers (e.g., Google, Meta, Amazon) work in “closed systems,” engaging directly with brands and agencies.

The Ad-tech ecosystem: Open web vs. walled gardens

The Ad-tech ecosystem can be broadly divided into two parts:

1. Walled gardens

These are closed ecosystems owned by tech giants, historically, the Google-Facebook duopoly, but increasingly including Amazon, Apple, and TikTok.

These platforms restrict access to their data and audiences. Advertisers must use the platform’s own ad-buying tools (Google Ads, Facebook Ads Manager, Amazon Advertising, Apple Search Ads) to reach users within their ecosystems.

Strength: They offer unmatched scale, deterministic user data (logged-in users), and closed-loop attribution.

Limitation: Advertisers cannot port campaign-level data outside the platform; transparency is limited.

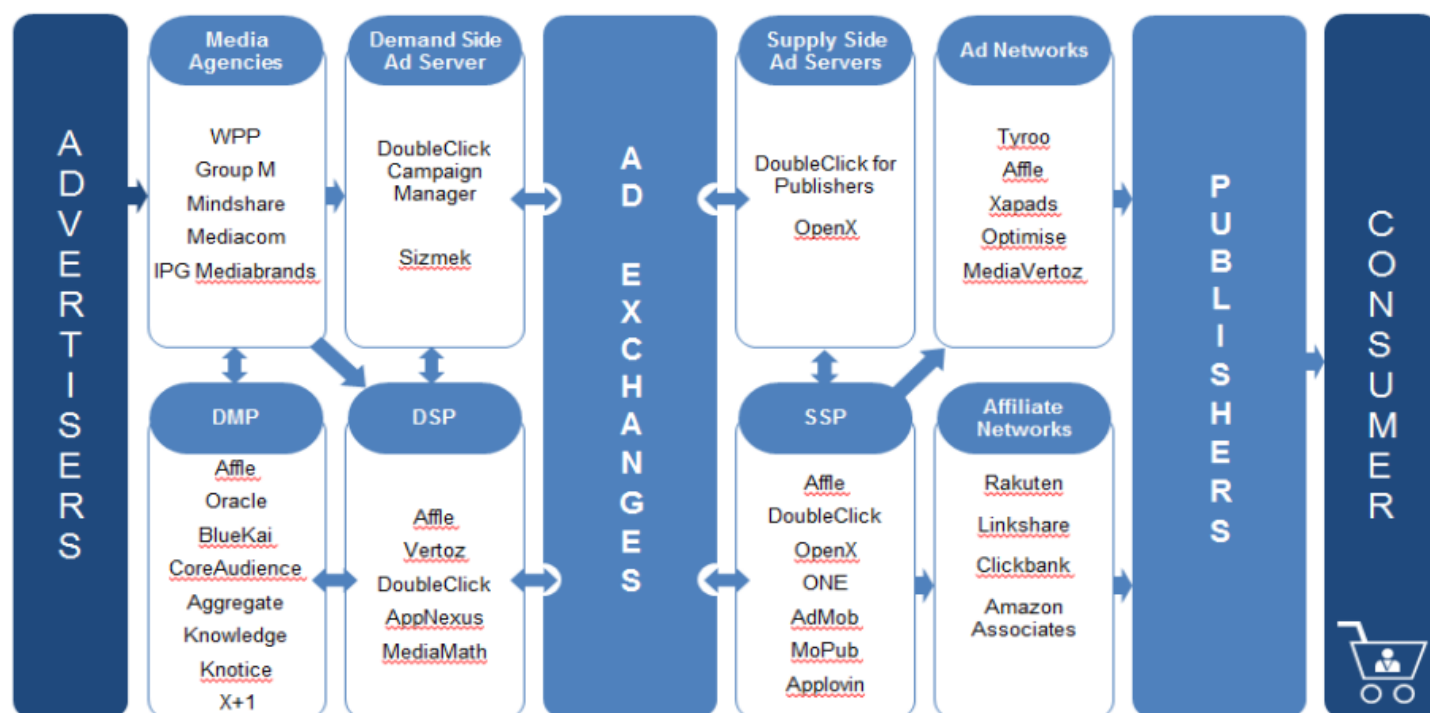
Accessing walled gardens: Advertisers cannot go around them—brands must work directly through their self-serve platforms or via certified marketing partners. For example, campaigns on Google’s Search and YouTube inventory must be purchased through Google Ads, not an independent DSP.

2. Open web

The open web refers to the fragmented, long-tail universe outside the walled gardens. This includes: Regional publishers, news sites, blogs, app developers and gaming platforms, OEM app stores (Xiaomi, Oppo, Vivo), telecom operators’ content apps, OTT streaming platforms (non-YouTube), etc.

Here, advertisers typically **buy inventory via ad exchanges, DSPs, or ad networks, with significant use of cookies, MAIDs, and probabilistic data.**

Exhibit 251: Digital advertising value chain



Source: I-Sec research, Affle DRHP

Ad networks: Ad networks platforms aggregated ad inventory from multiple publishers (websites, app developers, gaming portals, etc.) and sold it to advertisers in one consolidated package. Ad networks simplified the buying process for advertisers by offering wider reach and gave publishers an opportunity to monetise the unsold inventory. Pricing was usually fixed or negotiable.

Ad Exchange: Soon after, ad exchanges evolved as a more open, market-based solution. An ad exchange is a digital marketplace where advertisers and publishers buy and sell ad space in real time through real-time bidding (RTB). Here, advertisers bid for impressions, and publishers sell to the highest bidder, all within milliseconds. Unlike ad networks, which act as intermediaries, ad exchanges function as transparent marketplaces where pricing is determined algorithmically.

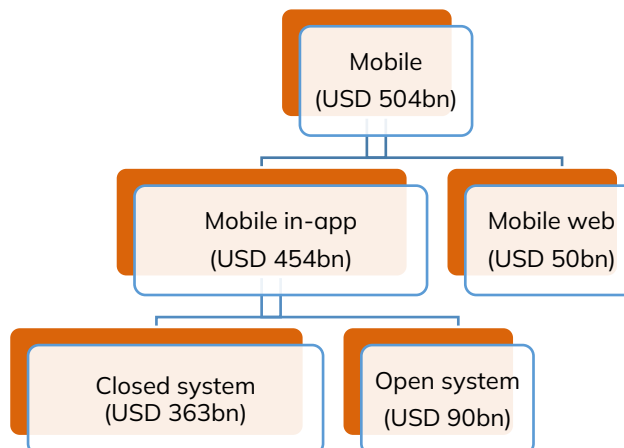
To enable this high-speed, data-driven market, several layers of technology were developed:

- **DSP (Demand-side Platforms):** Used by advertisers to automate and optimise the purchase of ad inventory across multiple publishers.
- **SSP (Supply-side Platforms):** Used by publishers to manage and sell their ad inventory to maximise yield.
- **Ad servers:** Software that manages the delivery of ads, measures impressions/clicks, and tracks performance.
- **Data Management Platforms (DMPs) and Customer Data Platforms (CDPs):** Collect, unify, and analyse data (cookies, mobile advertising IDs / MAIDs, first-party behavioural data) to create detailed audience profiles. These allow advertisers to run targeted campaigns across devices and measure performance.
- Over time, the clear distinctions between pure ad networks and pure DSP/SSP players have blurred. Earlier, ad networks simply aggregated inventory, while DSPs and SSPs were pipes connecting advertisers and publishers in real time. Today, most leading Ad-tech platforms have evolved into **end-to-end, full-stack**

solutions that integrate demand, supply, data, and measurement. Advertisers increasingly prefer a single platform that can provide audience insights, campaign execution, real-time bidding, fraud detection, attribution, and outcome-based pricing in one place. This convergence reflects the industry's shift from siloed tools to **integrated marketing platforms**.

Market size of closed system and open system

Exhibit 252: Mobile in-app accounts for ~45% of total global ad market; open system accounts for 20% of mobile in-app market



Source: I-Sec research

As consumers globally and in India maintain their preference for smartphones for media consumption, mobile devices are earning nearly 70% (or close to USD 504bn) of total digital ad spend and are expected to maintain dominance. New channels like connected TV (CTV), which currently commands roughly a 10% share, are gaining salience at the expense of desktop, owing to increasing smart TV penetration and access to premium consumers.

The handful of tech giants making up the closed system account for ~80% of the mobile in app market. Open-system players account for the remaining 20%. While the share between the two systems has remained largely stable in the past few years and is expected to remain so, the open-system landscape is undergoing consolidation, driven by scale and network benefits, which has led to the emergence of scaled players (e.g., AppLovin, InMobi, Moloco). These players are vertically integrating and unlocking advantages like better data pipelines, wider demand/supply networks, operational synergies, and intelligent capabilities augmented by first-party inventory and

Players in mobile in-app open system

Mobile in-app open system market size is USD 90bn. As per our channel checks, 70-75% market share is held by google Ad mob and meta-audience network. Remaining 25-30% market share is held by players like AppLovin, Unity, Vungle, Inmobi, Affle and others.

India with its rapidly growing Internet user base has become an attractive destination for international ad tech vendors, including Criteo, Mobvista, FreakOut – who have set up recently, alongside existing companies such as Affle, RevX, InMobi, among others. However, India presents its unique set of challenges such as a disjointed demographic which is just getting habituated to digital applications (such as use of e-commerce, digital payments, etc.). Only 10% of Internet users are active (i.e., making a purchase at least once per month) e-commerce customers.

It can be a hard market to sustain, even for market participants who are globally successful. With an average CPC at USD 0.1 to 0.3, the price points are quite low compared to the global market

Revenue model of open system and closed system players

Ad-tech revenue models focus on monetising digital content and user attention through automated, data-driven advertising transactions.

Primary models include CPM (cost per mille/thousand impressions), CPC (cost per click), and CPA (cost per action/conversion).

Revenue is driven by platforms like SSPs (Supply-Side Platforms) selling publisher inventory and DSPs (Demand-Side Platforms) helping advertisers buy, often utilizing real-time bidding (RTB) to maximize value.

Exhibit 253: Revenue model of open system and closed system players

Business model	Metrics	Typical Pricing Range
Media-based pricing model	Cost per media (for example, number of banners, videos)	USD 0.15 –USD 5 per thousand impressions
Performance-based pricing model	Cost per click, cost per sale, cost per view, cost per action (such as app downloads)	USD 0.1 –USD 0.3 per click
Flat fee model	A flat rate for each media / channel	Varies
Software as a service	Monthly fee based on technology stack, number of users targeted, etc.	USD 15k –USD 35k per month

Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Brands prefer performance-based models, where they are charged based on harder metrics such as number of clicks or converted users. This way, ad tech companies have more incentives to ensure targeted reach for the brand.

In fact, with bots faking clicks as well, some companies such as Affle and Criteo, have embraced action or performance driven sales, where customers don't pay for clicks, but for actions such as app installs, purchases, etc. This assures transparency for brands and increased revenues for vendors. In some cases, companies use a revenue sharing model where a percentage of the sale value from the client's product goes to the vendor.

Exhibit 254: Ad-tech sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	• Digital Market Leadership: Digital is now India's largest ad channel, driving massive demand for programmatic platforms and retail-media stacks that offer measurable, performance-driven results.
	• Programmatic Maturity: The shift toward automated buying and real-time measurement reduces transaction costs and unlocks high-value inventory like CTV and short-form video.
	• Inventory Diversification: Emerging channels like retail media allow brands to monetize first-party shopper data, reducing reliance on traditional formats and integrating commerce with measurement.
Weakness	• Fragmented Standards: Disparate measurement metrics and attribution models across local and global players increase reconciliation costs and diminish advertiser trust.
	• Persistent Ad Fraud: Issues with bot traffic and domain spoofing inflate effective costs and force vendors to invest heavily in expensive verification and remediation services.
	• Privacy Rework: Transitioning to cookieless models and complying with India's DPDP Act requires costly engineering shifts that can lower targeting granularity and publisher yields.
Opportunity	• Retail Media Expansion: E-commerce growth allows Ad-tech players to build high-margin networks that link purchase intent directly to outcomes (ROAS) for performance marketers.
	• Regional and CTV Growth: Localized language targeting and addressable video on OTT platforms offer premium, high-CPM inventory for vendors capable of managing regional creative optimization.
	• SMB Productisation: Developing low-touch, self-serve ad stacks for MSMEs could unlock a massive, underserved market and reduce the industry's dependency on high-touch agency models.
Threat	• Regulatory and Privacy Shifts: Stricter consent regimes and the loss of third-party data threaten traditional profiling models, forcing a painful and margin-compressing pivot to first-party data.
	• Policy and Tax Uncertainty: Evolving digital taxation and international trade disputes could alter the economic landscape for global platforms and shift how value is captured in India.
	• Walled Garden Dominance: The concentration of revenue within a few global giants limits the pricing power of independent Ad-tech firms and squeezes yields for smaller local publishers.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- **Clear, operational privacy rules and implementation guidance (DPDP rollout support):** The Digital Personal Data Protection environment (DPDP and related guidance) has created higher compliance burdens and uncertainty for companies that historically relied on third-party data. Ad-tech firms face hard choices on consent flows, data retention, cross-border transfers and lawful bases for profiling, and many lack clear administrative guidance on practical implementation for ad use-cases.
- **Anti-fraud/safety infrastructure and data sharing for detection:** Ad fraud remains an industry externality; platforms and publishers are individually investing in detection, but cross-publisher intelligence sharing is limited by legal and technical barriers.
- **Tax clarity for digital advertising and support for local innovation:** Ambiguity in taxation (equalisation levies, GST treatment on ad inventory and cross-border services) raises compliance and commercial unpredictability for both global and local Ad-tech vendors. Sudden policy reversals or ad hoc levies distort platform economics and negotiating positions with global publishers.
- **Support for first-party identity and interoperability standards:** The cookieless world forces reliance on first-party identifiers (publisher logins, retail shopper IDs). But building interoperable, privacy-safe identity graphs is expensive, and absence of common standards leads to vendor lock-in and fragmentation.

Companies in the Ad-tech sector

Affle 3i

Company overview

Affle 3i Ltd is a global technology and advertising platform that leverages AI-led connected device intelligence to empower brands with mobile advertising, programmatic solutions and customer acquisition tools across mobile, Connected TV and other connected screens; the company rebranded from Affle (India) Limited to Affle 3i Limited in Apr'25 to emphasize Innovation, Impact and Intelligence.

Business model and value proposition

Affle 3i operates a consumer intelligence-driven ad-tech SaaS and programmatic advertising model that charges on a Cost Per Converted User (CPCU) basis, delivering personalised and contextual advertising across devices via platforms such as Appnext, Jampp, Mediasmart, RevX and YouAppi, helping advertisers drive measurable ROI.

Exhibit 255: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	22.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	3.8 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	2,200
Notable investors	Peak XV, Tiger Global Management and Surge

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Affle 3i was founded in 2006 and completed its IPO in India in Aug'19; its leadership includes Anuj Khanna Sohum (Chairperson, MD and CEO), supported by a seasoned technology and advertising management team across revenue, operations and product functions.



Anuj Khanna Sohum
Founder, MD & CEO



Anuj Kumar
Co-Founder

Glance

Company overview

Glance is an AI-enabled content, commerce and engagement platform (incorporated 2019, headquartered in Bengaluru) that transforms the mobile lock screen into an interactive surface for personalised content, entertainment, gaming and shopping, reaching hundreds of millions of users across India and beyond.

Business model and value proposition

Glance operates a platform-as-a-service business model where it monetises a large active user base by integrating personalised content, creator-led commerce and advertisements directly into the lock screen experience for OEMs and telcos, while also expanding AI-driven commerce and interactive services.

Exhibit 256: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	6.1 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(9.2) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	390
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,800
Notable investors	Google, Mithril Capital Management, Reliance Jio, Stride Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, CNBC

Founders and leadership

Co-founded by Naveen Tewari, Abhay Singhal, Mohit Saxena and Piyush Shah, all veteran entrepreneurs from the ad-tech ecosystem (also behind InMobi), Glance's leadership blends deep technical, strategic and product experience in mobile advertising and platform growth, anchored by Tewari's vision for immersive mobile experiences.



Naveen Tewari
Founder, CEO



Piyush Shah
Co-Founder,
President



Mohit Saxena
Co-Founder, CTO



Abhay Singhal
Co-Founder

Recent developments

Glance is leveraging Generative AI to create personalized, shoppable experiences directly on mobile and TV screens. Key developments include strategic partnerships with Google Cloud and NVIDIA to enhance visual AI capabilities, expansion into the US and Japanese markets, and the launch of AI-led fashion shopping.

InMobi

Company overview

InMobi is a Bengaluru-based multinational mobile advertising and technology company that provides mobile-first programmatic ad solutions, consumer insights platforms and an ecosystem of engagement products (including Glance and Roposo) across global markets.

Business model and value proposition

InMobi's business model centres on mobile and programmatic advertising services, offering advertisers and publishers tools for audience targeting, monetisation, analytics and campaign optimisation, underpinned by AI and data-driven capabilities.

Exhibit 257: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	773
Last known valuation (USD mn)	4,000-5,000
Notable investors	SoftBank, Kleiner Perkins Caufield & Byers (KPCB), Sherpalo Ventures, The Carlyle Group, Varde Partners, Lightbox, Tennenbaum Capital Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2007 by Naveen Tewari, Mohit Saxena, Amit Gupta, Piyush Shah and Abhay Singhal, InMobi's leadership combines deep expertise in mobile tech, AI and advertising platforms; Naveen Tewari (Founder and CEO) is an IIT Kanpur and Harvard MBA alumnus recognised for pioneering mobile advertising innovation.



Naveen Tewari
Founder & CEO



Abhay Singhal
Co-Founder, InMobi
& CEO, InMobi
Advertising



Mohit Saxena
Co-Founder & CTO



Piyush Shah
Co-Founder



Amit Gupta
Co-Founder

Pixis

Company overview

Pixis is a California-based AI-powered marketing and advertising platform that provides brands with a codeless, full-stack AI infrastructure to optimise advertising performance and campaign creativity, helping marketers improve ROI across digital channels.

Business model and value proposition

Pixis operates a B2B SaaS and AI-driven creative automation model, offering tools that automate and optimise ad campaign performance, creative generation, audience targeting and analytics for enterprise clients across industries.

Exhibit 258: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.6 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.35) (FY23)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	209
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	SoftBank Vision Fund, General Atlantic, Touring Capital, Premji Invest, Celesta Capital, Chiratae Ventures, Grupo Carso

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2018 by Shubham Mishra, Harikrishna Valiyath and Vrushali Prasade, Pixis blends AI expertise with marketing technology innovation to empower brands with next-gen automation and data-driven insights.



Shubham Mishra
Co-Founder, CEO
Global



Harikrishna Valiyath
Co-Founder, CBO



Vrushali Prasade
Co-Founder, CTO

Chapter 17: Deep dive into Gaming

Gaming sector – overview

The Indian gaming industry has experienced a dramatic structural transformation following the Aug'25 ban on Real Money Gaming (RMG). The sector has contracted by ~80%, shrinking from INR 500bn-550bn (~USD 6bn) to just INR 100bn (~USD 1bn). This tectonic shift has forced companies to pivot toward eSports, free-to-play models, and alternative monetisation strategies, including micro-dramas and audio chat features.

According to our estimates, the remaining INR 100bn market is now heavily concentrated, with 70-80% of revenue generated by just 2-3 major players, primarily Krafton (PUBG) and Garena (Free Fire). The government has lost ~INR 250bn in annual tax revenue due to the RMG ban.

Market structure: Pre-ban vs. post-ban

Pre-ban

Before the ban, the industry was overwhelmingly driven by RMG platforms (88-90% of total market) such as fantasy sports, rummy, poker and casual skill games. Companies like Zupee and WinZO were generating revenue of INR 4bn and INR 3.5bn per month, respectively, while Dream11, Games24x7 and others formed the backbone of a fast-scaling ecosystem. The growth rate for the RMG gaming was 30% YoY.

RMG growth from INR 330bn–350bn in FY24 to INR 440bn–450bn in FY25 highlighted strong demand elasticity and user monetisation capability. Non-RMG gaming remained secondary, contributing only 10–12% of the overall market, having a growth rate of ~15% YoY, primarily driven by PUBG and Free Fire.

Post-ban

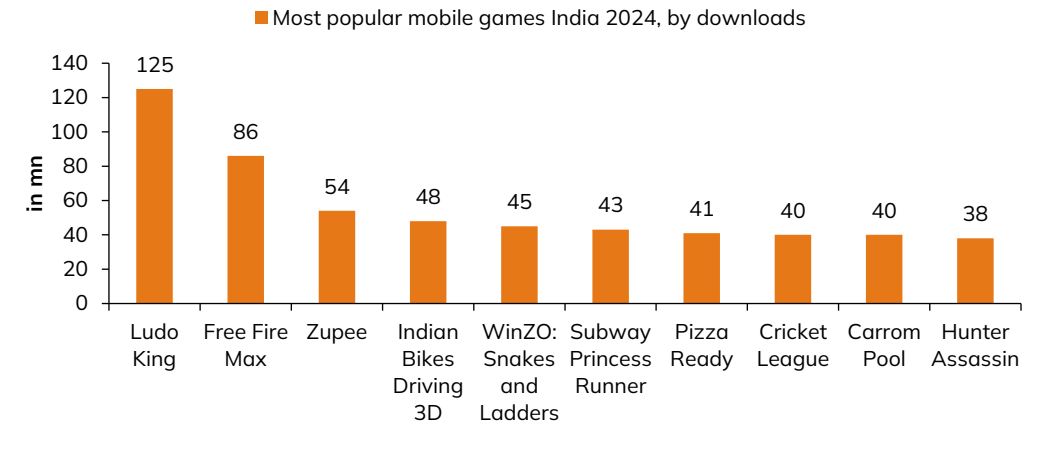
The current INR 100bn market is highly concentrated, with 70–80% of revenue generated by 2–3 players. The dominant category is first-person shooter (FPS) games. Krafton's PUBG/BGMI generates INR 20bn–25bn annually from India alone, with 6mn DAU and 21–22mn MAU. Its DAU/MAU ratio of 1:3.5 indicates exceptionally strong engagement relative to industry benchmarks.

Revenue mix is ~80% in-app purchases (IAP) and 20% advertising. Garena's Free Fire has even higher user numbers (8mn DAU; 67–76mn MAU, peaking at 80mn), though monetisation is weaker compared to PUBG.

eSports has emerged as the fastest-growing compliant segment (~20% YoY). Nodwin Gaming generates INR 5-6bn annually through tournament organisation, broadcasting rights, sponsorships and ticketing, largely centred around PUBG and Free Fire tournaments.

Casual gaming remains meaningful but slower growing; for example, Ludo King generates INR 2.5bn annually (INR 1.8bn ads, INR 0.7bn IAP), with 10mn DAU but relatively low ARPDAU (~INR 0.75 combined from ads and IAP).

Exhibit 259: Increasing downloads of F2P games



Source: Statista, I-Sec research

Monetisation dynamics: Structural constraints

Post-ban monetisation has highlighted structural challenges in India. IAP monetisation works primarily where users perceive competitive advantage or status signalling (e.g., better weapons or skins in PUBG). Casual cosmetic monetisation remains weak. ARPDAU for IAP in casual games stands at ~INR 0.25, while blended advertising ECPM in India averages ~USD 0.45 (~INR 40 per 1,000 impressions), limiting scalability of ad-based models. These constraints have made it difficult for former RMG players to replace lost revenues through advertising alone.

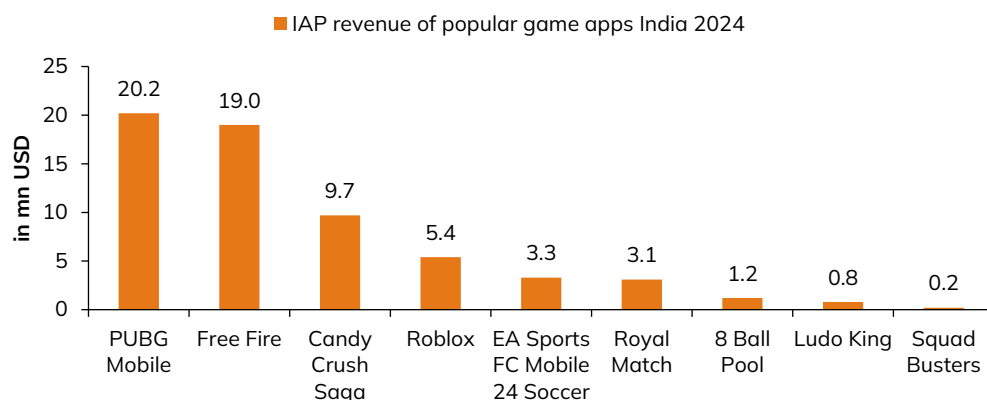
Companies such as Dream11 and Zupee have pivoted toward free-to-play tournaments funded by advertising, micro-dramas, subscription experiments and audio chat features.

However, these models are either early-stage or face sustainability and regulatory risks. Micro-drama platforms, monetized via frequent UPI auto-renewals, are considered high risk from a regulatory standpoint.

IAP monetisation is highly concentrated and genre-led

The in-app purchase (IAP) revenue pattern in India highlights extreme monetisation concentration, with competitive shooter formats such as PUBG Mobile and Free Fire generating materially higher IAP revenues than all other categories. This suggests that Indian consumers are selective payers, willingness to spend is not broad-based across gaming, but instead concentrated in formats where purchases deliver competitive advantage, progression benefits, or social signalling value.

Exhibit 260: In-app purchase revenue of top game apps in India in 2024



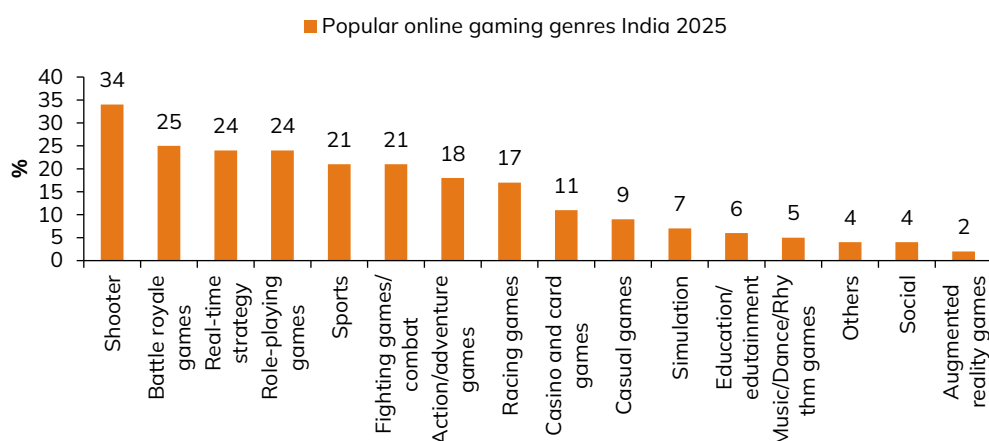
Source: Statista, I-Sec research

Casual and puzzle formats, despite scale in downloads and engagement, exhibit significantly lower IAP depth, reinforcing that high DAU does not automatically translate into monetisation elasticity.

Demand was structurally competitive, not just monetary

Even during the RMG-driven revenue phase, user preference leaned toward shooters, battle royale, strategy, and sports formats, genres that emphasize real-time competition, progression systems, and peer comparison. This suggests that the core engagement engine of the industry was competitive intensity, with monetary overlays acting as accelerants rather than the primary driver of interest. Casual and simulation-led categories remained secondary in preference depth, reinforcing that download accessibility does not necessarily translate into durable engagement.

Exhibit 261: Most popular genres for online gaming in India as of Jan'25



Source: Statista, I-Sec research

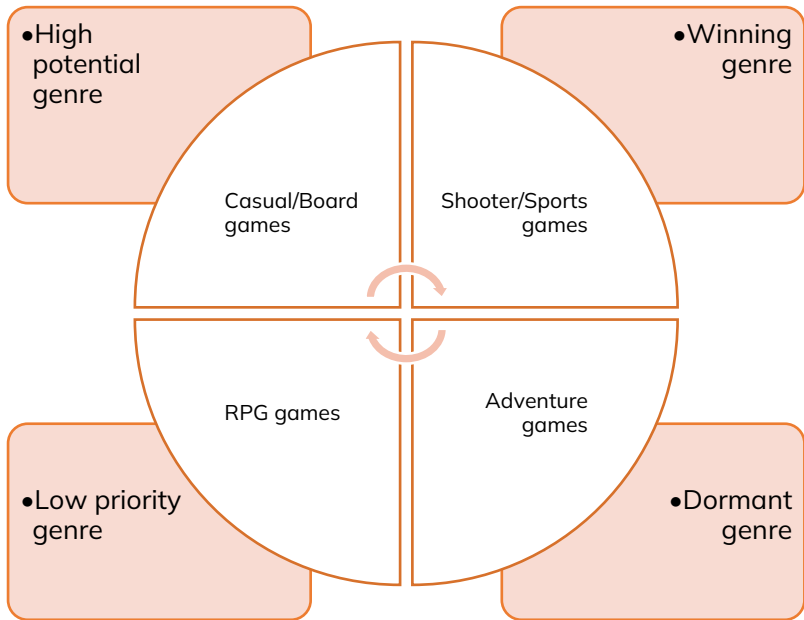
Engagement-driven genres could capture disproportionate value

The Indian Gaming Opportunity Matrix highlights that long-term value creation in the sector will likely remain concentrated in genres that combine high engagement with competitive intensity, particularly shooter and sports formats, as these drive stronger retention, network effects, and monetisation through performance-led in-app purchases rather than purely cosmetic spending.

High-engagement but under-penetrated categories such as casual/board and open-world games offer optionality, but require sharper product innovation and monetisation levers to migrate into the core profit pool.

Conversely, adventure and RPG genres currently face structural challenges in India’s mobile-first ecosystem, where shorter session lengths and social competition dominate user behaviour. For investors, the matrix reinforces that revenue durability in Indian gaming is less about download scale and more about engagement depth translating into monetisation elasticity, with capital best allocated toward formats that embed competitive dynamics and recurring user participation.

Exhibit 262: Indian gaming opportunity matrix



Source: Dentsu report, I-Sec research

Exhibit 263: Gaming sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	- Large population with mobile and internet access: Post-Jio intervention, massive population has smartphones and affordable data, creating largest potential gaming market globally - Strong engagement metrics: PUBG DAU/MAU ratio of 1:3.5 vs. industry standard 1:6, showing high-quality user retention possible in India - Young demographics: Large youth population in Tier 2/3 cities with time and small disposable income - Mobile-first development: Solved hardware barrier; gaming integrated into daily-use device - Growing eSports ecosystem: 20% YoY growth with tournament infrastructure developing (Nodwin INR 5-6bn revenue) - International success of Indian studios: Gameberry, Moonfrog, PlaySimple generating INR 30bn+ combined in international markets
Weakness	- Low willingness to pay for IAP: Indians won't pay for cosmetic items; only PUBG/Free Fire cracked IAP with tactical advantages. ARPDAU for IAP at INR 0.25 vs. international markets significantly higher - No PC/console gaming infrastructure: Globally recognized skill games (Call of Duty, Counter-Strike, Age of Empires) have minimal Indian player base. Barriers: expensive hardware, high-speed internet requirements, game costs, learning curve - Skill vs. luck grey area: Mobile games that are easy to understand inherently appear luck-based even if it is skill-based, results in regulatory challenges - Low advertising ECPM: INR 40 per 1,000 impressions is industry standard in India; limited upside for ad-based monetization - Limited computing capabilities: High-quality processors, high-speed internet not accessible to majority; won't change for 1-2 decades
Opportunity	- RMG comeback with guardrails: During our channel checks, there appears to be a hope around RMG revival with stricter regulatory framework. - eSports growth: 20% YoY growth rate. Tournament ticketing, broadcasting, sponsorships gaining traction. Could potentially include broader RMG-style formats if guidelines written broadly - Audio chat monetization: Yalla Ludo, developed by Dubai-based Yalla Group Limited, is a dominant voice-centric social gaming application primarily focused on the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region. It combines classic board games like Ludo, Domino, and Jackaroo with real-time voice chat. It recorded INR 730bn in revenue, demonstrates massive potential. - International expansion: Indian RMG companies could enter US market where RMG is legal. Currently no one pursuing this strategy - Game studio growth: Room for more studios developing for international markets. Bangalore emerging as hub
Threat	- Offshore platform migration: 20-30% of RMG spending moved to Stake.com, Bet365 via VPN and cryptocurrency (USDT trading at 30% premium). Government loses tax revenue and oversight; no consumer protection - Betting platforms overtaking gaming: If skill-based gaming remains banned while offshore betting thrives, betting culture will likely dominate. It's been observed wherever betting is legal, skill-based online gaming doesn't do well - Audio chat moderation failures: Obscene content risks, data security concerns, national security questions around encrypted audio could lead to crackdown on this emerging monetization avenue - Global competition: PUBG (Krafton - South Korean) and Free Fire (Garena - Singaporean) dominate Indian market. Network effects and quality barriers prevent Indian competitors from gaining share

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways
eSports guidelines clarity

Clarity around the upcoming eSports guidelines will likely be a key monitorable for the sector, as they are expected to define permitted formats, prize money structures, and monetisation avenues such as sponsorship and broadcasting rights. The current framework appears to favour tournament-based, multi-player formats with prize pools while disallowing one-on-one commission-driven structures that formed the core of the earlier RMG model.

Reconsideration on allowing skill-based RMG formats with adequate safeguards

The industry is lobbying for broader rules that could potentially accommodate some skill-based RMG formats within eSports with clear guidelines and strict enforcement to ensure spending limits to prevent excessive losses. The industry is open to mandatory KYC for users who deposit money, but clearer guidance is needed on what level of verification is required and how transactions should be monitored.

Companies in Gaming sector

Dream Sports

Company overview

Dream Sports is a sports entertainment and fantasy sports platform operator, best known for Dream11. Founded in 2008 and headquartered in Mumbai, the company has expanded into broader sports content, engagement, tech, and fan experiences, positioning itself at the convergence of sports and digital technology.

Business model and value proposition

The company builds and operates fantasy sports, fan engagement and sports tech products (e.g., Dream11, FanCode, DreamSetGo). While traditionally driven by paid fantasy contests, recent regulatory changes have shifted the focus toward ad-supported social gaming, content, and experiential offerings, diversifying how fans interact with live sports and digital content.

Exhibit 264: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	67.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(4.8) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Tiger Global, Alpha Wave Global, DST Global, RedBird Capital, D1 Capital, TCV, and Kalaari Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

The company was co-founded by Harsh Jain (CEO and Co-founder) and Bhavit Sheth (COO and Co-founder), both of whom have driven aggressive growth, tech integration and community engagement through fantasy sports and sports tech platforms since inception.



Harsh Jain
Co-Founder, CEO



Bhavit Sheth
Co-Founder, COO

Recent developments

Following the passage of the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025, Dream Sports pivoted Dream11 away from paid real-money contests toward free-to-play, ad-supported social games and complementary fan platforms.

Nazara

Company overview

Nazara Technologies is a Mumbai-based public gaming and interactive entertainment platform with diversified interests across mobile games, eSports, sports media and interactive IPs. It began as an online gaming portal in 1999.

Business model and value proposition

Nazara combines direct game development/ownership, investments in gaming studios, content IP aggregations and esports operations, monetised across in-app purchases, subscription services, licensing and media rights. Its portfolio spans child-friendly games (e.g., World Cricket Championship), esports events and franchise acquisitions.

Exhibit 265: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	16.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.5 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,100
Notable investors	Plutus Wealth Management LLP, SBI Mutual Fund, Nippon Mutual Funds

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by Nitish Mittersain, the company has grown from a single game publisher to a diversified gaming conglomerate with several subsidiaries and acquisitions.



Nitish Mittersain
Founder, CEO

Nodwin

Company overview

Nodwin Gaming is a leading Indian esports and youth digital media company, established to organise competitive gaming events, manage franchises, and build IPs that bridge esports and mainstream entertainment.

Business model and value proposition

The company's model blends live esports events, digital tournament platforms, sponsorship sales, media rights, and IP creation for teams, leagues and content. It serves advertisers, players and communities within India's rapidly growing competitive gaming segment.

Exhibit 266: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.15) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Krafton, Nazara Tech, Sony Group, JetSynthesys

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Nodwin Gaming

Founders and leadership

Akshat Rathee and Gautam Singh Virk co-founded Nodwin Gaming in 2014, building it into one of India's most visible esports organisations with international events and partnerships. Investors have included Nazara Technologies (major shareholder), Krafton and others.



Akshat Rathee
Co-Founder, MD



Gautam Singh Virk
Co-Founder, CEO

PlaySimple

Company overview

PlaySimple is a Bengaluru-based mobile gaming developer focused on free-to-play casual and word games, with global hit titles such as Daily Themed Crossword, Word Trip, Word Jam and WordWars. Founded in 2014, PlaySimple has built a strong worldwide user base.

Business model and value proposition

It operates on a free-to-play model, generating revenue from in-app purchases, advertising and virtual goods, and leverages data-driven design to keep engagement and monetisation high, particularly in global English-language markets.

Exhibit 267: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	6.4 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.2) (FY23)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	450
Notable investors	Elevation Capital and Chiratae Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Reuters

Founders and leadership

Founded by Siddharth Jain, Siddhanth Jain, Preeti Reddy, and Suraj Nalin, the leadership combines experience from Zynga, Walmart Labs and other digital platforms to build engaging, analytics-driven mobile games.



Siddharth Jain
Co-Founder



Siddhanth Jain
Co-Founder



Preeti Reddy
Co-Founder



Suraj Nalin
Co-Founder

Zupee

Company overview

Zupee is a Gurugram-based online gaming platform founded in 2018 that specialises in interactive multiplayer games such as Ludo Supreme, Snakes & Ladders and other casual/social formats, building a large user base across India.

Business model and value proposition

The company's model centres on multiplayer game engagement with social features, driving monetisation through virtual items, ads and in-app engagement mechanics rather than cash-based contests, particularly after regulatory reforms altered the real-money gaming landscape in India.

Exhibit 268: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	11.2 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.5 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	122
Last known valuation (USD mn)	600
Notable investors	Matrix Partners India, Smile Group, Tomales Bay Capital, WestCap, Nepean Capita, Z47, AJ Capital Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Dilsher Singh Malhi** and **Siddhant Saurabh**, Zupee's leadership emphasises casual gaming experiences, product engagement and scalability; its games have amassed hundreds of millions of users globally.



Dilsher Singh Malhi
Founder, CEO



Siddhant Saurabh
Co-Founder

Recent developments

Following the Online Gaming Bill, 2025, Zupee discontinued real-money contests and refocused on free-to-play multiplayer titles while maintaining strong user engagement and adjusting its business to comply with the new regulatory framework for online gaming in India.

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Chapter 18: Deep dive into Online Classifieds

Online Classifieds – sector overview

The online classifieds market is segmented into various types, including Real Estate, Automotive, Jobs, Services, Electronics, Fashion, Home and Furniture, Education and Learning, and Others

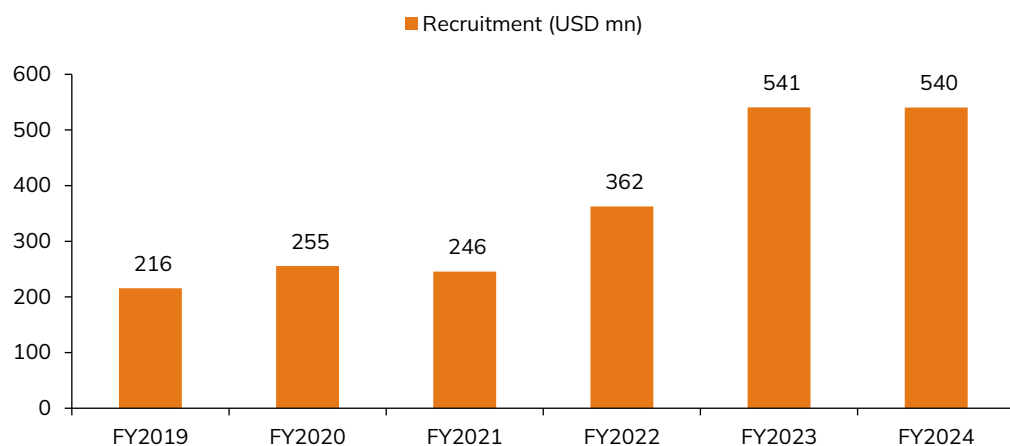
The India online classifieds market is characterized by a dynamic mix of regional and international players. Leading participants such as OLX India, Quikr, Sulekha, MagicBricks, 99acres, CarDekho, Housing.com, NoBroker, Justdial, IndiaMART, Snapdeal, Flipkart, Amazon India, and Facebook Marketplace,

Classified recruitment

India's online recruitment classified sector is one of the largest and most scalable segments within the digital classifieds ecosystem. The industry transitioned from print job listings and placement agencies to online job portals in the early 2000s and is now evolving toward AI-led talent matching and hiring solutions. Unlike matrimony, recruitment is a recurring and economically linked category, making it more cyclical but structurally larger in size.

The market size is estimated at ~USD 540mn (INR 48bn) for organized online job portals, with mid-to-high single digit growth over cycles (as per our estimates). Growth tends to accelerate during periods of strong corporate hiring and moderate sharply during macro slowdowns. Historically, Tech, IT and BPM segments have been the largest contributors, given higher hiring intensity and digital adoption. However, recent traction is visible in GCCs (Global Capability Centres) and other sectors such as BFSI, infrastructure and manufacturing,

Exhibit 269: Recruitment classifieds – market size



Source: I-Sec research

While the market has traditionally been dominated by white-collar hiring, structural growth is also visible in blue- and grey-collar roles, particularly across logistics, e-commerce, retail, and gig-linked segments. This shift reflects increasing formalisation of frontline hiring and higher worker mobility post-pandemic.

Emerging blue-collar focused platforms such as Jobhai are scaling rapidly, benefiting from gig economy expansion and SME hiring digitisation.

Within segments, white-collar / corporate hiring platforms (e.g., Naukri, LinkedIn, Indeed) operate largely on enterprise subscription models, generating higher ARPU through job postings, database access, and bundled recruitment tools. These models benefit from sticky client contracts and renewal rates.

In contrast, blue-collar and gig hiring platforms operate at significantly lower ARPU per listing but benefit from large volumes, faster job cycles, and structural growth in informal-to-formal transitions. Local / hyperlocal classifieds typically exhibit low monetisation intensity but provide wide reach for entry-level and neighbourhood hiring.

Market Structure

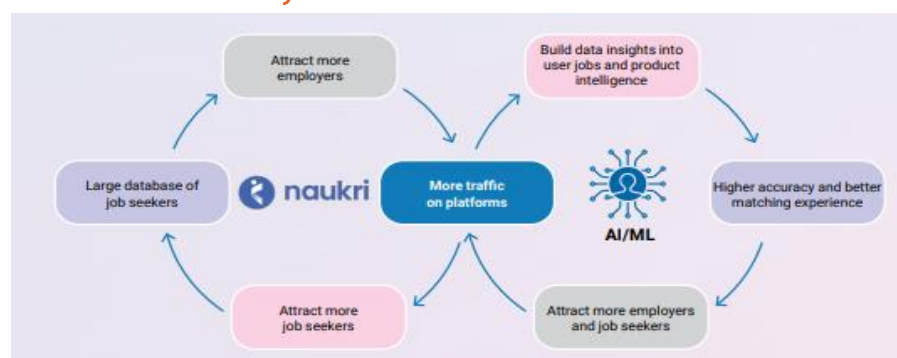
The market is highly concentrated, led by Naukri.com (part of Info Edge), followed by LinkedIn, Indeed and Monster India. Market leadership is driven by resume database depth, recruiter relationships, brand recall, and technology capabilities.

Naukri.com, owned by Info Edge, dominates the organized online recruitment classifieds space with an estimated ~40-45% market share in paid listings, supported by its extensive CV database (Resdex), long-standing enterprise relationships, and strong brand recall. Revenue growth remains cyclical and correlated with macro hiring sentiment, particularly in IT and mid-market white-collar roles.

The online recruitment classified sector in India primarily operates on a B2B monetisation model, wherein employers and recruiters pay to access talent databases, post job listings, and use hiring solutions. At a broad industry level, revenue streams in online classifieds typically include subscription-based database access, pay-per-listing fees, employer branding solutions, targeted advertising, and increasingly, AI-enabled recruitment tools and analytics. Unlike consumer internet models that rely heavily on advertising, recruitment classifieds derive the majority of their revenue directly from enterprise clients, making monetisation more predictable but cyclical with hiring trends.

Naukri.com follows a predominantly subscription-led model. Its core revenue driver is recruiter access to its searchable resume database, typically sold through annual or multi-month packages with defined download limits and user licenses. Additional revenue comes from paid job listings, premium placement options, and employer branding services such as targeted mailers and display visibility. Over time, the platform has layered value-added offerings, including AI-driven resume matching and hiring workflow tools, which enhance monetisation and increase client stickiness. The model benefits from strong renewal rates due to the depth of its database and embedded recruiter relationships.

Exhibit 270: Naukri Flywheel



Source: Company data, I-Sec research

By contrast, LinkedIn monetises recruitment in India as part of a broader multi-vertical ecosystem. Its Talent Solutions segment includes recruiter licenses, sponsored job postings, and InMail credits, typically positioned at a premium and targeted toward large corporates and multinational firms. In addition to recruitment revenue, LinkedIn generates income from marketing solutions (advertising and sponsored content) and premium subscriptions, making its business model more diversified compared to pure-play job portals.

Overall, the recruitment classified industry generates revenue through recurring enterprise subscriptions, transaction-based job postings, branding solutions, and technology-led add-ons. Revenue growth is closely linked to corporate hiring cycles, sectoral demand (IT, GCCs, BFSI, manufacturing), and increasing formalisation of the workforce. While cyclical nature remains a structural feature, the subscription-heavy revenue mix provides visibility and operating leverage during hiring upcycles.

Cost structures are largely driven by employee expenses (sales teams and product development), marketing, and technology investments. Scaled leaders typically generate EBITDA margins in the 35–45% range during strong hiring cycles, supported by operating leverage and high incremental margins on database subscriptions. Capital intensity remains low, and cash generation is strong in upcycles.

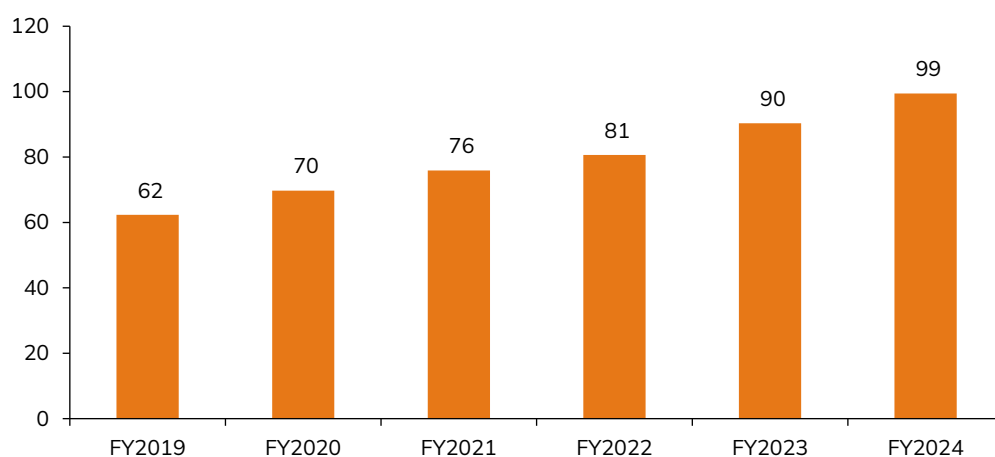
Recent trends include AI-powered candidate matching, recruiter automation tools, skill-based hiring filters, and data analytics integration. Platforms are increasingly embedding generative AI tools to enhance resume screening, job recommendations, and recruiter productivity. Additionally, there is rising traction in tier 2/3 hiring markets and increased hiring by Global Capability Centers (GCCs).

Classified matrimony

India's online matrimony classified sector is a niche segment within the broader digital classifieds ecosystem. The industry has evolved from traditional newspaper matrimonial ads and community brokers to organized digital platforms offering searchable databases, algorithm-driven matching, and assisted services. Despite rising urbanisation and changing social norms, arranged marriages continue to account for a significant share of marriages in India, supporting the relevance of matrimony platforms.

As per our estimates, the market size is estimated at a ~USD 100mn (INR 8–9bn) and has historically grown at mid-single digit rates, with growth moderating during periods of weak consumer sentiment.

Exhibit 271: Online matrimony classified revenue (USD mn)



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Unlike recruitment or real estate classifieds, matrimony is a lifecycle-driven category, where users typically subscribe for a limited duration until marriage. Revenue is largely subscription-based, with packages ranging from three to twelve months, supplemented by premium add-ons such as assisted matchmaking and profile visibility enhancements.

The market structure is oligopolistic, with Matrimony.com (BharatMatrimony), Shaadi.com, and Jeevansathi.com accounting for the majority of organized market share.

Competitive differentiation is driven by brand trust, scale of active profiles, regional and community segmentation, and service quality.

Demand drivers include growth in the marriageable age population (24–35 years), rising internet penetration in Tier-2/3 cities, increasing female workforce participation, and growing acceptance of online partner discovery. While metro markets are relatively mature, incremental growth is increasingly coming from non-metro regions. Assisted matchmaking services are gaining traction among higher-income and time-constrained users, supporting ARPU expansion.

Cost structures are dominated by marketing expenses (both digital and traditional media), employee costs for relationship managers, and technology investments. At scale, leading player (Matrimony.com) typically operate at EBITDA margins of 15–20%, supported by low capital intensity and strong cash conversion.

Exhibit 272: SWOT Analysis of online classified sector

SWOT	Comments
Strength	Asset-Light Scalability: High-margin unit economics improve rapidly with scale as platforms rely on listing fees rather than inventory ownership, requiring minimal incremental capex.
	Expanding User Base: Rapid internet penetration, particularly in rural India, provides massive category depth and a growing pool of buyers and sellers across all tiers.
	Value-Added Monetisation: A shift toward "full-stack" services, like inspections, financing, and escrow, increases ARPU and creates premium revenue streams beyond traditional ads.
Weakness	Trust and Fraud Gaps: Persistent issues with scams, fake listings, and duplicate content damage user trust and necessitate heavy spending on moderation and customer support.
	High Compliance Costs: Scaling safely requires constant investment in AI moderation, KYC flows, and legal compliance, which could lead to volatile margins in high-risk verticals.
	Low Tier-2/3 Liquidity: Smaller markets often suffer from lower transaction density and higher trust deficits, requiring expensive localization and operational "trust marks" to convert.
Opportunity	Transaction Integration: Moving from lead generation to completed transactions in high-ticket categories like autos and real estate multiplies the monetization potential per listing.
	Ancillary Service Uplift: Offering seller analytics, insurance, and instant buyback tools provides clear ARPU growth, particularly for high-value goods.
	Vernacular and Rural Expansion: Tailored products and trust programs for regional language users could unlock massive, previously unreachable supply and demand cohorts.
Threat	Regulatory Crackdowns: Heightened scrutiny from consumer protection authorities regarding scams or deceptive UI could result in heavy fines and mandatory, costly product changes.
	Vertical Competition: Specialist players in the used-car and real-estate sectors are encroaching on high-value categories, driving up acquisition costs and squeezing margins.
	Macro Ad Sensitivity: A heavy reliance on ad-driven revenue makes the sector vulnerable to budget cuts during economic slowdowns before transaction-led models fully mature.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- **Verification and liability:** Publishing clear guidance that distinguishes verification and liability requirements by category (Jobs, Real Estate, Autos) could help platforms design proportionate controls, preventing over-restrictive measures that harm user experience.
- **Digital verification architecture:** A government-endorsed, privacy-preserving verification API for high-risk categories—including real estate, high-value autos, and verified employers—could reduce fraud and moderation costs while protecting user data.
- **Standardised fraud escalation:** Creating secure, standardized channels for platforms to escalate suspected fraud to local law enforcement could discourage repeat offenders and shorten resolution times for victims.
- **Formalisation incentives:** GST rationalisation or certification support for 'certified pre-owned' programs could migrate more transactions onto formal rails (invoices, escrow, warranties), unlocking higher ARPU and consumer protection.
- **High-trust seller certification:** A government-backed, periodically renewed certification for high-trust sellers could increase buyer confidence in non-metro markets, reducing friction for platforms expanding vernacular and rural reach.

Companies in Online Classifieds

Apna

Company overview

Apna is a professional networking and job discovery platform connecting blue-, grey- and entry-level workers with employers via a mobile-first, community-driven ecosystem, enabling hiring, upskilling and professional identity creation.

Business model and value proposition

Operates a B2B2C recruitment and networking model, generating revenue from employer job postings, hiring solutions and AI-driven talent matching while offering free access to job seekers.

Exhibit 273: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.5) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	194
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,100
Notable investors	Peak XV Partners, Lightspeed India Partners, Insight Partners, Tiger Global Management, GSV Ventures, Owl Ventures, Sequoia Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Forbes India

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2019 by Nimit Parikh (Founder and Group CEO), a Stanford MBA and former Apple and Intel product/operations leader who returned to India to build digital job solutions for underserved workers.



Nimit Parikh
Founder, Group CEO

Info Edge

Company overview

Info Edge is a public internet technology holding company that owns and operates leading online classifieds and portals such as Naukri.com, 99Acres.com, Jeevansathi.com and educates with Shiksha.com.

Business model and value proposition

Runs a subscription- and advertising-driven classifieds ecosystem with strong cash flows from paid listings, SaaS tools and strategic early-stage investments via Info Edge Ventures.

Exhibit 274: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	28.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	13.1 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	7,200
Notable investors	Nalanda, Government of Singapore, LIC, Axis MF, UTI MF, ICICI pru MF

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded in 1995 by Sanjeev Bikhchandani, an IIM Ahmedabad alumnus and Padma Shri awardee, who built Naukri.com into India's leading jobs portal and expanded the portfolio into real estate, matrimonial and Ed-tech verticals.



Sanjeev Bikhchandani
Founder

Matrimony.com

Company overview

Matrimony.com operates BharatMatrimony, EliteMatrimony and related matchmaking platforms, facilitating arranged and personal matchmaking services with deep penetration across India's diverse demographic segments.

Business model and value proposition

A subscription and service-fee based matchmaking model with revenue from paid memberships, premium matchmaking, personalised services, and ancillaries such as wedding planning.

Exhibit 275: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.5 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	100
Notable investors	Nalanda India Equity Fund Limited, MIT Investment Management Company (MITIMCo), Icici Prudential

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by Murugavel Janakiraman in 1997; Murugavel is a pioneer in India's digital matrimony sector with strong product focus on cultural matchmaking workflows and high-engagement retention metrics.



Murugavel Janakiraman
Founder, CEO

Shaadi.com

Company overview

Shaadi.com is one of the earliest online matrimonial platforms globally, connecting millions of users seeking life partners through online profiles, matchmaking and personalised services.

Business model and value proposition

Generates revenue from premium membership plans, profile boosts, matchmaking services and related offerings, with strong network effects and high repeat usage.

Exhibit 276: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	NA

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded by Anupam Mittal, an Indian entrepreneur and angel investor, whose vision made Shaadi.com a household brand. Apart from starting Shaadi.com, he has also been a prominent investor in Shark Tank.

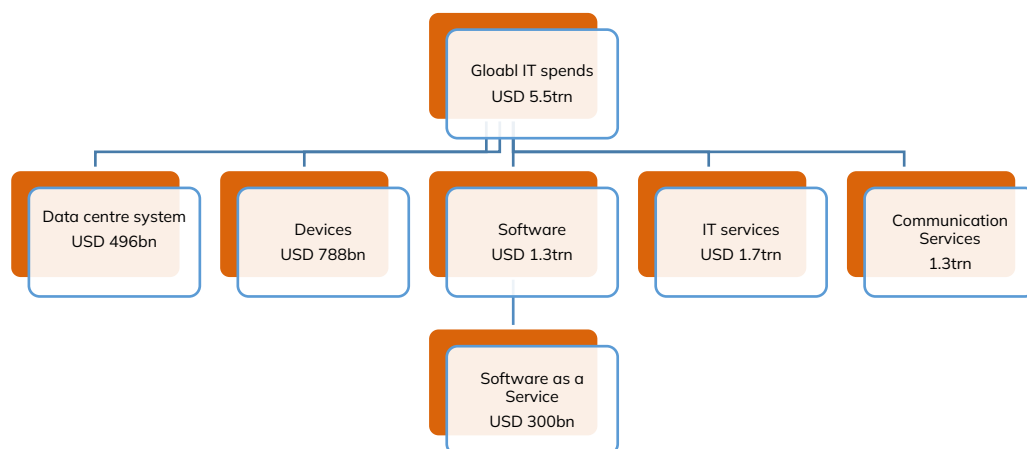


Anupam Mittal
Founder

Chapter 19: Deep dive into Enterprise Tech/Saas

Enterprise Tech/SaaS sector overview

Exhibit 277: Total global IT Spends

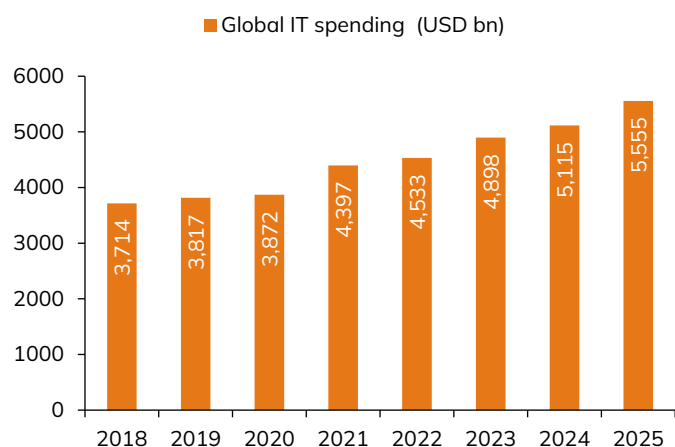


Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Total global technology spending is estimated at ~USD 5.5trn in 2025, covering data centre system, Devices, Software, IT services and communication services, as per our channel checks. Technology has become mission-critical across industries, and IT budgets typically account for 3–6% of revenue in traditional industries and 8–15% in digital-first sectors such as BFSI, e-commerce, and SaaS-native businesses.

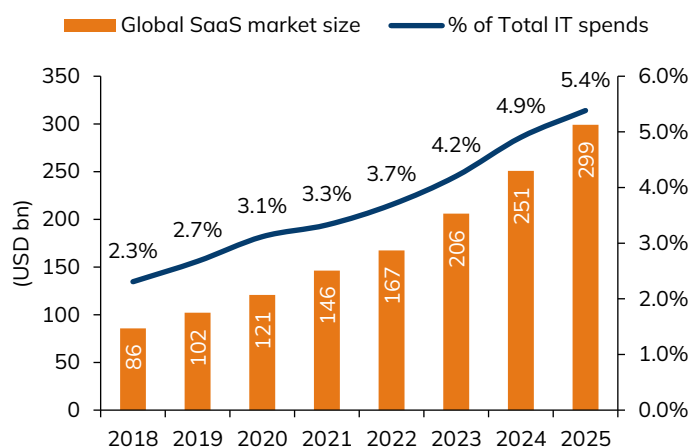
Within this, Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) accounts for ~5.4% of global technology spending, translating into a market size of roughly USD 300bn.

Exhibit 278: Global tech spends



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 279: Global SaaS market size

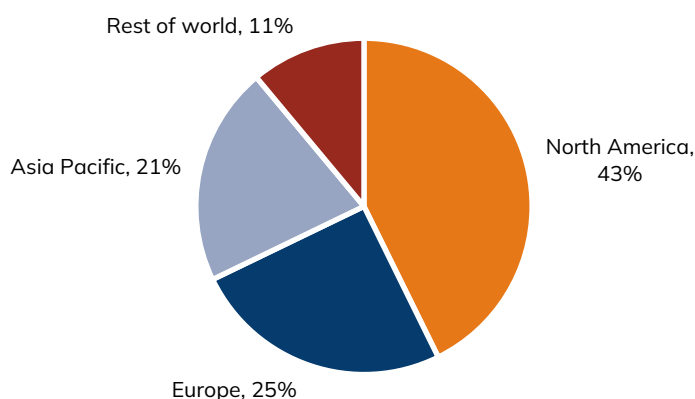


Source: I-Sec research, Company data

North America accounts for ~40–45% of global SaaS expenditure, driven primarily by the US. Europe contributes around 20–25%, supported by strong enterprise IT budgets and ongoing manufacturing digitisation.

Asia-Pacific represents about 20–21% and is the fastest-growing region, with China, India, and Japan driving incremental demand. The rest of the world, including Latin America, the Middle East, and Africa, accounts for the remaining 5–10%.

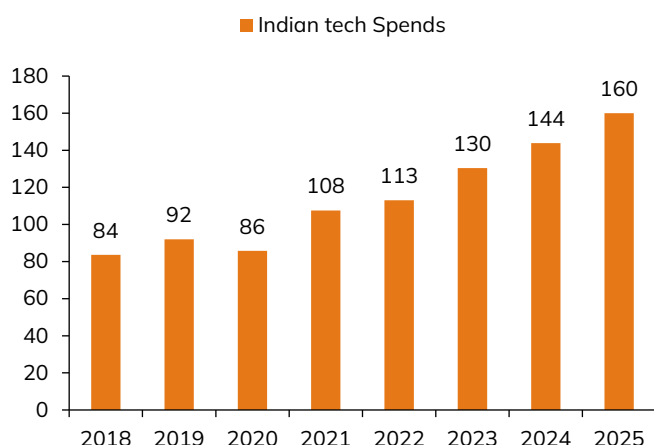
Exhibit 280: North America and Europe currently dominate the SaaS space



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

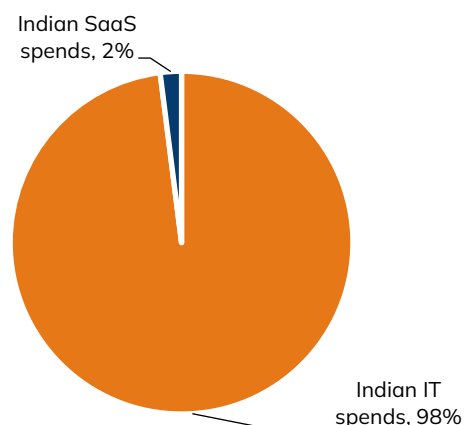
India's total technology spending is estimated at ~USD 160bn annually. Although India's IT spending as a percentage of GDP remains below developed markets, it is expanding rapidly due to digitisation across BFSI, telecom, retail, startups, and government initiatives such as India Stack and UPI.

Exhibit 281: Indian tech spends



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Exhibit 282: Indian SaaS spends is 2% of total tech spends

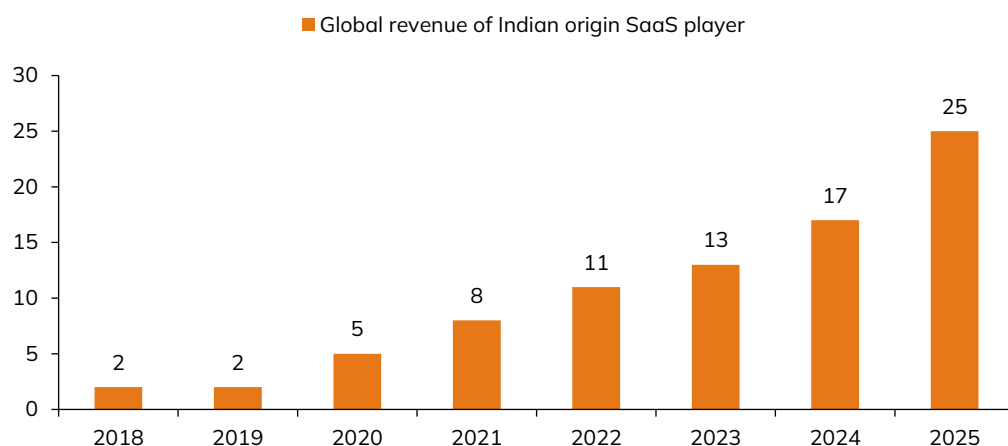


Source: I-Sec research, Company data

Within total tech spends, India's domestic enterprise SaaS spends remains at USD 3bn annually (2% of total Indian IT spends). Within domestic SaaS expenses, multinational vendors such as Microsoft, Salesforce, and SAP command nearly 60–70% market share, particularly in large enterprise deals.

India remains a challenging domestic SaaS market. Lower labour costs reduce the immediate ROI from automation compared to Western markets where labour is expensive. Currency dynamics also play a role, as export revenues benefit from USD billing while domestic contracts are INR-based and often lower in value. Additionally, enterprise sales cycles in India typically range from 6–12 months, with procurement complexity and pricing sensitivity extending deal closures.

Exhibit 283: Indian origin SaaS companies' global revenue (USD bn)



Source: I-Sec research, Company data

In CY25, Indian-origin SaaS companies generate ~USD 20–25bn in global revenue, reflecting a strong export-led orientation. Indian origin SaaS companies are company building cloud software in India. This includes companies selling primarily to Indian customers, such as Perfios and Darwinbox, and companies selling primarily to global customers which include names such as Freshworks, Zoho and more

Indian SaaS companies are comparatively stronger in SMB and mid-market segments and have built globally competitive businesses focused on exports. Structurally, India's SaaS opportunity resembles the IT services wave of the 2000s, but is product-led rather than labour-arbitrage-led, enabling higher long-term margin potential.

SaaS revenue and cost structure models

Enterprise SaaS companies operate asset-light, subscription-driven revenue models. Most follow an annual subscription structure, where pricing is based on per-user, per-seat, or per-module formats, and revenue visibility is tracked through Annual Contract Value (ACV) and Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR).

Multi-year contracts and upselling additional modules or higher usage tiers drive revenue expansion. Some SaaS models follow usage- or API-based pricing, where customers pay per transaction or API call, causing revenue to scale with usage volumes. Hybrid models that combine base subscriptions with usage-based overage fees are increasingly common.

From a cost structure perspective, SaaS businesses operate with high gross margins but require significant upfront investment. Cost of revenue typically accounts for 20–30% of sales and includes cloud hosting (AWS, Azure, GCP), infrastructure, and customer support, resulting in gross margins of 70–85%, materially higher than IT services.

Sales and marketing are the largest expense during growth phases, often 25–50% of revenue, reflecting high customer acquisition costs but supported by strong lifetime value in enterprise models.

Research and development accounts for 15–25%, covering engineering talent and continuous product innovation, while general and administrative expenses remain relatively lean at 5–10%.

As SaaS companies scale and operating leverage kicks in, mature players could achieve EBITDA margins of 25–35%, free cash flow margins of 20–30%, and maintain net revenue retention of 110–130%, driven by upselling, cross-selling, and pricing power.

AI impacts on SaaS

AI is reshaping the SaaS landscape, but its impact will likely vary significantly across categories. SaaS platforms that function as Systems of Record such as ERP, CRM, HRMS, or financial accounting software are likely to remain structurally resilient because they store mission-critical, structured enterprise data and are deeply embedded in workflows. These platforms benefit from high switching costs, compliance requirements, and proprietary data moats, making them difficult to displace even as AI enhances automation within them.

Similarly, SaaS solutions that act as integration or workflow layers, connecting multiple systems and orchestrating data across platforms, are also well positioned. As enterprises deploy multiple AI tools, data fragmentation increases, making integration, governance, and interoperability even more critical.

However, Systems of Reference tools used occasionally for lookup, dashboards, reporting, or secondary insights face a higher risk of disruption. If their core value lies in surfacing information rather than owning primary data or controlling workflows, AI agents can increasingly replicate that functionality directly through conversational interfaces or embedded analytics within Systems of Record. Over time, standalone reference platforms with limited proprietary data or shallow workflow integration may vanish or get absorbed into broader platforms. Ultimately, durable SaaS value will likely concentrate around companies that either control core enterprise data or sit at the intersection of multiple systems, embedding AI into operational decision-making rather than offering isolated, reference-based features.

Exhibit 284: Enterprise SaaS sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	Cost and currency arbitrage: Lower engineering costs and a dollar-denominated revenue base provide a structural margin advantage and a natural hedge against the INR.
	Modern tech stacks: Cloud-native, API-first architectures allow Indian firms to avoid legacy technical debt, ensuring greater agility and easier global integration.
	Vertical specialisation: Expertise in high-growth niches like travel and hospitality allows firms to capture rising infrastructure demand across global and Asian markets.
Weakness	Market concentration: Heavy reliance on the US market creates significant exposure to developed-world economic cycles and geopolitical shifts.
	Slow domestic adoption: Prolonged government procurement cycles and lagging domestic enterprise digitisation strain working capital and slow local scalability.
	Specialised talent gap: A mismatch between traditional education and the high-end skills needed for AI and data engineering creates a potential innovation bottleneck.
Opportunity	AI-driven differentiation: Integrating AI into workflows enhances pricing power, while domestic compute initiatives could reduce reliance on foreign infrastructure.
	Regional ecosystem growth: The explosion of digital infrastructure in Asia offers a massive export runway for vertical-specific SaaS solutions.
	Strategic consolidation: Acquiring niche global players and migrating their operations to India's cost-efficient base could rapidly scale footprint and profitability.
	Regulatory compliance: Tightening global data and governance norms creates high demand for specialized compliance-led software and cybersecurity tools.
Threat	Policy and data uncertainty: Ambiguous cross-border data transfer rules and shifting privacy frameworks create execution risks for global data handling.
	Macro and geopolitical sensitivity: Vertical-specific demand (e.g., travel) is highly vulnerable to global conflicts and sudden shifts in enterprise tech spending.
	Competitive compression: Aggressive pricing and deeper capital pools of global SaaS giants heighten customer acquisition costs and pressure independent margins.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- Digital infrastructure and ai compute expansion:** India's data centre and high-performance compute infrastructure lags global peers. While recent budget announcements have indicated incentives for data centres and AI compute facilities, tangible near-term implementation remains limited. Accelerated rollout of AI compute clusters and cloud infrastructure incentives would augment India's ability to compete in AI-driven SaaS innovation over the next 3–5 years.
- Clarity on data protection and cross-border policies:** Clear, stable and predictable data protection regulations are critical. Uncertainty around evolving data protection frameworks and cross-border data flow norms discourage long-term infrastructure commitments. A transparent regulatory roadmap with defined compliance timelines could reduce investment risk and lift global customer confidence.
- R&D tax incentives and innovation credits:** Historically, software firms benefited from stronger tax incentives for R&D. Over the past decade, many of these benefits have reduced. Reinstating or enhancing R&D tax credits—especially for AI and deep-tech development—could encourage higher domestic product innovation. Expanded thresholds and broader eligibility could stimulate sector-wide investment.
- Skilling and education reform for AI and SaaS:** A structured national program focused on AI, cloud engineering, cybersecurity, and SaaS product management would bridge the skill gap. Public-private partnerships between industry and academia could modernise curriculum and create a workforce aligned with next-generation software demands.
- Public procurement reform:** Streamlining procurement processes, introducing faster vendor onboarding mechanisms, and creating SaaS-specific procurement frameworks could simplify and shorten Government adoption cycles. Given that government and PSU spending constitutes around ~10% of sector opportunity, reducing sales cycle friction could materially improve growth visibility.

Companies in Enterprise Tech/SaaS

Atlan

Company overview

Atlan is a modern data collaboration and metadata management platform designed to help data teams discover, govern and trust enterprise data assets. Founded in 2018, Atlan positions itself as a 'collaboration layer for data teams' integrating deeply with data warehouses, BI tools and cloud ecosystems to address data sprawl in large organisations.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a B2B SaaS, enterprise subscription model, selling annual and multi-year contracts to mid-to-large enterprises. Pricing is typically based on users, scale of data assets and enterprise deployment size, with strong expansion revenue driven by wider adoption across analytics, governance and engineering teams.

Exhibit 285: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.2 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.1 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	206
Last known valuation (USD mn)	750
Notable investors	WaterBridge Ventures, 500 Startups, Insight Partners, Peak XV Partners, Salesforce Ventures, Meritech Capital Partners, GIC

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Atlan

Founders and leadership

Founded by Prukalpa Sankar and Varun Banka - The founders previously worked on large-scale data problems in governance and public-sector data infrastructure.



Prukalpa Sankar
Co-Founder, Co-CEO

Varun Banka
Co-Founder, Co-CEO

BetterPlace

Company overview

BetterPlace is a Human Capital SaaS platform, providing a full-suite HRMS for managing the entire lifecycle of frontline workers, from hiring, onboarding, payroll, and background verification to upskilling, insurance, and credit solutions, empowering both enterprises and the informal workforce through a unified technology platform across India, APAC, and GCC regions.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2B SaaS + transaction-led model, combining subscription revenues with usage-based fees for services such as background verification, identity checks, compliance filings and workforce documentation. By leveraging data, automation and integrations with government and verification databases, it enables enterprises to hire faster, ensure regulatory compliance, lower attrition risk and improve workforce productivity, while achieving high switching costs and recurring revenue visibility.

Exhibit 286: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.3 (FY23)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.3) (FY23)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	94
Last known valuation (USD mn)	250
Notable investors	Jungle Ventures, 3one4 Capital, CX Partners, Unitus Ventures, British International Investment (BII), Macquarie Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

BetterPlace was founded by Pravin Agarwala and Saurabh Tandon. Agarwala identified the large gap in digitisation in India's blue-collar labour ecosystem and built BetterPlace with a compliance-first, enterprise-grade mindset, rather than a consumer HR tech approach.



Pravin Agarwala
Co-Founder, CEO



Saurabh Tandon
Co-Founder, COO

BrowserStack

Company overview

BrowserStack is a global cloud-based testing platform that enables developers to test websites and mobile apps across thousands of real devices and browsers. Founded in 2011, it is one of India's most successful global SaaS exports, serving enterprises and developers worldwide.

Business model and value proposition

BrowserStack operates a pure-play global SaaS subscription model, with pricing tiers based on usage, devices, parallel testing and enterprise features. High gross margins, strong renewals and developer-led adoption have demonstrated predictable recurring revenue.

Exhibit 287: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	6.8 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.3 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	250
Last known valuation (USD mn)	4,000 (2021)
Notable investors	BOND (Bond Capital), Insight Partners, Accel

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, BrowserStack

Founders and leadership

Founded by Ritesh Arora and Nakul Aggarwal, both engineers with backgrounds in software development. The founders bootstrapped BrowserStack for several years before raising external capital.



Ritesh Arora
Co-Founder, CEO



Nakul Aggarwal
Co-Founder, CTO

Darwinbox

Company overview

Darwinbox is a cloud-native HRMS platform serving mid-to-large enterprises across Asia, the Middle East and global markets. Founded in 2015, Darwinbox provides end-to-end HR solutions covering recruitment, payroll, performance and employee engagement.

Business model and value proposition

Darwinbox follows an enterprise SaaS subscription model, typically sold via multi-year contracts priced per employee. Expansion revenue comes from cross-selling modules and geographic rollouts within large organisations.

Exhibit 288: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	290
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	Partners Group, KKR, Lightspeed India Partners, Peak XV Partners, Salesforce Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, VC Circle

Founders and leadership

Founded by Jayant Paleti, Rohit Chennamaneni, Chaitanya Peddi, Vineet Singh. The leadership brings deep understanding of enterprise workflows and change management. Their background has helped Darwinbox win large and complex enterprise accounts.



Jayant Paleti
Co-Founder



Rohit Chennamaneni
Co-Founder



Vineet Singh
Co-Founder



Chaitanya Peddi
Co-Founder

Druva

Company overview

Druva is a cloud-native data protection and security company offering backup, disaster recovery and ransomware protection solutions. Founded in 2008, Druva was among the earliest Indian startups to build exclusively for the cloud.

Business model and value proposition

Druva operates a subscription-based SaaS model, pricing based on data volumes, workloads and enterprise usage. The platform benefits from long customer lifecycles, high switching costs and compliance-driven demand.

Exhibit 289: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	475
Last known valuation (USD mn)	2,100
Notable investors	Caisse de dépôt et placement du Québec (CDPQ), Neuberger Berman, Atreides Management, Viking Global Investors, Riverwood Capital, Hercules Capital, Peak XV Partners, EDBI

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, CNBC

Founders and leadership

Founded by Jaspreet Singh, along with Co-Founders Milind Borate. Druva's leadership combines deep storage, security and enterprise software expertise. Singh has guided Druva through multiple global expansion phases.



Jaspreet Singh
Founder, CEO



Milind Borate
Co-Founder, CDO

Exotel

Company overview

An AI-powered cloud communication and customer engagement platform with tools including voice, chat, and other channels, acting as a virtual telecom operator with features like IVRs, call recording, omnichannel contact centres, and conversational AI for automation.

Business model and value proposition

It follows a usage-based SaaS + CPaaS model, earning revenue from call minutes, messaging volumes and enterprise subscriptions. The model benefits from recurring usage and deep integration into customer operations.

Exhibit 290: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.9 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.2 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	100
Last known valuation (USD mn)	400 (2022)
Notable investors	Steadview Capital, IIFL Asset Management, A91 Partners, Blume Ventures, Mumbai Angels

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

The company was founded by Shivakumar Ganesan and Sachin Bhatia in 2011. The founders built Exotel with a strong engineering and reliability focus, enabling it to serve mission-critical enterprise use cases.



Shivakumar Ganesan
Co-Founder, CEO



Sachin Bhatia
Co-Founder, CGO

Recent developments

In FY25, Exotel expanded **WhatsApp, omnichannel and automation capabilities**, while increasing focus on regulated industries like BFSI and healthcare.

Gupshup

Company overview

Gupshup is a global conversational messaging and CPaaS platform, enabling businesses to engage customers across WhatsApp, SMS, RCS and other messaging channels. Originally founded as an early social platform, Gupshup pivoted successfully into enterprise messaging.

Business model and value proposition

Gupshup operates a usage-based CPaaS model, monetising through message volumes, chatbot tools, automation and enterprise APIs. Scale, global reach and platform stickiness drive revenue growth. Roughly 75% of revenue from India, with operations in MEA, APAC, LATAM, EU, and US.

Exhibit 291: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	19.4 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.3 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	278
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Fidelity Investments, Think Investments, Malabar Investments, Neuberger Berman, Globespan Capital Partners, and EvolutionX Debt Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

The primary founders of Gupshup are Beerud Sheth, who currently serves as the Chief Executive Officer, and Rakesh Mathur, who serves as the Chairman. Both of them are alumni of IIT Bombay. Gupshup's leadership combines deep internet history with enterprise SaaS execution. Sheth previously founded Elance (merged into Upwork), adding global credibility.



Beerud Sheth
Co-Founder, CEO



Rakesh Mathur
Co-Founder

Hackerrank

Company overview

HackerRank is a global developer skills assessment and technical hiring platform used by enterprises to evaluate, interview and upskill software engineers. Founded in 2012, it has become a core part of hiring workflows for tech and non-tech companies alike, helping standardise technical assessments at scale.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2B SaaS subscription model, selling annual contracts to enterprises based on number of candidates assessed, interview usage and advanced analytics modules. The platform benefits from strong renewal rates, embedded usage within hiring teams and growing demand for remote, skills-based hiring.

Exhibit 292: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	115
Last known valuation (USD mn)	500
Notable investors	Susquehanna Growth Equity, JMI Equity, Khosla Ventures, Recruit Holdings, Randstad Innovation Fund

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TechCrunch

Founders and leadership

Founded by Vivek Ravisankar and Harishankaran Karunanidhi, both with engineering backgrounds. The founders built HackerRank by deeply understanding developer communities and enterprise hiring pain points. Vivek Ravisankar (CEO) has led the company's transition from a competitive programming platform to a full-stack enterprise hiring solution.



Vivek Ravisankar
Co-Founder, CEO



Harishankaran Karunanidhi
Co-Founder, CTO

Icertis

Company overview

Icertis is a global leader in Contract Lifecycle Management (CLM) software, serving large enterprises across industries such as technology, manufacturing, healthcare and BFSI. Founded in 2009, Icertis has built a category-defining platform for managing complex, high-value contracts.

Business model and value proposition

Icertis operates a high-ticket enterprise SaaS model, selling multi-year contracts priced on contract volume, users and AI modules. The business benefits from long sales cycles but extremely sticky deployments and strong expansion revenue.

Exhibit 293: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	8.7 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.9 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	566
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	B Capital Group, Greycroft, PremjiInvest, Meritech Capital Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by Samir Bodas and Monish Darda, the leadership brings deep experience in enterprise software, consulting and global sales. Samir Bodas has been central to positioning Icertis as the default CLM partner for Fortune 500 companies.



Samir Bodas
Co-Founder, Exe. Chairman



Monish Darda
Co-Founder

Lambdatest (TestMu AI)

Company overview

LambdaTest is a global cloud-based cross-browser and mobile testing platform, enabling developers to test web and mobile applications across thousands of browsers and devices. Founded in 2017, LambdaTest has rapidly scaled among mid-market and enterprise customers.

Business model and value proposition

LambdaTest follows a global SaaS subscription model, pricing based on testing minutes, parallel sessions and enterprise features. The company benefits from product-led growth, developer adoption and strong upsell into enterprise plans.

Exhibit 294: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.7 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.18 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	108
Last known valuation (USD mn)	400
Notable investors	PremjiInvest, Blume Ventures, Leo Capital Holdings, Telstra Ventures, Wamda Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by Asad Khan, Jay Singh, Mayank Bhola and Mudit Singh. The leadership brings hands-on experience in software testing and developer tooling. Their focus on ease of use, speed and customer support has helped LambdaTest compete effectively with larger incumbents.



Asad Khan
Co-Founder, CEO



Jay Singh
Co-Founder, Chief
Customer Officer



Mayank Bhola
Co-Founder, Head of
Products



Mudit Singh
Co-Founder, Head of
Growth

LeadSquared

Company overview

An AI-powered platform that combines sales CRM, marketing automation, and field force automation to help businesses manage leads, streamline sales, and boost efficiency, especially for high-volume companies in sectors like Ed-tech, Healthcare, and BFSI. Founded in 2011, LeadSquared focuses on converting leads into revenue at scale.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2B SaaS subscription model, priced per user and module, with additional revenue from onboarding and integrations. Its vertical-focused approach enables faster adoption and strong customer retention.

Exhibit 295: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.89) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	205
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	WestBridge Capital, International Finance Corporation, Gaja Capital, Jyoti Bansal, Stakeboat Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Lead Squared

Founders and leadership

Founded by Nilesh Patel and Prashant Singh. The leadership combines enterprise software execution with deep understanding of India-centric sales workflows. Prashant Singh has driven LeadSquared's steady, capital-efficient growth.



Nilesh Patel
Co-Founder, CEO



Prashant Singh
Co-Founder, COO

MapmyIndia

Company overview

MapmyIndia is India's leading digital mapping, geospatial and navigation technology company, serving automotive OEMs, governments and enterprises. Founded in 1995, it has built proprietary mapping data for India, a critical strategic asset.

Business model and value proposition

MapmyIndia operates a licensing and SaaS-like model, earning revenue through map data licensing, APIs, navigation solutions and enterprise contracts. The model is high-margin, IP-driven and benefits from regulatory protection of domestic mapping data.

Exhibit 296: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.5 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	57
Last known valuation (USD mn)	550
Notable investors	Nexus, Qualcomm, Flipkart, Zenrin, Lightbox Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by Rakesh Verma and Rashmi Verma. The leadership has spent decades building India-specific geospatial IP. The company specializes in advanced digital maps, geospatial software, and IoT technologies, primarily focusing on B2B and B2B2C markets with a strong executive team managing operations.



Rakesh Verma
Co-Founder,
Chairman, MD



Rashmi Verma
Co-Founder, CTO

Mindtickle

Company overview

Mindtickle is a sales enablement and revenue productivity platform that helps enterprises train, coach and measure sales teams. Founded in 2011, Mindtickle serves global enterprises across technology, manufacturing and SaaS sectors.

Business model and value proposition

Mindtickle operates a mid-to-enterprise SaaS subscription model, priced per sales rep and functionality. Revenue is driven by long-term contracts, expansion within large sales organisations and measurable ROI for customers.

Exhibit 297: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	280
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,200 (2021)
Notable investors	Canaan Partners, Accel Partners, New Enterprise Associates, Qualcomm Ventures, Norwest Venture Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Mindtickle

Founders and leadership

Founded by Krishna Gopal Depura, Deepak Diwakar and Nishant Mungali. The leadership is a blend of consulting and product backgrounds. Krishna Depura (CEO) has been instrumental in positioning Mindtickle as a category leader in sales enablement.



Krishna Gopal Depura
Co-Founder, CEO



Deepak Diwakar
Co-Founder, COO



Nishant Mungali
Co-Founder, CCO

MoEngage

Company overview

MoEngage is a **customer engagement and marketing automation platform** that enables consumer internet companies to personalise messaging across channels such as push notifications, email, SMS and WhatsApp. Founded in 2014, MoEngage serves global consumer brands.

Business model and value proposition

MoEngage follows a **usage-based SaaS model**, pricing based on **monthly active users, message volume and advanced analytics features**. The platform benefits from recurring usage and deep integration into customers' marketing stacks.

Exhibit 298: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.11 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.15) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	307
Last known valuation (USD mn)	850-900
Notable investors	Matrix Partners, Eight Roads Ventures, Helion Venture Partners, VenturEast, A91 Partners, Goldman Sachs Alternatives, Exfinity Venture Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Raviteja Dodda and Yashwanth Kumar, both IIT Kharagpur alumni. MoEngage's leadership blends strong product thinking with global go-to-market execution. They have positioned the company as an Asia-origin challenger to global martech incumbents.



Raviteja Dodda
Co-Founder, CEO



Yashwanth Kumar
Co-Founder, CTO &
CISO

Mu Sigma

Company overview

Mu Sigma is one of India's earliest and largest **decision sciences and analytics services firms**, founded in 2004 and headquartered in Bengaluru with a strong presence in the US. Mu Sigma pioneered large-scale analytics outsourcing for Fortune 500 companies, positioning analytics as a core decision-making capability rather than a support function.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a **services-led analytics model**, delivering end-to-end decision support across data engineering, advanced analytics and business insights. Revenue is driven through **long-term enterprise contracts**, with embedded teams and recurring engagements, though margins are more services-like than pure SaaS.

Exhibit 299: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	215
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	FTV Capital, Peak XV Partners, General Atlantic, Mastercard, Fidelity, Accel

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded by Dhiraj Rajaram, Mu Sigma was built with a strong intellectual and problem-solving culture. Rajaram is known for his management philosophy and emphasis on first-principles thinking in analytics-driven decision-making.



Dhiraj Rajaram
Founder, CEO

MyGate

Company overview

MyGate is India's leading community and gated-society management platform, serving residential complexes with security, communication and payments solutions. Founded in 2016, MyGate has become deeply embedded in urban residential ecosystems.

Business model and value proposition

MyGate operates a B2B2C SaaS model, monetising primarily through subscription fees paid by housing societies, along with ancillary revenues from payments, home services and brand partnerships targeting residents.

Exhibit 300: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.1 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.4) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	83
Last known valuation (USD mn)	180
Notable investors	Prime Venture Partners, Tiger Global Management, JS Capital Management, Tencent Holdings

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, India Today

Founders and leadership

Founded by Vijay Arisetty, Abhishek Kumar, Shreyans Daga, and Rohit Jindal, the leadership brings experience from consumer internet and operations. Vijay Arisetty has been instrumental in scaling MyGate across metros with a strong on-ground sales strategy.



Vijay Arisetty
Founder, Chairman



Abhishek Kumar
Co-Founder, CEO



Shreyans Daga
Co-Founder, CPO



Rohit Jindal
Co-Founder, CBO

Perfios

Company overview

B2B SaaS company providing an AI-powered operating system for the Banking, Financial Services, and Insurance (BFSI) sector, helping financial institutions with digital onboarding, automated credit decisioning, risk assessment, fraud checks, and financial data analysis using structured/unstructured data.

Business model and value proposition

Perfios operates a transactional and subscription-based SaaS model, earning through API usage, data processing volumes and enterprise contracts. Its products are deeply embedded in lending workflows, creating high switching costs.

Exhibit 301: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	6.7 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.0 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	440
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	Ontario Teachers' Pension Plan (via Teachers' Venture Growth), Warburg Pincus, Bessemer Venture Partners, Kedaara Capital, Stride Ventures, InnoVen Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

- **V.R. Govindarajan:** Co-Founder and Executive Chairman. A veteran with over 35 years of experience in the IT industry.
- **Debasish Chakraborty:** Co-Founder and Board Member. He has 22 years of experience in the software industry, with previous roles at Wipro and IBM.



V.R. Govindarajan
Co-Founder, Exe.
Chairman



Debasish Chakraborty
Co-Founder

Postman

Company overview

API platform that helps developers design, build, test, document, and manage APIs throughout their entire lifecycle, making it easier to create better software faster through streamlined collaboration and automation tools for individuals and large enterprises.

Business model and value proposition

Postman follows a freemium + enterprise SaaS model, monetising through team collaboration features, governance, security and enterprise-scale API management. Product-led growth is a major driver of adoption.

Exhibit 302: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Insight Partners, CRV, Nexus Venture Partners, Coatue, Battery Ventures, and BOND

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TheArcWeb

Founders and leadership

Founded by Abhinav Asthana, Abhijit Kane and Ankit Sobti. Asthana (CEO) has positioned Postman as a neutral platform across API ecosystems.



Abhinav Asthana
Co-Founder, CEO



Abhijit Kane
Co-Founder



Ankit Sobti
Co-Founder

Rategain

Company overview

RateGain is a global SaaS company focused on the travel and hospitality industry, providing solutions for pricing intelligence, distribution, revenue management and customer engagement. Founded in 2004 and headquartered in Noida, RateGain serves hotels, airlines, OTAs and car rental companies across more than 100 countries, positioning itself as a core technology partner for hospitality revenue optimisation.

Business model and value proposition

RateGain operates a subscription-based B2B SaaS model, with revenues driven by annual contracts linked to number of properties, rooms, users or transaction volumes. The company benefits from high recurring revenue, strong international exposure and cross-selling across modules such as rate intelligence, channel management and marketing analytics.

Exhibit 303: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	11 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	2 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	750
Notable investors	Plutus Wealth Management, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund , Nippon Life India Mutual Fund, Sundaram Mutual Fund, Axis Mutual Fund, Bajaj Allianz Life Insurance Co.

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by Bhanu Chopra, RateGain's leadership brings deep domain expertise in hospitality distribution and pricing dynamics. Chopra has scaled the company from an India-focused startup into a globally recognised hospitality SaaS provider, successfully navigating international sales cycles and enterprise customer requirements.



Bhanu Chopra
Founder, MD

Uniphore

Company overview

Uniphore is a global conversational AI and automation company providing voice AI, customer service automation and analytics solutions to large enterprises. Founded in 2008, Uniphore has built a strong presence in contact centres and customer experience workflows across industries.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a high-ARPU enterprise AI SaaS model, selling multi-year contracts for contact centre automation, conversational analytics and AI assistants. Revenue is driven by enterprise licences, usage-based components and expansion across departments.

Exhibit 304: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	987
Last known valuation (USD mn)	3,000
Notable investors	NVIDIA, AMD, Snowflake, Databricks, New Enterprise Associates (NEA), March Capital, BNF Capital, National Grid Partners, Prosperity7 Ventures, Chiratae Ventures, Sorenson Capital, Cisco Investments

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Uniphore

Founders and leadership

Founded by Umesh Sachdev and Ravi Saraogi, Uniphore's leadership blends deep AI research expertise with enterprise go-to-market execution. Sachdev is widely recognised as a pioneer in voice AI, while Saraogi has driven operational and commercial scaling.



Umesh Sachdev (CEO) & Ravi Saraogi (President- APAC)
Co-Founders

Whatfix

Company overview

Whatfix is a global Digital Adoption Platform (DAP) that helps enterprises improve user onboarding, training and productivity across software applications. Founded in 2014, it serves large enterprises adopting complex SaaS and ERP systems.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows a B2B SaaS subscription model, with pricing based on number of users, applications supported and analytics modules. Long-term enterprise contracts and expansion within existing accounts drive predictable recurring revenue.

Exhibit 305: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.2) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	265
Last known valuation (USD mn)	900
Notable investors	Warburg Pincus, SoftBank Vision Fund 2, Peak XV Partners, Eight Roads Ventures, F-Prime Capital, Stellaris Venture Partners, Helion Venture Partners, Dragoneer Investment Group, Cisco Investments

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

- **Khadim Batti:** Co-founder and CEO, driving the company's vision and growth in digital adoption solutions.
- **Vara Kumar Namburu:** Co-founder and Head of R&D, instrumental in developing Whatfix's core technology.



Khadim Bhatti
Co-Founder, CEO



Vara Kumar Namburu
Co-Founder, Head of R&D

Zaggle

Company overview

Zaggle is a listed SaaS-led fintech platform offering employee benefits, rewards, prepaid cards and corporate spend management solutions. Founded in 2011, Zaggle serves mid-to-large enterprises across India.

Business model and value proposition

It operates a SaaS + transaction fee model, generating revenue through subscription fees, interchange income, program management fees and float income. Its platform integrates payments, compliance and expense management in a single offering.

Exhibit 306: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	13.08 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.87 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	110.3
Last known valuation (USD mn)	400
Notable investors	ICICI Prudential AMC, ValueQuest, Societe Generale, Nuvama, Ventureast

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, NSE

Founders and leadership

Founded by Raj P Narayanam, Zaggle's leadership brings deep experience in payments, enterprise sales and fintech regulation. Narayanam has guided Zaggle through its transition from a startup to a publicly listed enterprise SaaS-fintech hybrid.



Raj P Narayanam
Founder, Exe.
Chairman

Zenoti

Company overview

Zenoti is a global vertical SaaS platform for spas, salons, med-spas and wellness chains. Founded in 2010, Zenoti serves thousands of businesses worldwide, particularly in North America, with end-to-end operational and customer management software.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows a vertical SaaS subscription model, pricing based on number of locations, service volume and add-on modules, with additional monetisation from integrated payments and analytics.

Exhibit 307: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	331
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,500 (2021)
Notable investors	TPG, Advent International, Steadview, Tiger Global Management, Accel, Norwest Venture Partners

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, GeekWire

Founders and leadership

Founded by Sudheer Koneru and Dheeraj Koneru, both serial entrepreneurs and Sudheer a former Microsoft Executive, Zenoti's leadership brings deep enterprise software and vertical SaaS experience.



Sudheer Koneru
Co-Founder, CEO



Dheeraj Koneru
Co-Founder

WebEngage

Company overview

WebEngage is a Mumbai-based Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) company that provides customer engagement and retention solutions to businesses across industries. Founded in 2011, the company focuses on enabling enterprises to improve user engagement through data-driven communication across multiple channels such as email, push notifications, SMS, WhatsApp, and in-app messaging. Over time, WebEngage has evolved from a notification and feedback tool into a full-stack customer data and engagement platform, helping businesses manage the entire user lifecycle from acquisition to retention.

Business model and value proposition

WebEngage operates a pure-play SaaS business model based on subscription pricing, typically structured around usage metrics such as the number of monthly active users, events tracked, and communication volume. The platform enables businesses to collect, unify, and analyze customer data in real time, and then orchestrate personalised engagement campaigns across multiple channels. Its value proposition lies in improving customer retention, increasing lifetime value, and driving higher conversion rates through targeted and automated communication. For businesses, this translates into better marketing efficiency and deeper customer relationships, while reducing churn.

Exhibit 308: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.4 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.7) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	32.7
Last known valuation (USD mn)	90 (as of Aug'22)
Notable investors	Singularity Growth Opportunities Fund, SWC Global, India Quotient, Blume Ventures, GTI Capital Group

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

WebEngage was founded by Avlesh Singh and Ankit Utreja. Avlesh Singh, the CEO, has a strong background in data science and machine learning, which has shaped the company's focus on data-driven engagement. Ankit Utreja, the CTO, has deep expertise in engineering and product development, leading the technology architecture of the platform.



Avlesh Singh
Co-Founder, CEO



Ankit Utreja
Co-Founder, CTO

CleverTap

Company overview

CleverTap is a global customer engagement and retention platform that helps businesses deliver personalised experiences across digital channels. Founded in 2013 and headquartered in Mountain View, California, with significant operations in India, the company focuses on enabling brands to understand user behavior, segment audiences, and drive engagement through data-driven insights. CleverTap serves a wide range of industries including e-commerce, fintech, gaming, and media, and has built a strong global footprint across North America, India, Southeast Asia, and the Middle East.

Business model and value proposition

CleverTap operates a subscription-based SaaS model, where enterprises pay based on factors such as the number of users tracked, data volume, and engagement usage across channels like push notifications, email, SMS, and in-app messaging. The platform integrates customer data collection, real-time analytics, and campaign orchestration into a unified system, enabling businesses to create highly personalized and automated user journeys.

Exhibit 309: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.3 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.3 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	182
Last known valuation (USD mn)	600 (as of Aug'22)
Notable investors	CDPQ, Tiger Global Management, Sequoia India (now Peak XV Partners), Accel, Recruit Holdings

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

CleverTap was founded by Sunil Thomas, Anand Jain, and Suresh Kondamudi. Sunil Thomas, the CEO, has extensive experience in enterprise software and previously held leadership roles at global technology companies, which has helped shape CleverTap's enterprise-focused strategy. Anand Jain and Suresh Kondamudi bring strong technical and product development expertise, having previously worked on large-scale data and analytics platforms.



Anand Jain Sunil Thomas Suresh Kondamudi
 Co-Founder, CMO Co-Founder, CEO Co-Founder, CTO

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Chapter 20: Deep dive into Agri-tech sector

Agri-tech – sector overview

India's agriculture sector remains one of the largest in the world, contributing ~15–18% to GDP and supporting over 45% of the workforce. The total agricultural ecosystem in India covering inputs, outputs, and credit facilities. Agri-tech is attempting to digitise this fragmented value chain, although online penetration remains very low across most segments.

Agri-input market

The Indian agri-input market is estimated at ~INR 2.3trn, based on our channel checks. It comprises – crop protection pesticides valued at ~INR 1.3trn, fertilisers: ~INR 600bn, seeds: ~INR 250bn and tools and equipment: ~INR 150bn.

Despite the large base, online penetration is ~1%, reflecting deep rural fragmentation, trust deficit, and credit dependency on local retailers.

Agri-tech startups are attempting to reorganise the input value chain through three primary models:

- **Manufacturer to retailer platforms (B2B input marketplaces)**

These platforms connect agri-input manufacturers directly with retailers, enabling transparent pricing and better inventory management. Many players are also launching private-label products to improve gross margins.

- **Manufacturer to farmer direct (B2F model)**

Startups aggregate farmer demand via mobile applications or call centres and deliver inputs through third-party logistics providers in rural areas. This reduces intermediary margins but requires strong last-mile execution.

- **Franchise-led retail model**

Existing local agri stores are rebranded as franchises of agri-tech companies. These players supply inputs directly while encouraging local entrepreneurs to set up new rural stores under their brand umbrella.

Key players operating across these models include DeHaat and AgroStar, both of whom operate integrated input-output-credit ecosystems.

Agri-output market

The agricultural output market is significantly larger than inputs, given India's gross agricultural production value exceeds INR 20trn based on our channel checks. This segment remains highly fragmented with multiple intermediaries (mandis, traders, commission agents).

Agri-tech startups operate across B2B and B2C models:

A. B2B output platforms

These platforms source produce directly from farmers or farmer collectives and connect them to institutional buyers (retail chains, processors, exporters). They typically operate through three models: Mandi-to-Business, Collection Centre-to-Mandi and Farmgate-to-Business/Mandi.

B. Trading platforms for intermediaries

These platforms serve middlemen and commission agents by adding a trust and accountability layer, including rating systems and transaction transparency to reduce counterparty risk.

C. Export-oriented platforms

These connect Indian farmers directly to export markets, especially developed economies. They command higher margins due to superior price realisation and often provide precision farming advisory to improve quality standards.

D. Farm to consumer (B2C)

In this model, agri-tech players control the entire supply chain—from farm procurement to last-mile delivery, ensuring higher quality produce, lower wastage, and better pricing efficiency.

Overall, output agri-tech models are capital intensive given working capital requirements, logistics, and wastage risks but offer higher revenue pools versus inputs.

Exhibit 310: Agri-tech sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	• Massive market headroom Operating in an ~INR 22trn ecosystem with only ~1-2% digital penetration, integrated models drive high farmer stickiness and lifetime value.
	• Embedded finance and private labels Controlling crop-cycle data enables low-CAC financial cross-selling, while private labels offer superior margins over traditional distribution.
Weakness	• Thin margins and high capital intensity Output aggregation suffers from low contribution margins due to wastage and price volatility, requiring significant working capital.
	• Fragmented farmer base Low digital literacy and reliance on informal credit networks make farmer acquisition difficult and limit scale efficiency per holding.
	• Interstate regulatory friction Differing state-level APMC rules and licensing requirements for inputs slow down national expansion and increase operational costs.
Opportunity	• Digital formalisation A modest shift toward digital procurement in the INR 20trn annual output market represents a massive, multi-trillion revenue opportunity.
	• High-value exports and precision tech Quality-standardised export models and data-led advisory services offer pathways to higher margins and deeper engagement.
	• Scalable profit pools Embedded insurance and co-lending models, supported by digital land records, represent the most lucrative growth areas for the sector.
Threat	• Climate and price volatility Unpredictable weather and market price swings directly threaten transaction volumes and farmer repayment capacity.
	• Competitive encroachment Entry by agri-input majors or deep-pocketed horizontal e-commerce players could trigger aggressive margin compression.
	• Disintermediation risk As digital infrastructure matures, large buyers or manufacturers may bypass platforms to integrate directly with farmers.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

India's agri-tech sector operates in a highly regulated agricultural ecosystem. For digital platforms to scale sustainably across inputs, outputs, and credit, coordinated regulatory support is essential. The following areas are particularly critical:

- **Input distribution and licensing reform:** Agri-input sales (fertilisers, pesticides, seeds) are governed by multiple central and state-level licenses. Startups operating across states face compliance fragmentation and local approval delays. A **national unified licensing framework**, digital approvals, and portability of licenses across states could significantly reduce friction. Clear guidelines around private label manufacturing and direct-to-farmer sales could also improve compliance certainty.
- **Market access and APMC reforms:** Many agri-output platforms are affected by state-level APMC regulations that mandate mandi transactions and levy market fees. Rationalisation of mandi fees, interstate trading freedom, and clarity on digital trade platforms could improve economics for farmgate procurement models. Strengthening interoperability with platforms like e-NAM could increase transparency and reduce counterparty risk.
- **Logistics and infrastructure enablement:** Cold chain infrastructure, grading labs, warehouse accreditation, and quality certification systems need regulatory standardisation. Faster approvals for warehousing and better enforcement of warehouse receipt systems could reduce wastage and improve working capital cycles in output aggregation models.
- **Digital land records and farmer identity:** Access to authenticated land records and crop data is critical for credit underwriting and precision advisory. Continued digitisation under programs like Digital India and integration with Aadhaar-linked farmer databases could materially lower fraud risk and enable embedded finance at scale.
- **Credit an NBFC framework flexibility:** Agri-tech platforms offering embedded finance require regulatory clarity around co-lending, first-loss default guarantees (FLDG), and digital KYC norms. Stable policies under Reserve Bank of India guidelines are essential to scale agri-credit without regulatory overhang. Priority sector lending (PSL) incentives aligned with agri-tech platforms could further deepen rural credit penetration.
- **Insurance distribution simplification:** Clearer norms for digital distribution of crop and livestock insurance, in coordination with Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India, could improve farmer adoption and reduce mis-selling risks. Standardised digital claims processing could also improve trust in crop insurance schemes.
- **Export facilitation and quality standards:** Export-oriented agri-tech platforms require simplified phytosanitary certifications, faster customs processing, and harmonised global quality benchmarks. This could enable higher margin realisation and reduce working capital lock-up in export cycles.

Companies in Agri-tech sector

Absolute Foods

Company overview

Absolute Foods is an Indian agri-tech and food supply solutions company focused on integrating precision farming, quality assurance and supply chain technology across fresh produce and input markets, with presence in domestic and selected international markets.

Business model and value proposition

Absolute Foods operates as an integrated production-to-market agri-tech player, partnering with farmers and using tech for precision agriculture and supply chain optimisation, delivering produce to consumers and businesses while improving farm yields and traceability.

Exhibit 311: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.6 (FY22)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.4) (FY22)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	102
Last known valuation (USD mn)	500 (2022)
Notable investors	Sequoia Capital India, Alpha Wave Global, Tiger Global

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded by Agam Khare, Prateek Rawat, Samder Singh in 2015 and headquartered in Gurugram, the leadership blends agriculture supply experience with technology integration to scale farming outcomes and trading operations.



Agam Khare
Founder, CEO



Prateek Rawat
Co-Founder



Samder Singh
Co-Founder

Arya.ag

Company overview

Arya.ag is India's largest integrated grain commerce platform focused on post-harvest solutions including hermetic storage, financing, and market linkages that collectively improve farmer outcomes and reduce losses across the agricultural value chain.

Business model and value proposition

It operates an asset-light agri-tech platform that combines storage services, price discovery and warehouse receipt financing (through its NBFC), enabling farmers to store grain and access credit and buyers without distress sales at harvest time.

Exhibit 312: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.34 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	168
Last known valuation (USD mn)	325
Notable investors	GEF Capital Partners, Lightrock Venture, Aspada Investment Company, Blue Earth Capital, and Quona Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2013 by Prasanna Rao, Chattanathan Devarajan and Anand Chandra, Arya.ag's leadership brings expertise in agri-tech, financial services and rural markets, scaling an integrated platform across India's agricultural heartlands.



Prasanna Rao
Co-Founder, CEO



Chattanathan Devarajan
Co-Founder, MD



Anand Chandra
Co-Founder

Recent developments

In Jan'26, the company has raised INR 7.25bn in a Series D equity round led by GEF Capital Partners, as it looks to scale climate-smart agriculture solutions, strengthen farmgate infrastructure and reduce post-harvest losses across the agri supply chain.

DeHaat

Company overview

DeHaat is a full-stack Indian agri-tech marketplace that provides farmers with digital access to inputs, advisory services, marketplace linkages, finance and logistics, helping integrate smallholder farmers into formal value chains nationwide.

Business model and value proposition

The company's model blends digital platform services and physical on-ground distribution to deliver seeds, fertilisers, pesticides, advisory and output market access, earning revenue from input sales, service commissions and value-added offerings.

Exhibit 313: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	30.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.1) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	284
Last known valuation (USD mn)	700-800
Notable investors	Sofina, Temasek, Prosus Ventures, Peak XV Partners (formerly Sequoia Capital India), and Lightrock India.

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Inc42

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2012 by alumni from IIT Delhi, IIT Kharagpur, IIM Ahmedabad & other top institutes. Shashank Kumar, Shyam Sundar Singh, Amrendra Singh and Adarsh Srivastav. DeHaat's leadership combines agri-tech operational experience with deep rural ecosystem engagement.



Shashank Kumar
Co-Founder, CEO



Shyam Sundar Singh
Co-Founder



Amrendra Singh
Co-Founder



Adarsh Srivastava
Co-Founder

Ninjacart

Company overview

Ninjacart is an Indian agri-tech platform that connects farmers and food producers directly with retailers, restaurants and institutional buyers, facilitating efficient movement of fresh produce and reducing wastage through tech-enabled supply chains.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2B marketplace and logistics platform that sources fresh produce directly from farms and moves it to urban wholesale and retail buyers using its own tech and logistics, monetising via transaction commissions and supply agreements.

Exhibit 314: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	16.3 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(2.6) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	407
Last known valuation (USD mn)	815 (2022)
Notable investors	Flipkart, Walmart, Tiger Global Management, Accel Partners, Syngenta Ventures, Qualcomm Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Ninjacart was founded in 2015 by a team of serial entrepreneurs aiming to revolutionize the agricultural supply chain in India. The company was established by Thirukumaran Nagarajan, Kartheeswaran KK, Sharath Loganathan, Ashutosh Vikram, Vasudevan Chinnathambi, and Sachin Jose.



Kartheeswaran KK
Co-Founder & CEO



Thirukumaran Nagarajan
Co-Founder



Sharath Loganathan
Co-Founder



Vasudevan C
Co-Founder



Ashutosh Vikram
Co-Founder



Sachin Jose
Co-Founder

AgroStar

Company overview

AgroStar is an India-based agri-tech company focused on empowering farmers through a digital platform that provides agricultural inputs, advisory services, and market linkages. Founded in 2013 and headquartered in Pune, the company operates as a full-stack agricultural solutions provider, addressing key inefficiencies in India's fragmented farming ecosystem. AgroStar enables farmers to purchase seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, and other farm inputs directly through its platform while also offering expert agronomy advice in regional languages.

Business model and value proposition

AgroStar operates a hybrid marketplace and inventory-led model, combining direct sales of agricultural inputs with a digital advisory platform. The company generates revenue primarily through the sale of farm inputs, where it sources products from manufacturers and sells them directly to farmers, often under its own private labels to improve margins. In addition, its digital platform provides personalised crop advisory services based on factors such as soil conditions, weather, and crop type, helping farmers make informed decisions. The value proposition lies in improving farm productivity and income by providing access to high-quality inputs, transparent pricing, and expert guidance, all delivered through a convenient digital interface.

Exhibit 315: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	8.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.4) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	140
Last known valuation (USD mn)	250 (2025)
Notable investors	Just Climate, Accel, Bertelsmann India Investments, Chiratae Ventures (formerly IDG Ventures India), Aavishkaar Capital, British International Investment, Evolve India, Hero Enterprise, Schroders Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

AgroStar was founded by Shardul Sheth and Sitanshu Sheth. The founders bring complementary expertise in business strategy, operations, and technology, with prior experience across consulting and entrepreneurship.



Shardul Sheth
Co-Founder, CEO



Sitanshu Sheth
Co-Founder, COO

Chapter 21: Deep dive into Online Ticketing

Online ticketing – sector overview

India's online entertainment ticketing – from cyclical releases to structural experience economy

Market size – growth and evolution

The Indian online entertainment ticketing market has undergone a significant structural transformation in the post-pandemic period. Post-Covid-19, the market rebounded sharply and, by 2024, had reached ~USD 2.5bn (~INR 208bn). This rebound was not merely a recovery; we believe the consumers are stepping out more fervently, absorbing any form of available entertainment content, whether movies, live concerts, sports, theatricals, or seasonal cultural events.

The market has sustained a CAGR of 15–20% YoY since the pandemic. Our channel checks project that at a steady 20% CAGR, the market will likely comfortably reach INR 500bn–550bn by 2029. There has been no significant slowdown recorded in any sub-segment; in fact, each category has continued to grow robustly, particularly seasonal events growth has accelerated sharply, with that category's contribution to total market revenue doubling from ~5–6% to 10–15% over the past couple of years.

A critical enabler of this growth has been the shift from physical to digital ticketing. Consumers adapted quickly to mobile ticketing and home delivery of wristbands for live events, eliminating long queues at box offices and dramatically improving convenience.

It has been noted that Gen-Z consumers have emerged as key demand drivers and cultural influencers, actively creating social pressure to attend events, which has expanded the total addressable audience substantially.

Technology, particularly the gradual adoption of AI-driven discovery and personalisation tools, is expected to act as the next growth catalyst, although its full impact on the market is still emerging.

The large-scale supply of diverse content, from international acts like Coldplay and Linkin Park to domestic mega-events like Navratri, Holi, and Durga Puja, has been a fundamental demand driver during this period.

Exhibit 316: Sub-segment breakdown (revenue contribution)

Sub-segment	Estimated Revenue Contribution
Sports (IPL + International Tours)	~30%
Live Events (Concerts, Shows)	~25%
Movies	~20%
Seasonal Events (Navratri, Holi, etc.)	~10–15%
Other (Plays, Experiences, Activities)	Remainder

Source: I-Sec research

IPL is by far the largest single contributor within the sports sub-segment, accounting for 30–40% of all sports ticketing revenue.

Within movies, the platform operates on a booking-fee model rather than a commission model. Cinemas do not pay commissions to ticketing platforms; instead, the platform earns through the convenience/booking fee charged to the end consumer.

The live events segment runs on a dual-revenue model: a 10–15% commission charged to third-party event producers, plus a 5–7% booking fee charged to the end customer.

Sector nuances

Key growth drivers

The most significant structural growth driver is the shift towards experience-driven demand. Consumers today are not merely buying tickets but are purchasing an entire experience ecosystem.

- The move from outdoor to indoor venues, for instance, has unlocked several experience enhancements: events can run later (till 1–2 AM indoors versus the 10 PM outdoor curfew), venues are air-conditioned, parking is more organised, and access is smoother. These improvements have meaningfully driven repeat attendance and willingness to pay premium prices.
- Technology forms the second major pillar. Home delivery of wristbands, real-time seat selection, mobile-first ticketing, and increasingly dynamic pricing capabilities have made the purchase journey frictionless. Dynamic pricing is identified as one of the fastest-moving levers for profitability; the ability to optimise ticket prices based on demand signals could significantly improve revenue without requiring incremental content costs.
- Content supply and its quality remain the most powerful near-term demand triggers. A single high-profile artist announcement can shift thousands of tickets within hours. Artists like Arijit Singh (~20,000 attendees per show), Linkin Park (40,000–50,000 per show), and Coldplay (roughly 1,00,000 per show) demonstrate how artist calibre directly sets the scale ceiling of any live event. This makes content acquisition and artist relationships a critical competitive moat.
- Sponsorships are perhaps the most underappreciated revenue lever and profitability driver in the ecosystem. For large-scale events, sponsorships can cover up to 40–60% of total event costs. White-labelled IP creation for alcohol and FMCG brands is an increasingly common structure where the brand sponsors 60% of costs and owns the IP, while the producer handles execution end-to-end. For such arrangements, the producer is profitable from day one since cost coverage is front-loaded. Sponsorship is also a lever most likely to drive EBITDA margin expansion for the ticketing platforms that produce their own events.
- Banking and financial institution partnerships (Mastercard, Visa, RuPay) have created a powerful pre-sale and loyalty-driven demand channel. These institutions enable early access to high-demand tickets as a benefit for cardholders, driving conversion rates and generating a captive demand pool that de-risks ticket sales for producers and platforms alike.

Market scale potential

Given a 20–25% growth rate across all sub-segments, the market is expected to scale substantially. If the current INR 208bn (2024) base expands at even a conservative 20% CAGR, the market would approach INR 500bn–550bn by 2029.

Movies and live events together are expected to drive 40–50% of the upside, with IPL and other sports contributing a further 15–20%. Seasonal events, which have already doubled their share of revenue, are expected to sustain double-digit growth as more producers and brands invest in this category. Infrastructure expansion, particularly the development of dedicated, large-format, well-equipped event venues, is the single most significant gating factor for the market reaching its full potential.

Profitability outlook

For the core online ticketing business (movies), EBITDA margins are estimated to be in the range of 20–25% at steady state. This is a relatively lean operation since the platform earns purely on booking fees and does not bear content or venue risk.

For live events, however, economics are far more volatile. Through channel checks it's been noted that a well-executed event can generate 30% EBITDA margins, while poor content choices or underestimated costs can result in negative 10–20% margins.

For IP creation like Lollapalooza, where BookMyShow is the local producer, breakeven typically requires two to three years. The first year is largely spent establishing brand recognition and audience familiarity with the festival format. If execution is strong, breakeven can be achieved in year two; more commonly, breakeven comes in year three and profitability in year four.

The path to profitability depends heavily on securing the right venue capacity (50,000–60,000 person venues), building reliable sponsorship revenue (targeting 30% of total costs from sponsors, with an additional 10% as upside), and optimising food, beverage, and ancillary revenue which contributes another 25–30% of the total revenue pie.

The fastest levers to move profit, in order of impact, are: (1) securing and expanding sponsorships to cover costs, (2) dynamic pricing of tickets to maximise yield per seat, (3) increasing the supply of well-curated, in-demand content, and (4) controlling production and logistics costs through better infrastructure and repeat-venue relationships. Food and beverage, while additive, contributes only 10–15% of revenue and is not the primary profitability driver.

Exhibit 317: Online Ticketing sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strength	• High structural demand: Post-COVID revenge consumption plus Gen Z spending patterns support strong attendance.
	• Content scalability: Large international acts can draw 50,000–100,000 people per show.
	• Tech penetration: Shift from offline to mobile-based ticketing improves transparency and monetization.
	• Sponsorship ecosystem: Strong BFSI and brand partnerships create monetization beyond ticket revenue.
Weakness	• Dependence on Big Content: No Coldplay → no spike. Demand is event-driven.
	• Regulatory fragmentation: Each state has different rules (fire, excise, police, etc.), increasing friction.
	• Infrastructure deficit: Limited large-format venues outside select metros.
	• Economic sensitivity: Discretionary spending risk in downturns.
Opportunity	• Untapped Government Events: Large state festivals (e.g., Dasara, Durga Puja scale events) remain under-monetized via structured ticketing.
	• Corporate and Brand IP Creation: White-labelled IP models where brands cover 60% of cost reduce promoter risk.
	• Tier-2/3 Expansion: Seasonal and cultural monetization potential is rising.
	• Venue Development: If platforms can secure long-term land leases with approvals, vertical integration improves margins.
Threat	• Rising Competition: New entrants with capital backing.
	• High Fixed Costs in Events: Artist fees and logistics can wipe out profitability.
	• Regulatory Discretion: Free passes and multiple permissions erode revenue.
	• Infrastructure Delays: Land and approval bottlenecks limit capacity expansion.

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- **Single-window clearance:** Fire, law and order, excise, municipal approvals should be consolidated into transparent, fixed timelines.
- **Standardised fee structure:** Clear-cut, predefined regulatory charges to avoid uncertainty.
- **Limit on free passes:** Unregulated distribution of complimentary passes directly impacts revenue.
- **Infrastructure facilitation:** Faster land allocation and blanket approvals for event venues.

Companies in the Online Ticketing sector

BookMyShow

Company overview

BookMyShow is India's largest entertainment discovery and ticketing platform, enabling users to book tickets for movies, live events, sports, theatre and experiential entertainment. Founded in 1999 and headquartered in Mumbai, BookMyShow has evolved from a movie-ticketing site into a full-stack entertainment platform with strong brand recall and national reach.

Business model and value proposition

BookMyShow operates a platform-led marketplace model, monetising through ticketing convenience fees, commissions from event organisers and cinemas, advertising, sponsorships and brand partnerships. It also invests selectively in event IPs, live experiences and content production, allowing it to capture higher margins beyond pure ticketing.

Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	18.7 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	1.9 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	225
Last known valuation (USD mn)	900 (2024)
Notable investors	Stripes Group, Network 18, Accel Partners India, SAIF Partners, TPG Growth, Grab Ventures, Jungle Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Times of India

Founders and leadership

Founded by Ashish Hemrajani, along with Parikshit Dar, Rajesh Balpande, the leadership brings deep experience in media, technology and consumer platforms. Ashish Hemrajani (CEO) has been instrumental in scaling BookMyShow through multiple industry cycles, including cinema digitisation and the live-events boom.



Ashish Hemrajani
Co-Founder, CEO



Parikshit Dar
Co-Founder



Rajesh Balpande
Co-Founder

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Chapter 22: Deep dive into Clean-tech

Clean-tech – sector overview

India's Clean-tech sector is undergoing a structural transformation, driven by the dual imperatives of energy security and climate commitments. The sector spans renewable energy generation, electric mobility, battery storage, and green infrastructure.

The India renewable energy market size was valued at USD 26bn in 2025 and is projected to reach USD 53bn by 2034, growing at a CAGR of ~8% (Source: IMARC). India's installed renewable power generation capacity has increased at a fast pace over the past few years, posting a CAGR of ~19% between FY16 and FY26 (as of Oct'25).

India has ~250GW of renewable energy capacity in FY26 (as of Oct'25). With the 3rd largest energy consumption globally, India's transition to renewable energy is pivotal for global climate action. As of Oct,'25, ~50% of the total power installed capacity is from renewable sources - achieved this milestone five years early against its Paris Agreement goal. The country plans to reach 500GW of installed renewable energy capacity by 2030, with 280 GW expected from solar power. This target could provide investment opportunities worth ~USD 220bn by 2030.

Exhibit 318: Installed renewable energy capacity (GW) in India

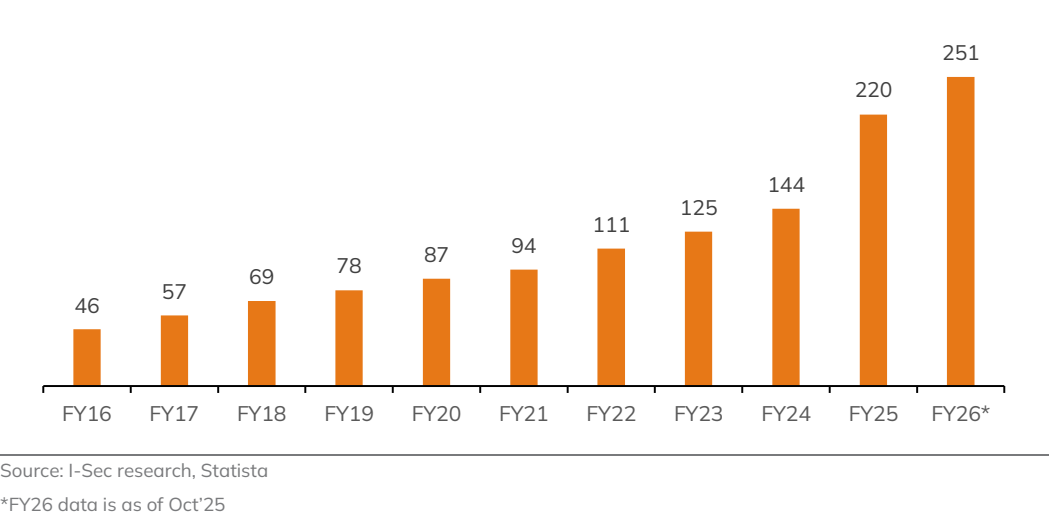


Exhibit 319: Energy capacity by source (as of Dec'25) – total capacity 514GW

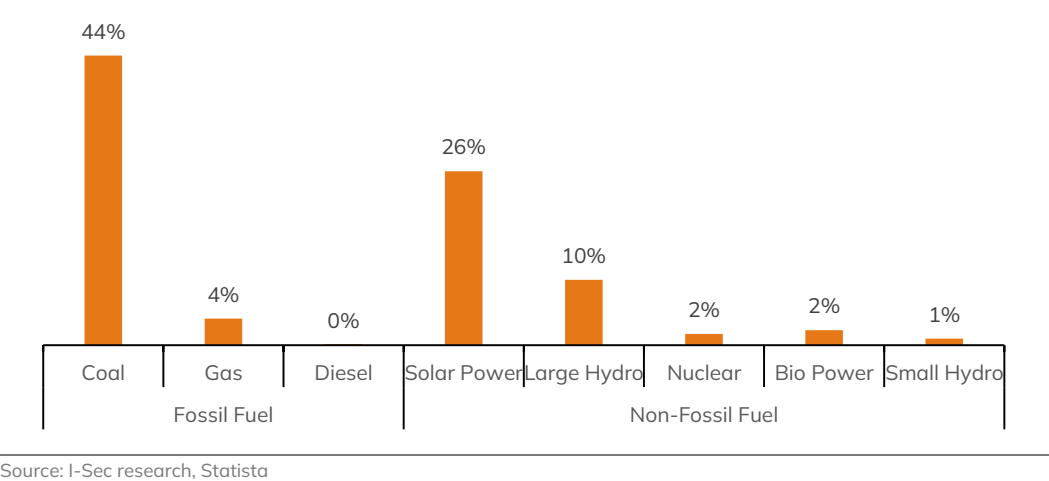
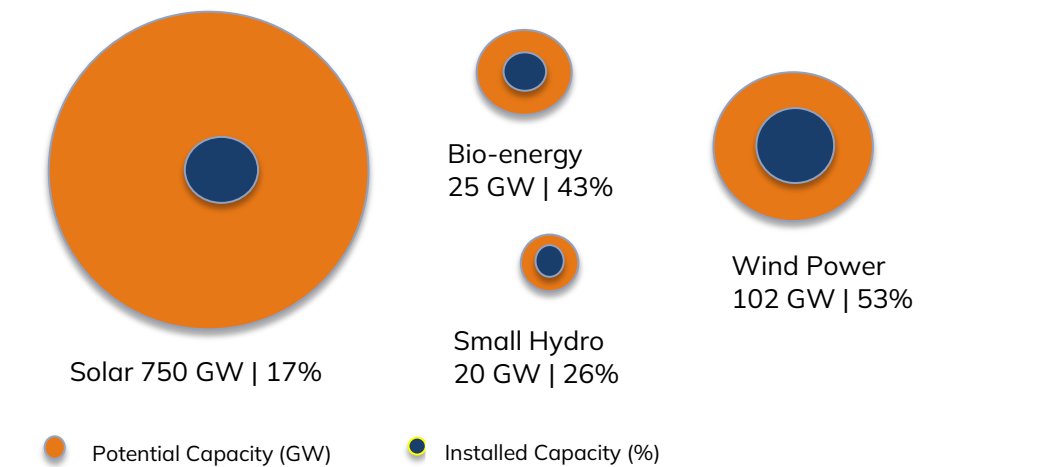


Exhibit 320: Renewable Energy potential and installed capacity: India has immense potential for solar power generation, estimated at 750GW, ~36% of the total renewable energy potential



Source: I-Sec research, Niti Aayog

Solar energy

Solar power has experienced a remarkable 42x surge in adoption, with installed capacity increasing from 2.8GW in 2014 to 130GW+ as of Dec'25. This includes 91 GW from ground-mounted solar plants, 20 GW from grid-connected rooftop systems, 3 GW from hybrid projects, and 5 GW from off-grid solar installations, reflecting the country's diverse approach to expanding renewable energy. India's long-term goal is to achieve 280 GW of solar capacity by 2030, making solar the main contributor to its renewable energy portfolio.

India's solar manufacturing sector includes key components like solar modules, solar PV cells, and ingots and wafers. Producing these within the country supports the domestic economy and reduces dependence on imports. In just one-year, solar module manufacturing capacity nearly doubled—from 38GW in Mar'24 to 74GW in Mar'25. Similarly, solar PV cell manufacturing rose from 9GW to 25GW.

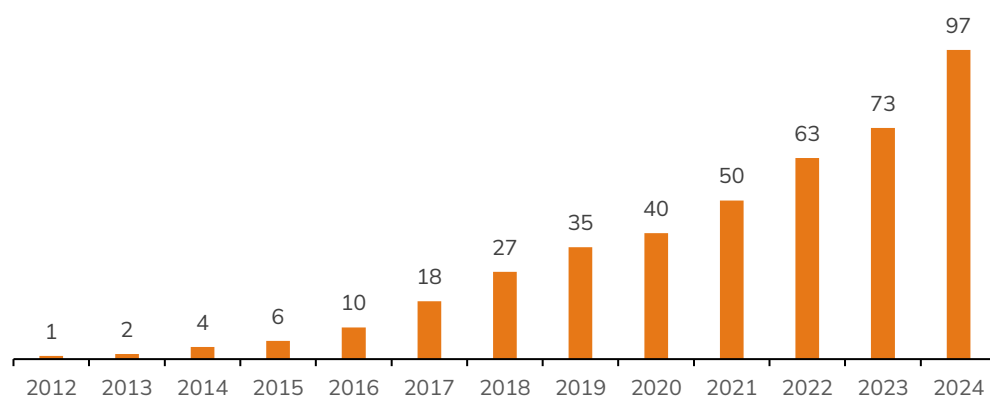
Manufacturing value chain

Module manufacturing capacity nearly doubled in a single year — from 38 GW (Mar'24) to ~74-78 GW (Mar'25). Solar PV cell capacity grew from 9 GW to 25 GW in the same period. India's first ingot-wafer facility (2 GW) became operational in 2025, a key milestone in reducing upstream import dependence.

Key Government Catalysts

- **National Solar Mission / NEP Target:** India's National Electricity Plan mandates 280 GW of solar PV capacity by 2030, requiring ~30 GW of annual additions. Annual tendering plans for FY24-FY28 call for 40 GW of renewable capacity additions each year.
- **PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana:** A flagship rooftop scheme targeting 10mn households by 2026-27. Subsidies of up to INR 78,000 per household (~3 kW system) and low-interest loans of up to INR 200k are driving residential adoption.
- **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme:** Two PLI tranches supporting 48 GW+ of integrated cell-to-module capacity; investments of INR 240bn (USD 2.88bn) are underwriting domestic manufacturing. PLI awards require 60% domestic value addition within 5 years.
- **Basic Custom Duty (BCD):** 25% duty on imported solar cells and 40% on modules, introduced in 2022, has accelerated domestic manufacturing investments.
- **Solar Parks:** 50 solar parks sanctioned with ~38 GW combined capacity, offering ready-to-use land and grid connectivity to developers.
- **SECI Auctions:** Solar tariffs have fallen below INR 2/kWh in some auctions — among the world's cheapest — making solar the most cost-competitive electricity source in India, undercutting even coal.

Exhibit 321: Solar energy capacity in India (in GW)



Source: I-Sec research, Statista

Exhibit 322: Notable solar companies in India

Segment	Leading Companies	Key Focus
Utility and Large-Scale IPPs	ReNew Energy, Azure Power, Greenko, Adani Green	Grid-scale solar and wind projects
Rooftop and Industrial C&I	CleanMax, Fourth Partner Energy, Amp Energy	Rooftop and open-access solar for commercial and industrial clients
Solar Manufacturing	Waaree Energies, Tata Power Solar, Adani Solar, Goldi Solar	Module, cell manufacturing; PLI scheme beneficiaries
Tech / SaaS for Solar	SenseHawk, Solar Labs	AI, IoT, and SaaS for design, operations, and grid management
Residential and D2C	SolarSquare, ZunRoof, Amplus Solar	Rooftop solar for homes with O&M and financing
Rural / Agri-Tech	Ecozen, Gram Oorja, SELCO	Solar irrigation, cold-chain, village microgrids

Source: I-Sec research

Electric vehicles

India's EV industry has been experiencing rapid growth, with sales reaching over 2.2mn units in 2025, marking a 16% YoY increase and setting the stage for 30% market penetration by 2030. India's EV market is expected to maintain its current growth momentum, driven by rising fuel prices, consumer awareness, and policy support. In 2025, 2Ws and 3Ws dominate EV sales, accounting for over 93% of the ~2.2mn units sold. Government incentives, better product availability, and fleet electrification are expected to continue to support growth.

The EV battery market opportunity

Recent industry projections show that India's EV battery demand could grow from around 17.7 GWh in 2025 to over 256 GWh by 2032, representing a more than 14x increase in less than a decade (Source: CES report). This explosive demand underscores a structural transformation that will likely shape battery manufacturing, supply chains, and energy infrastructure across the country — and create immense opportunities for EV battery manufacturers in India.

Exhibit 323: EV ecosystem in India – key highlights

USD130bn+ India's EV Market Opportunity By 2030
1.2mn+ 2W EV sold In 2025
2.2mn+ total EV sold in 2025
2.8 Mn+ EV Targeted In PM E Drive Scheme From 2024-2026
USD3.7 Bn+ Raised By Indian EV Startups Since 2014



Source: I-Sec research, Inc42

Total battery demand in 2024 stood at ~13GWh, with 4Ws alone contributing over 33%. In 2024, EVs accounted for ~6% of total vehicle sales in India. Out of the 13GWh total demand, 3Ws led battery consumption at 34%, closely followed by 4Ws at 33%. 2Ws contribute ~25%, while buses (6%) and trucks (2%) take smaller shares.

Exhibit 324: EV startup ecosystem in India

OEMs	Battery Tech
	
EV Charging/Infrastructure	Fleet & Mobility
	

Source: I-Sec research

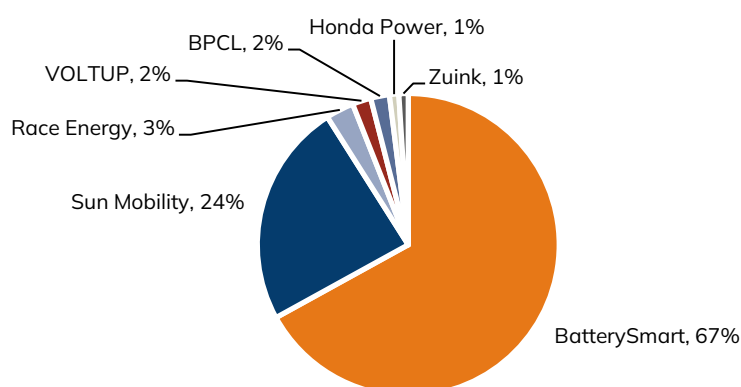
Battery swapping market

Key statistics

- Current market size (2025): USD 48mn (Source: IMARC)
- Projected market size (2030): USD 180mn
- Growth: 30% CAGR

The battery swapping model aims to address the challenges of long charging times and limited charging infrastructure, providing a swift and efficient alternative. There are more than 20 active battery swapping operators in the country, operating ~1,000-1,100 swapping stations with over 150k batteries.

Key players: Sun Mobility, Battery Smart, Bounce Infinity, Ola Electric (own network), Gogoro (entering India). Battery-as-a-Service (BaaS) models — where the vehicle is sold without battery to reduce upfront cost, and users pay per swap — are gaining traction, especially in the 3W commercial segment.

Exhibit 325: Market share of battery swapping station operators in India

Source: I-Sec research, PIB

Battery swapping operators in the market are offering two types of services to EV users – **Battery as a service (BaaS)** and **Mobility as a service (MaaS)**

	BaaS	MaaS
Brief	Exclusively furnish the battery to users through subscription or pay-per-use/charge arrangements, primarily targeting the B2C sector, where individual users or fleet operators maintain ownership or leasing of their respective vehicles or fleets	In this model, the battery is included with the vehicle, along with additional services such as insurance and maintenance. This comprehensive subscription-based solution empowers clients, particularly in the B2B sector, to decrease the assets managed by business proprietors
Players	Two major players – Battery Smart and Sun Mobility	Three major players – Bounce Infinity, Zipp and Sun Mobility
Advantages	Reduced capex for BaaS operators compared to MaaS, given that vehicle ownership remains with the user	MaaS brings players seeking asset-light solutions to the market; it increases the number of customers
Disadvantages	Limited reach within B2B customer base	MaaS players acquire ownership of the vehicle, the capex and inventory increase, and high vehicle utilisation is required to ensure return on investment

Exhibit 326: Clean-tech sector – SWOT analysis

SWOT	Comments
Strengths	- World's third-largest solar producer with 123GW installed; one of the cheapest solar tariffs globally (~INR 2/kWh) 42x growth in solar capacity in a decade — strong structural momentum - Large and growing EV market driven by world's 3rd largest auto market - Strong policy commitment: 500 GW non-fossil target by 2030; FAME-II, PLI schemes - Rising domestic manufacturing across solar modules, cells, and battery assembly
Weaknesses	- India still imports 90%+ of Li-ion battery cells; critical vulnerability for EV cost competitiveness - Only ~1% of end-of-life Li-ion batteries are currently recycled — supply chain circularity gap - Transmission grid bottlenecks and land clearance delays impeding large-scale solar project execution - Limited grid storage infrastructure creating curtailment risk for high-solar states
Opportunities	- Battery demand set to grow 7-14x by 2030 - Rooftop solar still at ~20 GW vs. 40 GW target — large headroom for residential and MSME adoption - EV commercial fleet electrification (buses, trucks, last-mile) at inflection point - Green hydrogen and BESS (Battery Energy Storage Systems) creating new adjacent markets
Threats	- Critical mineral supply risk: India lacks domestic lithium, cobalt, nickel reserves; import dependency a vulnerability - EV fire safety incidents (Li-ion) damaging consumer confidence; regulatory scrutiny rising

Source: I-Sec research

Potential policy pathways

- **Critical-mineral security:** India needs a national critical-mineral strategy to protect domestic battery manufacturing economics. India's USD 5bn+ import exposure in batteries by 2030 (ICEA estimate) is a strategic vulnerability.
- **Battery recycling infrastructure:** With only ~1% of Li-ion batteries currently recycled, India could benefit immensely from a framework with binding targets, collection infrastructure funding, and incentives for secondary material recovery — creating a circular supply chain for battery materials.
- **Battery swapping standards:** Policymakers may wish to explore interoperability standards for battery swapping to prevent ecosystem fragmentation — enabling any vehicle to use any operator's battery. This could catalyse the segment and reduce the effective cost of 2W/3W EVs.

Rooftop solar simplification: While the PM Surya Ghar subsidy provides a strong foundation, its full impact could be unlocked by streamlining administrative requirements and shortening the timeline for grid integration. Adoption rates are seemingly influenced by procedural complexities and variable connection timelines, which often range from 3–6 months. A single-window clearance and mandatory 30-day connection commitment from DISCOMs could materially accelerate the 40 GW rooftop target.

Companies in Clean-tech

Battery Smart

Company overview

Battery Smart is a leading EV battery-swapping network and infrastructure company that enables rapid battery swaps for electric two- and three-wheelers, enhancing EV uptime and affordability in India's fast-growing electric mobility landscape.

Business model and value proposition

Operates a battery-as-a-service (BaaS) model via a partner-led swap station network across cities, monetising through swaps, subscriptions and partner fees while lowering battery ownership costs for fleet users.

Exhibit 327: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	170
Last known valuation (USD mn)	450
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Blume Ventures, Stride Ventures, Trifecta Capital, British International Investment, MUFG, Panasonic

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2019 by Pulkit Khurana and Siddharth Sikka, both IIT Kanpur graduates, bringing engineering and mobility ecosystem experience to tackle range anxiety and charging infrastructure gaps.



Pulkit Khurana
Co-Founder



Siddharth Sikka
Co-Founder

Recent developments

Battery Smart surpassed 100mn EV battery swaps, launched a driver welfare fund and expanded swap stations to over 50 cities, solidifying its network leadership in India's EV ecosystem in FY25.

Lohum

Company overview

Lohum is a clean-tech company focused on lithium-ion battery recycling and sustainable critical mineral supply, creating second-life applications and producing battery materials for EV and energy storage markets.

Business model and value proposition

Runs a circular battery materials ecosystem, earning through recycling, repurposing and refining lithium-ion materials for reuse in EVs and stationary storage, reducing import dependence and raw material costs.

Exhibit 328: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.3 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.27 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	114
Last known valuation (USD mn)	480
Notable investors	Baring Private Equity Partners, Singularity Growth (AMC), Cactus Venture Partners, Ventureast Proactive Fund, Stride Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, FundTQ, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2018 by Rajat Verma (Founder and CEO), driven by a vision to formalise battery recycling and support India's EV supply chain.



Rajat Verma
Founder, CEO

ReNew Energy

Company overview

The company is one of India's largest renewable energy producers, developing and operating solar, wind and energy storage assets globally, and the first Indian renewables company listed on NASDAQ.

Business model and value proposition

Operates a project development and power generation model, earning through long-term PPAs, green bonds, carbon credits and integrated decarbonisation services across solar, wind, storage and hydrogen.

Exhibit 329: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	109 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	4.6 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Goldman Sachs, Canada Pension Plan Investment Board (CPPIB), Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), JERA, BlackRock, and Millennium Management, Asian Development Bank (ADB), British International Investment (BII)

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2011 by Sumant Sinha, an IIT Delhi, IIM Calcutta and Columbia alumnus, who scaled ReNew into a global leader in clean energy with extensive operational capacity.



Sumant Sinha
Founder, Chairman,
CEO

Yulu

Company overview

Yulu is a Bengaluru-based electric shared mobility company, offering micro-mobility solutions through electric bikes and scooters targeted at first- and last-mile connectivity in urban areas.

Business model and value proposition

It operates an asset-heavy shared mobility model, deploying and managing its own fleet of EVs while monetising through pay-per-use rides, subscriptions and B2B partnerships with delivery platforms and enterprises. Battery swapping and fleet utilisation are key cost drivers.

Exhibit 330: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	2.4 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.3) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	135
Last known valuation (USD mn)	210
Notable investors	Blume Ventures, 3one4 Capital, Wavemaker Partners, Magna International, Bajaj Auto Finance

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by Amit Gupta, RK Misra, Naveen Dachuri, Anuj Tewari, Yulu's leadership blends experience in telecom, mobility and operations. The company has benefited from strategic backing by Bajaj Auto, which has supported EV development and manufacturing.



Amit Gupta
Co-Founder, CEO



RK Misra
Co-Founder,
President – Ecosystem Partnerships



Naveen Dachuri
Co-Founder, CTO



Anuj Tewari
Co-Founder, CFO

Simple Energy

Company overview

Simple Energy is a Bengaluru-based electric vehicle company founded in 2019 that designs, engineers and manufactures electric two-wheelers (notably the Simple One and Simple OneS) with a focus on long-range performance, smart features and advanced propulsion technology for the Indian EV market.

Business model and value proposition

The company's model is B2C EV manufacturing and sales, selling premium electric scooters through a growing retail network and dealership presence (over 50+ showrooms), monetising via vehicle sales, retail expansion and enhanced service offerings while building proprietary battery and motor technologies.

Exhibit 331: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.4 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	51
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Haran Family Office, Vasavi Family Office, Sattva Group & Desai Family Office, Dr. Arokiaswamy Velumani (Thyrocare Family Office)

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded by Suhas Rajkumar (CEO) alongside Shreshth Mishra, the leadership combines strong founder-led EV innovation with strategic retail expansion execution; Rajkumar's vision focuses on performance EV products and integrated manufacturing.



Suhas Rajkumar
Founder, CEO



Shreshth Mishra
Co-Founder

Zypp Electric

Company overview

Zypp Electric is a tech-enabled electric vehicles-as-a-service platform focused on last-mile delivery electrification and fleet management, serving businesses with IoT-driven sustainable mobility solutions.

Business model and value proposition

Operates an EV-as-a-service model with subscription and fleet solutions for last-mile deliveries, leveraging AI-and IoT-enabled scooters to optimise routes and reduce emissions for enterprise clients.

Exhibit 332: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	4.55 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.9) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	76.5
Last known valuation (USD mn)	350
Notable investors	IAN Fund, 100 Unicorns, Anthill Ventures, LetsVenture

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, SiliconIndia

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2017 by Akash Gupta, Rashi Agarwal and Tushar Mehta, with Gupta having deep experience in tech and fintech and Agarwal in business management and strategy.



Akash Gupta
Co-Founder, CEO



Rashi Agarwal
Co-Founder, CBO



Tushar Mehta
Co-Founder, COO

Others

Astrotalk

Company overview

Astrotalk is a leading online astrology and spiritual wellness platform in India that connects users with verified astrologers via chat, voice and video consultations. Founded in 2017 and headquartered in Noida, Astrotalk has mainstreamed astrology by combining traditional practices with a mobile-first, on-demand experience, catering to a wide demographic across Tier-1 to Tier-3 cities.

Business model and value proposition

Astrotalk operates a two-sided marketplace model, onboarding astrologers and monetising user interactions on a pay-per-minute / per-session basis. Additional revenue streams include horoscopes, premium features, puja bookings and digital products, while the platform takes a commission from astrologer earnings. High engagement frequency and low customer acquisition costs underpin attractive unit economics.

Exhibit 333: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	12.1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.33 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	34
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Elev8.vc, Left Lane Capital, QED Innovation Labs

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Founded by Puneet Gupta and Anmol Jain (both IITians), Astrotalk's leadership combines strong product thinking with data-driven marketplace execution. Gupta identified astrology as a culturally entrenched but under-digitised category and focused on standardising quality, trust and pricing, key to scaling a traditionally informal service into a tech-led platform.



Puneet Gupta
Founder, CEO



Anmol Jain
Co-Founder

Cashkaro

Company overview

CashKaro is India's largest cashback and coupons platform, enabling users to earn rewards while shopping across e-commerce, travel, fintech and consumer services. Founded in 2013 and headquartered in Gurugram, CashKaro acts as an intermediary between consumers and merchants, driving incremental traffic and conversions.

Business model and value proposition

The company follows an affiliate-led performance marketing model, earning commissions from merchants on successful transactions and sharing a portion of that commission with users as cashback. Revenue is driven by transaction volumes, merchant partnerships and category diversification, with a capital-light structure and strong operating leverage.

Exhibit 334: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.5 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	EBITDA loss of INR (0.2)bn
Total funding raised (USD mn)	32
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Kalaari Capital, Korea Investment Partners, Affle

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded by **Rohan Bhargava and Swati Bhargava** (both London School of Economics alumni), CashKaro's leadership blends consulting, finance and consumer internet expertise. Swati Bhargava has been instrumental in building merchant relationships and scaling the platform; she is also known for her role as a judge on Shark Tank India, enhancing brand visibility. Rohan has been instrumental in driving CashKaro's growth and establishing it as a key player in the Indian online savings landscape.



Swati Bhargava & Rohan Bhargava
Co-Founders

5ire

Company overview

5ire is an India-origin **Layer-1 blockchain ecosystem** positioned around sustainability and impact-driven decentralisation. Founded in 2021 and headquartered across India and global hubs, 5ire aims to build infrastructure that aligns blockchain incentives with the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), differentiating itself from purely financial-driven chains.

Business model and value proposition

5ire operates a Layer-1 protocol and ecosystem model, monetising through network fees, validator participation, staking economics and ecosystem development. The platform incentivises sustainable behaviour via its proprietary “Proof-of-5ire” consensus, which integrates ESG-aligned metrics into network governance and rewards.

Exhibit 335: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	121
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,500
Notable investors	Global Emerging Markets, SRAM & MRAM, Gotbit, Magnus Capital, Extra Watts, Alphabit, Moonrock Capital, 2A Ventures, Marshland Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

5ire was founded by **Pratik Gauri and Prateek Dwivedi**. Pratik Gauri (CEO) has a background in technology, public policy and sustainability advocacy, and is a prominent voice in Web3-for-impact discussions. The founding team positions 5ire at the intersection of blockchain infrastructure, governance and sustainability.



Pratik Gauri
Co-Founder, CEO



Prateek Dwivedi
Co-Founder, CPO

Stader Labs

Company overview

Stader Labs is a leading multi-chain liquid staking protocol, enabling users to stake assets across blockchains like Ethereum, Polygon, BNB Chain and others while retaining liquidity. Founded in 2021, Stader has become a key infrastructure layer within the global DeFi ecosystem.

Business model and value proposition

Stader operates a DeFi protocol model, earning revenue via staking commissions and protocol fees. By issuing liquid staking tokens, Stader allows users to earn staking rewards while deploying capital across DeFi applications, improving capital efficiency and driving protocol adoption.

Exhibit 336: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	16.5
Last known valuation (USD mn)	450 (2022)
Notable investors	Pantera Capital, Three Arrows Capital, Accel, Blockchain.com, True Ventures, and DWeb3 Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

Founded by Amitej Gajjala, Sidhartha Doddipalli, Dheeraj Borra, with strong backgrounds in consulting, fintech and blockchain systems, Stader's leadership combines protocol design expertise with go-to-market execution. The team has focused on building institutional-grade staking infrastructure with strong security and decentralisation principles.



Amitej Gajjala
Co-Founder



Sidhartha Doddipalli
Co-Founder



Dheeraj Borra
Co-Founder

Captain Fresh

Company overview

Captain Fresh is a Bengaluru-based global seafood supply-chain platform that connects fish and seafood producers directly with restaurants, retailers and exporters, with operations across India, the US, Middle East and Southeast Asia.

Business model and value proposition

It runs a full-stack, inventory-led global trade model, managing sourcing, processing, cold-chain logistics and cross-border exports, monetising through product margins and long-term supply contracts.

Exhibit 337: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	34.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.4 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	218
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	Ankur Capital, Incubate Fund India, Matrix Partners India, Accel Partners India, Tiger Global, Prosus

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded by Utham Gowda, the leadership combines ecommerce execution with global agri-export operations and cold-chain logistics expertise.



Utham Gowda
Founder, CEO

Dealshare

Company overview

DealShare is a social commerce / value e-commerce platform (started via WhatsApp groups) that targets price-sensitive buyers in smaller cities with bulk/group buying and deep discounting.

Business model and value proposition

Social + community commerce: group buys, localised catalogue, private labels and aggressive price optimisation; revenue from product margins and repeat consumption in non-metro cohorts.

Exhibit 338: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.7) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	399
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,700
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Alpha Wave Global, Kora, Dragoneer Investment Group, Unilever Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Business Standard

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2018 by Vineet Rao with co-founders Sourjyendu Medda, Sankar Bora and Rajat Shikhar; founding team combined engineering/product and operations backgrounds.



Vineet Rao
Co-Founder



Sankar Bora
Co-Founder



Sourjyendu Medda
Co-Founder



Rajat Shikhar
Co-Founder

Fireflies AI

Company overview

Fireflies.ai is a global **AI-powered meeting assistant and conversation intelligence platform** that automates recording, transcription, summarisation and action-item extraction from spoken conversations across meetings, calls and audio files. Built to work seamlessly with major collaboration tools such as Zoom, Google Meet and Microsoft Teams, Fireflies enables teams to capture and revisit insights from meetings, improving alignment, accountability and productivity.

Business model and value proposition

Fireflies operates a B2B SaaS subscription model with tiered pricing based on user counts, advanced AI features, integrations and enterprise security. Its value proposition centres on turning unstructured verbal conversations into structured, searchable organisational knowledge, automating a traditionally manual task, reducing meeting friction, and enabling downstream workflows like CRM updates, task tracking and analytics.

Exhibit 339: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	33.3
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	Khosla Ventures, f7 Ventures, Canaan Partners, Forum Ventures, Deep Ventures, Acceleprise, Right Side Capital

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Yahoo Finance

Founders and leadership

Fireflies AI was co-founded by Krish Ramineni (Co-Founder and CEO) and Sam Udotong (Co-Founder and CTO). Ramineni, a University of Pennsylvania alumnus and former Microsoft product manager, teamed up with Udotong, an MIT graduate, to tackle the challenge of making meetings more actionable through AI. Starting as a side project in 2015, the product evolved into an enterprise solution that now reaches Fortune 500 companies and millions of users.



Krish Ramineni
Co-Founder, CEO



Sam Udotong
Co-Founder, CTO

Neuron7.ai

Company overview

Neuron7.ai is an AI-driven service resolution intelligence platform that helps global enterprises diagnose and resolve complex customer service and field support issues at scale. Founded in 2020 and headquartered in San Jose, Neuron7 combines structured and unstructured service data with advanced AI and neural networks to provide predictive guidance, turnaround solutions and consistent resolution steps for technical support teams, field technicians and contact centre agents.

Business model and value proposition

Neuron7 operates a B2B enterprise SaaS model tailored to large service organisations, where pricing is linked to scale of deployment, usage and advanced AI modules. The platform’s core value lies in turn-by-turn resolution intelligence, which captures and distills tribal knowledge, manuals and historical service cases into actionable workflows. This reduces resolution times, improves first-time fix rates and consistently elevates customer satisfaction (CSAT) while lowering operational costs.

Exhibit 340: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	NA
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	63
Last known valuation (USD mn)	275
Notable investors	Smith Point Capital, Nexus Venture Partners, Battery Ventures, and ServiceNow Ventures.

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, TechCrunch

Founders and leadership

Neuron7 was co-founded by Niken Patel and Vinay Saini. The founding team has deep experience in enterprise software and service systems, having first identified unmet needs in capturing and operationalising service knowledge across silos.



Niken Patel
Co-Founder, CEO



Vinay Saini
Co-Founder, Head of
Customer and Product
Delivery

Ola Krutrim

Company overview

Ola Krutrim is an AI and generative language model company founded in 2023 by Bhavish Aggarwal, the co-founder of Ola and Ola Electric, to build an India-centric artificial intelligence ecosystem. Krutrim aims to develop large language models (LLMs) and AI infrastructure tailored to India’s linguistic and cultural diversity, supporting multiple Indian languages and vernacular contexts.

Business model and value proposition

Krutrim’s model blends AI R&D, platform licensing, developer APIs and integration services to position India’s first homegrown GenAI stack as an alternative to Western LLM incumbents. Its value proposition is rooted in cultural and linguistic adaptability, offering models that inherently understand Indian dialects, contexts and user needs, and can be deployed across consumer and enterprise applications. By building custom AI stacks and supporting applications such as Kruti, an agentic AI assistant.

Exhibit 341: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	NA
Total funding raised (USD mn)	75
Last known valuation (USD mn)	1,000
Notable investors	Matrix Partners, Bhavish Aggarwal, Sarin Family (Z47)

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Business World

Founders and leadership

Krutrim was founded by Bhavish Aggarwal, an IIT Bombay alumnus and serial entrepreneur; best known as the Co-Founder of Ola Cabs and Ola Electric. Aggarwal’s vision for Krutrim is to create an ‘India-first AI’ that truly reflects local languages and use cases, a strategic pivot from existing global AI models that often under-represent Indian contexts.



Bhavish Aggarwal
Founder

GreyOrange

Company overview

GreyOrange is a global AI-driven robotics and warehouse automation company (headquartered in Roswell, Georgia, USA, with core operations in India and other regions) that builds integrated AI software and autonomous mobile robots to automate warehouse fulfilment and logistics operations for retail, e-commerce and 3PL customers.

Business model and value proposition

GreyOrange's business model combines AI-powered fulfilment orchestration software (GreyMatter™) and autonomous robots (Ranger™ series) in an integrated robotic automation stack, monetising via enterprise robotics and software sales, recurring services and solutions for smart warehousing.

Exhibit 342: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.4 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.1 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	437
Last known valuation (USD mn)	600 (2021)
Notable investors	Tiger Global Management, Blume Ventures, Mitsubishi Corporation, BlackRock, Flipkart

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

GreyOrange was founded in 2011 by Akash Gupta and Samay Kohli. With technical roots in AI and robotics, both bring engineering expertise and global automation vision, having expanded the company's product footprint across the Americas, Europe and Asia.



Akash Gupta
Co-Founder, CEO



Samay Kohli
Co-Founder

Pixxel

Company overview

Pixxel is a Bengaluru-based space technology company building a constellation of hyperspectral Earth-observation satellites for high-resolution imaging and analytics to address climate, agriculture, environment, energy and infrastructure applications globally.

Business model and value proposition

Pixxel's model is a B2B tech and data platform, selling hyperspectral satellite imaging and analytics through subscription and data licensing to enterprises, governments and research organisations, enabled by its in-house satellite manufacturing and ground data platforms.

Exhibit 343: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.3 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.2) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	NA
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Google, GIC, Lightspeed, Radical Ventures, Seraphim Space, M&G Catalyst, Glade Brook Capital, Accenture Ventures, and Blume Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry

Founders and leadership

Founded in 2019 by Awais Ahmed and Kshitij Khandelwal (both BITS Pilani alumni), the leadership blends aerospace, remote sensing and space systems expertise; Pixxel was recognised in TIME's 100 Best Inventions and as a World Economic Forum Technology Pioneer for its hyperspectral imaging innovation.



Awais Ahmed
Co-Founder, CEO



Kshitij Khandelwal
Co-Founder, CTO

Recent developments

Space-tech startup Pixxel is preparing to scale up its satellite manufacturing capacity as demand for its space infrastructure grows, with plans to expand production from its current capacity of 20-25 satellites at a time to as many as 100 over the next one year.

Raphe mPhibr

Company overview

Raphe mPhibr is a Noida-based aerospace and defence technology company that designs, develops and manufactures indigenous Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs), autonomous systems, avionics and related critical aerospace technologies for defence and dual-use applications.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a high-technology aerospace manufacturing model, providing fully integrated design-to-production solutions for UAV platforms (ranging from high-altitude logistics and surveillance drones to swarm-capable systems) and vertically integrates advanced composites, avionics, AI systems and navigation tech to meet defence and strategic needs.

Exhibit 344: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.86 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.09 (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	145
Last known valuation (USD mn)	900
Notable investors	General Catalyst, Think Investments

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Economic Times

Founders and leadership

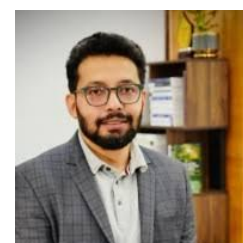
Founded in 2017 by brothers Vikash Mishra and Vivek Mishra (with support from Co-Founder Nitin Katiyar), the leadership brings deep engineering and aerospace expertise. Vikash studied at MIT, and Vivek earned a PhD from Georgia Tech, focusing on autonomous systems, materials and sensor networks.



Vikash Mishra
Co-Founder, Chairman



Vivek Mishra
Co-Founder, CEO



Nitin Katiyar
Co-Founder

Recent Developments

In Jun'25, Raphe mPhibr secured USD 100mn in a funding round led by General Catalyst with participation from Think Investments and others, the largest private defence-tech fundraise in India, bringing its total capital to ~USD 145mn to scale indigenous UAV design, engineering and manufacturing capabilities.

Servify

Company overview

Servify is a **global device lifecycle management platform** that enables OEMs, retailers and telecom operators to manage post-sales services such as warranties, repairs, trade-ins and device protection. Founded in 2015, Servify operates across smartphones, consumer electronics and appliances in multiple international markets.

Business model and value proposition

Servify follows a platform-plus-services model, monetising through long-term enterprise contracts, warranty programs, service fees and device protection plans. Its deep integration with OEM ecosystems creates high switching costs and recurring revenue streams linked to device sales volumes.

Exhibit 345: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	7.8 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.9) (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	130
Last known valuation (USD mn)	700
Notable investors	Iron Pillar, BEENEXT, and Blume Ventures, Singularity AMC, Trifecta Capital, DMI Sparkle Fund, and Bajaj Holdings

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entrackr

Founders and leadership

Sreevathsa Prabhakar is an engineer with over 20 years of experience in customer experience and technology, having worked at companies like Nokia, Tata Teleservices, and Samsung.



Sreevathsa Prabhakar
Founder, CEO

Magicpin

Company overview

Magicpin (Samast Technologies Private Limited) is an Indian hyperlocal discovery and rewards platform founded in 2015. Headquartered in Gurugram, it bridges the gap between offline and online commerce by allowing users to discover local retailers, earn rewards, and transact across various categories like food, fashion, electronics, and pharmacy.

Business model and value proposition

Magicpin operates as a hyperlocal discovery and rewards platform that bridges offline retail with online consumers. Its business model centres around creating a "digital bridge" for local merchants to attract and retain customers through deals, rewards, and data-driven marketing. Users discover nearby stores and earn magicpin points by performing actions like uploading photos of their bills or sharing experiences. For merchants, Magicpin acts as a performance marketing tool where they pay primarily for measurable returns (sales or foot traffic) rather than just visibility.

Exhibit 346: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	8.7 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.08) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	105
Last known valuation (USD mn)	323 (as of Jan'22)
Notable investors	Lightspeed Venture Partners, Zomato, Samsung Venture Investment, and WaterBridge Ventures

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, StoryBoard18

Founders and leadership

Magicpin was founded by Anshoo Sharma (CEO) and Brij Bhushan, both former investors with experience at Lightspeed Venture Partners and Bain & Co.



Anshoo Sharma
Co-founder and CEO



Brij Bhushan
Co-founder

Recent Developments

Magicpin provides its extensive network of over 80,000 restaurants to Rapido's "Ownly" delivery app, while gaining access to Rapido's fleet for last-mile delivery. The company announced a major expansion strategy to increase its active user base from 15 million in 2025 to 20 million by 2026, with food delivery as a key growth driver.

Miko Robotics

Company overview

Miko is a consumer robotics company, founded in 2015 by IIT Bombay alumni, that develops AI-powered companion robots aimed at educating and entertaining children aged 5–10. Their flagship products, Miko 3 and Miko Mini, utilize advanced AI, IoT, and emotional intelligence to engage kids through interactive games, conversation, and learning content.

Business model and value proposition

Miko operates a hybrid business model that combines one-time hardware sales with a growing recurring revenue stream through subscriptions. The company generates its primary revenue from the sale of robotic devices, while increasingly focusing on monetising its content ecosystem through paid subscriptions that offer educational modules, games, and interactive experiences. This shift toward subscription revenue is strategically important, as it enhances customer lifetime value and reduces reliance on one-time hardware purchases. The value proposition for children lies in personalized, conversational learning experiences that adapt to user behavior, making education engaging and interactive.

Exhibit 347: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	3.6 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(1.2) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	155
Last known valuation (USD mn)	550 (as of Aug'25)
Notable investors	iHeartMedia, IvyCap Ventures, Chiratae Ventures, IIFL AMC

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Miko was founded by Sneh Vaswani, Prashant Iyengar, and Chintan Raikar, all of whom are alumni of IIT Bombay. The founding team brings together strong expertise in robotics, artificial intelligence, and product development, which has been instrumental in building a consumer-facing robotics product in a category that has historically seen high failure rates globally. Sneh Vaswani, has been central to shaping the company's strategic direction, particularly in terms of global expansion, partnerships, and positioning Miko as a premium AI learning brand.



Sneh Vaswani
Co-Founder, CEO



Prashant Iyengar
Co-Founder, CTO



Chintan Raikar
Co-Founder, COO

Recent Developments

In November 2025, Miko raised approximately USD 10.5mn from iHeartMedia in a strategic funding round aimed at integrating the latter's extensive audio content library into Miko's ecosystem.

Ultrahuman

Company overview

Ultrahuman is an India-based health and fitness technology company focused on metabolic health, wearable devices, and personalized wellness. Founded in 2019 and headquartered in Bengaluru, the company initially started with continuous glucose monitoring (CGM)-based metabolic tracking and has since evolved into a broader platform combining hardware, software, and biomarkers. It operates globally, with a strong presence in the United States and Europe, positioning itself as a premium, science-backed alternative in the fast-growing wearable health tech market.

Business model and value proposition

Ultrahuman follows a vertically integrated model that combines hardware sales with a high-margin, subscription-driven software ecosystem. The company generates revenue through the sale of devices such as the Ring Air, along with subscription services that provide advanced analytics, coaching, and personalized insights based on user data. Its value proposition is centered around metabolic health optimisation, a relatively underpenetrated but increasingly relevant segment within the broader fitness and wellness industry.

Exhibit 348: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	5.6 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.73 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	100
Last known valuation (USD mn)	600
Notable investors	Nexus Venture Partners, Blume Ventures, Steadview Capital, Alpha Wave Global

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, MoneyControl

Founders and leadership

Ultrahuman was founded by Mohit Kumar and Vatsal Singhal. Mohit Kumar, the CEO, previously co-founded Runnr, a hyperlocal delivery startup that later merged with Zomato, bringing strong entrepreneurial and scaling experience to Ultrahuman. The leadership team combines expertise in consumer technology, product design, and data-driven platforms, which has been instrumental in building a differentiated offering in the highly competitive wearable tech space.



Mohit Kumar
Co-Founder, CEO

Vatsal Singhal
Co-Founder

Garuda Aerospace

Company overview

Garuda Aerospace is a drone technology company providing solutions across agriculture, surveillance, and industrial applications.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a Drone-as-a-Service (DaaS) and manufacturing model, generating revenue from drone sales, leasing, and service contracts (e.g., agri spraying, mapping). Government partnerships play a key role in scaling.

Exhibit 349: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	1.2 (FY25)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	0.2 (FY25)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	49.5
Last known valuation (USD mn)	NA
Notable investors	Venture Catalysts, Nkaresearch, Rishabh homes,

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

Garuda Aerospace was founded by Agnishwar Jayaprakash, who serves as CEO. He has an entrepreneurial background with a strong focus on drone technology and has built the company by leveraging partnerships with government bodies and institutions.



Agnishwar Jayaprakash
Founder & CEO

NewSpace Research & Technologies

Company overview

NewSpace R&T is a deep-tech defense company focused on developing autonomous drone swarms and AI-driven military technologies.

Business model and value proposition

The company operates a B2G contract-driven model, deriving revenue from defence contracts and strategic projects. High entry barriers due to technology complexity and regulatory requirements.

Exhibit 350: Financial snapshot

Financial metrics publicly available	Details
Revenue (INR bn)	0.01 (FY24)
Profit/(Loss) (INR bn)	(0.6) (FY24)
Total funding raised (USD mn)	73.2
Last known valuation (USD mn)	120
Notable investors	Pavestone Technology Fund, 360 ONE (formerly IIFL Wealth), Cornerstone Venture Partners, Volrado Venture Partners, QRG Investments & Holdings, L N Bangur Group

Source: I-Sec research, Industry, Entracker

Founders and leadership

NewSpace Research & Technologies was founded by Sameer Joshi, a former Indian Air Force officer who brings deep expertise in air combat strategy and defence systems. He leads the company's vision and engagement with defence stakeholders.



Sameer Joshi
Founder & CEO

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